

RTL Design Sherpa

RTL AMBA AXI4 Module Reference — Rev 0.90

October 2026

Table of Contents

1 AXI4 (Advanced eXtensible Interface) Modules....32
1.1 Overview....32
1.1.1 Key Features....32
1.1.2 Module Categories....32
1.2 Functional Description....34
1.2.1 Channel Architecture....34
1.2.2 Key Signals....34
1.3 Timing....35
1.3.1 Throughput....35
1.3.2 Latency....35
1.3.3 Resource Usage....35
1.4 Usage Example....37
1.4.1 Basic Read Master....37
1.4.2 Basic Write Slave....38
1.4.3 Monitor Integration....38
1.5 Design Notes....39
1.5.1 Design Patterns....39
1.5.2 ID Width Selection....40
1.5.3 Buffer Depth Guidelines....40
1.5.4 Burst Optimization....40
1.6 Related Modules....40
1.6.1 RTL Design Sherpa Documentation....40

1.6.2 Configuration and Integration....40
1.6.3 Source Code....41
1.7 Testing....41
1.8 References....41
1.8.1 Protocol Specifications....41
1.8.2 Papers and textbooks....42
1.9 Navigation....42
2 axi4_cdc_wr / axi4_cdc_rd....43
2.1 What it is....43
2.2 Parameters....43
2.3 Reset....44
2.4 Throughput and latency....44
2.5 Verification....44
2.6 References....45
3 AXI4 Clock-Gated Variants Guide....46
3.1 Overview....46
3.1.1 Available Clock-Gated Modules....46
3.1.2 Key Features....46
3.2 Parameters....47
3.3 Ports....47
3.3.1 Clock Gating Configuration Inputs....47
3.3.2 Clock Gating Status Outputs....47
3.4 Functional Description....48
3.4.1 Gating Conditions (All Must Be True)....48

3.4.2 Ungating Conditions (Any Triggers Ungating)....48
3.5 Timing....49
3.5.1 Ungating Latency....49
3.5.2 Throughput Impact....49
3.5.3 Sustained Throughput....49
3.6 Usage Example....50
3.6.1 Basic Clock Gating (Master Read)....50
3.6.2 Dynamic Configuration (Runtime Adjustment)....50
3.6.3 System-Level Power Monitoring....51
3.7 Design Notes....52
3.7.1 Idle Count Selection....52
3.7.2 When to Use Clock Gating....52
3.7.3 Traffic Pattern Analysis....52
3.7.4 Power Savings Estimates....53
3.7.5 Measuring Power Savings....53
3.7.6 Test Mode Support....54
3.7.7 Simulation Considerations....54
3.7.8 Synthesis Considerations....54
3.8 Related Modules....54
3.8.1 Base Module Documentation....54
3.8.2 Architecture....55
3.9 References....55
3.10 Navigation....55
4 axi4_dwidth_converter....56

4.1 Overview....56
4.1.1 Key Features....56
4.2 Parameters....57
4.2.1 Width Configuration....57
4.2.2 Buffer Depths....57
4.2.3 Calculated Parameters (Auto)....58
4.3 Ports....58
4.3.1 AXI4 Slave Interface....58
4.3.2 AXI4 Master Interface....58
4.3.3 Status/Debug Outputs....59
4.4 Functional Description....60
4.4.1 Conversion Mechanics....62
4.5 Timing Characteristics....63
4.5.1 Performance Characteristics....63
4.6 Usage Examples....64
4.6.1 Basic Upsize Converter (32-bit → 128-bit)....64
4.6.2 Basic Downsize Converter (128-bit → 32-bit)....65
4.7 Design Notes....66
4.7.1 WIDTH_RATIO Constraints....66
4.7.2 Address Alignment....66
4.7.3 Burst Length Calculation....66
4.7.4 Buffer Depth Guidelines....67
4.8 Related Modules....68
4.8.1 Specialized Converters....68

4.8.2 Core Modules....68
4.8.3 Used Components....68
4.9 References....68
4.9.1 Specifications....68
4.9.2 Source Code....68
4.9.3 Documentation....69
4.10 Navigation....69
5 axi4_master_rd....70
5.1 Overview....70
5.2 Parameters....70
5.3 Ports....71
5.3.1 Module Declaration....71
5.3.2 Clock and Reset....72
5.3.3 Slave AXI Interface (Input Side - FUB)....72
5.3.4 Master AXI Interface (Output Side)....74
5.3.5 Status Interface....75
5.4 Functional Description....76
5.4.1 Block diagram....76
5.4.2 Dual Buffer Design....76
5.4.3 Key Features....76
5.4.4 Address Channel Processing....77
5.4.5 Data Channel Processing....77
5.4.6 Busy Signal Generation....77
5.5 Timing Characteristics....77

5.5.1 Buffer Latency....77
5.5.2 Performance Metrics....77
5.5.3 Transaction Latency....78
5.6 Usage Examples....78
5.7 Design Notes....79
5.7.1 Buffer Depth Selection....79
5.7.2 Burst Optimization....80
5.7.3 Quality of Service (QoS)....80
5.7.4 Transaction Monitoring....80
5.7.5 Error Handling and Recovery....81
5.7.6 Synthesis Considerations....81
5.8 Related Modules....81
5.9 Testing....82
5.9.1 Protocol Compliance....82
5.9.2 Buffer Verification....82
5.9.3 Performance Verification....82
5.10 References....82
5.11 Navigation....83
6 axi4_master_rd_cg....84
6.1 Overview....84
6.2 Parameters....84
6.2.1 Derived Parameters (do not override)....85
6.3 Ports....85
6.4 Functional Description....88

6.4.1 Block diagram....88
6.5 Timing Characteristics....89
6.6 Usage Examples....89
6.7 Design Notes....90
6.8 Related Modules....90
6.9 Testing....90
6.10 References....91
6.11 Navigation....91
7 axi4_master_rd_mon....92
7.1 Overview....92
7.1.1 Key Features....92
7.2 Parameters....92
7.2.1 AXI4 Master Parameters....93
7.2.2 Monitor Parameters....93
7.2.3 Synthesis-Cone Parameters....95
7.2.4 Derived Parameters (do not override)....96
7.3 Ports....96
7.3.1 AXI4 Interfaces....96
7.3.2 Monitor Configuration....97
7.3.3 Monitor Bus Output....99
7.3.4 Status Outputs....100
7.3.5 Packet filters....100
7.4 Functional Description....102
7.4.1 Block diagram....102

7.4.2 Monitor Backpressure (block_ready)....102
7.4.3 Address-Range Checker....103
7.4.4 Performance Monitoring....104
7.4.5 Monitor Packet Format....106
7.5 Timing Characteristics....107
7.6 Waveforms....107
7.6.1 Scenario 1: Single-Beat Read Transaction....107
7.6.2 Scenario 2: AR Channel Handshake Detail....108
7.6.3 Scenario 3: R Response Channel Detail....108
7.6.4 Scenario 4: Complete AXI4 Read Transaction....108
7.6.5 Scenario 5: Monitor Bus Packet Generation....109
7.6.6 Scenario 6: Simple ARVALID Transaction....109
7.6.7 Scenario 7: Alternative Single-Beat Read....109
7.7 Usage Examples....110
7.8 Design Notes....112
7.8.1 Filtering Hierarchy....112
7.8.2 Configuration Conflicts....113
7.8.3 Performance Considerations....113
7.8.4 Transaction Table....113
7.9 Related Modules....113
7.9.1 Companion Monitors....113
7.9.2 Base Modules....113
7.9.3 Used Components....113
7.10 Testing....114

7.11 References....114
7.11.1 Specifications....114
7.11.2 Papers and textbooks....114
7.11.3 Source Code....114
7.11.4 Documentation....115
7.12 Navigation....115
8 axi4_master_rd_mon_cg....116
8.1 Overview....116
8.1.1 Key Differences from Base Module....116
8.1.2 When to Use the Clock-Gated Variant....116
8.2 Parameters....117
8.2.1 Clock Gating Parameters....117
8.2.2 Base Module Parameters....119
8.2.3 Filter configuration (forwarded)....120
8.2.4 Parameter Relationships....121
8.2.5 Derived Parameters (do not override)....121
8.3 Ports....121
8.4 Functional Description....127
8.4.1 Block diagram....127
8.4.2 Clock Gating Architecture....127
8.4.3 Gating State Machine....128
8.4.4 Performance Monitoring....128
8.5 Timing Characteristics....129
8.5.1 Wake-Up and Gating Latency....129

8.6 Usage Examples....129
8.6.1 Example 1: Maximum Power Savings (Burst Traffic)....129
8.6.2 Example 2: Balanced Performance and Power....130
8.6.3 Example 3: Clock Gating Disabled (Functional Verification)....130
8.7 Design Notes....131
8.7.1 Power Savings Analysis....131
8.7.2 Power Monitoring Signals....131
8.7.3 Verification Considerations....132
8.7.4 Synthesis Considerations....132
8.8 Related Modules....132
8.8.1 See Also....133
8.9 Testing....133
8.10 References....133
8.11 Navigation....134
9 AXI4 Master Read Stub....135
9.1 Overview....135
9.1.1 Key Features....135
9.2 Parameters....135
9.3 Ports....136
9.3.1 Clock and Reset....136
9.3.2 AXI4 Read Address Channel (AR)....136
9.3.3 AXI4 Read Data Channel (R)....137
9.3.4 AR Packet Interface....137
9.3.5 R Packet Interface....138

9.4 Functional Description 138
9.4.1 Block diagram 138
9.4.2 Packet Formats 139
9.5 Timing Characteristics 140
9.6 Usage Examples 140
9.7 Design Notes 142
9.7.1 Skid Buffer Operation 142
9.7.2 Packet Packing Order 142
9.7.3 Internal Architecture 142
9.8 Related Modules 143
9.9 Testing 143
9.10 References 143
9.11 Navigation 144
10 AXI4 Master Stub 145
10.1 Overview 145
10.1.1 Key Features 145
10.2 Parameters 145
10.3 Ports 147
10.3.1 Clock and Reset 147
10.3.2 AXI4 Write Channels 147
10.3.3 AXI4 Read Channels 148
10.3.4 Write Packet Interfaces 149
10.3.5 Read Packet Interfaces 150
10.4 Functional Description 151

10.4.1 Block diagram....151
10.4.2 Packet Formats....151
10.4.3 Transaction Flow....152
10.5 Timing Characteristics....153
10.6 Usage Examples....153
10.7 Design Notes....156
10.7.1 Internal Architecture....156
10.7.2 Read/Write Independence....156
10.7.3 Skid Buffer Depths....157
10.8 Related Modules....157
10.9 Testing....157
10.10 References....157
10.11 Navigation....158
11 AXI4 Master Write....159
11.1 Overview....159
11.1.1 Key Features....159
11.2 Parameters....159
11.2.1 Derived Parameters (do not override)....160
11.3 Ports....160
11.3.1 Clock and Reset....162
11.3.2 Frontend AXI Interface (fub_axi_*)....162
11.3.3 Master AXI Interface (m_axi_*)....164
11.3.4 Status Outputs....164
11.4 Functional Description....164

11.4.1 Block diagram....164
11.4.2 Architecture....165
11.4.3 Channel Operations....165
11.4.4 Busy Signal....165
11.5 Timing Characteristics....166
11.6 Usage Examples....166
11.7 Design Notes....167
11.7.1 Buffer Depth Selection....167
11.7.2 Recommended Configurations....168
11.7.3 Buffer Independence....168
11.7.4 Packet Preservation....168
11.7.5 Backpressure Handling....169
11.7.6 Reset Behavior....169
11.8 Related Modules....169
11.8.1 Companion Modules....169
11.8.2 Used Components....169
11.8.3 Related Infrastructure....169
11.9 Testing....169
11.10 References....170
11.10.1 Specifications....170
11.10.2 Papers and textbooks....170
11.10.3 Source Code....170
11.10.4 Documentation....171
11.11 Navigation....171

12 AXI4 Master Write Interface (Clock-Gated)....172
12.1 Overview....172
12.2 Parameters....172
12.2.1 Derived Parameters (do not override)....173
12.3 Ports....173
12.4 Functional Description....176
12.4.1 Block diagram....176
12.5 Timing Characteristics....177
12.6 Usage Examples....177
12.7 Design Notes....178
12.8 Related Modules....178
12.9 Testing....178
12.10 References....179
12.11 Navigation....179
13 AXI4 Master Write Monitor....180
13.1 Overview....180
13.1.1 Key Features....180
13.2 Parameters....180
13.2.1 AXI4 Master Parameters....181
13.2.2 Monitor Parameters....181
13.2.3 Synthesis-Cone Parameters....183
13.2.4 Derived Parameters (do not override)....184
13.3 Ports....184
13.3.1 AXI4 Write Channels....184

13.3.2 Monitor Configuration....185
13.3.3 Monitor Bus Output....185
13.3.4 Status Outputs....186
13.3.5 Packet filters....186
13.4 Functional Description....188
13.4.1 Block diagram....188
13.4.2 Monitor Backpressure (block_ready)....188
13.4.3 Address-Range Checker....189
13.4.4 Performance Monitoring....190
13.4.5 Monitor Packet Format....192
13.5 Timing Characteristics....193
13.6 Waveforms....193
13.6.1 Scenario 1: Single-Beat Write Transaction....193
13.6.2 Scenario 2: Alternative Single-Beat Write....194
13.7 Usage Examples....194
13.7.1 Configuration Strategies....194
13.7.2 Basic Integration....195
13.8 Design Notes....197
13.8.1 Write-Specific Monitoring....197
13.8.2 Performance Considerations....197
13.8.3 Buffer Depth Guidelines....197
13.9 Related Modules....197
13.9.1 Companion Monitors....197
13.9.2 Base Modules....198

13.9.3 Used Components....198
13.10 Testing....198
13.11 References....198
13.11.1 Specifications....198
13.11.2 Papers and textbooks....198
13.11.3 Source Code....199
13.11.4 Documentation....199
13.12 Navigation....199
14 AXI4 Master Write Monitor (Clock-Gated)....200
14.1 Overview....200
14.2 Parameters....200
14.2.1 Filter configuration (forwarded)....203
14.2.2 Derived Parameters (do not override)....204
14.3 Ports....204
14.4 Functional Description....210
14.4.1 Block diagram....210
14.4.2 Performance Monitoring....210
14.5 Timing Characteristics....211
14.6 Usage Examples....211
14.7 Design Notes....212
14.8 Related Modules....212
14.9 Testing....213
14.10 References....213
14.11 Navigation....214

15 AXI4 Master Write Stub 215
15.1 Overview 215
15.1.1 Key Features 215
15.2 Parameters 215
15.3 Ports 216
15.3.1 Clock and Reset 216
15.3.2 AXI4 Write Address Channel (AW) 216
15.3.3 AXI4 Write Data Channel (W) 217
15.3.4 AXI4 Write Response Channel (B) 217
15.3.5 AW Packet Interface 218
15.3.6 W Packet Interface 218
15.3.7 B Packet Interface 218
15.4 Functional Description 219
15.4.1 Block diagram 219
15.4.2 Packet Formats 219
15.5 Timing Characteristics 221
15.6 Usage Examples 222
15.7 Design Notes 224
15.7.1 Skid Buffer Operation 224
15.7.2 Channel Independence 224
15.7.3 Packet Packing Order 224
15.7.4 Internal Architecture 224
15.8 Related Modules 224
15.9 Testing 225

15.10 References....225
15.11 Navigation....226
16 AXI4 Slave Read....227
16.1 Overview....227
16.1.1 Key Features....227
16.2 Parameters....227
16.2.1 Derived Parameters (do not override)....228
16.3 Ports....228
16.3.1 Clock and Reset....230
16.3.2 Slave AXI Interface (s_axi_*)....230
16.3.3 Backend Interface (fub_axi_*)....231
16.3.4 Status Outputs....231
16.4 Functional Description....232
16.4.1 Block diagram....232
16.4.2 Architecture....232
16.4.3 Channel Operations....232
16.4.4 Busy Signal....233
16.5 Timing Characteristics....233
16.6 Usage Examples....233
16.7 Design Notes....235
16.7.1 Buffer Depth Selection....235
16.7.2 Recommended Configurations....235
16.7.3 Buffer Independence....235
16.7.4 Packet Preservation....235

16.7.5 Backpressure Handling....236
16.7.6 ID and Burst Handling....236
16.7.7 Reset Behavior....236
16.8 Related Modules....236
16.8.1 Companion Modules....236
16.8.2 Used Components....236
16.8.3 Related Infrastructure....236
16.9 Testing....236
16.10 References....237
16.10.1 Specifications....237
16.10.2 Papers and textbooks....237
16.10.3 Source Code....237
16.10.4 Documentation....238
16.11 Navigation....238
17 AXI4 Slave Read Interface (Clock-Gated)....239
17.1 Overview....239
17.2 Parameters....239
17.2.1 Derived Parameters (do not override)....240
17.3 Ports....240
17.4 Functional Description....243
17.4.1 Block diagram....243
17.5 Timing Characteristics....244
17.6 Usage Examples....244
17.7 Design Notes....245

17.8 Related Modules....245
17.9 Testing....245
17.10 References....246
17.11 Navigation....246
18 AXI4 Slave Read Monitor....247
18.1 Overview....247
18.1.1 Key Features....247
18.2 Parameters....247
18.2.1 AXI4 Slave Parameters....248
18.2.2 Monitor Parameters....248
18.2.3 Synthesis-Cone Parameters....250
18.2.4 Derived Parameters (do not override)....251
18.3 Ports....251
18.3.1 AXI4 Read Channels....251
18.3.2 Monitor Configuration....252
18.3.3 Monitor Bus Output....252
18.3.4 Status Outputs....253
18.3.5 Packet filters....253
18.4 Functional Description....255
18.4.1 Block diagram....255
18.4.2 Monitor Backpressure (block_ready)....255
18.4.3 Address-Range Checker....256
18.4.4 Performance Monitoring....257
18.4.5 Monitor Packet Format....259

18.5 Timing Characteristics....259
18.6 Waveforms....260
18.6.1 Scenario 1: Single-Beat Read (Slave View)....260
18.6.2 Scenario 2: Alternative Single-Beat Read (Slave View)....260
18.7 Usage Examples....261
18.8 Design Notes....263
18.8.1 Slave-Side Monitoring....263
18.8.2 Performance Considerations....263
18.8.3 Buffer Depth Guidelines....264
18.9 Related Modules....264
18.9.1 Companion Monitors....264
18.9.2 Base Modules....264
18.9.3 Used Components....264
18.10 Testing....264
18.11 References....264
18.11.1 Specifications....264
18.11.2 Papers and textbooks....265
18.11.3 Source Code....265
18.11.4 Documentation....265
18.12 Navigation....265
19 AXI4 Slave Read Monitor (Clock-Gated)....266
19.1 Overview....266
19.2 Parameters....266
19.2.1 Filter configuration (forwarded)....268

19.2.2 Derived Parameters (do not override)....269
19.3 Ports....270
19.4 Functional Description....275
19.4.1 Block diagram....275
19.4.2 Performance Monitoring....275
19.5 Timing Characteristics....276
19.6 Usage Examples....276
19.7 Design Notes....277
19.8 Related Modules....277
19.9 Testing....278
19.10 References....278
19.11 Navigation....279
20 AXI4 Slave Read Stub....280
20.1 Overview....280
20.1.1 Key Features....280
20.2 Parameters....280
20.3 Ports....281
20.3.1 Clock and Reset....281
20.3.2 AXI4 Read Address Channel (AR)....281
20.3.3 AXI4 Read Data Channel (R)....282
20.3.4 AR Packet Interface....282
20.3.5 R Packet Interface....283
20.4 Functional Description....283
20.4.1 Block diagram....283

20.4.2 Packet Formats....283
20.5 Timing Characteristics....285
20.6 Usage Examples....285
20.7 Design Notes....287
20.7.1 Skid Buffer Operation....287
20.7.2 Packet Packing Order....287
20.7.3 Internal Architecture....287
20.8 Related Modules....287
20.9 Testing....288
20.10 References....288
20.11 Navigation....289
21 AXI4 Slave Stub....290
21.1 Overview....290
21.1.1 Key Features....290
21.2 Parameters....290
21.3 Ports....292
21.3.1 Clock and Reset....292
21.3.2 AXI4 Write Channels....292
21.3.3 AXI4 Read Channels....293
21.3.4 Write Packet Interfaces....294
21.3.5 Read Packet Interfaces....295
21.4 Functional Description....296
21.4.1 Block diagram....296
21.4.2 Architecture....296

21.4.3 Packet Formats 296
21.4.4 Transaction Flow 297
21.5 Timing Characteristics 298
21.6 Usage Examples 298
21.7 Design Notes 301
21.7.1 Internal Architecture 301
21.7.2 Read/Write Independence 301
21.7.3 Skid Buffer Depths 301
21.7.4 Memory Model Integration 302
21.8 Related Modules 302
21.9 Testing 302
21.10 References 303
21.11 Navigation 303
22 AXI4 Slave Write 304
22.1 Overview 304
22.1.1 Key Features 304
22.2 Parameters 304
22.3 Ports 305
22.3.1 Clock and Reset 307
22.3.2 Slave AXI Interface (s_axi_*) 307
22.3.3 Backend Interface (fub_axi_*) 309
22.3.4 Status Outputs 309
22.4 Functional Description 309
22.4.1 Block diagram 309

22.4.2 Architecture....310
22.4.3 Channel Operations....310
22.4.4 Busy Signal....310
22.5 Timing Characteristics....311
22.6 Usage Examples....311
22.7 Design Notes....312
22.7.1 Buffer Depth Selection....312
22.7.2 Recommended Configurations....313
22.7.3 Buffer Independence....313
22.7.4 Packet Preservation....313
22.7.5 Backpressure Handling....314
22.7.6 ID and Burst Handling....314
22.7.7 Reset Behavior....314
22.8 Related Modules....314
22.8.1 Companion Modules....314
22.8.2 Used Components....314
22.8.3 Related Infrastructure....314
22.9 Testing....314
22.10 References....315
22.10.1 Specifications....315
22.10.2 Papers and textbooks....315
22.10.3 Source Code....315
22.10.4 Documentation....316
22.11 Navigation....316

23 AXI4 Slave Write Interface (Clock-Gated)....317
23.1 Overview....317
23.2 Parameters....317
23.2.1 Derived Parameters (do not override)....318
23.3 Ports....318
23.4 Functional Description....321
23.4.1 Block diagram....321
23.5 Timing Characteristics....322
23.6 Usage Examples....322
23.7 Design Notes....323
23.8 Related Modules....323
23.9 Testing....323
23.10 References....324
23.11 Navigation....324
24 AXI4 Slave Write Monitor....325
24.1 Overview....325
24.1.1 Key Features....325
24.2 Parameters....325
24.2.1 AXI4 Slave Parameters....326
24.2.2 Monitor Parameters....326
24.2.3 Synthesis-Cone Parameters....328
24.2.4 Derived Parameters (do not override)....329
24.3 Ports....329
24.3.1 AXI4 Write Channels....329

24.3.2 Monitor Configuration....330
24.3.3 Monitor Bus Output....330
24.3.4 Status Outputs....331
24.3.5 Packet filters....331
24.4 Functional Description....333
24.4.1 Block diagram....333
24.4.2 Monitor Backpressure (block_ready)....333
24.4.3 Address-Range Checker....334
24.4.4 Performance Monitoring....335
24.4.5 Monitor Packet Format....337
24.5 Timing Characteristics....337
24.6 Waveforms....338
24.6.1 Scenario 1: Single-Beat Write (Slave View)....338
24.6.2 Scenario 2: Alternative Single-Beat Write (Slave View)....338
24.7 Usage Examples....339
24.8 Design Notes....341
24.8.1 Configuration Strategies....341
24.8.2 Slave-Side Monitoring....342
24.8.3 Performance Considerations....343
24.8.4 Buffer Depth Guidelines....343
24.8.5 Write Transaction Characteristics....343
24.9 Related Modules....343
24.9.1 Companion Monitors....343
24.9.2 Base Modules....343

24.9.3 Used Components....343
24.10 Testing....344
24.11 References....344
24.11.1 Specifications....344
24.11.2 Papers and textbooks....344
24.11.3 Source Code....344
24.11.4 Documentation....344
24.12 Navigation....345
25 AXI4 Slave Write Monitor (Clock-Gated)....346
25.1 Overview....346
25.2 Parameters....346
25.2.1 Filter configuration (forwarded)....349
25.2.2 Derived Parameters (do not override)....349
25.3 Ports....350
25.4 Functional Description....355
25.4.1 Block diagram....355
25.4.2 Performance Monitoring....356
25.5 Timing Characteristics....356
25.6 Usage Examples....357
25.7 Design Notes....357
25.8 Related Modules....358
25.9 Testing....358
25.10 References....358
25.11 Navigation....359

26 AXI4 Slave Write Stub 360
26.1 Overview 360
26.1.1 Key Features 360
26.2 Parameters 360
26.3 Ports 361
26.3.1 Clock and Reset 361
26.3.2 AXI4 Write Address Channel (AW) 361
26.3.3 AXI4 Write Data Channel (W) 362
26.3.4 AXI4 Write Response Channel (B) 362
26.3.5 AW Packet Interface 363
26.3.6 W Packet Interface 363
26.3.7 B Packet Interface 363
26.4 Functional Description 364
26.4.1 Block diagram 364
26.4.2 Architecture 364
26.4.3 Packet Formats 364
26.5 Timing Characteristics 366
26.6 Usage Examples 367
26.7 Design Notes 369
26.7.1 Skid Buffer Operation 369
26.7.2 Channel Independence 369
26.7.3 Packet Packing Order 369
26.7.4 Internal Architecture 369
26.8 Related Modules 369

26.9 Testing.....369
26.10 References.....370
26.11 Navigation.....370

1 AXI4 (Advanced eXtensible Interface) Modules

Location: `rtl/amba/axi4/` **Test Location:** `val/amba/` **Status:** Production Ready

1.1 Overview

The AXI4 subsystem is a complete implementation of the ARM AMBA AXI4 protocol: masters, slaves, monitors, data width converters, and interconnect components. AXI4 is the high-performance, high-frequency protocol in the AMBA family, designed for multi-master, multi-slave systems with out-of-order transaction support. This page is the map — what exists, where it lives, and how the pieces fit together.

1.1.1 Key Features

- **Full AXI4 Protocol Support:** Complete implementation of read and write channels
- **Burst Transactions:** Support for fixed, incrementing, and wrapping bursts
- **Out-of-Order Transparent:** `AxID`/`RID`/`BID` are carried end-to-end, so out-of-order slaves are supported; the buffer modules themselves are ID-agnostic pass-throughs and do not reorder or track transactions
- **Quality of Service (QoS):** Priority-based arbitration support
- **Monitoring Infrastructure:** Comprehensive verification and debug capabilities
- **Data Width Conversion:** Automatic upsizing and downsizing
- **Clock Gating Variants:** Power-optimized versions with dynamic gating

1.1.2 Module Categories

1.1.2.1 Core Master/Slave Modules

Module	Description	Documentation	Status
axi4_master_rd	AXI4 read master with buffered channels	axi4_master_rd.md	Documented
axi4_master_wr	AXI4 write master with buffered channels	axi4_master_wr.md	Documented
axi4_cdc_wr	AXI4 channels across	axi4_cdc.md	Documented

Module	Description	Documentation	Status
/ **axi4_cdc_rd**	a clock-domain boundary, one async FIFO per channel		
axi4_slave_rd	AXI4 read slave with buffered channels	axi4_slave_rd.md	Documented
axi4_slave_wr	AXI4 write slave with buffered channels	axi4_slave_wr.md	Documented

1.1.2.2 Monitor Modules (Verification)

Module	Description	Documentation	Status
axi4_master_rd_mon	Read master with integrated monitoring	axi4_master_rd_mon.md	Documented
axi4_master_wr_mon	Write master with integrated monitoring	axi4_master_wr_mon.md	Documented
axi4_slave_rd_mon	Read slave with integrated monitoring	axi4_slave_rd_mon.md	Documented
axi4_slave_wr_mon	Write slave with integrated monitoring	axi4_slave_wr_mon.md	Documented

1.1.2.3 Data Width Converters

Module	Description	Documentation	Status
axi4_dwidth_converter	Bidirectional data width conversion	axi4_dwidth_converter.md	Planned - no RTL
axi4_dwidth_converter_rd	Read-only data width conversion	converters MAS 2.6	Not in rtl/amba — converters component
axi4_dwidth_converter_wr	Write-only data width conversion	converters MAS 2.5	Not in rtl/amba — converters component

The converters live in `projects/components/utility-ip/converters/rtl/`, not `rtl/amba/axi4/`.

1.1.2.4 Clock-Gated Variants

All clock-gated variants documented in: axi4_clock_gating_guide.md

Module	Base Module	Status
axi4_master_rd_cg	axi4_master_rd	Documented
axi4_master_wr_cg	axi4_master_wr	Documented
axi4_slave_rd_cg	axi4_slave_rd	Documented
axi4_slave_wr_cg	axi4_slave_wr	Documented
axi4_master_rd_mon_cg	axi4_master_rd_mon	Documented
axi4_master_wr_mon_cg	axi4_master_wr_mon	Documented
axi4_slave_rd_mon_cg	axi4_slave_rd_mon	Documented
axi4_slave_wr_mon_cg	axi4_slave_wr_mon	Documented

1.2 Functional Description

1.2.1 Channel Architecture

AXI4 uses five independent channels for read and write transactions:

Write Transaction: 1. **AW (Write Address)** - Master → Slave: Address and control 2. **W (Write Data)** - Master → Slave: Data and strobes 3. **B (Write Response)** - Slave → Master: Completion status

Read Transaction: 1. **AR (Read Address)** - Master → Slave: Address and control 2. **R (Read Data)** - Slave → Master: Data and response

1.2.2 Key Signals

Address Channels (AR/AW): - `ARID/AWID` - Transaction ID for reordering - `ARADDR/AWADDR` - Byte address - `ARLEN/AWLEN` - Burst length (1-256 beats) - `ARSIZE/AWSIZE` - Transfer size (1, 2, 4, 8, 16, ... 128 bytes) - `ARBURST/AWBURST` - Burst type (FIXED, INCR, WRAP) - `ARCACHE/AWCACHE` - Cache attributes - `ARPROT/AWPROT` - Protection attributes - `ARQOS/AWQOS` - Quality of Service

Data Channels (R/W): - `RID` - Read data transaction ID - `RDATA/WDATA` - Transfer data - `RRESP/BRESP` - Response (OKAY, EXOKAY, SLVERR, DECERR) - `RLAST/WLAST` - Last transfer in burst - `WSTRB` - Write strobes (byte lane enables)

AXI4 vs AXI3 note: AXI4 removed `WID`. Write data beats are matched to their address by ordering alone, so write bursts from a single master cannot be interleaved. None of the modules here implement or expect `WID`.

Exclusive access: `EXOKAY` appears in the `RRESP`/`BRESP` encodings because it is part of the AXI4 protocol, but no module in this subsystem implements an exclusive monitor. `AxLOCK` and any `EXOKAY` response are carried through untouched; exclusive-access semantics must be provided by the endpoint slave.

1.3 Timing

1.3.1 Throughput

Configuration	Address CH	Data CH	Notes
Single transaction	1 txn/cycle	1 beat/cycle	When buffers not stalled
Burst (len=16)	1 txn/16 cycles	1 beat/cycle	Sustained
Multiple outstanding	Up to MAX_TRANS	1 beat/cycle	Out-of-order

1.3.2 Latency

Path	Cycles	Notes
AR → R (single)	2-3	Minimum read latency
AW → B (single)	2-3	Minimum write latency
Buffer overhead	+1 per channel	Skid buffer latency

1.3.3 Resource Usage

Module Type	LUTs	FFs	BRAM	Notes
Master/Slave (32-bit)	~500	~330	0	Per direction (rd/wr). FFs are the SKID payloads: AR 70 b x 2 + R 44 b x 4 +

Module Type	LUTs	FFs	BRAM	Notes
				control
Monitor (+mon)	thousands	>**10,000**	0	At the default `MAX_TRANSACTIONS = 16`. See below – this is NOT a small addition
Clock-gated (+cg)	not measured	+**5**	0	Counted from the RTL: `r_wakeup` (1 FF, `amba_clock_gate_ctrl`) + `r_idle_counter` (`IDLE_CNTR_WIDTH`, default 4, `clock_gate_ctrl`). Scales as 1 + `CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH`. The ICG is a latch/BUFGCE, not a fabric flop

The monitor row deserves the emphasis. It is a structural floor, counted from the RTL rather than estimated, so synthesis can only add to it:

Contributor	FFs	Where
Transaction table	4,560	`bus_transaction_t` is 285 bits x `MAX_TRANSACTIONS` = 16
Reporter's local copy	4,560	`r_trans_table_local` – a

Contributor	FFs	Where
		second full snapshot
Timeout timers	768	3 phases x 16 slots x 16 bits
Threshold latency	512	16 slots x 32 bits
Floor	**>10,000**	plus the interrupt FIFO and the CAM compare/priority-encoder LUTs

This table previously said “+800 FFs”, which is roughly **13x low**. Budget a monitored interface accordingly: four monitors is tens of thousands of flops, not a few thousand. `MAX_TRANSACTIONS` is the knob – the cost is linear in it, and `NUM_BANKS` exists because 40 slots did not close timing where 16 did.

1.4 Usage Example

1.4.1 Basic Read Master

```
axi4_master_rd #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AR(2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_R(4),
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH(4),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH(64)
) u_rd_master (
    .aclk           (axi_clk),
    .aresetn        (axi_resetn),

    // Frontend interface
    .fub_axi_arid     (cpu_arid),
    .fub_axi_araddr   (cpu_araddr),
    .fub_axi_arlen    (cpu_arlen),
    // ... rest of AR/R signals

    // Master interface
    .m_axi_arid       (m_axi_arid),
    .m_axi_araddr     (m_axi_araddr),
    // ... rest of AR/R signals

    .busy             (rd_busy)
);
```

1.4.2 Basic Write Slave

```
axi4_slave_wr #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AW(2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_W(4),
    .SKID_DEPTH_B(2),
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH(4),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH(64)
) u_wr_slave (
    .aclk             (axi_clk),
    .aresetn          (axi_resetn),

    // Slave interface (from interconnect)
    .s_axi_awid       (s_axi_awid),
    .s_axi_awaddr     (s_axi_awaddr),
    // ... rest of AW/W/B signals

    // Backend interface (to memory/logic)
    .fub_axi_awid     (mem_awid),
    .fub_axi_awaddr   (mem_awaddr),
    // ... rest of AW/W/B signals

    .busy             (wr_busy)
);
```

1.4.3 Monitor Integration

```
axi4_master_rd_mon #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AR(2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_R(4),
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH(4),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH(64),
    .UNIT_ID(1),
    .AGENT_ID(10),
    .MAX_TRANSACTIONS(16),
    .ENABLE_FILTERING(1)
) u_rd_mon (
    .aclk               (axi_clk),
    .aresetn            (axi_resetn),

    // AXI interfaces
    .fub_axi_*(frontend_axi_*),
    .m_axi_*(master_axi_*),

    // Monitor configuration
    .cfg_monitor_enable     (1'b1),
```

```
    .cfg_error_enable       (1'b1),
    .cfg_timeout_enable     (1'b1),
    .cfg_perf_enable        (1'b0),
    .cfg_timeout_cycles     (16'd1000),

    // Filtering configuration
    .cfg_axi_pkt_mask       (16'b1111_1111_0000_0011),
    .cfg_axi_error_mask     (16'h0000),
    // ... rest of mask signals

    // Monitor bus output
    .monbus_valid           (mon_valid),
    .monbus_ready           (mon_ready),
    .monbus_packet          (mon_packet),

    // Status
    .busy                   (rd_busy),
    .active_transactions    (rd_active),
    .error_count            (rd_errors)
);
```

1.5 Design Notes

1.5.1 Design Patterns

1.5.1.1 Pattern 1: Buffered Master/Slave

All core modules use `gaxi_skid_buffer` for elastic buffering: - Decouples frontend and backend timing - Configurable depth per channel - Minimal latency overhead (1 cycle) - Full backpressure handling

1.5.1.2 Pattern 2: Monitor Integration

Monitor modules combine functional core with verification: - Non-invasive monitoring (tap signals) - 2-Level Filtering: packet-type drop masks + per-event masks (err_select is reserved – no routing) - 128-bit standardized monitor bus + 64-bit side-band timestamp (`monitor_common_pkg::monitor_packet_t` / `monbus_timestamp_t`; field layout is documented in the monitor bus group reference) - Real-time error detection

1.5.1.3 Pattern 3: Clock Gating

Clock-gated variants (`*_cg`) add power management: - Dynamic clock gating based on busy signal - Test mode support for scan insertion - Minimal area overhead

1.5.2 ID Width Selection

Choose ID width based on system requirements: - **4 bits (16 IDs):** Single master systems, simple slaves - **8 bits (256 IDs):** Multi-master systems, reordering support - **12+ bits:** Large systems, extensive out-of-order capability

1.5.3 Buffer Depth Guidelines

`SKID_DEPTH_*` is an entry count, not a log2 exponent: `SKID_DEPTH_AR = 2` gives a 2-entry buffer, not 4. The underlying `gaxi_skid_buffer` allocates one register slot per entry and tracks occupancy with a 4-bit counter; legal values are 2..8 inclusive (any integer – odd depths are legal). Values above 8 fail elaboration (the guard errors rather than overflowing); place a `gaxi_fifo_sync` stage ahead of the module when deeper elasticity is required.

Address Channels (AR/AW): - Default: 2 entries - sufficient for most cases - Increase for high-latency address decode or frequent backpressure

Data Channels (R/W): - Default: 4 entries - accommodates moderate bursts - Increase for large bursts (AWLEN/ARLEN > 8) - Use 8 entries for variable latency backends

Response Channel (B): - Default: 2 entries - responses are single-beat - Increase for many concurrent outstanding writes

1.5.4 Burst Optimization

Optimize burst parameters for efficiency:

```
// Cache line burst (64 bytes, 8x 64-bit)
.ARLEN    = 8'd7,          // 8 beats
.ARSIZE   = 3'b011,        // 8 bytes per beat
.ARBURST  = 2'b01          // INCR
```

1.6 Related Modules

1.6.1 RTL Design Sherpa Documentation

- **rtl-amba Overview** - Complete AMBA subsystem architecture
- **APB Modules** - Advanced Peripheral Bus
- **AXIL4 Modules** - AXI4-Lite (simplified protocol)
- **AXIS4 Modules** - AXI4-Stream (streaming data)
- **GAXI Modules** - Generic AXI utilities (buffers, FIFOs)

1.6.2 Configuration and Integration

- **AXI Monitor Configuration Guide** - Monitor setup strategies

- **Monitor Packet Specification** - 128-bit packet format (+ 64-bit side-band timestamp)

1.6.3 Source Code

- RTL: `rtl/amba/axi4/`
- Tests: `val/amba/test_axi4*.py`
- Framework: `bin/TBClasses/components/axi4/`
- Shared Infrastructure: `rtl/amba/shared/` (monitor base, transaction manager)

1.7 Testing

All AXI4 modules are verified using CocoTB-based testbenches:

```
# Run all AXI4 tests
pytest val/amba/test_axi4*.py -v

# Run specific module tests
pytest val/amba/test_axi4_master_rd.py -v
pytest val/amba/test_axi4_slave_wr.py -v
pytest val/amba/test_axi4_master_rd_mon.py -v

# Run data width converter tests
pytest val/amba/test_axi4_dwidth_converter*.py -v

# Run with waveforms
pytest val/amba/test_axi4_master_rd.py --vcd=waves.vcd -v
```

1.8 References

1.8.1 Protocol Specifications

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – the AXI4 interface: §A3.2 “Basic read and write transactions”, §A3.3 “Relationships between the channels”, §A3.4 “Transaction structure” (burst types, the 4KB rule, responses), ch. A5 “Transaction Identifiers”, §A7.2 “Exclusive accesses”. Issue H is the last issue that defines AXI4; Issue J onward removed AXI3/AXI4 content.

- Arm. *AMBA AXI Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue L, Aug. 2025. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/latest – the current issue, for the AXI5 features the sibling family carries.

1.8.2 Papers and textbooks

- Carloni, L.P., McMillan, K.L., Sangiovanni-Vincentelli, A.L. “Theory of Latency-Insensitive Design.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 20(9), Sept. 2001. DOI: 10.1109/43.945302 – register slices as relay stations.
- Cortadella, J., Kishinevsky, M., Grundmann, B. “Synthesis of Synchronous Elastic Architectures.” *Proc. 43rd Design Automation Conference (DAC ’06)*, July 2006, pp. 657-662. DOI: 10.1145/1146909.1147077 – the elastic (skid) buffer under every wrapper.
- Maaref, M. *Architecting and Building High-Speed SoCs*, Packt, 2022, ch. 3 “Basic and Advanced On-Chip Busses and Interconnects” (“AXI bus protocol overview”) – textbook overview (secondary source).
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF: `LatencyInsensitiveDesign__Carloni2001.pdf`, `ElasticBuffer__Cortadella2006.pdf`)

Last Updated: 2025-10-20

1.9 Navigation

- **← Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **← Back to Main Documentation Index**

2 axi4_cdc_wr / axi4_cdc_rd

Files: `rtl/amba/axi4/axi4_cdc_wr.sv`, `rtl/amba/axi4/axi4_cdc_rd.sv` **Filelists:** `rtl/amba/filelists/axi4_cdc_wr.f`, `axi4_cdc_rd.f` (each `-f`'s `rtl/cdc/filelists/gaxi_fifo_async.f`) **Test:** `val/amba/test_axi4_cdc.py` (`bin/TBClasses/amba/axi4_cdc_tb.py`)

2.1 What it is

AXI4 channels carried across a clock-domain boundary: `s_axi_*` on `s_aclk`/`s_aresetn`, `m_axi_*` on `m_aclk`/`m_aresetn`. One `gaxi_fifo_async` per channel, each crossing in the channel's own direction – AW, W and AR from the requester's domain into the completer's, B and R back. There is no protocol state, no ID logic and no reordering: each channel is an in-order FIFO, so what a channel accepts on one side it presents on the other, later. AW and W cross independently, as AXI permits.

Built for the bridge generator's CDC slave ports (bridge TASK-006, was BRIDGE-017): a slave port declared `cdc = true` gets these between the crossbar-side wrapper and its boundary, and its own `<slave>_aclk` / `<slave>_aresetn` pins on the bridge top. The pair stands on its own as an AXI4 clock converter.

2.2 Parameters

Parameter	Default	Description
`AXI_ID_WIDTH`, `AXI_ADDR_WIDTH`, `AXI_DATA_WIDTH`, `AXI_USER_WIDTH`	8, 32, 32, 1	port widths, both sides
`CDC_DEPTH`	8	entries per channel FIFO; also the beats a channel can have in flight across the boundary. Power of 2 under Gray pointers. 8 is the floor for full throughput: the pointer synchronizers make the FIFO's full/empty view about seven cycles stale round trip, and a 4-deep FIFO streams at 4/7 of a

Parameter	Default	Description
		beat per cycle (measured 0.58)
USE_JOHNSON	0	0 = Gray pointers (default), 1 = Johnson (any depth). Hoisted per the CDC handbook rule – a conscious choice, never the FIFO's own default
N_FLOP_CROSS	2	synchronizer depth for the crossed pointers

2.3 Reset

Both domains reset each FIFO's own pointer and its crossed copy of the remote pointer from that domain's reset. With both resets asserted together the crossing starts consistent. A **one-sided reset is not safe**: within N_FLOP_CROSS clocks of deassertion the crossed copy re-converges on a remote pointer that kept moving, so a requester-side-only reset fabricates entries and a completer-side-only reset replays them. Quiesce the bus before resetting one side – the same contract as apb4_slave_cdc, spelled out in vault/handbook/design/cdc.md.

2.4 Throughput and latency

One beat per clock of the slower domain per channel, once the FIFO has something to offer, provided CDC_DEPTH covers the pointer round trip: each side's view of the other's pointer is N_FLOP_CROSS plus a register stale, so a FIFO shallower than that round trip (about seven cycles with the defaults) stalls on a full or empty flag that is already out of date. At depth 4 the crossing streams at 0.58 beat per cycle with equal clocks; at the default 8 it streams at one. test_axi4_cdc asserts the streaming rate at three clock ratios, so a depth that cannot keep up fails the unit test before it reaches a bridge. Latency per crossing is the synchronizer depth plus the FIFO's registered flags, N_FLOP_CROSS + 1 clocks of the destination domain, each way.

2.5 Verification

test_axi4_cdc.py runs each module with the requester and completer at equal, requester-fast (10/3 ns) and requester-slow (3/10 ns) periods, 32- and 64-bit at FULL: sequential bursts of up to 16 beats (data straight out of the completer's memory, W beats contiguous and in order at the completer, WLAST on the last crossed beat, R beats in order at the requester), many bursts in flight at once with rotating IDs, and an out-of-range access whose SLVERR must come back through the response crossing with nothing written.

2.6 References

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.1.1 “Clock” (an AXI interface has a single ACLK, so two clock domains need a bridge) and §A3.3 “Relationships between the channels” with §A1.2.3 “Register slices” (the channels are independent, so one in-order FIFO per channel with no protocol state preserves the protocol).
- Cummings, C.E. “Simulation and Synthesis Techniques for Asynchronous FIFO Design.” *SNUG San Jose*, 2002 – the Gray-pointer async FIFO (`gaxi_fifo_async`, `USE_JOHNSON=0`) used once per channel.
- Ginosar, R. “Metastability and Synchronizers: A Tutorial.” *IEEE Design & Test of Computers*, 28(5), Sept./Oct. 2011. DOI: 10.1109/MDT.2011.113 – synchronizer depth (`N_FLOP_CROSS`) versus MTBF.
- Deschamps, J.-P., Sutter, G.D., Cantó, E. *Guide to FPGA Implementation of Arithmetic Functions*, Springer (LNEE 149), 2012, ch. 5 “Electronic Aspects of Digital Design” – sec. 5.3.5.3 “Asynchronous FIFO” and sec. 5.2.3 metastability/MTBF – textbook treatment (secondary source).
- Chinnakonda, M. *Designing a Multiprocessor Cache Subsystem*, ch. 7 “Multi-processing”, §7.23 “Asynchronous Bridges” – why a CPU-to-interconnect path needs an asynchronous bridge (secondary source).
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF, archived under `rtl/cdc/references/`: `AsyncFifoGrayPointers__Cummings2002.pdf`, `MetastabilitySynchronizers__Ginosar2011.pdf`)

3 AXI4 Clock-Gated Variants Guide

Location: `rtl/amba/axi4/*_cg.sv` **Status:** Production Ready

3.1 Overview

Every AXI4 module in this subsystem ships with a clock-gated (`_cg`) variant that adds power management through dynamic clock gating. The idea is simple: when the interfaces go idle for a configurable stretch, the clock stops, and the dynamic power goes with it. When traffic shows up again, the clock restarts on its own.

3.1.1 Available Clock-Gated Modules

Module	Base Module	Description
`axi4_master_rd_cg`	axi4_master_rd	Clock-gated read master
`axi4_master_wr_cg`	axi4_master_wr	Clock-gated write master
`axi4_slave_rd_cg`	axi4_slave_rd	Clock-gated read slave
`axi4_slave_wr_cg`	axi4_slave_wr	Clock-gated write slave
`axi4_master_rd_mon_cg`	axi4_master_rd_mon	Clock-gated read master with monitoring
`axi4_master_wr_mon_cg`	axi4_master_wr_mon	Clock-gated write master with monitoring
`axi4_slave_rd_mon_cg`	axi4_slave_rd_mon	Clock-gated read slave with monitoring
`axi4_slave_wr_mon_cg`	axi4_slave_wr_mon	Clock-gated write slave with monitoring

3.1.2 Key Features

- **Dynamic Clock Gating:** Automatic clock disable during idle periods
- **Configurable Idle Threshold:** Programmable idle count before gating
- **Functional Equivalence** for the plain _cg wrappers (minus the un-exported `busy`); the _mon_cg wrappers forward every base parameter except `ACTIVE_TRANS_THRESHOLD` (harmless – its inner default is derived

from the forwarded MAX_TRANSACTIONS) and tie off debug_block_ready – see their pages

- **Status Monitoring:** Real-time gating and idle status outputs
- **Test Mode Support:** Bypass capability for scan testing
- **Low Ungating Overhead:** One register stage on the wake-up path; the first usable gated-clock edge arrives 2 cycles after activity is seen

3.2 Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH	int	4	Width of idle counter (max idle = 2^N-1 cycles)

All other parameters are identical to the base module.

3.3 Ports

3.3.1 Clock Gating Configuration Inputs

Port	Direction	Width	Description
cfg_cg_enable	Input	1	Enable clock gating (0=disabled, 1=enabled)
cfg_cg_idle_count	Input	CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH	Idle cycles before gating; the clock gates cfg_cg_idle_count + 1 cycles after the internal wakeup deasserts, which is cfg_cg_idle_count + 2 cycles after the last bus activity on AXI4 (one extra for the r_wakeup flop)

3.3.2 Clock Gating Status Outputs

Port	Direction	Width	Description
cg_gating	Output	1	Clock currently gated (1=gated, 0=running)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
cg_idle	Output	1	All internal buffers empty (1=idle, 0=active)

The _cg wrappers expose gating state only. They do not implement a cumulative gated-cycle counter; accumulate cg_gating externally if a power metric is needed.

All other ports are identical to the base module, with two exceptions: the plain _cg wrappers do NOT re-export the base busy output (it is consumed internally as a wake term), and the _mon_cg wrappers tie off debug_block_ready rather than forwarding it. Connect either of those and elaboration fails – use the base module when you need them.

3.4 Functional Description

3.4.1 Gating Conditions (All Must Be True)

1. **Interface Idle:** No valid/ready handshakes on any AXI channel
2. **Idle Duration:** Idle for cfg_cg_idle_count + 1 consecutive cycles measured from the internal wakeup deassertion, which is cfg_cg_idle_count + 2 cycles from the last bus activity
3. **Gating Enabled:** cfg_cg_enable = 1

3.4.2 Ungating Conditions (Any Triggers Ungating)

1. Any *valid signal asserted on any channel
2. cfg_cg_enable deasserted (opens the clock immediately). NOTE: cfg_cg_idle_count is NOT a wake trigger – while gated, changing it has no effect until bus activity wakes the block (the counter only reloads on wakeup or !enable)

Ungating Latency: activity is registered once (AXI4, AXI5, AXI4-Lite, AXI4-Stream) or twice (APB, APB5, AXI5-Stream) before reaching the ICG enable, which is combinational. The AXI4 _cg wrappers drive user_valid/axi_valid combinationally, so there is exactly **1 register stage** — r_wakeup inside amba_clock_gate_ctrl — and the first gated-clock rising edge available to the block arrives **2 cycles** after activity asserts.

```
stateDiagram-v2
    [*] --> RUNNING

    RUNNING --> IDLE : activity = 0<br/>(no valid signals)
    IDLE --> RUNNING : wakeup (activity) or !cfg_cg_enable
    IDLE --> GATED : count >= threshold<br/>&& cg_enable
    GATED --> RUNNING : activity detected<br/>(any valid signal)
```

```
    state RUNNING {
        note right of RUNNING : Clock running normally
    }

    state IDLE {
        note right of IDLE : Counting idle cycles
    }

    state GATED {
        note right of GATED : Clock stopped
    }
```

3.5 Timing

3.5.1 Ungating Latency

One register stage on the wake-up path; the first usable gated-clock edge arrives 2 cycles after activity asserts. `clock_gate_ctrl` adds no flop of its own — `w_gate_enable` is combinational from `wakeup` into the ICG enable, and its header comment "Wakeup: 1 clock from wakeup assertion to clock restoration" describes the resulting clock edge rather than a register stage.

```
Cycle N:   Interface idle, clock gated. ARVALID asserted; user_valid =
1
           combinationally, ARREADY forced low so no handshake occurs.
Cycle N+1: r_wakeup = 1 -> ICG enable released combinationally,
cg_gating = 0.
Cycle N+2: First usable gated-clock edge; transaction proceeds
normally.
```

3.5.2 Throughput Impact

- Two cycles of added latency on the first transfer out of a gated period
- No penalty on subsequent transfers while the interface stays active
- Functionally equivalent to the non-gated module (AXI handshakes are not dropped, only delayed by the wake-up cycles)

3.5.3 Sustained Throughput

Identical to base module: - Gating only occurs during idle - Active transactions unaffected

---

3.6 Usage Example

3.6.1 Basic Clock Gating (Master Read)

```
axi4_master_rd_cg #(
    // Base parameters
    .SKID_DEPTH_AR      (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_R       (4),
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH       (4),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH     (32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH     (64),

    // Clock gating parameters
    .CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH(4)   // Up to 15 idle cycles
) u_rd_master_cg (
    .aclk               (axi_clk),
    .aresetn            (axi_resetn),

    // Clock gating configuration
    .cfg_cg_enable      (1'b1),      // Enable gating
    .cfg_cg_idle_count  (4'd5),      // Gate after 5 idle cycles

    // AXI signals (identical to base module)
    .fub_axi_arid       (cpu_arid),
    .fub_axi_araddr     (cpu_araddr),
    // ... rest of AR/R signals ...

    .m_axi_arid         (mem_arid),
    .m_axi_araddr       (mem_araddr),
    // ... rest of AR/R signals ...

    // Clock gating status
    .cg_gating          (rd_clk_gated),
    .cg_idle            (rd_idle)
);

// Monitor power savings
always_ff @(posedge axi_clk) begin
    if (rd_clk_gated) begin
        $display("Read master clock gated - saving power");
    end
end
```

3.6.2 Dynamic Configuration (Runtime Adjustment)

```
// Power management controller
logic [3:0] idle_threshold;
```

```
always_comb begin
    case (power_mode)
        POWER_HIGH_PERF:  idle_threshold = 4'd15;  // Conservative
gating
        POWER_BALANCED:   idle_threshold = 4'd5;   // Moderate gating
        POWER_LOW:        idle_threshold = 4'd1;   // Aggressive
gating
        default:          idle_threshold = 4'd5;
    endcase
end

axi4_master_wr_cg #(
    // ... parameters ...
) u_wr_master_cg (
    // ... ports ...

    // Dynamic clock gating control
    .cfg_cg_enable      (power_mgmt_enable),
    .cfg_cg_idle_count  (idle_threshold),

    .cg_gating          (wr_clk_gated),
    .cg_idle            (wr_idle)
);
```

3.6.3 System-Level Power Monitoring

```
// Aggregate power metrics from all interfaces
wire master_rd_gated, master_wr_gated;
wire slave_rd_gated, slave_wr_gated;

// The _cg wrappers do not count gated cycles. Accumulate each
cg_gating
// output locally (see "Measuring Power Savings" below) to obtain
these.
logic [31:0] master_rd_gated_cycles;
logic [31:0] master_wr_gated_cycles;
logic [31:0] slave_rd_gated_cycles;
logic [31:0] slave_wr_gated_cycles;

// Total gated cycles (power savings metric)
wire [31:0] total_gated_cycles = master_rd_gated_cycles +
                                 master_wr_gated_cycles +
                                 slave_rd_gated_cycles +
                                 slave_wr_gated_cycles;

// Instantaneous gating status
```

```
wire any_gating = master_rd_gated | master_wr_gated |
                  slave_rd_gated | slave_wr_gated;

// Power savings estimate (assuming 50% power reduction when gated)
wire [31:0] power_savings_percent = (total_gated_cycles * 50) /
total_cycles;
```

3.7 Design Notes

3.7.1 Idle Count Selection

Aggressive Gating (High Idle Time):

```
.cfg_cg_idle_count(4'd1)   // Gate after 1 idle cycle
// Use when: Burst traffic, low duty cycle, max power savings
```

Moderate Gating (Balanced):

```
.cfg_cg_idle_count(4'd5)   // Gate after 5 idle cycles
// Use when: Mixed traffic, balanced power/performance
```

Conservative Gating (Low Latency):

```
.cfg_cg_idle_count(4'd10)  // Gate after 10 idle cycles
// Use when: High throughput, latency-sensitive, minimal power
overhead
```

Disable Gating:

```
.cfg_cg_enable(1'b0)       // Clock gating disabled
// Use when: 100% utilization, ultra-low latency, debug/test
```

3.7.2 When to Use Clock Gating

Recommended for: - Burst traffic patterns (idle periods between bursts) - Low-duty-cycle interfaces (< 50% utilization) - Power-constrained systems (battery, thermal limits) - Variable workloads (idle states common)

Not recommended for: - 100% utilization scenarios (no idle time = no power benefit) - Ultra-low-latency requirements (gating overhead unacceptable) - Continuous streaming (no natural idle points)

3.7.3 Traffic Pattern Analysis

Burst Traffic (Good for Clock Gating):

```
Time:    |----BURST----|idle|----BURST----|idle|----BURST----|
Gating:  |             |GG|              |GG|              |
Savings: ~30-40% depending on burst duty cycle
```

Continuous Traffic (Poor for Clock Gating):

```
Time:    |----DATA----DATA----DATA----DATA----DATA----|
Gating:  |                                           |
Savings: ~0% (never idle long enough to gate)
```

3.7.4 Power Savings Estimates

Illustrative, not measured. No power characterization has been run on this library; `axi4_master_rd_cg.md` says so explicitly. These rows also disagree with the per-module tables at comparable duty cycles (this table: 30 % duty -> 25-40 %; `axi4_master_rd_mon_cg.md`: 25 % utilization -> 45-55 %), which is itself evidence that neither is a measurement. Use them for the trend, never in a power budget.

Traffic Pattern	Duty Cycle	Idle Count	Power Savings
Burst (aggressive)	30%	1	35-40%
Burst (moderate)	30%	5	30-35%
Burst (conservative)	30%	10	25-30%
Mixed workload	50%	5	20-25%
Low activity	10%	1	40-45%
High activity	80%	5	5-10%
Continuous	100%	any	0%

Note: Actual savings depend on: - Process technology (clock tree power) - Traffic patterns (idle duration distribution) - Configuration (idle count threshold) - Logic behind clock gate (amount of logic gated)

3.7.5 Measuring Power Savings

```
// Calculate power savings percentage
logic [31:0] total_cycles;
logic [31:0] gated_cycles;

always_ff @(posedge axi_clk or negedge aresetn) begin
    if (!aresetn) begin
        total_cycles <= '0;
```

```
            gated_cycles <= '0;
        end else begin
            total_cycles <= total_cycles + 1;
            if (cg_gating) begin
                gated_cycles <= gated_cycles + 1;
            end
        end
    end

    // Power savings = (gated_cycles / total_cycles) × 100%
    assign power_savings_pct = (gated_cycles * 100) / total_cycles;
```

3.7.6 Test Mode Support

For scan testing, disable clock gating:

```
.cfg_cg_enable(~scan_mode)  // Disable during DFT scan
```

3.7.7 Simulation Considerations

Waveform Analysis: - `cg_gating=1`: Clock gated (idle) - `cg_gating=0`: Clock running (active)

Power Estimation:

```
initial begin
    $monitor("Time %0t: Gating=%b, Idle=%b",
             $time, cg_gating, cg_idle);
end
```

3.7.8 Synthesis Considerations

Clock Gating Cell: - Uses standard cell library clock gate (GTECH_AND, ICG, etc.) - Synthesis tool automatically inserts appropriate cell - No vendor-specific primitives required

Timing: - Clock gating logic adds minimal delay - The ICG enable is combinational from `r_wakeup`, so the ungating path must close in a single cycle - Gating path is non-critical

---

3.8 Related Modules

3.8.1 Base Module Documentation

- **axi4_master_rd** - Base read master
- **axi4_master_wr** - Base write master
- **axi4_slave_rd** - Base read slave
- **axi4_slave_wr** - Base write slave
- **axi4_master_rd_mon** - Base master read monitor

- **axi4_master_wr_mon** - Base master write monitor
- **axi4_slave_rd_mon** - Base slave read monitor
- **axi4_slave_wr_mon** - Base slave write monitor

3.8.2 Architecture

- **rtl-amba Overview** - Complete AMBA subsystem
- **AXI4 Index** - AXI4 module index

Last Updated: 2025-10-20

3.9 References

- Benini, L., De Micheli, G. “Automatic Synthesis of Low-Power Gated-Clock Finite-State Machines.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 15(6), June 1996. DOI: 10.1109/43.503933 – the latch-based clock-gating cell under every `_cg` wrapper.
- Benini, L., Bogliolo, A., De Micheli, G. “A Survey of Design Techniques for System-Level Dynamic Power Management.” *IEEE Trans. VLSI Systems*, 8(3), June 2000. DOI: 10.1109/92.845896 – fixed-timeout idle shutdown (`cfg_cg_idle_count`).
- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §E1.7 “Wake-up Signaling” (Issue L §A14.1.1 “AWAKEUP rules and recommendations”): the AXI5 signal that lets a manager restart a gated interface before VALID; AXI4 has none, so these wrappers wake on VALID.
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF, archived under `rtl/common/references/`: `LatchBasedClockGating__Benini1996.pdf`, `DynamicPowerManagementTimeout__Benini2000.pdf`)

3.10 Navigation

- **← Back to AXI4 Index**
- **← Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **← Back to Main Documentation Index**

4 axi4_dwidth_converter

Module: `axi4_dwidth_converter.sv` **Location:** Not implemented **Status:** Planned - no RTL in this repository

The read-only and write-only converters DO exist, but they belong to the converters component, not to `rtl/amba/axi4`, and they are documented in its micro-architecture spec: `axi4_dwidth_converter_rd` and `axi4_dwidth_converter_wr`. This book carried a second copy of both until 2026-08-31; a module's docs live with the component that owns the module.

4.1 Overview

> **Implementation status:** There is no `axi4_dwidth_converter.sv` in the repository. This page describes a planned bidirectional converter and its intended parameterization (`AW_FIFO_DEPTH`, `W_FIFO_DEPTH`, `B_FIFO_DEPTH`, `AR_FIFO_DEPTH`, `R_FIFO_DEPTH`); none of those parameters exist in RTL today. The shipping converters are the read-only and write-only variants in `projects/components/utility-ip/converters/rtl/`, which use `SKID_DEPTH_*` skid buffers rather than channel FIFOs:
>
> - axi4_dwidth_converter_rd
> - axi4_dwidth_converter_wr
>
> Instantiate a `_rd` and a `_wr` converter side by side to obtain full-duplex width conversion.

Read the blockquote above before you read anything else on this page — this module is a plan, not silicon. With that said, the design is worth documenting: the AXI4 Data Width Converter provides bidirectional data width conversion between AXI4 interfaces of different data widths while maintaining full protocol compliance. A single parameterized module handles both upsizing (narrow→wide) and downsizing (wide→narrow), automatically recalculating burst parameters and managing data packing/unpacking.

4.1.1 Key Features

- **Bidirectional Conversion:** Single module supports both upsize and downsize
- **Full AXI4 Protocol:** All 5 channels (AW, W, B, AR, R) with complete signal support
- **Burst Preservation:** Maintains burst semantics across width conversion

- **Auto Burst Recalculation:** Adjusts AWLEN/ARLEN and AWSIZE/ARSIZE automatically
- **Error Propagation:** Correctly forwards SLVERR/DECERR responses
- **Elastic Buffering:** Configurable FIFO depths for each channel
- **Status Outputs:** Busy signal and pending transaction counters
- **Parameter Validation:** Compile-time checks for valid configurations

---

4.2 Parameters

4.2.1 Width Configuration

Parameter	Type	Default	Range	Description
`S_AXI_DATA_WIDTH`	int	32	8-1024	Slave interface data width (power of 2)
`M_AXI_DATA_WIDTH`	int	128	8-1024	Master interface data width (power of 2)
`AXI_ID_WIDTH`	int	8	1-16	Transaction ID width
`AXI_ADDR_WIDTH`	int	32	12-64	Address bus width
`AXI_USER_WIDTH`	int	1	0-1024	User signal width

4.2.2 Buffer Depths

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
`AW_FIFO_DEPTH`	int	4	Write address FIFO depth (power of 2)
`W_FIFO_DEPTH`	int	8	Write data FIFO depth (power of 2)
`B_FIFO_DEPTH`	int	4	Write response FIFO depth (power of 2)
`AR_FIFO_DEPTH`	int	4	Read address FIFO depth (power of 2)

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
R_FIFO_DEPTH	int	8	Read data FIFO depth (power of 2)

4.2.3 Calculated Parameters (Auto)

Parameter	Calculation	Description
S_STRB_WIDTH	S_AXI_DATA_WIDTH / 8	Slave write strobe width
M_STRB_WIDTH	M_AXI_DATA_WIDTH / 8	Master write strobe width
WIDTH_RATIO	MAX / MIN	Data width ratio (2-16)
UPSIZE	S < M	1 if upsizing, 0 if downsizing
DOWNSIZE	S > M	1 if downsizing, 0 if upsizing
PTR_WIDTH	$clog2(WIDTH_RATIO)	Beat pointer width

4.3 Ports

4.3.1 AXI4 Slave Interface

Write Channels: - AW channel: s_axi_awid, s_axi_awaddr, s_axi_awlen, s_axi_awsize, s_axi_awburst, s_axi_awlock, s_axi_awcache, s_axi_awprot, s_axi_awqos, s_axi_awregion, s_axi_awuser, s_axi_awvalid, s_axi_awready - W channel: s_axi_wdata[S_AXI_DATA_WIDTH], s_axi_wstrb[S_STRB_WIDTH], s_axi_wlast, s_axi_wuser, s_axi_wvalid, s_axi_wready - B channel: s_axi_bid, s_axi_bresp, s_axi_buser, s_axi_bvalid, s_axi_bready

Read Channels: - AR channel: s_axi_arid, s_axi_araddr, s_axi_arlen, s_axi_arsize, s_axi_arburst, s_axi_arlock, s_axi_arcache, s_axi_arprot, s_axi_arqos, s_axi_arregion, s_axi_aruser, s_axi_arvalid, s_axi_arready - R channel: s_axi_rid, s_axi_rdata[S_AXI_DATA_WIDTH], s_axi_rresp, s_axi_rlast, s_axi_ruser, s_axi_rvalid, s_axi_rready

4.3.2 AXI4 Master Interface

Write Channels: - AW channel: m_axi_awid, m_axi_awaddr, m_axi_awlen, m_axi_awsize, m_axi_awburst, m_axi_awlock, m_axi_awcache, m_axi_awprot, m_axi_awqos,

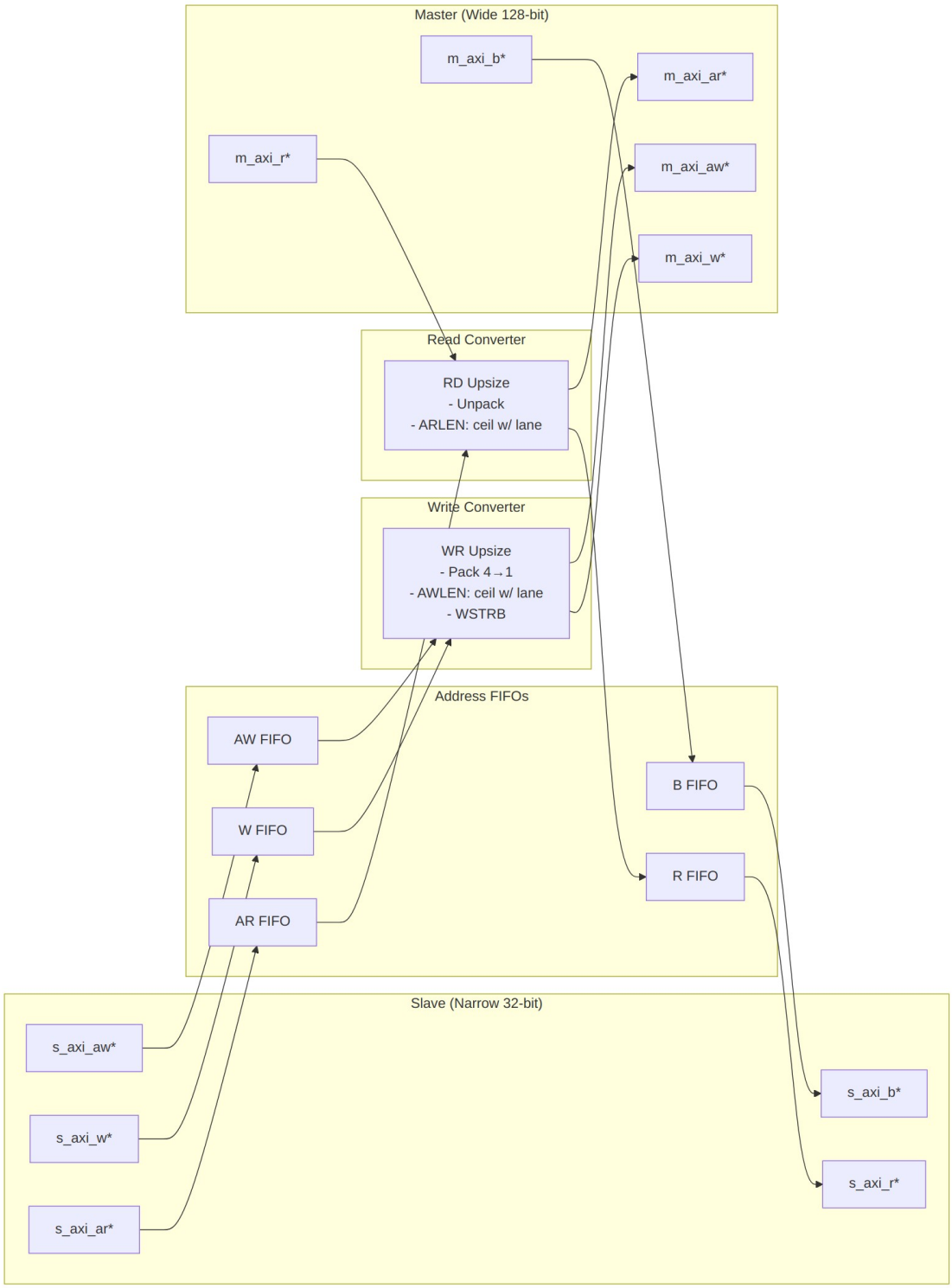
m_axi_awregion, m_axi_awuser, m_axi_awvalid, m_axi_awready - W channel: m_axi_wdata[M_AXI_DATA_WIDTH], m_axi_wstrb[M_STRB_WIDTH], m_axi_wlast, m_axi_wuser, m_axi_wvalid, m_axi_wready - B channel: m_axi_bid, m_axi_bresp, m_axi_buser, m_axi_bvalid, m_axi_bready

Read Channels: - AR channel: m_axi_arid, m_axi_araddr, m_axi_arlen, m_axi_arsize, m_axi_arburst, m_axi_arlock, m_axi_arcache, m_axi_arprot, m_axi_arqos, m_axi_arregion, m_axi_aruser, m_axi_arvalid, m_axi_arready - R channel: m_axi_rid, m_axi_rdata[M_AXI_DATA_WIDTH], m_axi_rresp, m_axi_rlast, m_axi_ruser, m_axi_rvalid, m_axi_rready

4.3.3 Status/Debug Outputs

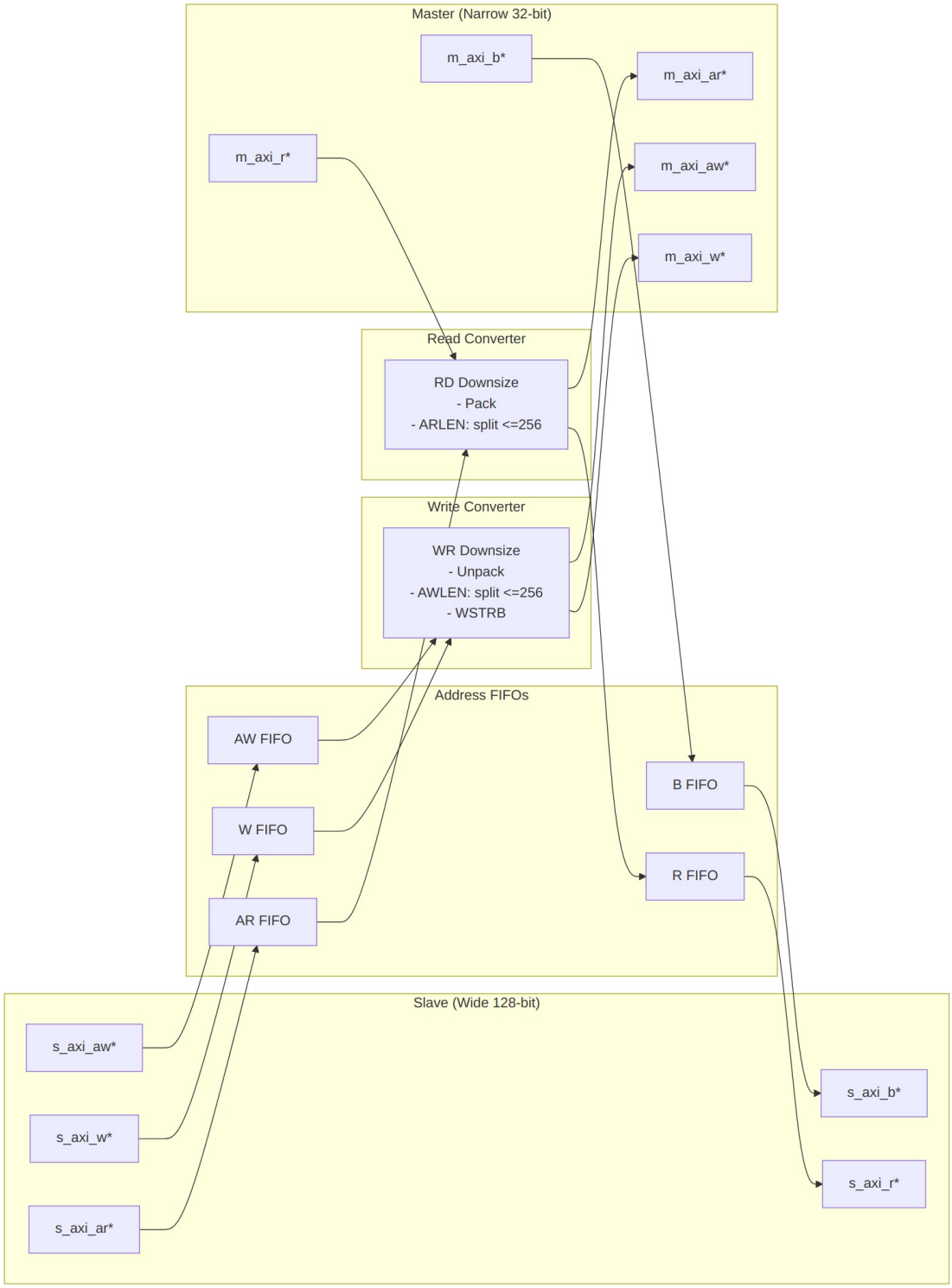
Port	Direction	Width	Description
busy	Output	1	Indicates active conversions in progress
wr_transactions_pending	Output	16	Number of pending write transactions
rd_transactions_pending	Output	16	Number of pending read transactions

4.4 Functional Description



Upsize Mode (Narrow → Wide)

WIDTH_RATIO = **4** (128/32): Burst 16 beats @ 32-bit → 4 beats @ 128-bit



Downsize Mode (Wide → Narrow)

WIDTH_RATIO = **4** (128/32): Burst 4 beats @ 128-bit → 16 beats @ 32-bit

4.4.1 Conversion Mechanics

4.4.1.1 Upsize Conversion (Narrow → Wide)

Write Path:

```
Example: 32-bit → 128-bit (WIDTH_RATIO = 4)

Slave Write:                Master Write:
AWLEN = 15 (16 beats)      AWLEN = 3 (4 beats)
AWSIZE = 3'b010 (4 bytes)  AWSIZE = 3'b100 (16 bytes)
AWADDR = 0x1000            AWADDR = 0x1000 (aligned)

W beats (32-bit):          W beats (128-bit):
Beat 0: wdata[31:0]
Beat 1: wdata[31:0]
Beat 2: wdata[31:0]    Beat 0: {beat3, beat2, beat1, beat0}
Beat 3: wdata[31:0]
Beat 4: wdata[31:0]
Beat 5: wdata[31:0]
Beat 6: wdata[31:0]    Beat 1: {beat7, beat6, beat5, beat4}
Beat 7: wdata[31:0]
... (16 beats total)       ... (4 beats total)
```

Read Path:

```
Slave Read:                Master Read:
ARLEN = 15 (16 beats)      ARLEN = 3 (4 beats)
ARSIZE = 3'b010 (4 bytes)  ARSIZE = 3'b100 (16 bytes)
ARADDR = 0x2000            ARADDR = 0x2000 (aligned)

R beats (128-bit):         R beats (32-bit):
Beat 0: {127:0}  Beat 0: rdata[31:0]   (bits [31:0])
                           Beat 1: rdata[31:0]   (bits [63:32])
                           Beat 2: rdata[31:0]   (bits [95:64])
                           Beat 3: rdata[31:0]   (bits [127:96])
Beat 1: {127:0}  Beat 4-7: ...
... (4 beats total)        ... (16 beats total)
```

4.4.1.2 Downsize Conversion (Wide → Narrow)

Write Path:

```
Example: 128-bit → 32-bit (WIDTH_RATIO = 4)

Slave Write:               Master Write:
AWLEN = 3 (4 beats)        AWLEN = 15 (16 beats)
```

```
AWSIZE = 3'b100 (16 bytes) AWSIZE = 3'b010 (4 bytes)
AWADDR = 0x3000            AWADDR = 0x3000 (aligned)

W beats (128-bit):         W beats (32-bit):
Beat 0: wdata[127:0]  Beat 0: [31:0]
                           Beat 1: [63:32]
                           Beat 2: [95:64]
                           Beat 3: [127:96]
Beat 1: wdata[127:0]  Beat 4-7: ...
... (4 beats total)        ... (16 beats total)
```

Read Path:

```
Slave Read:                Master Read:
ARLEN = 3 (4 beats)        ARLEN = 15 (16 beats)
ARSIZE = 3'b100 (16 bytes) ARSIZE = 3'b010 (4 bytes)
ARADDR = 0x4000            ARADDR = 0x4000 (aligned)

R beats (32-bit):          R beats (128-bit):
Beat 0: rdata[31:0]
Beat 1: rdata[31:0]
Beat 2: rdata[31:0]    Beat 0: {beat3, beat2, beat1, beat0}
Beat 3: rdata[31:0]
... (16 beats total)       ... (4 beats total)
```

4.4.1.3 WSTRB Handling

Upsize: Packs narrow WSTRB beats into wide WSTRB

```
32-bit WSTRB:    4'b1111, 4'b1111, 4'b1111, 4'b1111
                    ↓        ↓        ↓        ↓
128-bit WSTRB:   16'b1111_1111_1111_1111
```

Downsize: Unpacks wide WSTRB into narrow WSTRB beats

```
128-bit WSTRB:   16'b1111_0000_1111_0000
                    ↓
32-bit WSTRB:    4'b0000, 4'b1111, 4'b0000, 4'b1111
```

4.5 Timing Characteristics

4.5.1 Performance Characteristics

Throughput (Upsize): - Accumulation latency: WIDTH_RATIO-1 cycles per wide beat - Example (WIDTH_RATIO=4): 3-cycle latency to accumulate first wide beat

Throughput (Downsize): - Unpacking latency: 1 cycle per narrow beat - Full wide beat can be unpacked in consecutive cycles

Backpressure Handling: - FIFOs provide elastic buffering - Prevents deadlock during width mismatch scenarios - Slave can stall independently of master

---

4.6 Usage Examples

4.6.1 Basic Upsize Converter (32-bit → 128-bit)

```
axi4_dwidth_converter #(
    // Width configuration
    .S_AXI_DATA_WIDTH   (32),     // Narrow slave
    .M_AXI_DATA_WIDTH   (128),    // Wide master
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH       (4),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH     (32),
    .AXI_USER_WIDTH     (1),

    // Buffer depths
    .AW_FIFO_DEPTH      (4),
    .W_FIFO_DEPTH       (16),     // Deeper for burst accumulation
    .B_FIFO_DEPTH       (4),
    .AR_FIFO_DEPTH      (4),
    .R_FIFO_DEPTH       (16)      // Deeper for burst unpacking
) u_upsize_conv (
    .aclk               (axi_clk),
    .aresetn            (axi_resetn),

    // Slave (narrow) interface
    .s_axi_awid         (narrow_awid),
    .s_axi_awaddr       (narrow_awaddr),
    .s_axi_awlen        (narrow_awlen),     // e.g., 15 (16 beats)
    .s_axi_awsize       (narrow_awsize),    // e.g., 3'b010 (4 bytes)
    .s_axi_awvalid      (narrow_awvalid),
    .s_axi_awready      (narrow_awready),
    // ... rest of slave AW/W/B/AR/R signals

    // Master (wide) interface
    .m_axi_awid         (wide_awid),
    .m_axi_awaddr       (wide_awaddr),
    .m_axi_awlen        (wide_awlen),       // e.g., 3 (4 beats)
    .m_axi_awsize       (wide_awsize),      // e.g., 3'b100 (16 bytes)
    .m_axi_awvalid      (wide_awvalid),
    .m_axi_awready      (wide_awready),
    // ... rest of master AW/W/B/AR/R signals
```

```
    // Status
    .busy                   (conv_busy),
    .wr_transactions_pending(wr_pend),
    .rd_transactions_pending(rd_pend)
);

// Typical upsize scenario: CPU (32-bit) → Memory controller (128-bit)
```

4.6.2 Basic Downsize Converter (128-bit → 32-bit)

```
axi4_dwidth_converter #(
    // Width configuration
    .S_AXI_DATA_WIDTH   (128),    // Wide slave
    .M_AXI_DATA_WIDTH   (32),     // Narrow master
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH       (4),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH     (32),

    // Buffer depths
    .AW_FIFO_DEPTH      (4),
    .W_FIFO_DEPTH       (8),      // Moderate depth for unpacking
    .B_FIFO_DEPTH       (4),
    .AR_FIFO_DEPTH      (4),
    .R_FIFO_DEPTH       (32)      // Deeper for burst packing
) u_downsize_conv (
    .aclk               (axi_clk),
    .aresetn            (axi_resetn),

    // Slave (wide) interface
    .s_axi_awid         (wide_awid),
    .s_axi_awaddr       (wide_awaddr),
    .s_axi_awlen        (wide_awlen),       // e.g., 3 (4 beats)
    .s_axi_awsize       (wide_awsize),      // e.g., 3'b100 (16 bytes)
    // ... rest of slave signals

    // Master (narrow) interface
    .m_axi_awid         (narrow_awid),
    .m_axi_awaddr       (narrow_awaddr),
    .m_axi_awlen        (narrow_awlen),     // e.g., 15 (16 beats)
    .m_axi_awsize       (narrow_awsize),    // e.g., 3'b010 (4 bytes)
    // ... rest of master signals

    // Status
    .busy                   (conv_busy),
    .wr_transactions_pending(wr_pend),
    .rd_transactions_pending(rd_pend)
);
```

```
// Typical downsize scenario: Interconnect (128-bit) → Peripheral (32-
bit)
```

4.7 Design Notes

4.7.1 WIDTH_RATIO Constraints

Supported Ratios: 2, 4, 8, 16 - WIDTH_RATIO = 2: e.g., 32→64, 64→128, 128→256 - WIDTH_RATIO = 4: e.g., 32→128, 64→256 - WIDTH_RATIO = 8: e.g., 32→256, 64→512 - WIDTH_RATIO = 16: e.g., 32→512, 64→1024

Why Limited to 16? - Larger ratios require excessive buffering (512+ beats) - Address alignment becomes complex - Performance degrades significantly - Rare in real designs (use multi-stage conversion instead)

4.7.2 Address Alignment

Critical: Slave addresses must be aligned to master data width in upsize mode

```
// Upsize 32→128 (WIDTH_RATIO=4, M_STRB_WIDTH=16)
// Slave addresses must be 16-byte aligned (bottom 4 bits = 0)

VALID:   AWADDR = 0x1000 (aligned to 16 bytes)
VALID:   AWADDR = 0x2000
INVALID: AWADDR = 0x1004 (not 16-byte aligned)
INVALID: AWADDR = 0x2008 (not 16-byte aligned)
```

Downsize: No alignment restrictions (master can access any byte)

4.7.3 Burst Length Calculation

Upsize: the start address matters. A burst that begins part-way into a wide word fills fewer narrow lanes in its first beat, so the lane offset is part of the count – omit it and an unaligned burst is short by one beat.

```
lane          = AWADDR[clog2(M_STRB_WIDTH)-1 : 0] >>
clog2(S_STRB_WIDTH)
Master AWLEN  = ceil((lane + Slave AWLEN + WIDTH_RATIO) / WIDTH_RATIO)
- 1
Master AWSIZE = $clog2(M_STRB_WIDTH)          // the full wide size,
not a delta

Example: 32->128 (WIDTH_RATIO=4), aligned
Slave:  AWLEN=15, AWSIZE=2 (4 bytes)  -> 16 beats x 4 bytes = 64 bytes
Master: AWLEN=3,  AWSIZE=4 (16 bytes) -> 4 beats x 16 bytes = 64 bytes
```

```
Same burst starting at lane 2 (AWADDR = 0x8):
Master: AWLEN=4  -- five wide beats, the first and last partial
```

`axi4_dwidth_converter_wr.sv` computes this on a 10-bit intermediate so that `lane + 255 + WIDTH_RATIO` cannot wrap before the divide.

Downsize: there is no single-burst formula, because there cannot be one. One wide beat becomes `WIDTH_RATIO` narrow beats, so a full 256-beat slave burst would need up to `256 * WIDTH_RATIO` narrow beats – not expressible in an 8-bit AWLEN and not legal AXI4.

```
Master AWSIZE = $clog2(M_STRB_WIDTH)
Master AWLEN  = one burst per <= 256 narrow beats, issued back to back
```

The converter therefore **splits** one slave burst into as many master bursts of <= 256 beats as it takes, recording each in a split queue so the W framing and the B fold stay consistent. WRAP never reaches this path: AXI4 caps WRAP at 16 beats, and `16 * WIDTH_RATIO <= 256` for every supported ratio.

Split-fold B handling. In downsize mode one slave write burst is split into as many master bursts as needed. The converter records each master burst's beat count in the `splitq_*` queue for W framing, while the B channel uses a separate per-burst CAM keyed by AWID. Each CAM entry holds the number of outstanding master bursts for that slave burst and the worst BRESP seen so far. A master B response searches the CAM for the oldest matching AWID, decrements the counter, folds the response, and forwards a slave B only when the counter reaches zero. Same-ID ordering is preserved; cross-ID responses can complete in any order (fixed 2026-10-04, projects/components/utility-ip/converters BUG-008).

Read-side ordering guarantee. The read converter reassembles R beats per ID before reframing: a downstream may interleave R beats across ARIDs at beat level (AXI4's full freedom), and each slave R beat still carries its own RID/RUSER with per-ID order preserved. The layer is bounded by a one-outstanding-master-burst-per-ID reservation (same-ID chains serialize through reassembly; cross-ID traffic stays concurrent). Fixed 2026-10-04 as projects/components/utility-ip/converters BUG-009; see the read converter's MAS 2.6.9 for the design.

> The naive `(Slave AWLEN + 1) * WIDTH_RATIO - 1` this section used to give is the bug the split logic replaced: computed into the 8-bit field it wrapped, turning 511 into 255 (half the burst silently lost), and at 4:1 a 128-beat slave burst asked for 515 beats and got 3.

4.7.4 Buffer Depth Guidelines

Address Channels (AW/AR): - Default: 4 entries (sufficient for most cases) - Increase if high address command rate

Data Channels (W/R): - **Upsize:** Deeper buffers needed to accumulate narrow beats - W_FIFO_DEPTH ≥ WIDTH_RATIO × max_burst_length - R_FIFO_DEPTH ≥ WIDTH_RATIO ×

max_burst_length - **Downsize:** Moderate buffers for unpacking wide beats - W_FIFO_DEPTH ≥ max_burst_length (wide side) - R_FIFO_DEPTH ≥ WIDTH_RATIO × max_burst_length (for packing)

Example (32→128, max burst=16 narrow beats):

```
.W_FIFO_DEPTH  (16),  // Accumulate 16 narrow beats → 4 wide beats
.R_FIFO_DEPTH  (16)   // Unpack 4 wide beats → 16 narrow beats
```

4.8 Related Modules

4.8.1 Specialized Converters

- **axi4_dwidth_converter_rd** - Read-only data width conversion
- **axi4_dwidth_converter_wr** - Write-only data width conversion

4.8.2 Core Modules

- **axi4_master_rd** - AXI4 read master
- **axi4_master_wr** - AXI4 write master
- **axi4_slave_rd** - AXI4 read slave
- **axi4_slave_wr** - AXI4 write slave

4.8.3 Used Components

- **gaxi_skid_buffer** - Elastic buffering
- **gaxi_fifo_sync** - Synchronous FIFOs

4.9 References

4.9.1 Specifications

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.4.4 “Data read and write structure” (write strobes, narrow transfers, byte lanes) and §A3.4.1 “Address structure” (burst length and size, the 4KB rule a converter must preserve when it reshapes bursts). Issue L: §A3.2.3 “Narrow transfers”, §A3.1 “Transaction request”.

4.9.2 Source Code

- RTL: none – this page describes a PLANNED combined converter; the real modules are

`projects/components/utility-ip/converters/rtl/axi4_dwidth_converter_{rd,wr}.sv`

- Tests: `projects/components/utility-ip/converters/dv/tests/test_axi4_dwidth_converter_wr.py`
- Framework: `bin/TBClasses/components/axi4/`

4.9.3 Documentation

- Architecture: rtl-amba Overview
- AXI4 Index: README.md

Last Updated: 2026-10-04

4.10 Navigation

- **← Back to AXI4 Index**
- **← Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **← Back to Main Documentation Index**

5 axi4_master_rd

An AXI4 read master module that provides high-performance read transaction processing with dual skid buffer architecture for optimal throughput and pipeline efficiency in AXI4 memory-mapped systems.

5.1 Overview

The `axi4_master_rd` module implements a complete AXI4 read master interface with integrated address and data channel buffering using GAXI skid buffers. It acts as a bridge between upstream AXI4 read requestors and downstream AXI4 memory interfaces, providing transaction buffering, pipeline optimization, and flow control to maximize memory subsystem performance. It's a complete, high-performance read-master solution: advanced buffering, full protocol compliance, and the system integration hooks (busy status for clock gating, full sideband support) you'd expect.

5.2 Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
SKID_DEPTH_AR	int	2	Address channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
SKID_DEPTH_R	int	4	Read data channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
AXI_ID_WIDTH	int	8	AXI transaction ID width
AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	int	32	AXI address bus width
AXI_DATA_WIDTH	int	32	AXI data bus width
AXI_USER_WIDTH	int	1	AXI user signal width
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	int	AXI_DATA_WIDTH/8	AXI write strobe width (calculated)

5.3 Ports

5.3.1 Module Declaration

```
module axi4_master_rd #(
    parameter int SKID_DEPTH_AR     = 2,
    parameter int SKID_DEPTH_R      = 4,
```

```
    parameter int AXI_ID_WIDTH      = 8,
    parameter int AXI_ADDR_WIDTH    = 32,
    parameter int AXI_DATA_WIDTH    = 32,
    parameter int AXI_USER_WIDTH    = 1,
    parameter int AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH   = AXI_DATA_WIDTH / 8,
    // Short and calculated params
    parameter int AW       = AXI_ADDR_WIDTH,
    parameter int DW       = AXI_DATA_WIDTH,
    parameter int IW       = AXI_ID_WIDTH,
    parameter int SW       = AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH,
    parameter int UW       = AXI_USER_WIDTH,
    parameter int ARSize   = IW+AW+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+UW,
    parameter int RSize    = IW+DW+2+1+UW
) (
    // Global Clock and Reset
    input  logic                        aclk,
    input  logic                        aresetn,

    // Slave AXI Interface (Input Side) - FUB
    // Read address channel (AR)
    input  logic [IW-1:0]               fub_axi_arid,
    input  logic [AW-1:0]               fub_axi_araddr,
    input  logic [7:0]                  fub_axi_arlen,
    input  logic [2:0]                  fub_axi_arsize,
    input  logic [1:0]                  fub_axi_arburst,
    input  logic                        fub_axi_arlock,
    input  logic [3:0]                  fub_axi_arcache,
    input  logic [2:0]                  fub_axi_arprot,
    input  logic [3:0]                  fub_axi_arqos,
    input  logic [3:0]                  fub_axi_arregion,
    input  logic [UW-1:0]               fub_axi_aruser,
    input  logic                        fub_axi_arvalid,
    output logic                        fub_axi_arready,

    // Read data channel (R)
    output logic [IW-1:0]               fub_axi_rid,
    output logic [DW-1:0]               fub_axi_rdata,
    output logic [1:0]                  fub_axi_rresp,
    output logic                        fub_axi_rlast,
    output logic [UW-1:0]               fub_axi_ruser,
    output logic                        fub_axi_rvalid,
    input  logic                        fub_axi_rready,

    // Master AXI Interface (Output Side)
    // Read address channel (AR)
    output logic [IW-1:0]               m_axi_arid,
    output logic [AW-1:0]               m_axi_araddr,
    output logic [7:0]                  m_axi_arlen,
```

```
    output logic [2:0]                  m_axi_arsize,
    output logic [1:0]                  m_axi_arburst,
    output logic                        m_axi_arlock,
    output logic [3:0]                  m_axi_arcache,
    output logic [2:0]                  m_axi_arprot,
    output logic [3:0]                  m_axi_arqos,
    output logic [3:0]                  m_axi_arregion,
    output logic [UW-1:0]               m_axi_aruser,
    output logic                        m_axi_arvalid,
    input  logic                        m_axi_arready,

    // Read data channel (R)
    input  logic [IW-1:0]               m_axi_rid,
    input  logic [DW-1:0]               m_axi_rdata,
    input  logic [1:0]                  m_axi_rresp,
    input  logic                        m_axi_rlast,
    input  logic [UW-1:0]               m_axi_ruser,
    input  logic                        m_axi_rvalid,
    output logic                        m_axi_rready,

    // Status outputs for clock gating
    output logic                        busy
);
```

5.3.2 Clock and Reset

Port	Width	Direction	Description
aclk	1	Input	AXI clock
aresetn	1	Input	AXI active-low reset

5.3.3 Slave AXI Interface (Input Side - FUB)

5.3.3.1 Read Address Channel (AR)

Port	Width	Direction	Description
fub_axi_arid	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Input	Read address ID
fub_axi_araddr	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	Input	Read address
fub_axi_arlen	8	Input	Burst length, AXI-encoded: beats - 1 (`0x00` = 1 beat, `0xFF` = 256)
fub_axi_ar	3	Input	Transfer size (bytes per

Port	Width	Direction	Description
size			beat)
fub_axi_arburst	2	Input	Burst type (FIXED, INCR, WRAP)
fub_axi_arlock	1	Input	Lock type (atomic access)
fub_axi_arcache	4	Input	Cache attributes
fub_axi_arprot	3	Input	Protection attributes
fub_axi_arqos	4	Input	Quality of Service
fub_axi_arregion	4	Input	Region identifier
fub_axi_aruser	AXI_USER_WIDTH	Input	User-defined signals
fub_axi_arvalid	1	Input	Read address valid
fub_axi_arready	1	Output	Read address ready

5.3.3.2 Read Data Channel (R)

Port	Width	Direction	Description
fub_axi_rid	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Output	Read data ID
fub_axi_rdata	AXI_DATA_WIDTH	Output	Read data
fub_axi_rresp	2	Output	Read response (OKAY, EXOKAY, SLVERR, DECERR)
fub_axi_rlast	1	Output	Last read transfer in burst
fub_axi_ruser	AXI_USER_WIDTH	Output	User-defined signals
fub_axi_rv	1	Output	Read data valid

Port	Width	Direction	Description
alid			
fub_axi_rready	1	Input	Read data ready

5.3.4 Master AXI Interface (Output Side)

5.3.4.1 Read Address Channel (AR)

Port	Width	Direction	Description
m_axi_arid	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Output	Read address ID
m_axi_araddr	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	Output	Read address
m_axi_arlen	8	Output	Burst length, AXI-encoded: beats - 1 (`0x00` = 1 beat, `0xFF` = 256)
m_axi_arsize	3	Output	Transfer size (bytes per beat)
m_axi_arburst	2	Output	Burst type (FIXED, INCR, WRAP)
m_axi_arlock	1	Output	Lock type (atomic access)
m_axi_arcache	4	Output	Cache attributes
m_axi_arprot	3	Output	Protection attributes
m_axi_arqos	4	Output	Quality of Service
m_axi_arregion	4	Output	Region identifier
m_axi_aruser	AXI_USER_WIDTH	Output	User-defined signals
m_axi_arvalid	1	Output	Read address valid
m_axi_arre	1	Input	Read address ready

Port	Width	Direction	Description
ady			

5.3.4.2 Read Data Channel (R)

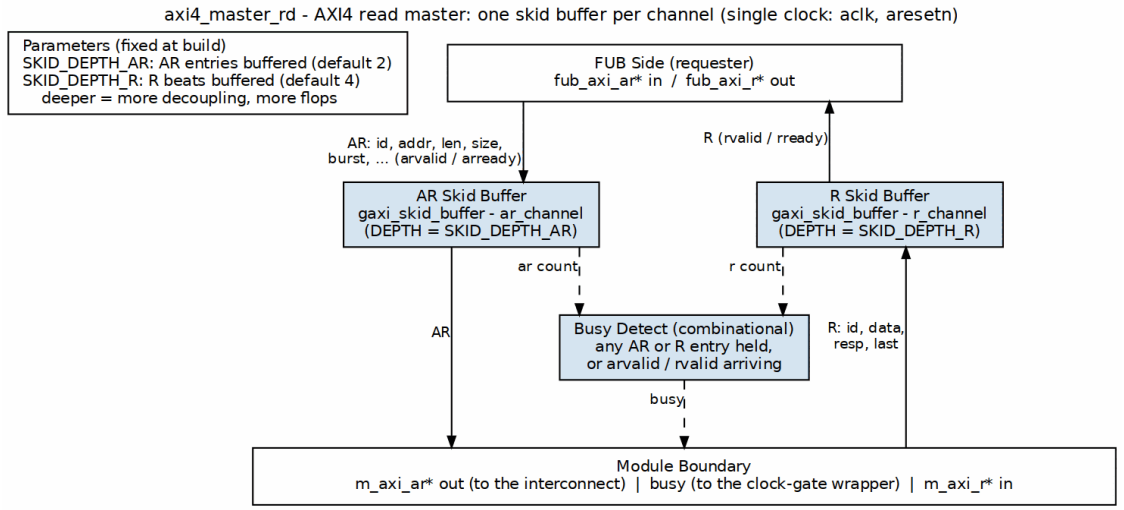
Port	Width	Direction	Description
m_axi_rid	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Input	Read data ID
m_axi_rdata	AXI_DATA_WIDTH	Input	Read data
m_axi_rresp	2	Input	Read response (OKAY, EXOKAY, SLVERR, DECERR)
m_axi_rlast	1	Input	Last read transfer in burst
m_axi_ruser	AXI_USER_WIDTH	Input	User-defined signals
m_axi_rvalid	1	Input	Read data valid
m_axi_rready	1	Output	Read data ready

5.3.5 Status Interface

Port	Width	Direction	Description
busy	1	Output	Module activity indicator for clock gating

5.4 Functional Description

5.4.1 Block diagram



axi4_master_rd block diagram

AR travels down the left lane from the requester (FUB) side through its own `gaxi_skid_buffer` to the m_axi master port; read data (R) comes back up the right lane through a second skid buffer. Busy Detect sits between the lanes: it watches both buffers' occupancy and the incoming valids, and drives `busy`, the activity input the `_cg` clock-gated wrapper uses. `SKID_DEPTH_AR` and `SKID_DEPTH_R` set how many entries each buffer holds.

5.4.2 Dual Buffer Design

The module employs a dual skid buffer architecture:

1. **AR Channel Buffer**: Buffers read address transactions
2. **R Channel Buffer**: Buffers read data responses

5.4.3 Key Features

- **Pipeline Optimization**: Dual buffering eliminates pipeline stalls
- **AXI4 Compliance**: Full AXI4 protocol support including all signals
- **Flow Control**: Independent buffering for address and data channels
- **Clock Gating Support**: Busy signal for power optimization
- **Burst Support**: Full burst transaction handling (1-256 beats)
- **ID Preservation**: Transaction ID forwarding (no matching – IDs pass through unchecked, as the ID handling section states)
- **Error Handling**: Proper error response propagation

5.4.4 Address Channel Processing

1. **Address Capture**: Incoming address transactions buffered in AR skid buffer
2. **Address Forward**: Buffered addresses forwarded to master interface
3. **Flow Control**: Ready/valid handshaking manages buffer flow

5.4.5 Data Channel Processing

1. **Data Reception**: Read data from master interface buffered in R skid buffer
2. **Data Forward**: Buffered data forwarded to FUB interface
3. **ID Pass-Through**: `RID` is carried through the R skid buffer as ordinary payload bits. The module does not maintain a transaction table and performs no ID matching, reordering, or outstanding-transaction tracking; ordering is whatever the downstream slave produces.

5.4.6 Busy Signal Generation

The busy output indicates module activity:

```
assign busy = (int_ar_count > 0) || (int_r_count > 0) ||
                fub_axi_arvalid || m_axi_rvalid;
```

5.5 Timing Characteristics

5.5.1 Buffer Latency

Buffer	Default Depth	Latency	Description
AR Channel	2 entries (SKID_DEPTH_AR=2)	1 cycle	Address buffering
R Channel	4 entries (SKID_DEPTH_R=4)	1 cycle	Data buffering

5.5.2 Performance Metrics

Metric	Value	Conditions
Maximum Frequency	300-600 MHz	Technology dependent
Address Throughput	1 transaction/cycle	When buffers not full
Data Throughput	1 beat/cycle	When buffers not empty

Metric	Value	Conditions
Pipeline Efficiency	95-99%	With appropriate buffer sizing

5.5.3 Transaction Latency

Transaction Type	Latency	Description
Single Read	2-3 cycles	Address → Data (minimum)
Burst Read	2+N cycles	Address + N data beats
Back-to-back	1 cycle/txn	Sustained rate with buffering

5.6 Usage Examples

Every parameter and port below is read from the module declaration.

```
axi4_master_rd #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AR          (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_R           (4),
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH           (8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH         (32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH         (32),
    .AXI_USER_WIDTH         (1)
) u_axi4_master_rd (
    .aclk                   (aclk),
    .aresetn                (aresetn),
    .fub_axi_arid           (fub_axi_arid),
    .fub_axi_araddr         (fub_axi_araddr),
    .fub_axi_arlen          (fub_axi_arlen),
    .fub_axi_arsize         (fub_axi_arsize),
    .fub_axi_arburst        (fub_axi_arburst),
    .fub_axi_arlock         (fub_axi_arlock),
    .fub_axi_arcache        (fub_axi_arcache),
    .fub_axi_arprot         (fub_axi_arprot),
    .fub_axi_arqos          (fub_axi_arqos),
    .fub_axi_arregion       (fub_axi_arregion),
    .fub_axi_aruser         (fub_axi_aruser),
    .fub_axi_arvalid        (fub_axi_arvalid),
    .fub_axi_arready        (fub_axi_arready),
    .fub_axi_rid            (fub_axi_rid),
    .fub_axi_rdata          (fub_axi_rdata),
    .fub_axi_rresp          (fub_axi_rresp),
    .fub_axi_rlast          (fub_axi_rlast),
```

```
    .fub_axi_ruser          (fub_axi_ruser),
    .fub_axi_rvalid         (fub_axi_rvalid),
    .fub_axi_rready         (fub_axi_rready),
    .m_axi_arid             (m_axi_arid),
    .m_axi_araddr           (m_axi_araddr),
    .m_axi_arlen            (m_axi_arlen),
    .m_axi_arsize           (m_axi_arsize),
    .m_axi_arburst          (m_axi_arburst),
    .m_axi_arlock           (m_axi_arlock),
    .m_axi_arcache          (m_axi_arcache),
    .m_axi_arprot           (m_axi_arprot),
    .m_axi_arqos            (m_axi_arqos),
    .m_axi_arregion         (m_axi_arregion),
    .m_axi_aruser           (m_axi_aruser),
    .m_axi_arvalid          (m_axi_arvalid),
    .m_axi_arready          (m_axi_arready),
    .m_axi_rid              (m_axi_rid),
    .m_axi_rdata            (m_axi_rdata),
    .m_axi_rresp            (m_axi_rresp),
    .m_axi_rlast            (m_axi_rlast),
    .m_axi_ruser            (m_axi_ruser),
    .m_axi_rvalid           (m_axi_rvalid),
    .m_axi_rready           (m_axi_rready),
    .busy                   (busy)
);
```

5.7 Design Notes

5.7.1 Buffer Depth Selection

Choose buffer depths based on system characteristics:

`SKID_DEPTH_*` is an entry count, not a log2 exponent. The underlying `gaxi_skid_buffer` stores one register slot per entry and tracks occupancy in a 4-bit counter, so legal values are 2..8 inclusive (any integer – odd depths are legal). Values above 8 fail elaboration (the guard errors rather than overflowing); for deeper elasticity use a `gaxi_fifo_sync` stage ahead of the module instead.

System Type	SKID_DEPTH_AR	SKID_DEPTH_R	Rationale
Low Latency CPU	2	2	Minimize latency
High Throughput DMA	4	8	Maximize bandwidth
DDR4 Interface	4	8	Handle refresh

System Type	SKID_DEPTH_AR	SKID_DEPTH_R	Rationale
			cycles
PCIe Interface	4	6	Variable latency tolerance

5.7.2 Burst Optimization

```
// Optimize for burst efficiency
localparam BURST_LENGTH = 16; // Optimize for cache line size

// Generate efficient burst addresses
always_comb begin
    axi_araddr = base_addr & ~(BURST_LENGTH * DATA_BYTES - 1); //
Align
    axi_arlen  = BURST_LENGTH - 1;                              //
Length
    axi_arsize = $clog2(DATA_BYTES);                            // Size
    axi_arburst = 2'b01;                                        // INCR
end
```

5.7.3 Quality of Service (QoS)

```
// QoS-aware read master configuration
always_comb begin
    case (requestor_type)
        CPU_CRITICAL:  axi_arqos = 4'hF;    // Highest priority
        CPU_NORMAL:    axi_arqos = 4'h8;    // Medium priority
        DMA_BULK:      axi_arqos = 4'h4;    // Lower priority
        BACKGROUND:    axi_arqos = 4'h1;    // Lowest priority
        default:       axi_arqos = 4'h0;
    endcase
end
```

5.7.4 Transaction Monitoring

```
// Performance monitoring integration
logic [31:0] read_transaction_count;
logic [31:0] read_burst_total;
logic [31:0] read_latency_accumulator;

always_ff @(posedge axi_clk) begin
    // Count transactions
    if (fub_axi_arvalid && fub_axi_arready) begin
        read_transaction_count <= read_transaction_count + 1;
        read_burst_total <= read_burst_total + fub_axi_arlen + 1;
    end
```

```
    // Measure latency (simplified)
    if (fub_axi_rvalid && fub_axi_rready && fub_axi_rlast) begin
        read_latency_accumulator <= read_latency_accumulator +
measured_latency;
    end
end

// Average burst length and latency calculations
assign avg_burst_length = read_burst_total / read_transaction_count;
assign avg_latency = read_latency_accumulator /
read_transaction_count;
```

5.7.5 Error Handling and Recovery

```
// Enhanced error handling
logic error_detected;
logic [7:0] error_count;

always_ff @(posedge axi_clk) begin
    error_detected <= fub_axi_rvalid && fub_axi_rready &&
                      (fub_axi_rresp == 2'b10 || fub_axi_rresp ==
2'b11);

    if (error_detected) begin
        error_count <= error_count + 1;
        // Log error details for debugging
        error_log <= {fub_axi_rid, fub_axi_rresp, timestamp};
    end
end
```

5.7.6 Synthesis Considerations

Area Optimization: - Reduce buffer depths for area-constrained designs - Use smaller ID widths when possible - Share buffers across multiple masters if timing allows

Timing Optimization: - Register all interface signals for timing closure - Use appropriate buffer depths to break critical paths - Consider pipeline stages for very high-frequency operation

Power Optimization: - Use clock gating variant (`axi4_master_rd_cg`) when available - Implement QoS-based power scaling - Size buffers appropriately to minimize switching activity

5.8 Related Modules

- **axi4_master_rd_cg**: Clock-gated version for power optimization
- **axi4_master_wr**: Complementary AXI4 write master
- **gaxi_skid_buffer**: Underlying buffer infrastructure

- **axi4_interconnect**: AXI4 interconnect for multi-master systems
- **axi_monitor_base**: AXI4 protocol monitoring and analysis

5.9 Testing

5.9.1 Protocol Compliance

- Verify AXI4 handshaking on all channels
- Check burst handling and RLAST generation
- Validate ID preservation through the pipeline

5.9.2 Buffer Verification

- Test buffer overflow/underflow protection
- Verify data integrity through buffers
- Check flow control under various load conditions

5.9.3 Performance Verification

- Measure sustained throughput with various patterns
- Verify buffer efficiency and utilization
- Check latency under different loading conditions

5.10 References

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.2.1 “Handshake process” and §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the per-channel VALID/READY contract each skid buffer preserves); §A1.2.3 “Register slices” and §A3.1.1 “Clock” (a register stage may sit in any channel for one cycle of latency, and an interface must have no combinational input-to-output path, which a slice breaks). §A5.2.1 “Read data ordering” (same-ID read data returns in order, so a FIFO per channel is enough). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.
- Carloni, L.P., McMillan, K.L., Sangiovanni-Vincentelli, A.L. “Theory of Latency-Insensitive Design.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 20(9), Sept. 2001. DOI: 10.1109/43.945302 – relay stations: a channel can be pipelined by any number of back-pressured stages without changing its behavior, which is why a skid buffer per channel is transparent to both ends.

- Cortadella, J., Kishinevsky, M., Grundmann, B. “Synthesis of Synchronous Elastic Architectures.” *Proc. 43rd Design Automation Conference (DAC ’06)*, July 2006, pp. 657-662. DOI: 10.1145/1146909.1147077 – the elastic buffer with valid/stop back-pressure, the structure a skid buffer implements.
- Chipressian. *Crack the Hardware Interview: from RTL Designers’ Perspective*, Part 2 ch. 2 “Handshake Protocols” (forward and backward register slices) – textbook treatment of the valid/ready slice; the backward slice’s extra data register is the skid entry (secondary source).
- Maaref, M. *Architecting and Building High-Speed SoCs*, Packt, 2022, ch. 3 “Basic and Advanced On-Chip Busses and Interconnects” (“AXI bus protocol overview”) – textbook overview of the AXI channels, bursts and ID ordering (secondary source).
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF: `LatencyInsensitiveDesign__Carloni2001.pdf`, `ElasticBuffer__Cortadella2006.pdf`)

5.11 Navigation

- **← Back to AXI4 Index**
- **← Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **← Back to Main Documentation Index**

6 axi4_master_rd_cg

Module: `axi4_master_rd_cg.sv` **Base Module:** axi4_master_rd **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/`
Status: Production Ready

6.1 Overview

This is the **clock-gated variant** of axi4_master_rd — same datapath, with an activity-based clock gate wrapped around it for power optimization.

For complete clock-gating documentation, usage examples, and configuration guidelines, see:

→ Clock-Gated Variants Guide

What you get over the base module:

- **Same Functionality:** 100% equivalent to base module
- **Power Savings:** traffic-dependent; unmeasured in this repo – treat any percentage as a placeholder until characterized
- **Configurable at runtime:** `cfg_cg_enable` / `cfg_cg_idle_count` inputs
- **Zero Overhead When Disabled:** `cfg_cg_enable=0` bypasses the gate

6.2 Parameters

In addition to the axi4_master_rd parameters (note: the base module's `busy` output is NOT re-exported by this wrapper – it is consumed internally as a wake term):

Parameter	Default	Description
`CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH`	4	Width of the idle countdown, sizing `cfg_cg_idle_count`
`SKID_DEPTH_AR`	2	Skid-buffer depth on the AR channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are legal.
`SKID_DEPTH_R`	4	Skid-buffer depth on the R channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are

Parameter	Default	Description
		legal.

The gating controls are RUNTIME INPUTS, not parameters: `cfg_cg_enable` (gate master-enable) and `cfg_cg_idle_count` (idle cycles before gating). Status outputs are `cg_gating` and `cg_idle`. There are no per-domain gates – one `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` gates the whole module. (This page once documented an ENABLE_CLOCK_GATING / CG_IDLE_CYCLES / CG_GATE_* parameter interface that never existed; the clock-gating guide in this book was always the accurate reference.)

6.2.1 Derived Parameters (do not override)

These are declared as `parameter` so the elaborator can compute them, not so callers can set them. Each defaults to an expression over the parameters above; overriding one desynchronises it from its source and the design fails to elaborate or silently mis-sizes a bus. Set the parameters they are derived FROM and leave these alone.

Derived parameter	Default expression
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	AXI_DATA_WIDTH / 8
AW	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH
DW	AXI_DATA_WIDTH
IW	AXI_ID_WIDTH
SW	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH
UW	AXI_USER_WIDTH
ARSize	IW+AW+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+UW
RSize	IW+DW+2+1+UW

6.3 Ports

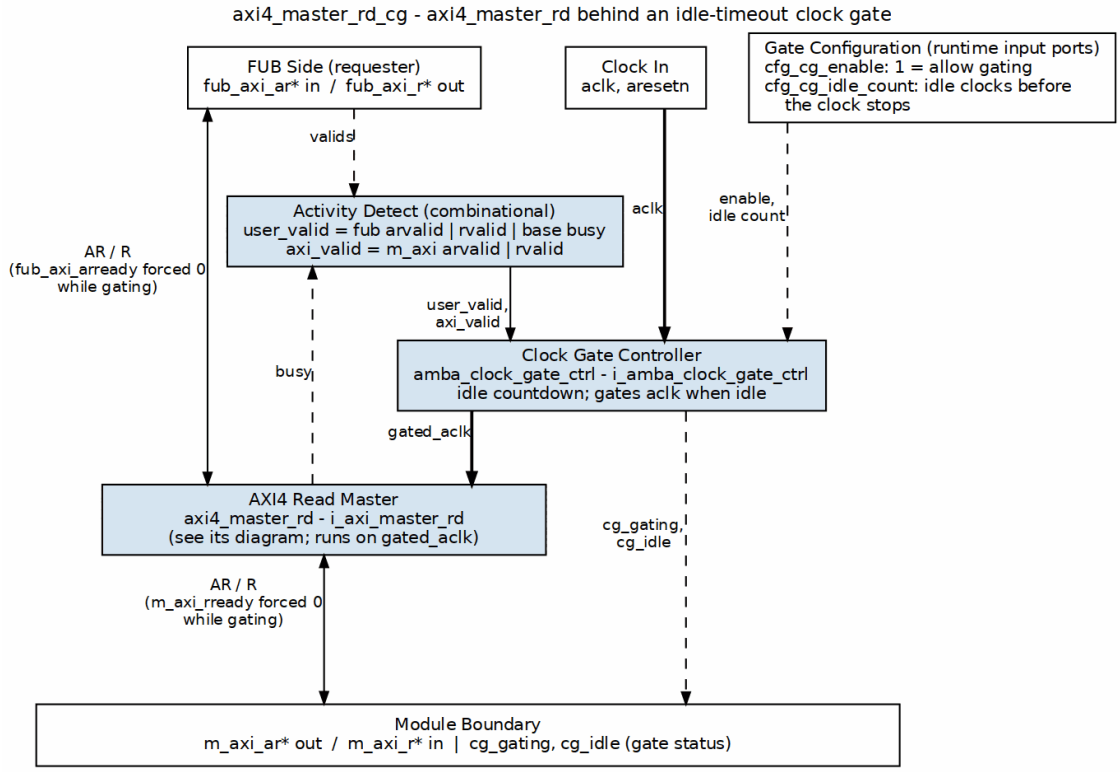
Port	Dir	Width	Description
aclk	In	1	
aresetn	In	1	
cfg_cg_enable	In	1	
cfg_cg_idle_count	In	[CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH-1:0]	
fub_axi_arid	In	[IW-1:0]	
fub_axi_araddr	In	[AW-1:0]	
fub_axi_arlen	In	[7:0]	

Port	Dir	Width	Description
fub_axi_arsize	In	[2:0]	
fub_axi_arburst	In	[1:0]	
fub_axi_arlock	In	1	
fub_axi_arcache	In	[3:0]	
fub_axi_arprot	In	[2:0]	
fub_axi_arqos	In	[3:0]	
fub_axi_arregion	In	[3:0]	
fub_axi_aruser	In	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_arvalid	In	1	
fub_axi_arready	Out	1	
fub_axi_rid	Out	[IW-1:0]	
fub_axi_rdata	Out	[DW-1:0]	
fub_axi_rresp	Out	[1:0]	
fub_axi_rlast	Out	1	
fub_axi_ruser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_rvalid	Out	1	
fub_axi_rready	In	1	
m_axi_arid	Out	[IW-1:0]	
m_axi_araddr	Out	[AW-1:0]	
m_axi_arlen	Out	[7:0]	
m_axi_arsize	Out	[2:0]	
m_axi_arburst	Out	[1:0]	
m_axi_arlock	Out	1	
m_axi_arcache	Out	[3:0]	
m_axi_arprot	Out	[2:0]	

Port	Dir	Width	Description
m_axi_arqos	Out	[3:0]	
m_axi_arregion	Out	[3:0]	
m_axi_aruser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
m_axi_arvalid	Out	1	
m_axi_arready	In	1	
m_axi_rid	In	[IW-1:0]	
m_axi_rdata	In	[DW-1:0]	
m_axi_rresp	In	[1:0]	
m_axi_rlast	In	1	
m_axi_ruser	In	[UW-1:0]	
m_axi_rvalid	In	1	
m_axi_rready	Out	1	
cg_gating	Out	1	Active gating indicator
cg_idle	Out	1	All buffers empty indicator

6.4 Functional Description

6.4.1 Block diagram



axi4_master_rd_cg block diagram

The base `axi4_master_rd` is one child box (see its own diagram), clocked by `gated_aclk`. The clock is the heavy center column: `aclk` enters `amba_clock_gate_ctrl`, which stops it after `cfg_cg_idle_count` idle clocks. Activity Detect ORs this side's valids with the base's `busy` (`user_valid`) and the far side's valids (`axi_valid`) to wake the clock. While gating, the outward ready signals are forced to 0, so no handshake is lost; `cg_gating` and `cg_idle` report the gate's state.

This wrapper is the base module plus one `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` instance. The datapath is untouched – every channel signal is forwarded verbatim – so functional behaviour is identical to the base module and the wrapper adds no latency of its own.

What it adds is a gated clock. `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` watches two activity terms, `user_valid` (this side's valids plus the base module's `busy`) and `axi_valid` (the far side's valids), registers their OR into `r_wakeup`, and stops the inner module's clock once both have been quiet for `cfg_cg_idle_count` cycles. The clock restarts on the next activity, one cycle later.

While the clock is stopped the wrapper masks its outward-facing READY signals with `! cg_gating`, so a peer sees no acceptance until the clock runs again and no handshake is lost across the wake boundary.

`cfg_cg_enable` arms this behaviour; with it low the clock free-runs and the module is indistinguishable from its base.

6.5 Timing Characteristics

Skid parameter	Default depth
`SKID_DEPTH_AR`	2 entries
`SKID_DEPTH_R`	4 entries

Each channel traverses one `gaxi_skid_buffer`, which registers both `rd_valid` and its storage. The **1-cycle input-to-output latency therefore applies on every transfer, including the unstalled case** – there is no combinational bypass. Depth buys backpressure absorption, not throughput; full rate is sustained once the pipeline is primed. Legal range is 2..8 inclusive, odd values included.

Clocking: `aclk`, reset `aresetn` (active-low asynchronous).

No synthesis numbers are quoted here. Frequency and area depend on the target device and the parameters you elaborate with; run your own build.

6.6 Usage Examples

```
axi4_master_rd_cg #(
    // Base module parameters (see axi4_master_rd.md)
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH(8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH(64),
    .CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH(4)
) u_cg (
    .aclk(clk),
    .aresetn(rst_n),
    .cfg_cg_enable(1'b1),
    .cfg_cg_idle_count(4'd8),
    .cg_gating(),           // status: clock currently gated
    .cg_idle(),             // status: interfaces quiet (~r_wakeup)
    // ... all other ports same as axi4_master_rd (except busy)
);
```

6.7 Design Notes

A peer's READY must never enter the activity term. A consumer that parks its response-ready high while idle is behaving correctly; folding that signal into `user_valid` pins this block permanently awake and defeats gating entirely – silently, because function is unaffected. Ten wrappers in this repository shipped that way and nothing failed until someone measured. `val/amba/test_cg_peer_ready.py` parks the peer READY high, holds every VALID low, and requires `cg_gating`. Canonical rule: `vault/handbook/design/clock-gating-activity-terms.md`.

`cfg_cg_enable` is not a kill switch. It arms gating and reaches `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` only; the datapath and any monitor enables are forwarded untouched. With it low the clock free-runs and this module behaves exactly like its base.

Gating latency. The clock stops `cfg_cg_idle_count` + 2 cycles after the last bus activity – the idle counter, plus one for the `r_wakeup` flop. Size the idle count against your traffic's inter-burst gap: too small and the block wakes constantly, too large and it never gates.

Cost. Five flops: `r_wakeup` plus `r_idle_counter` at `IDLE_CNTR_WIDTH`, scaling as 1 + `CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH`. The ICG itself is a latch or BUFGCE, not fabric flops.

6.8 Related Modules

- **Base Module Functionality:** axi4_master_rd.md
- **Clock Gating Guide:** clock_gated_variants.md
- **Detailed CG Examples:**
  - axi4_master_rd_mon_cg.md (AXI4 monitor)
  - axil4_master_rd_mon_cg.md (AXIL4 monitor)
  - apb4_slave_cg.md (APB interface)

6.9 Testing

`val/amba/test_axi4_master_rd_cg.py` exercises this module. It collects 1 parameter cases at the default `REG_LEVEL`.

```
source env_python
pytest val/amba/test_axi4_master_rd_cg.py -v
```

6.10 References

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.2.1 “Handshake process” and §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the per-channel VALID/READY contract each skid buffer preserves); §A1.2.3 “Register slices” and §A3.1.1 “Clock” (a register stage may sit in any channel for one cycle of latency, and an interface must have no combinational input-to-output path, which a slice breaks). §A5.2.1 “Read data ordering” (same-ID read data returns in order, so a FIFO per channel is enough). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.
- Benini, L., De Micheli, G. “Automatic Synthesis of Low-Power Gated-Clock Finite-State Machines.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 15(6), June 1996. DOI: 10.1109/43.503933 – the latch-based clock-gating cell (`icg`, via `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` and `clock_gate_ctrl`) that gates this wrapper’s clock.
- Benini, L., Bogliolo, A., De Micheli, G. “A Survey of Design Techniques for System-Level Dynamic Power Management.” *IEEE Trans. VLSI Systems*, 8(3), June 2000. DOI: 10.1109/92.845896 – fixed-timeout shutdown: gate after `cfg_cg_idle_count` idle cycles, wake on activity.
- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – AXI4 has no wake-up signal. AXI5 adds AWAKEUP (Issue H §E1.7 “Wake-up Signaling”; Issue L §A14.1.1), which lets a manager restart a gated interface before VALID. This wrapper wakes on the flopped OR of the VALIDs and holds READY low while gated.
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF, archived under `rtl/common/references/`: `LatchBasedClockGating__Benini1996.pdf`, `DynamicPowerManagementTimeout__Benini2000.pdf`)

6.11 Navigation

- **← Back to AXI4 Index**
- **← Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **← Back to Main Documentation Index**

7 axi4_master_rd_mon

Module: `axi4_master_rd_mon.sv` **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/` (protocol monitors live with their protocol; only the monitor CORE pieces are in `rtl/amba/ocelus/`) **Status:** Production Ready

---

7.1 Overview

The AXI4 Master Read Monitor combines a functional AXI4 master read interface with comprehensive transaction monitoring and filtering. This is the module you drop into a verification environment when you want real-time protocol checking, error detection, performance metrics, and configurable packet filtering without giving up the datapath — the traffic flows through it, and it watches on the way by.

7.1.1 Key Features

- **Integrated Monitoring:** Combines `axi4_master_rd` with `axi_monitor_filtered`
- **2-Level Filtering: packet-type drop masks + per-event masks (err_select is reserved – no routing)**
- **Error Detection:** SLVERR, DECERR, orphaned read data, timeouts (protocol-violation events are write-monitor only – see Error Detection Events)
- **Timeout Monitoring:** Configurable timeout detection for stuck transactions
- **Performance Metrics:** Latency tracking, transaction counting, throughput analysis
- **Monitor Bus Output:** 128-bit packets paired with 64-bit side-band timestamps
- **Configuration Validation:** Detects conflicting configuration settings
- **Clock Gating Support:** Busy signal for power management

7.2 Parameters

A lite-monitor version of this wrapper exists as `axi4_master_rd_monlite`: the same core and taps with `axi_monitor_lite` instead of `axi_monitor_filtered`, about a fifth of the

monitor gates, error/timeout/completion/threshold packets only. Selected in generated bridges by `mon_preset = "lite"`.

7.2.1 AXI4 Master Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
SKID_DEPTH_AR	int	2	AR channel skid buffer depth
SKID_DEPTH_R	int	4	R channel skid buffer depth
AXI_ID_WIDTH	int	8	Transaction ID width
AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	int	32	Address bus width
AXI_DATA_WIDTH	int	32	Data bus width
AXI_USER_WIDTH	int	1	User signal width

7.2.2 Monitor Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
UNIT_ID	logic [7:0]	8'h01	8-bit unit identifier in monitor packets
AGENT_ID	logic [15:0]	16'h000A	16-bit agent identifier in monitor packets
MAX_TRANSACTIONS	int	16	Maximum concurrent outstanding transactions
ACLK_MHZ	int	100	Clock frequency in MHz – keeps the 1 us tick exact off-100MHz
CFI_MIN_FREQ_MHZ / CFI_MAX_FREQ_MHZ	int	= ACLK_MHZ	Bounds for the freq-invariant counter LUT (`cfg_freq_sel` indexes within them)
USE_WDATA_ORDER_Q	bit	0	Write-data ordering queue

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
NUM_BANKS	int	1	Banked transaction tables. >**1 on a WRITE monitor requires** **USE_WDATA_ORDER_Q=1** – axi_monitor_trans_mgr fails elaboration otherwise
ID_FILTER_ENABLE	bit	0	Synthesises the per-instance ID-slice filter
ID_MATCH_BASE	int	0	First ID this instance owns
ID_MATCH_COUNT	int	0	How many; 0 means ALL, so a zeroed register block does not silently filter everything away
ACTIVE_TRANS_THRESHOLD	int	MAX_TRANSACTIONS/2	Active-transaction count that trips a threshold packet when cfg_threshold_enable=1. Replaces the former hardwired 8/4; threshold packets now scale with the table sizing
ENABLE_FILTERING	bit	1	Enable packet filtering: two active drop levels (packet type, then event code). Level 2 is reserved and routes nothing
ADD_PIPELINE_STAGE	bit	0	Add register stage for timing closure
USE_MONITOR	bit	1	Synthesis-time monitor enable. 0 = omit monitor and tie outputs to safe non-blocking defaults; 1 = full monitor

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
			functionality.
N_ADDR_RANGES	int	0	Number of address-range comparators. 0 = checker omitted (zero area). >0 = N independent [low, high] ranges; feeds the shared allowlist checker: a debug-range hit -> AddrMatch, an error-allowlist miss -> Error/ADDR_RANGE (see axi_monitor_addr_check.md).
ADDR_RANGE_IS_ERROR	logic [N_ADDR_RANGES-1:0]	'0	Per-range flavor: bit i = 0 -> DEBUG range (hit -> AddrMatch), 1 -> ERROR range (allowlist miss -> Error/ADDR_RANGE). Default all-0 (feature inert).

7.2.3 Synthesis-Cone Parameters

Each detection cone can be compiled out to save area. The classic cones default on; the debug cone defaults off. Setting a bit to 0 drops the corresponding cone at synthesis via a `generate`-if inside `axi_monitor_reporter` — the area saving is real.

Parameter	Type	Default	Effect when 0
ENABLE_ERROR_LOGIC	bit	1	Drop the error-detection cone
ENABLE_TIMEOUT_LOGIC	bit	1	Drop the timeout cone **and** the `axi_monitor_timeout` instance
ENABLE_COMPL_LOGIC	bit	1	Drop the completion cone
ENABLE_THRESHOLD_LOGIC	bit	1	Drop the threshold cone

Parameter	Type	Default	Effect when 0
ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC	bit	1	Gates only the reporter's legacy perf-packet cone and the two lifetime counters – the window FSM and meters are unconditional
ENABLE_DEBUG_LOGIC	bit	0	Drop the debug (trace) cone — the 6th reporter sub-block (off by default)

Internally the wrapper hardwires two master switches on its `axi_monitor_filtered` instance: `ENABLE_PERF_PACKETS = 1` (the reporter's legacy perf cone is built; `ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC` gates THAT cone only, never the measurement window) and `ENABLE_DEBUG_MODULE = 0` (debug tracking module omitted). These are not top-level parameters of the wrapper.

The transaction CAM is always pipelined.

7.2.4 Derived Parameters (do not override)

These are declared as `parameter` so the elaborator can compute them, not so callers can set them. Each defaults to an expression over the parameters above; overriding one desynchronises it from its source and the design fails to elaborate or silently mis-sizes a bus. Set the parameters they are derived FROM and leave these alone.

Derived parameter	Default expression
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	AXI_DATA_WIDTH / 8
AW	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH
DW	AXI_DATA_WIDTH
IW	AXI_ID_WIDTH
SW	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH
UW	AXI_USER_WIDTH

7.3 Ports

7.3.1 AXI4 Interfaces

Frontend Interface (fub_axi_*): - AR channel inputs: `arid, araddr, arlen, arsize, arburst, arlock, arcache, arprot, arqos, arregion, aruser, arvalid` - AR channel output: `aready` - R channel outputs: `rid, rdata, rresp, rlast, ruser, rvalid` - R channel input: `rready`

Master Interface (m_axi_*): - AR channel outputs: `arid, araddr, arlen, arsize, arburst, arlock, arcache, arprot, arqos, arregion, aruser, arvalid` - AR channel input: `aready` - R channel inputs: `rid, rdata, rresp, rlast, ruser, rvalid` - R channel output: `rready`

7.3.2 Monitor Configuration

Basic Configuration:

Port	Direction	Width	Description
`cfg_monitor_enable`	Input	1	Master runtime gate. 0 = monitor inert: no allocation, transaction CAM held clear, and the upstream ready is never stalled (a disabled monitor cannot block the datapath). 1 = normal operation
`cam_clear`	Input	1	Synchronous clear of the monitor transaction CAM (driven from the harness clear control bit, e.g. CTRL[4])
`cfg_error_enable`	Input	1	Enable error packet generation
`cfg_timeout_enable`	Input	1	Enable timeout detection
`cfg_perf_enable`	Input	1	Enable performance metrics
`cfg_compl_enable`	Input	1	Enable transaction-completion packets
`cfg_threshold_enable`	Input	1	Enable threshold-crossed packets
`cfg_debug_enable`	Input	1	Enable debug/trace packets (gates the debug cone — the 6th reporter sub-block)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
cfg_timeout_cycles	Input	16	Unified coarse timeout control, a MICROSECOND count passed through at FULL 16-bit width: 1..65535 us per phase; 0 = 16'hFFFF (~65 ms, effectively never). One value drives all three phase counts (addr/data/resp). The old 4-bit squash that saturated >= 16 at 15 us is retired
cfg_latency_threshold	Input	32	Latency threshold for alerts
cfg_freq_sel	Input	4	counter_freq_invariant LUT index scaling the 1 us timer tick – the microsecond timeouts above are measured in these ticks

The inner monitor's cfg_debug_level (tied to 0) and cfg_debug_mask (0) are fixed inside the wrapper; cfg_active_trans_threshold is driven from the ACTIVE_TRANS_THRESHOLD parameter (default MAX_TRANSACTIONS/2). cfg_debug_enable is the only debug-cone control exposed here.

Filtering Configuration (levels 1 and 3 drop packets; level 2 is reserved):

Level 1 - Packet Type Masks:

Port	Direction	Width	Description
cfg_axi_pkt_mask	Input	16	Drop mask for entire packet types
cfg_axi_err_select	Input	16	Error routing select (future use)

Level 2 & 3 - Individual Event Masks:

Port	Direction	Width	Description
cfg_axi_error_mask	Input	16	Mask specific error events
cfg_axi_timeout_mask	Input	16	Mask specific timeout events
cfg_axi_compl_mask	Input	16	Mask specific completion events
cfg_axi_thresh_mask	Input	16	Mask specific threshold events
cfg_axi_perf_mask	Input	16	Mask specific performance events
cfg_axi_addr_mask	Input	16	Mask specific address match events
cfg_axi_debug_mask	Input	16	Mask specific debug events

7.3.3 Monitor Bus Output

Port	Direction	Width	Description
monbus_valid	Output	1	Monitor packet valid
monbus_ready	Input	1	Downstream ready to accept packet
monbus_packet	Output	128	monitor_packet_t (see format below)
monbus_timestamp	Output	64	monbus_timestamp_t paired atomically with monbus_packet
debug_block_ready	Output	1	Observability tap for the block_ready gating net (drives nothing internally; leave unconnected if unused)
i_mon_time	Input	64	Free-running counter from monbus_group_core, sampled at packet

Port	Direction	Width	Description
			emission

7.3.4 Status Outputs

Port	Direction	Width	Description
busy	Output	1	Indicates active transactions (for clock gating)
active_transactions	Output	8	Current number of outstanding transactions
error_count	Output	16	Lifetime count of error+timeout packets actually emitted (reporter perf counter; reads 0 when ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC=0 or USE_MONITOR=0)
transaction_count	Output	32	Lifetime count of completion packets actually emitted (zero-extended 16-bit reporter perf counter; reads 0 when ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC=0 or USE_MONITOR=0)
cfg_conflict_error	Output	1	Configuration conflict detected

7.3.5 Packet filters

Two independent runtime filters cut monbus traffic without touching the datapath. Both are inert until driven, which is the failure to watch for: the build-time parameter only decides whether the logic is SYNTHESISED, and a design that sets the parameter but leaves the cfg_* ports tied low filters nothing and looks like the feature is broken.

Address-range filter — ADDR_FILTER_ENABLE (bit, default 0) builds it.

Port	Width	Description
cfg_addr_filter_enable	1	High: suppress packets for transactions outside the window. Low: inert, whatever the parameter says
cfg_addr_filter_low	ADDR_WIDTH	Window base, inclusive
cfg_addr_filter_high	ADDR_WIDTH	Window limit, inclusive

The verdict is latched per table entry at ALLOCATION, from the command address, and held for that entry's life. Widening the window mid-flight does not un-filter entries already admitted — which is exactly what makes it safe to reprogram live, since an entry's fate is decided when it is admitted and the retire accounting cannot be corrupted afterwards. Contrast the address-range CHECKER (N_ADDR_RANGES), which re-evaluates per command.

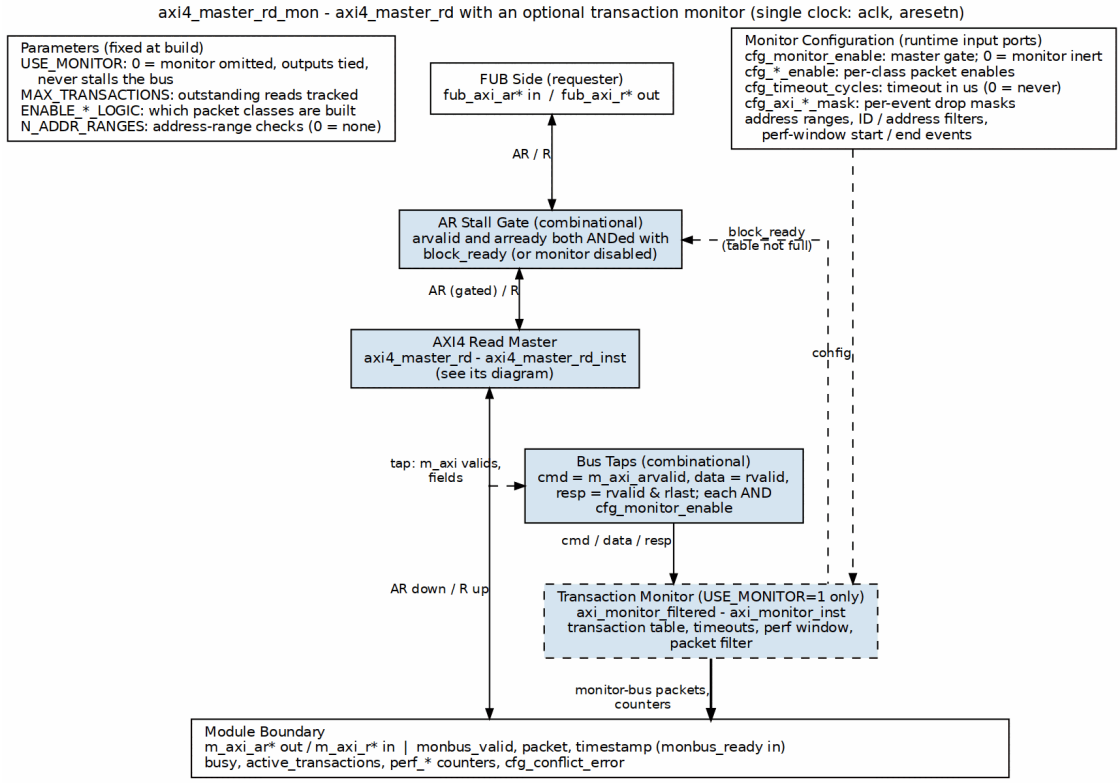
Runtime ID filter — overrides the ID_MATCH_BASE/ID_MATCH_COUNT elaboration constants so an instance can be retargeted at a different master without a rebuild.

Port	Width	Description
cfg_id_filter_enable	1	High: use the window below. Low: use the parameters, bit-identical to a build without this feature
cfg_id_match_base	ID_WIDTH	First ID owned
cfg_id_match_count	ID_WIDTH+1	How many; 0 means ALL, matching the parameter rule so a zeroed register block does not silently filter everything away

The window is half-open: [base, base + count).

7.4 Functional Description

7.4.1 Block diagram



axi4_master_rd_mon block diagram

AXI traffic runs down the left column: through the AR stall gate, into the base `axi4_master_rd` (one child box, see its own diagram), and out through the bar. The monitor taps the m_axi side, below the base, gates each valid with `cfg_monitor_enable`, and `axi_monitor_filtered` turns the transactions into monitor-bus packets (the heavy edge). When its transaction table is full, `block_ready` drops and the stall gate holds both arvalid and arready low, so a full table stalls the bus instead of losing events. With `USE_MONITOR=0` the monitor is omitted, its outputs are tied off, and the gate never stalls.

The module instantiates two sub-modules: 1. **axi4_master_rd** - Core AXI4 functionality with buffering 2. **axi_monitor_filtered** - Transaction monitoring with 2-Level Filtering: packet-type drop masks + per-event masks (err_select is reserved – no routing)

7.4.2 Monitor Backpressure (block_ready)

`block_ready` is exported as the `debug_block_ready` output port – the wrapper deliberately makes the gating contract observable (the plain `_mon_cg` wrapper ties it off rather than forwarding it). It goes low when the monitor's transaction-table occupancy reaches its blocking threshold (a function of `MAX_TRANSACTIONS`; the reporter FIFO depth `INTR_FIFO_DEPTH` has no

path to it). The wrapper ANDs it into the upstream-facing `fub_axi_arready` so a saturated monitor throttles new transactions at the handshake instead of dropping events.

- **Where the stall lands**: the upstream `fub_axi_arready` is forced low until the monitor drains.
- **When `USE_MONITOR=0`**: `block_ready` is internally tied high, so the wrapper imposes no stall and runs at full bandwidth.
- **When `cfg_monitor_enable=0`**: the wrapper gate forces the upstream ready open, so a runtime-disabled monitor can never stall the datapath (in-RTL formal property `ap_disabled_never_stalls`).

Recovery is guaranteed by the **saturation-recovery contract**: command-originated table entries are capped at `MAX_TRANSACTIONS - cmd_entry_reserve(MAX_TRANSACTIONS)` (reserve = 4 for tables of 16 or more, 0 below; the function lives in `monitor_common_pkg`), and `block_ready` re-asserts at occupancy `< MAX_TRANSACTIONS - (reserve - 1)` – a threshold strictly ABOVE the command cap – so a saturated table always drains back below the reopen point. Blocking throttles; it never deadlocks. Tables smaller than 16 keep full legacy allocation (small tables cannot spare slots) and trade the recovery guarantee for tracking capacity. The contract is verified by in-RTL formal properties (mutation-checked) and a 100-seed deliberately-undersized-table stream sweep; see axi_monitor_base for the canonical description.

Sizing note: a monitor on a bus shared by several channels/requesters must size `MAX_TRANSACTIONS` to cover `NUM_CHANNELS x per-channel outstanding` plus margin – the per-channel limit alone makes the monitor throttle the shared master. Tables deeper than 64 also need Verilator's `--unroll-count` raised (default 64) in sim builds.

7.4.3 Address-Range Checker

With `N_ADDR_RANGES > 0` the wrapper instantiates the shared allowlist checker (`axi_monitor_addr_check`). Each range carries a DEBUG/ERROR flavor:

- **DEBUG range** — a hit emits a `PktTypeAddrMatch` (`4'h8`) packet with event code `AXI_ADDR_RANGE_MATCH` (`8'h01`), gated by `cfg_debug_enable`.
- **ERROR range** — the enabled ERROR ranges form an allowlist; an address in NONE of them emits a `PktTypeError` (`4'h0`) packet with event code `AXI_ERR_ADDR_RANGE` (`8'h0D`), gated by `cfg_error_enable`.

This wrapper exposes **`ADDR_RANGE_IS_ERROR`** (per-range) as a parameter, so ranges can be assigned to either flavor.

Config inputs (active only when `N_ADDR_RANGES > 0`): - `cfg_addr_check_enable` — master on/off for the checker. - `cfg_addr_range_enable[N-1:0]` — per-range enable bit. - `cfg_addr_range_low/high[N-1:0][AXI_ADDR_WIDTH-1:0]` — inclusive bounds.

Event encoding: `event_data[63:60]` = `range_index` (matching DEBUG range, or `4'hF` sentinel on an ERROR miss); `event_data[59:0]` = full address. **Filtering:** AddrMatch is dropped by `cfg_axi_addr_mask[1]`, the ADDR_RANGE error by `cfg_axi_error_mask[13]`. See the checker page for coalescing + formal properties.

7.4.4 Performance Monitoring

The wrapper hardwires `ENABLE_PERF_PACKETS = 1` on its inner `axi_monitor_filtered`. The **measurement-window state machine** and its counters are unconditional `always_ff` blocks in `axi_monitor_base` – outside every generate – so they are present and running in EVERY build, including `ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC = 0`. That parameter reaches one consumer: the `g_perf` generate in `axi_monitor_reporter` holding the legacy perf-packet cone and the two 16-bit lifetime counters behind `perf_completed_count` / `perf_error_count`. Setting it to 0 saves that cone and nothing else. `USE_MONITOR = 0` is what ties the perfmon outputs off. The wrapper instantiates plus a bank of R-data-channel utilization counters. All counters accumulate **only while a window is open** (`window_active = 1`) and hold their values between windows, so the host can read a completed window's totals.

7.4.4.1 The Measurement Window

A window is opened by a **start event** and closed by an **end event**. The event sources are selected by `cfg_start_event_sel` / `cfg_end_event_sel` (3-bit; e.g. `3'b010` selects the `cfg_perf_enable` edge) and can also be fired directly by the `cfg_start_trigger` / `cfg_end_trigger` pulses (from an engine or CSR). `cfg_window_force_close` is a software override that closes the window immediately. While the window is open:

- `window_active` is high.
- `window_cycles[31:0]` free-runs, counting every clock elapsed inside the window.

Sample the counters on the cycle `window_active` falls to 0 (drive `cfg_end_trigger`, or wait for the configured end event).

7.4.4.2 Utilization Counters (R Data Channel)

Every cycle inside the window is classified by the R channel's `rvalid` / `rready` into exactly one of four buckets:

Output	Width	Condition	Meaning
`perf_prod_cycles`	32	rvalid && rready	productive beat transferred
`perf_bp_cycles`	32	rvalid && !rready	back-pressure (data offered, sink not ready)
`perf_starv_cyc`	32	!rvalid && rready	starvation (sink

Output	Width	Condition	Meaning
les			ready, no data)
perf_idle_cycles	32	!rvalid && !rready	idle

The four buckets sum to `window_cycles - 1` (the start cycle seeds window_cycles to 1 while the buckets reset to 0); the one-count skew is negligible for long windows.

7.4.4.3 Throughput Counters

Output	Width	Meaning
perf_beat_count	32	R data beats transferred (= perf_prod_cycles, 1 beat/cycle)
perf_byte_count	64	bytes transferred = beats × (1 << ARSIZE), using the ARSIZE captured at the most recent AR address phase (upper bound: counts full-width beats; an unaligned start address means the first beat carries fewer useful bytes)
perf_burst_count	32	AR address-phase handshakes

The integrator computes average burst length as `perf_beat_count / perf_burst_count`.

7.4.4.4 Performance Monitoring Ports

Port	Direction	Width	Description
cfg_perf_enable	Input	1	Enable performance-metric packet generation
cfg_start_event_sel	Input	3	Window **start** event source select
cfg_end_event_sel	Input	3	Window **end** event source select
cfg_start_trigger	Input	1	Pulse: open the measurement window

Port	Direction	Width	Description
cfg_end_trigger	Input	1	Pulse: close the measurement window
cfg_window_force_close	Input	1	Software override: force the window closed
window_active	Output	1	High while a measurement window is open
window_cycles	Output	32	Cycles elapsed in the current window
perf_prod_cycles	Output	32	rvalid && rready cycles
perf_bp_cycles	Output	32	rvalid && !rready cycles (back-pressure)
perf_starv_cycles	Output	32	!rvalid && rready cycles (starvation)
perf_idle_cycles	Output	32	!rvalid && !rready cycles
perf_beat_count	Output	32	R data beats transferred
perf_byte_count	Output	64	bytes transferred
perf_burst_count	Output	32	AR address-phase handshakes

When `USE_MONITOR = 0`, every perfmon output is tied to 0 and the window never opens.

7.4.5 Monitor Packet Format

The 128-bit `monbus_packet` (paired with the 64-bit `monbus_timestamp` side-band signal) follows the standardized AMBA monitor bus format:

```
Bits [127:124] - Packet Type:
  0x0 = ERROR      Error events (SLVERR, DECERR, protocol violations)
  0x1 = COMPL      Completion events (transaction finished)
  0x2 = THRESH     Threshold events
  0x3 = TIMEOUT    Timeout events
  0x4 = PERF       Performance metrics
  0x8 = ADDR_MATCH Address match events
  0x9 = APB        APB-specific events
  0xF = DEBUG      Debug events
```

```
Bits [123:109] - Reserved (15 bits, forward-compat slack)
Bits [108:105] - Protocol (4 bits): 0x0=AXI, 0x1=AXIS, 0x2=APB,
0x3=ARB, 0x4=CORE
Bits [104:97]  - Event Code (8 bits, protocol-specific)
Bits [96:88]   - Channel ID (9 bits — AXI ID or channel index)
Bits [87:72]   - Agent ID (16 bits, from AGENT_ID parameter)
Bits [71:64]   - Unit ID (8 bits, from UNIT_ID parameter)
Bits [63:0]    - Event Data (64 bits — full address, latency, etc.)
```

7.5 Timing Characteristics

Skid parameter	Default depth
SKID_DEPTH_AR	2 entries
SKID_DEPTH_R	4 entries

Each channel traverses one `gaxi_skid_buffer`, which registers both `rd_valid` and its storage. The **1-cycle input-to-output latency therefore applies on every transfer, including the unstalled case** – there is no combinational bypass. Depth buys backpressure absorption, not throughput; full rate is sustained once the pipeline is primed. Legal range is 2..8 inclusive, odd values included.

Clocking: `aclk`, reset `aresetn` (active-low asynchronous).

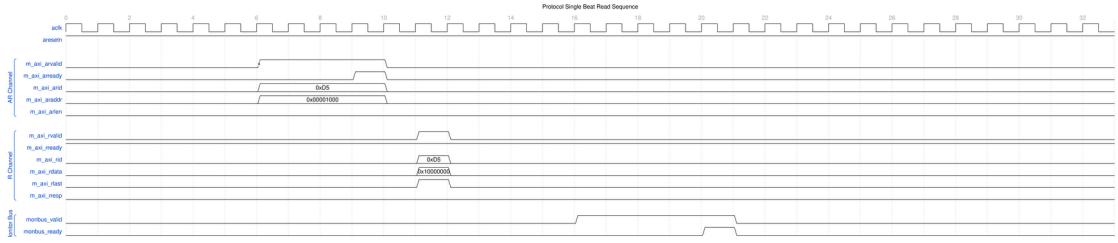
No synthesis numbers are quoted here. Frequency and area depend on the target device and the parameters you elaborate with; run your own build.

7.6 Waveforms

The following waveforms show AXI4 master read monitor behavior across various scenarios:

7.6.1 Scenario 1: Single-Beat Read Transaction

Complete AXI4 read transaction with AR handshake and R response:



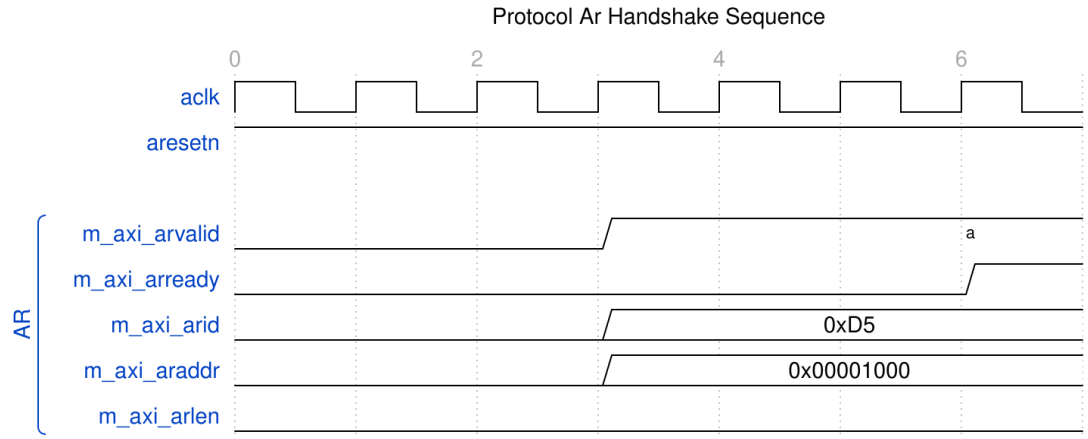
Single Beat Read

WaveJSON: single_beat_read_001.json

Key Observations: - AR channel handshake (ARVALID/ARREADY) - R channel response (RVALID/RREADY/RLAST) - Monitor bus packet generation - Transaction tracking and completion

7.6.2 Scenario 2: AR Channel Handshake Detail

Detailed view of address read channel handshake:



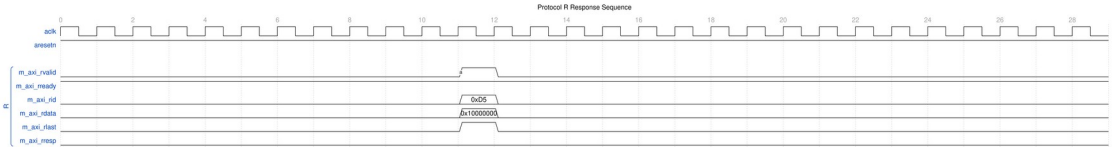
AR Handshake

WaveJSON: ar_handshake_001.json

Key Observations: - ARVALID assertion timing - ARREADY response from slave - Address and control signal stability - Handshake protocol compliance

7.6.3 Scenario 3: R Response Channel Detail

Read data response channel behavior:



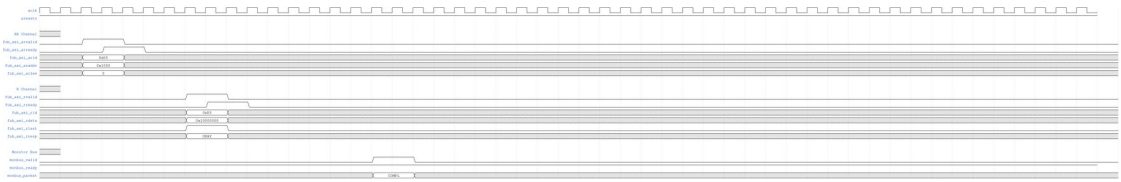
R Response

WaveJSON: r_response_001.json

Key Observations: - RVALID/RREADY handshake - RLAST assertion for transaction completion - RRESP status (OKAY/SLVERR/DECERR) - Read data capture

7.6.4 Scenario 4: Complete AXI4 Read Transaction

End-to-end AXI4 read transaction flow:



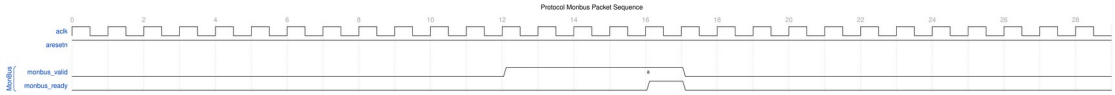
AXI4 Read Transaction

WaveJSON: axi4_read_transaction_001.json

Key Observations: - Complete AR → R channel flow - Transaction ID tracking - Burst length and size handling - Monitor packet correlation

7.6.5 Scenario 5: Monitor Bus Packet Generation

Monitor bus output packet format and timing:



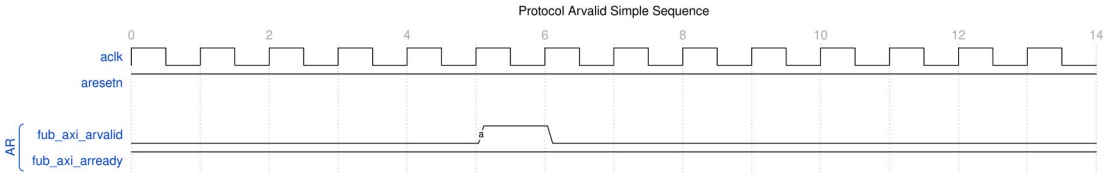
MonBus Packet

WaveJSON: monbus_packet_001.json

Key Observations: - Monitor bus valid/ready handshake - 128-bit packet format (plus 64-bit side-band timestamp) - Packet type encoding - Event data payload

7.6.6 Scenario 6: Simple ARVALID Transaction

Simplified view of ARVALID-based transaction:



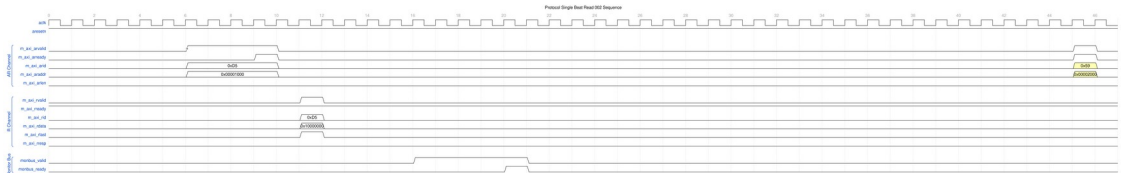
ARVALID Simple

WaveJSON: arvalid_simple_001.json

Key Observations: - Minimal handshake sequence - Single-beat read operation - Fast transaction completion

7.6.7 Scenario 7: Alternative Single-Beat Read

Variant single-beat read with different timing:



Single Beat Read Alt

WaveJSON: single_beat_read_002_001.json

Key Observations: - Different backpressure pattern - Ready signal de-assertion effects - Transaction latency variation

---

7.7 Usage Examples

Every parameter and port below is read from the module declaration.

```
axi4_master_rd_mon #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AR          (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_R           (4),
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH           (8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH         (32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH         (32),
    .AXI_USER_WIDTH         (1),
    .ACLK_MHZ               (100),
    .USE_MONITOR            (1'b1),
    .N_ADDR_RANGES          (0),
    .ADDR_RANGE_IS_ERROR    ('0)
) u_axi4_master_rd_mon (
    .aclk                   (aclk),
    .aresetn                (aresetn),
    .cam_clear              (cam_clear),
    .fub_axi_arid           (fub_axi_arid),
    .fub_axi_araddr         (fub_axi_araddr),
    .fub_axi_arlen          (fub_axi_arlen),
    .fub_axi_arsize         (fub_axi_arsize),
    .fub_axi_arburst        (fub_axi_arburst),
    .fub_axi_arlock         (fub_axi_arlock),
    .fub_axi_arcache        (fub_axi_arcache),
    .fub_axi_arprot         (fub_axi_arprot),
    .fub_axi_arqos          (fub_axi_arqos),
    .fub_axi_arregion       (fub_axi_arregion),
    .fub_axi_aruser         (fub_axi_aruser),
    .fub_axi_arvalid        (fub_axi_arvalid),
    .fub_axi_arready        (fub_axi_arready),
    .fub_axi_rid            (fub_axi_rid),
```

```
    .fub_axi_rdata         (fub_axi_rdata),
    .fub_axi_rresp         (fub_axi_rresp),
    .fub_axi_rlast         (fub_axi_rlast),
    .fub_axi_ruser         (fub_axi_ruser),
    .fub_axi_rvalid        (fub_axi_rvalid),
    .fub_axi_rready        (fub_axi_rready),
    .m_axi_arid            (m_axi_arid),
    .m_axi_araddr          (m_axi_araddr),
    .m_axi_arlen           (m_axi_arlen),
    .m_axi_arsize          (m_axi_arsize),
    .m_axi_arburst         (m_axi_arburst),
    .m_axi_arlock          (m_axi_arlock),
    .m_axi_arcache         (m_axi_arcache),
    .m_axi_arprot          (m_axi_arprot),
    .m_axi_arqos           (m_axi_arqos),
    .m_axi_arregion        (m_axi_arregion),
    .m_axi_aruser          (m_axi_aruser),
    .m_axi_arvalid         (m_axi_arvalid),
    .m_axi_arready         (m_axi_arready),
    .m_axi_rid             (m_axi_rid),
    .m_axi_rdata           (m_axi_rdata),
    .m_axi_rresp           (m_axi_rresp),
    .m_axi_rlast           (m_axi_rlast),
    .m_axi_ruser           (m_axi_ruser),
    .m_axi_rvalid          (m_axi_rvalid),
    .m_axi_rready          (m_axi_rready),
    .cfg_monitor_enable    (cfg_monitor_enable),
    .cfg_error_enable      (cfg_error_enable),
    .cfg_timeout_enable    (cfg_timeout_enable),
    .cfg_perf_enable       (cfg_perf_enable),
    .cfg_compl_enable      (cfg_compl_enable),
    .cfg_threshold_enable  (cfg_threshold_enable),
    .cfg_debug_enable      (cfg_debug_enable),
    .cfg_timeout_cycles    (cfg_timeout_cycles),
    .cfg_freq_sel          (cfg_freq_sel),
    .cfg_latency_threshold (cfg_latency_threshold),
    .cfg_axi_pkt_mask      (cfg_axi_pkt_mask),
    .cfg_axi_err_select    (cfg_axi_err_select),
    .cfg_axi_error_mask    (cfg_axi_error_mask),
    .cfg_axi_timeout_mask  (cfg_axi_timeout_mask),
    .cfg_axi_compl_mask    (cfg_axi_compl_mask),
    .cfg_axi_thresh_mask   (cfg_axi_thresh_mask),
    .cfg_axi_perf_mask     (cfg_axi_perf_mask),
    .cfg_axi_addr_mask     (cfg_axi_addr_mask),
    .cfg_axi_debug_mask    (cfg_axi_debug_mask),
    .cfg_addr_check_enable (cfg_addr_check_enable),
    .cfg_addr_range_enable (cfg_addr_range_enable),
    .cfg_addr_range_low    (cfg_addr_range_low),
```

```
    .cfg_addr_range_high   (cfg_addr_range_high),
    .cfg_id_filter_enable  (cfg_id_filter_enable),
    .cfg_id_match_base     (cfg_id_match_base),
    .cfg_id_match_count    (cfg_id_match_count),
    .cfg_addr_filter_enable(cfg_addr_filter_enable),
    .cfg_addr_filter_low   (cfg_addr_filter_low),
    .cfg_addr_filter_high  (cfg_addr_filter_high),
    .cfg_start_event_sel   (cfg_start_event_sel),
    .cfg_end_event_sel     (cfg_end_event_sel),
    .cfg_start_trigger     (cfg_start_trigger),
    .cfg_end_trigger       (cfg_end_trigger),
    .cfg_window_force_close(cfg_window_force_close),
    .i_mon_time            (i_mon_time),
    .monbus_valid          (monbus_valid),
    .monbus_ready          (monbus_ready),
    .monbus_packet         (monbus_packet),
    .monbus_timestamp      (monbus_timestamp),
    .busy                  (busy),
    .active_transactions   (active_transactions),
    .error_count           (error_count),
    .transaction_count     (transaction_count),
    .debug_block_ready     (debug_block_ready),
    .window_active         (window_active),
    .window_cycles         (window_cycles),
    .perf_prod_cycles      (perf_prod_cycles),
    .perf_bp_cycles        (perf_bp_cycles),
    .perf_starv_cycles     (perf_starv_cycles),
    .perf_idle_cycles      (perf_idle_cycles),
    .perf_beat_count       (perf_beat_count),
    .perf_byte_count       (perf_byte_count),
    .perf_burst_count      (perf_burst_count),
    .cfg_conflict_error    (cfg_conflict_error)
);
```

7.8 Design Notes

7.8.1 Filtering Hierarchy

The 2-Level Filtering: packet-type drop masks + per-event masks (err_select is reserved – no routing)

1. **Level 1 (cfg_axi_pkt_mask):** Coarse filtering by packet type
   - Bit per packet type (ERROR, TIMEOUT, COMPL, etc.)
   - 1 = drop, 0 = pass to next level
2. **Level 2 (cfg_axi_err_select):** Future error routing
   - Reserved for directing errors to alternate paths

3. **Level 3 (cfg_axi_*_mask):** Fine-grained event filtering
    - Individual event masks within each packet type
    - Allows selecting specific events while dropping others

7.8.2 Configuration Conflicts

`cfg_conflict_error` asserts when a packet type dropped by `cfg_axi_pkt_mask` is simultaneously selected for error routing by `cfg_axi_err_select`:

```
assign cfg_conflict_error = |(cfg_axi_pkt_mask & cfg_axi_err_select);
```

7.8.3 Performance Considerations

Monitor Bus Bandwidth: - The reporter sustains at most 1 packet per 2 cycles - Completion packets: 1 per transaction - Performance packets: periodic count rollups (completed-count and error-count), not per-transaction - Error packets: Variable (0-N per transaction)

Recommended Packet Budget: - Functional mode: 1-2 packets per transaction (COMPL + occasional ERROR/TIMEOUT) - Performance mode: ERROR packets plus periodic PERF rollups - Debug mode: several packets per transaction (all types)

7.8.4 Transaction Table

Monitors up to `MAX_TRANSACTIONS` concurrent transactions: - Tracks ARID, address, latency, status - Generates packets on completion, timeout, or error - Proper cleanup via event_reported feedback (fixed in v1.1)

7.9 Related Modules

7.9.1 Companion Monitors

- **axi4_master_wr_mon** - AXI4 master write with monitoring
- **axi4_slave_rd_mon** - AXI4 slave read with monitoring
- **axi4_slave_wr_mon** - AXI4 slave write with monitoring

7.9.2 Base Modules

- **axi4_master_rd** - Functional AXI4 master read (without monitoring)
- **axi_monitor_filtered** - Monitoring engine with filtering (monitor/)

7.9.3 Used Components

- **gaxi_skid_buffer** - Elastic buffering
- **axi_monitor_base** - Core monitoring logic (monitor/)

- **axi_monitor_trans_mgr** - Transaction tracking (monitor/)

7.10 Testing

`val/amba/test_axi4_master_rd_mon.py` exercises this module. It collects 4 parameter cases at the default `REG_LEVEL`.

```
source env_python
pytest val/amba/test_axi4_master_rd_mon.py -v
```

7.11 References

7.11.1 Specifications

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.4.5 “Read and write response structure” (the SLVERR/DECERR codes the monitor reports), ch. A5 “Transaction Identifiers” (per-ID tracking of outstanding transactions), §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the orderings a monitor timeout watches). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.
- Monitor Bus Packet Format: monitor_package_spec.md

7.11.2 Papers and textbooks

- The monitor’s own techniques (transaction table, timeouts, packet filtering) are cited on the AXI Monitor Base page and in the monitor family of the archive.
- Maaref, M. *Architecting and Building High-Speed SoCs*, Packt, 2022, ch. 3 “Basic and Advanced On-Chip Busses and Interconnects” (“AXI bus protocol overview”) – textbook overview of AXI responses and ID ordering (secondary source).
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (protocol specifications are citation only)

7.11.3 Source Code

- RTL: `rtl/amba/axi4/axi4_master_rd_mon.sv`
- Tests: `val/amba/test_axi4_master_rd_mon.py`

- Framework: `bin/TBClasses/components/axi4/`

7.11.4 Documentation

- Configuration Guide: AXI Monitor Base
- Architecture: rtl-amba Overview
- AXI4 Index: axi4/README.md

Last Updated: 2026-07-18

7.12 Navigation

- **← Back to AXI4 Index**
- **← Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **← Back to Main Documentation Index**

8 axi4_master_rd_mon_cg

Module: `axi4_master_rd_mon_cg.sv` **Base Module:** axi4_master_rd_mon **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/` (protocol monitors live with their protocol; only the monitor CORE pieces are in `rtl/amba/ocelus/`) **Status:** Production Ready

---

8.1 Overview

The `axi4_master_rd_mon_cg` module is a clock-gated variant of axi4_master_rd_mon that adds comprehensive power optimization capabilities through activity-based clock gating.

8.1.1 Key Differences from Base Module

- **Activity-Based Clock Gating:** one gate for the whole module, woken by bus valids, core busy, and a pending monitor packet
- **Runtime Control:** `cfg_cg_enable` / `cfg_cg_idle_count` (no per-domain policies)
- **Gating Status:** `cg_gating` / `cg_idle` outputs (no built-in power statistics)
- **Functional differences from base:** `ACTIVE_TRANS_THRESHOLD` not forwarded (harmless – its inner default is derived from the forwarded `MAX_TRANSACTIONS`), `debug_block_ready` tied off, and gated-clock caveats for windows/triggers (see the WARNING below) – use the base module when those matter

All other functionality is identical to the base module. See axi4_master_rd_mon.md for complete functional specification.

8.1.2 When to Use the Clock-Gated Variant

Use `axi4_master_rd_mon_cg` when: - Power consumption is a critical concern - Design has periods of inactivity (burst traffic patterns) - FPGA/ASIC has integrated clock gating support - Meeting power budgets for battery-operated systems

Use base module (`axi4_master_rd_mon`) when: - Maximum performance with no power constraints - Continuous high-activity traffic - Simpler design with fewer configuration parameters - Minimizing gate count is priority

---

8.2 Parameters

A lite-monitor version of this clock-gated wrapper exists as `axi4_master_rd_monlite_cg`: the same gating logic around `axi4_master_rd_monlite` instead of `axi4_master_rd_mon`, about a fifth of the monitor gates.

8.2.1 Clock Gating Parameters

In addition to all parameters from axi4_master_rd_mon, this module adds:

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
`CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH`	int	4	Width of the idle countdown, sizing `cfg_cg_idle_count`
`ADD_PIPELINE_STAGE`	bit	`0`	Insert a register stage for timing closure. Costs a cycle of latency. (Add register stage for timing closure)
`ENABLE_COMPL_LOGIC`	bit	`1'b1`	Synthesise the completion-packet cone. 0 removes the logic entirely.
`ENABLE_DEBUG_LOGIC`	bit	`1'b0`	Synthesise the debug-packet cone. 0 removes the logic entirely.
`ENABLE_ERROR_LOGIC`	bit	`1'b1`	Synthesise the error detection cone. 0 removes the logic entirely.
`ENABLE_FILTERING`	bit	`1`	Enable packet filtering: two active drop levels (packet type, then event code). Level 2 is reserved and routes nothing.
`ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC`	bit	`1'b1`	Synthesise the reporter's performance cone

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
			(g_perf). Does NOT gate the perfmon window state machine or its counters.
ENABLE_THRESHOLD_LOGIC	bit	1'b1	Synthesise the threshold-packet cone. 0 removes the logic entirely.
ENABLE_TIMEOUT_LOGIC	bit	1'b1	Synthesise the timeout detection cone. 0 removes the logic entirely.
SKID_DEPTH_AR	int	2	Skid-buffer depth on the AR channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are legal.
SKID_DEPTH_R	int	4	Skid-buffer depth on the R channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are legal.
AGENT_ID	logic	16'h000A	Agent identifier emitted in the agent_id field of every monitor packet. Pairs with UNIT_ID to identify the packet source. (16-bit Agent ID for monitor packets)
UNIT_ID	logic	8'h01	Unit identifier emitted in the unit_id field of every monitor packet. Give each monitored interface a distinct value or the packets cannot be told apart at the collector. (8-bit Unit ID for monitor packets)

The gating controls are RUNTIME INPUTS: `cfg_cg_enable` and `cfg_cg_idle_count`; status outputs are `cg_gating` / `cg_idle`. ONE `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` gates the entire inner monitor module – there are no per-domain gates and no `cg_*_gated` status signals. (The ENABLE_CLOCK_GATING / CG_IDLE_CYCLES / CG_GATE_* interface this page once documented never existed.)

8.2.2 Base Module Parameters

MOST base-module parameters pass through. As of 2026-09-01 only `ACTIVE_TRANS_THRESHOLD` is NOT forwarded, and that one is harmless: its inner default is `MAX_TRANSACTIONS/2`, computed from the `MAX_TRANSACTIONS` this wrapper DOES forward.

An earlier version of this page listed nine more as unforwarded, which was accurate when written. `ACLK_MHZ`, `CFI_MIN_FREQ_MHZ`, `CFI_MAX_FREQ_MHZ`, `USE_WDATA_ORDER_Q`, `NUM_BANKS` and `ADDR_RANGE_IS_ERROR` were threaded through every `_cg` wrapper on 2026-09-01, and `ID_FILTER_ENABLE` / `ID_MATCH_BASE` / `ID_MATCH_COUNT` the day before. Until then a clock-gated build could not state its clock frequency, so the 1 us timer tick was pinned to the 100 MHz default and every microsecond-denominated timeout was miscalibrated on any other clock – silently.

Among the forwarded ones:

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
`USE_MONITOR`	bit	1	Synthesis-time monitor enable. 0 = omit monitor and tie outputs to safe non-blocking defaults; 1 = full monitor functionality.
`N_ADDR_RANGES`	int	0	Number of address-range comparators (forwarded to base module).
`ADDR_FILTER_ENABLE`	bit	0	Synthesises the address-range report filter. **The parameter only decides whether the logic EXISTS** – a build that sets it and leaves `cfg_addr_filter_enable` low filters nothing and looks broken.
`ID_FILTER_ENABLE`	bit	0	Synthesises the ID report

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
			filter (see `cfg_id_*` for the runtime override).
`ID_MATCH_BASE`	int	0	First ID this instance owns.
`ID_MATCH_COUNT`	int	0	How many IDs; `0` means ALL, so a zeroed register block does not silently filter everything away.

Base-module ports are forwarded EXCEPT `debug_block_ready`, which the wrapper ties off (use the base module when you need the backpressure tap). `cam_clear` is forwarded (Input, 1) - synchronous clear of the monitor transaction CAM (driven from the harness clear control bit, e.g. CTRL[4]) - and the full performance-monitoring interface (see Performance Monitoring below). The six `ENABLE_*_LOGIC` synthesis-cone parameters and the `cfg_compl_enable` / `cfg_threshold_enable` / `cfg_debug_enable` control enables are also passed straight through.

8.2.3 Filter configuration (forwarded)

These reach the inner monitor through this wrapper; before 2026-09-01 they did not.

Port	Direction	Width	Description
`cfg_addr_filter_enable`	Input	1	High: suppress packets for transactions outside the window. Low: inert, whatever `ADDR_FILTER_ENABLE` says
`cfg_addr_filter_low`	Input	ADDR_WIDTH	Window base, inclusive
`cfg_addr_filter_high`	Input	ADDR_WIDTH	Window limit, inclusive
`cfg_id_filter_enable`	Input	1	High: use the runtime window below instead of the `ID_MATCH_*` parameters
`cfg_id_match_base`	Input	ID_WIDTH	First ID to accept
`cfg_id_match_count`	Input	ID_WIDTH+1	How many; `0` means ALL

Neither filter un-filters entries already admitted to the transaction table, which is what makes changing them at runtime safe.

8.2.4 Parameter Relationships

- **`cfg_cg_enable = 0`**: bypasses the gate at runtime; behavior is identical to base
- **`cfg_cg_idle_count`**: higher values keep the clock running longer after traffic stops, so the block is gated less often. It does not change wake-up latency, which is fixed at 1 register stage / 2 clocks to the first usable edge.

8.2.5 Derived Parameters (do not override)

These are declared as `parameter` so the elaborator can compute them, not so callers can set them. Each defaults to an expression over the parameters above; overriding one desynchronises it from its source and the design fails to elaborate or silently mis-sizes a bus. Set the parameters they are derived FROM and leave these alone.

Derived parameter	Default expression
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	AXI_DATA_WIDTH / 8
AW	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH
DW	AXI_DATA_WIDTH
IW	AXI_ID_WIDTH
SW	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH
UW	AXI_USER_WIDTH

8.3 Ports

Port	Dir	Width	Description
aclk	In	1	
aresetn	In	1	
cam_clear	In	1	sync clear of the monitor trans CAM
fub_axi_arid	In	[IW-1:0]	
fub_axi_araddr	In	[AW-1:0]	
fub_axi_arlen	In	[7:0]	
fub_axi_arsize	In	[2:0]	
fub_axi_arburst	In	[1:0]	

Port	Dir	Width	Description
fub_axi_arlock	In	1	
fub_axi_arcache	In	[3:0]	
fub_axi_arprot	In	[2:0]	
fub_axi_arqos	In	[3:0]	
fub_axi_arregion	In	[3:0]	
fub_axi_aruser	In	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_arvalid	In	1	
fub_axi_arready	Out	1	
fub_axi_rid	Out	[IW-1:0]	
fub_axi_rdata	Out	[DW-1:0]	
fub_axi_rresp	Out	[1:0]	
fub_axi_rlast	Out	1	
fub_axi_ruser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_rvalid	Out	1	
fub_axi_rready	In	1	
m_axi_arid	Out	[IW-1:0]	
m_axi_araddr	Out	[AW-1:0]	
m_axi_arlen	Out	[7:0]	
m_axi_arsize	Out	[2:0]	
m_axi_arburst	Out	[1:0]	
m_axi_arlock	Out	1	
m_axi_arcache	Out	[3:0]	
m_axi_arprot	Out	[2:0]	
m_axi_arqos	Out	[3:0]	
m_axi_arregion	Out	[3:0]	
m_axi_aruser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
m_axi_arvalid	Out	1	
m_axi_arready	In	1	
m_axi_rid	In	[IW-1:0]	
m_axi_rdata	In	[DW-1:0]	

Port	Dir	Width	Description
m_axi_rresp	In	[1:0]	
m_axi_rlast	In	1	
m_axi_ruser	In	[UW-1:0]	
m_axi_rvalid	In	1	
m_axi_rready	Out	1	
cfg_monitor_enable	In	1	Enable monitoring
cfg_error_enable	In	1	Enable error detection
cfg_timeout_enable	In	1	Enable timeout detection
cfg_perf_enable	In	1	Enable performance monitoring
cfg_compl_enable	In	1	Enable completion packets
cfg_threshold_enable	In	1	Enable threshold packets
cfg_debug_enable	In	1	Enable debug packets
cfg_timeout_cycles	In	[15:0]	Timeout threshold in MICROSECONDS (1 us tick), despite the name
cfg_freq_sel	In	[3:0]	counter_freq_invariant LUT index
cfg_latency_threshold	In	[31:0]	Latency threshold for alerts
cfg_axi_pkt_mask	In	[15:0]	Drop mask for packet types
cfg_axi_err_select	In	[15:0]	Error select for

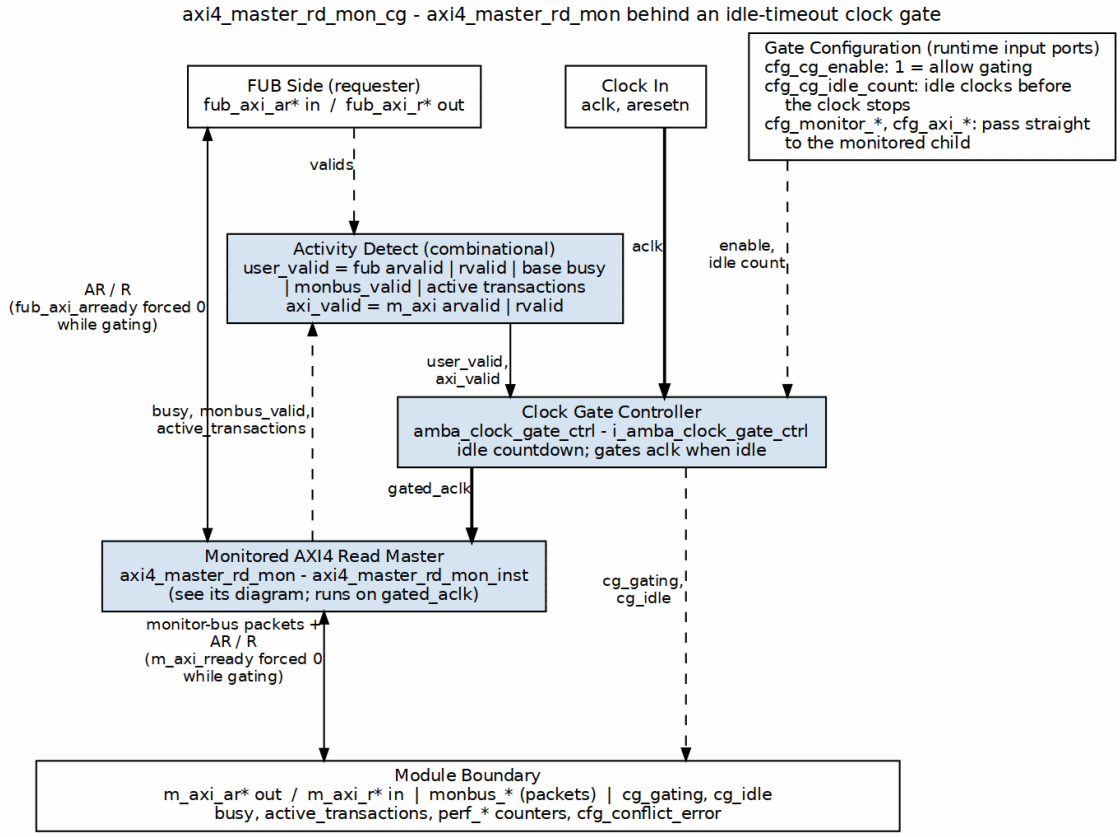
Port	Dir	Width	Description
			packet types (for future routing)
cfg_axi_error_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual error event mask
cfg_axi_timeout_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual timeout event mask
cfg_axi_compl_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual completion event mask
cfg_axi_thresh_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual threshold event mask
cfg_axi_perf_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual performance event mask
cfg_axi_addr_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual address match event mask
cfg_axi_debug_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual debug event mask
cfg_cg_enable	In	1	Enable clock gating
cfg_cg_idle_count	In	[CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH-1:0]	Idle cycles before gating
cfg_addr_check_enable	In	1	
cfg_addr_range_enable	In	[(N_ADDR_RANGES > 0 ? N_ADDR_RANGES : 1)-1:0]	
cfg_addr_range_low	In	[(N_ADDR_RANGES > 0 ? N_ADDR_RANGES : 1)-1:0]	
cfg_addr_range_h	In	[(N_ADDR_RANGES	

Port	Dir	Width	Description
igh		> 0 ? N_ADDR_RANGES : 1)-1:0]	
cfg_addr_filter_enable	In	1	
cfg_addr_filter_low	In	[AW-1:0]	
cfg_addr_filter_high	In	[AW-1:0]	
cfg_id_filter_enable	In	1	
cfg_id_match_base	In	[IW-1:0]	
cfg_id_match_count	In	[IW:0]	
i_mon_time	In	1	
monbus_valid	Out	1	Monitor bus valid
monbus_ready	In	1	Monitor bus ready
monbus_packet	Out	1	Monitor packet (128-bit)
monbus_timestamp	Out	1	Side-band sampled time
busy	Out	1	
active_transactions	Out	[7:0]	Number of active transactions
error_count	Out	[15:0]	Total error count
transaction_count	Out	[31:0]	Total transaction count
cg_gating	Out	1	Gated clock is stopped
cg_idle	Out	1	No activity observed
cfg_conflict_error	Out	1	Configuration conflict detected
cfg_start_event_sel	In	[2:0]	

Port	Dir	Width	Description
cfg_end_event_sel	In	[2:0]	
cfg_start_trigger	In	1	
cfg_end_trigger	In	1	
cfg_window_force_close	In	1	
window_active	Out	1	
window_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_prod_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_bp_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_starv_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_idle_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_beat_count	Out	[31:0]	
perf_byte_count	Out	[63:0]	
perf_burst_count	Out	[31:0]	

8.4 Functional Description

8.4.1 Block diagram



axi4_master_rd_mon_cg block diagram

This is the `_cg` pattern wrapped around `axi4_master_rd_mon` (one child box, see its own diagram): the heavy `aclk` column runs through `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` into the monitored child as `gated_aclk`. The activity term adds `monbus_valid` and any active transactions to the usual valids and `busy`, so the clock cannot stop with a monitor packet or an open transaction in flight. The `cfg_monitor_*` and `cfg_axi_*` ports pass straight through to the child; the outward readies are forced to 0 while gating.

8.4.2 Clock Gating Architecture

ONE `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` gates the whole inner monitor module. The wake term is bus activity plus pending monitor work (`fub_axi_arvalid || fub_axi_rvalid || int_busy || w_monbus_valid || (|active_transactions)` on the user side, `m_axi_arvalid || m_axi_rvalid` on the AXI side); when both sides idle for `cfg_cg_idle_count` cycles with nothing pending on the monitor bus and the monitor CAM empty, everything inside – transaction tracking, reporter, timers, perf counters – stops together. There are no per-domain gates. The external `monbus_valid` is masked with `!cg_gating`, so monitor-bus delivery is exactly-once

across gating at any idle count (`val/amba/test_mon_cg_gating.py` phase 6): a packet pending delivery holds the block awake, and the CAM-occupancy term covers the reporter's few-cycle retire -> FIFO -> output emission window, so a trailing packet cannot be stranded by the clock stopping before its valid rises – even at `cfg_cg_idle_count = 0`.

8.4.3 Gating State Machine

```
ACTIVE  IDLE_COUNT  GATED



        (Activity Detected)

States:
- ACTIVE: Clocks enabled, monitoring activity
- IDLE_COUNT: Counting cfg_cg_idle_count before gating
- GATED: Clocks disabled, waiting for activity
```

8.4.4 Performance Monitoring

The clock-gated wrapper exposes the full perfmon interface of the base module and **forwards every port unchanged** to the inner `axi4_master_rd_mon`. The measurement-window state machine, the four R-channel utilization buckets (productive / back-pressure / starvation / idle), and the beat/byte/burst throughput counters behave exactly as documented in the base module — see Performance Monitoring in axi4_master_rd_mon for the full narrative and per-bit semantics.

Forwarded perfmon ports (identical width and direction to the base module):

- **Inputs:** `cfg_perf_enable`, `cfg_start_event_sel` (3), `cfg_end_event_sel` (3), `cfg_start_trigger`, `cfg_end_trigger`, `cfg_window_force_close`
- **Outputs:** `window_active`, `window_cycles` (32), `perf_prod_cycles` (32), `perf_bp_cycles` (32), `perf_starv_cycles` (32), `perf_idle_cycles` (32), `perf_beat_count` (32), `perf_byte_count` (64), `perf_burst_count` (32)

WARNING – gating vs window accounting. The whole inner monitor runs on the gated clock, window state machine and counters included. An open measurement window is not one of the terms that keeps the clock alive: `user_valid` is bus valids, `busy`, and pending monitor-bus work, and nothing else.

Two consequences:

- **Counters freeze.** If the bus idles past the countdown while a window is open, the clock gates and `window_cycles` and the perf counters stop while wall-clock time keeps passing. The host reads an under-counted window and has no indication it was short.

- **Pulses are dropped.** `cam_clear`, `cfg_start_trigger`, `cfg_end_trigger` and `cfg_window_force_close` are sampled in the gated domain, so a pulse that arrives while the clock is gated is lost entirely.

For exact wall-clock windows, or for triggering on an idle bus, hold `cfg_cg_enable` low across the measurement or use the base module.

8.5 Timing Characteristics

8.5.1 Wake-Up and Gating Latency

Wake-up latency does not depend on `cfg_cg_idle_count`. Activity is registered once (AXI4, AXI5, AXI4-Lite, AXI4-Stream) or twice (APB, APB5, AXI5-Stream) before reaching the ICG enable, which is combinational. This monitor wrapper drives the activity terms combinationally, so it has **1 register stage** and the first usable gated-clock edge arrives **2 clock cycles** after activity asserts.

`cfg_cg_idle_count` sets the going-to-sleep delay only: gating engages `cfg_cg_idle_count + 1` clocks after the internal wakeup deasserts, which is `cfg_cg_idle_count + 2` clocks after the last bus activity.

Configuration	Clocks from last activity to gating	Use Case
`cfg_cg_idle_count=4`	6 clock cycles	Low-latency, frequent bursts
`cfg_cg_idle_count=8`	10 clock cycles	Balanced
`cfg_cg_idle_count=15`	17 clock cycles	Maximum power savings, infrequent traffic

8.6 Usage Examples

8.6.1 Example 1: Maximum Power Savings (Burst Traffic)

```
axi4_master_rd_mon_cg #(
    // Base parameters (see axi4_master_rd_mon.md)
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH(8),
```

```
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH(64),

    .CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH(4)
) u_cg (
    .aclk(clk),
    .aresetn(rst_n),
    // Clock gating -- aggressive: gate quickly after 4 idle cycles
    .cfg_cg_enable(1'b1),
    .cfg_cg_idle_count(4'd4),
    .cg_gating(), .cg_idle(),
    // ... connect signals same as base module
);
```

8.6.2 Example 2: Balanced Performance and Power

```
axi4_master_rd_mon_cg #(
    // Base parameters
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH(8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH(64),

    .CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH(4)
) u_cg (
    .aclk(clk),
    .aresetn(rst_n),
    // Clock gating -- balanced: wait longer before gating (gated less
often)
    .cfg_cg_enable(1'b1),
    .cfg_cg_idle_count(4'd15),
    .cg_gating(), .cg_idle(),
    // ... connect signals same as base module
);
```

8.6.3 Example 3: Clock Gating Disabled (Functional Verification)

```
axi4_master_rd_mon_cg #(
    // Base parameters
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH(8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH(64),

    .CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH(4)
) u_cg (
    .aclk(clk),
    .aresetn(rst_n),
    // Clock gating -- DISABLED for verification (runtime bypass)
    .cfg_cg_enable(1'b0),
    .cfg_cg_idle_count(4'd0),
```

```
    .cg_gating(), .cg_idle(),
    // ... connect signals same as base module
);
```

Note: With `cfg_cg_enable=0`, this module is functionally identical to the base module.

8.7 Design Notes

8.7.1 Power Savings Analysis

These numbers are illustrative, not measured. No power analysis has been run on this library – `axi4_master_rd_cg.md` states the ground truth: power saving is "traffic-dependent; unmeasured in this repo – treat any percentage as a placeholder until characterized." The shape of the curve (more idle time and a shorter idle count save more) is sound; the specific percentages are not sourced and disagree with the guide's table at comparable duty cycles. Treat the rows as a sketch of the trend.

Traffic Pattern	Clock Gating Enabled	Power Savings
10% Utilization	Aggressive (`cfg_cg_idle_count=4`)	60-70%
25% Utilization	Balanced (`cfg_cg_idle_count=8`)	45-55%
50% Utilization	Conservative (`cfg_cg_idle_count=15`)	25-35%
90% Utilization	Any configuration	5-10%

Note: Actual savings depend on FPGA/ASIC technology, tool implementation, and traffic patterns.

8.7.2 Power Monitoring Signals

The module provides these status signals for power analysis:

Signal	Width	Description
`cg_gating`	1	The (single) gated clock is currently stopped
`cg_idle`	1	No activity this cycle (`~r_wakeup` – asserts one cycle after the

Signal	Width	Description
		interfaces go quiet; it does NOT wait for the countdown)

8.7.3 Verification Considerations

Recommendation: Disable clock gating during functional verification:

```
// Testbench instantiation
axi4_master_rd_mon_cg dut (
    .cfg_cg_enable(1'b0),   // runtime bypass for faster simulation
    // ... connections
);
```

Rationale: - Simpler waveforms (no clock gating events) - Faster simulation (no gating overhead) - Easier debug (no timing dependencies)

For power-specific verification:

1. **Enable clock gating** with realistic parameters
2. **Monitor gating signals** (`cg_gating` / `cg_idle`) to verify expected behavior
3. **Vary traffic patterns** to test gating effectiveness
4. **Check wake-up timing** meets system requirements

8.7.4 Synthesis Considerations

FPGA Implementations

Xilinx: - Drive `cfg_cg_enable=1` and let synthesis map the ICG to `BUFGCE` primitives - Tool will infer clock enables automatically - Verify with post-synthesis power analysis

Quartus: - Drive `cfg_cg_enable=1` and let synthesis map the ICG to `ALTCLKCTRL` - May need vendor-specific clock gating primitives - Check power reports for gating effectiveness

Lattice: - Basic clock gating supported - May require manual instantiation of clock enables - Verify functionality in timing simulation

ASIC Implementations: - Work with foundry to select appropriate clock gating cells - Integrated Clock Gating (ICG) cells provide best results - Consider hold-time implications of clock gating - Verify power intent with UPF (Unified Power Format)

8.8 Related Modules

- **axi4_master_rd_mon** - Base module (non-clock-gated)
- **axi_monitor_base** - Core monitoring infrastructure

- **axi_monitor_filtered** - Filtering capabilities

8.8.1 See Also

- **Power Optimization Guide:** `docs/POWER_OPTIMIZATION_GUIDE.md`
- **Clock Gating Best Practices:** `docs/CLOCK_GATING_GUIDE.md`
- **AMBA Subsystem Overview:** `docs/markdown/rtl-amba/overview.md`

8.9 Testing

`val/amba/test_axi4_master_rd_mon_cg.py` exercises this module. It collects 3 parameter cases at the default `REG_LEVEL`.

```
source env_python
pytest val/amba/test_axi4_master_rd_mon_cg.py -v
```

8.10 References

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.4.5 “Read and write response structure” (the SLVERR/DECERR codes the monitor reports), ch. A5 “Transaction Identifiers” (per-ID tracking of outstanding transactions), §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the orderings a monitor timeout watches). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.
- Benini, L., De Micheli, G. “Automatic Synthesis of Low-Power Gated-Clock Finite-State Machines.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 15(6), June 1996. DOI: 10.1109/43.503933 – the latch-based clock-gating cell (`icg`, via `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` and `clock_gate_ctrl`) that gates this wrapper’s clock.
- Benini, L., Bogliolo, A., De Micheli, G. “A Survey of Design Techniques for System-Level Dynamic Power Management.” *IEEE Trans. VLSI Systems*, 8(3), June 2000. DOI: 10.1109/92.845896 – fixed-timeout shutdown: gate after `cfg_cg_idle_count` idle cycles, wake on activity.
- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – AXI4 has no wake-up signal. AXI5 adds AWAKEUP (Issue H §E1.7 “Wake-up Signaling”; Issue L §A14.1.1), which lets a manager restart a gated interface before

VALID. This wrapper wakes on the flopped OR of the VALIDs and holds READY low while gated.

- The monitor's own techniques are cited on the AXI Monitor Base page and in the monitor family of the archive.
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF, archived under `rtl/common/references/`: `LatchBasedClockGating__Benini1996.pdf`, `DynamicPowerManagementTimeout__Benini2000.pdf`)

8.11 Navigation

- **← Back to Base Module**
- **← Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **← Back to Main Documentation Index**

9 AXI4 Master Read Stub

Module: `axi4_master_rd_stub.sv` **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/stubs/` **Status:** Production Ready

9.1 Overview

Drive AXI4 read transactions without writing an AXI4 master into your testbench. The AXI4 Master Read Stub packs the AR (read address) and R (read data) channels into single wide packet buses through skid buffers, so the stimulus side sees one valid/ready handshake and one concatenated payload per channel instead of a dozen individual signals. That makes it a natural fit for testbenches and integration scenarios where a simplified interface beats a protocol-faithful one.

9.1.1 Key Features

- Packed packet interface for AR and R channels
- Configurable skid buffer depth on each channel
- Full AXI4 read transaction support
- Burst, ID, and user signal support
- Parameterized data widths

9.2 Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
SKID_DEPTH_AR	int	2	AR channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
SKID_DEPTH_R	int	4	R channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
AXI_ID_WIDTH	int	8	AXI transaction ID width
AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	int	32	AXI address bus width
AXI_DATA_WIDTH	int	32	AXI data bus width
AXI_USER_WIDTH	int	1	AXI user signal width
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	int	AXI_DATA_WIDTH/8	Write strobe width (unused)

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
AW	int	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	Short alias for address width
DW	int	AXI_DATA_WIDTH	Short alias for data width
IW	int	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Short alias for ID width
SW	int	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	Short alias for strobe width
UW	int	AXI_USER_WIDTH	Short alias for user width
ARSize	int	IW+AW+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+UW	AR packet size (calculated)
RSize	int	IW+DW+2+1+UW	R packet size (calculated)

9.3 Ports

9.3.1 Clock and Reset

Port	Direction	Width	Description
aclk	Input	1	AXI clock
aresetn	Input	1	AXI reset (active low)

9.3.2 AXI4 Read Address Channel (AR)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
m_axi_arid	Output	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Read address ID
m_axi_araddr	Output	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	Read address
m_axi_arlen	Output	8	Burst length
m_axi_arsize	Output	3	Burst size
m_axi_arburst	Output	2	Burst type
m_axi_arlock	Output	1	Lock type

Port	Direction	Width	Description
m_axi_arcache	Output	4	Cache type
m_axi_arprot	Output	3	Protection type
m_axi_arqos	Output	4	Quality of service
m_axi_arregion	Output	4	Region identifier
m_axi_aruser	Output	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User signal
m_axi_arvalid	Output	1	Read address valid
m_axi_arready	Input	1	Read address ready

9.3.3 AXI4 Read Data Channel (R)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
m_axi_rid	Input	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Read data ID
m_axi_rdata	Input	AXI_DATA_WIDTH	Read data
m_axi_rresp	Input	2	Read response
m_axi_rlast	Input	1	Read last
m_axi_ruser	Input	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User signal
m_axi_rvalid	Input	1	Read data valid
m_axi_rready	Output	1	Read data ready

9.3.4 AR Packet Interface

Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_arvalid	Input	1	AR packet valid
fub_axi_arready	Output	1	Ready to accept AR packet

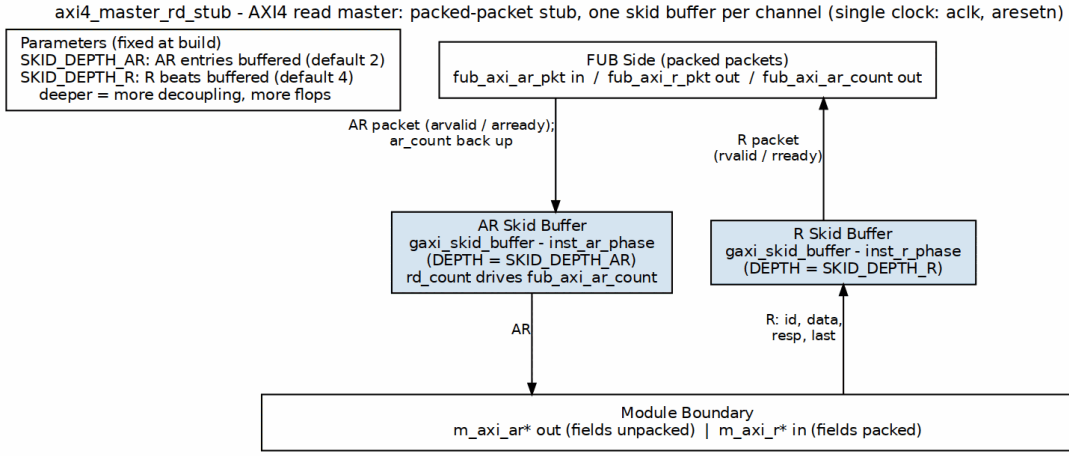
Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_ar_count	Output	4	AR skid occupancy (driven since the round_20 fix)
fub_axi_ar_pkt	Input	ARSize	Packed AR packet data

9.3.5 R Packet Interface

Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_rvalid	Output	1	R packet valid
fub_axi_rready	Input	1	Ready to accept R packet
fub_axi_r_pkt	Output	RSize	Packed R packet data

9.4 Functional Description

9.4.1 Block diagram



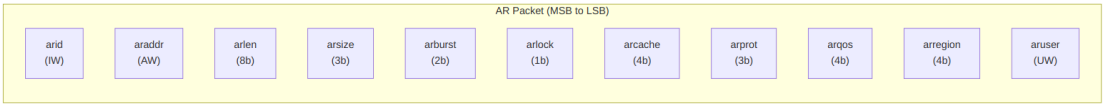
axi4_master_rd_stub block diagram

This stub is `axi4_master_rd` with a packed-packet interface at the top (FUB side): each channel's fields travel as one packet (`*_pkt`) through its own `gaxi_skid_buffer` (`inst_*_phase`), and are unpacked onto, or packed from, the AXI4 fields at the other side. The AR buffer's occupancy is exported as `fub_axi_ar_count`. There is no busy output and no clock gating.

Two skid buffers do all the real work here. The AR buffer unpacks your packet onto the AXI4 AR channel; the R buffer packs the returning read data back into a packet. Everything else is wiring.

9.4.2 Packet Formats

Packets are packed MSB-to-LSB in AXI signal order, so building one in the testbench is a single concatenation.

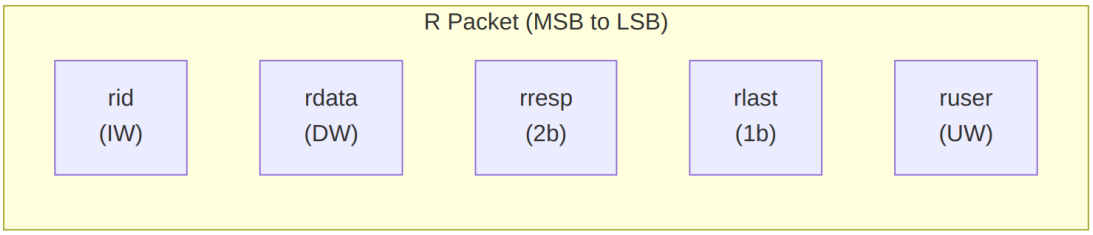


AR Packet Structure (Read Address)

Bit Positions:

```
fub_axi_ar_pkt = {arid, araddr, arlen, arsize, arburst, arlock,
arcache, arprot, arqos, arregion, aruser}

Width = IW + AW + 8 + 3 + 2 + 1 + 4 + 3 + 4 + 4 + UW
```

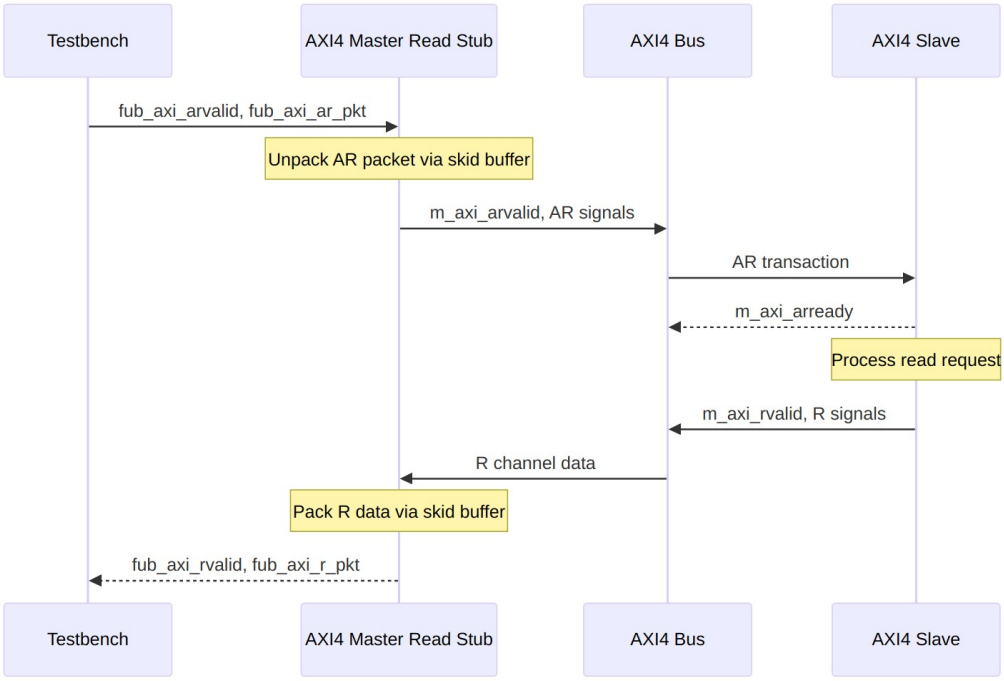


R Packet Structure (Read Data)

Bit Positions:

```
fub_axi_r_pkt = {rid, rdata, rresp, rlast, ruser}

Width = IW + DW + 2 + 1 + UW
```



Transaction Flow

9.5 Timing Characteristics

Timing diagram pending. The signals and sequence this scenario exercises:

- aclk
- fub_axi_arvalid, fub_axi_arready, fub_axi_ar_pkt
- AXI AR signals (m_axi_arvalid, m_axi_araddr, m_axi_arlen, etc.)
- AXI R signals (m_axi_rvalid, m_axi_rdata, m_axi_rlast, etc.)
- fub_axi_rvalid, fub_axi_rready, fub_axi_r_pkt
- Packet-to-AXI timing relationship with skid buffer operation

9.6 Usage Examples

```
axi4_master_rd_stub #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AR   (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_R    (4),
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH    (8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH  (32),
```

```
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH  (64),
    .AXI_USER_WIDTH  (4)
) u_axi4_master_rd_stub (
    .aclk            (axi_clk),
    .aresetn         (axi_rst_n),

    // AXI4 master read interface
    .m_axi_arid      (m_axi_arid),
    .m_axi_araddr    (m_axi_araddr),
    .m_axi_arlen     (m_axi_arlen),
    .m_axi_arsize    (m_axi_arsize),
    .m_axi_arburst   (m_axi_arburst),
    .m_axi_arlock    (m_axi_arlock),
    .m_axi_arcache   (m_axi_arcache),
    .m_axi_arprot    (m_axi_arprot),
    .m_axi_arqos     (m_axi_arqos),
    .m_axi_arregion  (m_axi_arregion),
    .m_axi_aruser    (m_axi_aruser),
    .m_axi_arvalid   (m_axi_arvalid),
    .m_axi_arready   (m_axi_arready),

    .m_axi_rid       (m_axi_rid),
    .m_axi_rdata     (m_axi_rdata),
    .m_axi_rresp     (m_axi_rresp),
    .m_axi_rlast     (m_axi_rlast),
    .m_axi_ruser     (m_axi_ruser),
    .m_axi_rvalid    (m_axi_rvalid),
    .m_axi_rready    (m_axi_rready),

    // Packed AR interface
    .fub_axi_arvalid (tb_ar_valid),
    .fub_axi_arready (tb_ar_ready),
    .fub_axi_ar_count(tb_ar_count),
    .fub_axi_ar_pkt  (tb_ar_pkt),

    // Packed R interface
    .fub_axi_rvalid  (tb_r_valid),
    .fub_axi_rready  (tb_r_ready),
    .fub_axi_r_pkt   (tb_r_pkt)
);

// Build AR packet (single beat read at address 0x1000)
localparam ARSize = 8 + 32 + 8 + 3 + 2 + 1 + 4 + 3 + 4 + 4 + 4;  //
Calculate size
assign tb_ar_pkt = {
    8'd0,           // arid
    32'h0000_1000,  // araddr
```

```
    8'd0,           // arlen (1 beat)
    3'b011,         // arsize (8 bytes)
    2'b01,          // arburst (INCR)
    1'b0,           // arlock
    4'b0011,        // arcache
    3'b000,         // arprot
    4'b0000,        // arqos
    4'b0000,        // arregion
    4'h0            // aruser
};

// Parse R packet
localparam int RSize = 8+64+2+1+4;  // match your instance widths
wire [7:0]  r_id   = tb_r_pkt[RSize-1:RSize-8];
wire [63:0] r_data = tb_r_pkt[RSize-9:RSize-72];
wire [1:0]  r_resp = tb_r_pkt[6:5];
wire        r_last = tb_r_pkt[4];
wire [3:0]  r_user = tb_r_pkt[3:0];
```

9.7 Design Notes

9.7.1 Skid Buffer Operation

The stub is only as smart as its `gaxi_skid_buffer` instances, which is exactly the point. They:

- Decouple timing between testbench and AXI bus
- Provide configurable buffering depth per channel
- Handle backpressure gracefully
- Support burst transactions without stalling

Recommended Depths: - **AR Channel:** 2-4 (address transactions) - **R Channel:** 4-8 (data beats for bursts)

9.7.2 Packet Packing Order

AR and R packets are packed MSB-to-LSB following AXI signal order:

- Simplifies testbench packet creation
- Matches common concatenation order
- Efficient for burst transaction handling

9.7.3 Internal Architecture

The stub instantiates two `gaxi_skid_buffer` modules:

- **AR Skid Buffer:** Unpacks AR packets to AXI AR channel
- **R Skid Buffer:** Packs AXI R channel to R packets

All AXI protocol handling is done by the skid buffers and downstream modules.

9.8 Related Modules

- **AXI4 Master Read** - Full AXI4 master read module (if wrapping one)
- **AXI4 Master Write Stub** - Corresponding write stub
- **AXI4 Master Stub** - Combined read/write stub
- **AXI4 Slave Read Stub** - Slave-side read stub

9.9 Testing

No dedicated testbench, and none is expected. This is a stub: a tie-off shell that presents the interface and drives inert values, so there is no behaviour to verify beyond elaboration. `make verilator` lints it as its own top on every run, which is the coverage that applies.

Treat any behaviour described on this page as unverified by simulation.

9.10 References

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.2.1 “Handshake process” and §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the per-channel VALID/READY contract each skid buffer preserves); §A1.2.3 “Register slices” and §A3.1.1 “Clock” (a register stage may sit in any channel for one cycle of latency, and an interface must have no combinational input-to-output path, which a slice breaks). §A5.2.1 “Read data ordering” (same-ID read data returns in order, so a FIFO per channel is enough). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.
- Carloni, L.P., McMillan, K.L., Sangiovanni-Vincentelli, A.L. “Theory of Latency-Insensitive Design.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 20(9), Sept. 2001. DOI: 10.1109/43.945302 – relay stations: a channel can be pipelined by any number of back-pressured stages without changing its behavior, which is why a skid buffer per channel is transparent to both ends.

- Cortadella, J., Kishinevsky, M., Grundmann, B. “Synthesis of Synchronous Elastic Architectures.” *Proc. 43rd Design Automation Conference (DAC ’06)*, July 2006, pp. 657-662. DOI: 10.1145/1146909.1147077 – the elastic buffer with valid/stop back-pressure, the structure a skid buffer implements.
- Chipressian. *Crack the Hardware Interview: from RTL Designers’ Perspective*, Part 2 ch. 2 “Handshake Protocols” (forward and backward register slices) – textbook treatment of the valid/ready slice; the backward slice’s extra data register is the skid entry (secondary source).
- Maaref, M. *Architecting and Building High-Speed SoCs*, Packt, 2022, ch. 3 “Basic and Advanced On-Chip Busses and Interconnects” (“AXI bus protocol overview”) – textbook overview of the AXI channels, bursts and ID ordering (secondary source).
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF: `LatencyInsensitiveDesign__Carloni2001.pdf`, `ElasticBuffer__Cortadella2006.pdf`)

9.11 Navigation

- **← Back to AXI4 Index**
- **← Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **← Back to Main Documentation Index**

10 AXI4 Master Stub

Module: `axi4_master_stub.sv` **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/stubs/` **Status:** Production Ready

10.1 Overview

Why instantiate two stubs when one will do? The AXI4 Master Stub combines the read and write stubs into a single module — it internally instantiates `axi4_master_rd_stub` and `axi4_master_wr_stub` — giving you packed packet interfaces on all five AXI4 channels behind one complete AXI4 master port. It's built for testbenches and integration scenarios where packet-based control beats wrangling individual AXI signals.

10.1.1 Key Features

- Combined read and write channel support
- Packed packet interfaces for all channels (AW, W, B, AR, R)
- Configurable skid buffer depths per channel
- Full AXI4 protocol support (bursts, IDs, user signals)
- Simplified testbench integration
- Parameterized data widths

10.2 Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
SKID_DEPTH_AW	int	2	AW channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
SKID_DEPTH_W	int	4	W channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
SKID_DEPTH_B	int	2	B channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
SKID_DEPTH_AR	int	2	AR channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
SKID_DEPTH_R	int	4	R channel skid buffer

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
			depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
AXI_ID_WIDTH	int	8	AXI transaction ID width
AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	int	32	AXI address bus width
AXI_DATA_WIDTH	int	32	AXI data bus width
AXI_USER_WIDTH	int	1	AXI user signal width
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	int	AXI_DATA_WIDTH/8	Write strobe width
AW	int	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	Short alias for address width
DW	int	AXI_DATA_WIDTH	Short alias for data width
IW	int	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Short alias for ID width
SW	int	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	Short alias for strobe width
UW	int	AXI_USER_WIDTH	Short alias for user width
AWSize	int	IW+AW+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+UW	AW packet size (calculated)
WSize	int	DW+SW+1+UW	W packet size (calculated)
BSize	int	IW+2+UW	B packet size (calculated)
ARSize	int	IW+AW+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+UW	AR packet size (calculated)
RSize	int	IW+DW+2+1+UW	R packet size (calculated)

10.3 Ports

10.3.1 Clock and Reset

Port	Direction	Width	Description
aclk	Input	1	AXI clock

Port	Direction	Width	Description
aresetn	Input	1	AXI reset (active low)

10.3.2 AXI4 Write Channels

Port	Direction	Width	Description
m_axi_awid	Output	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Write address ID
m_axi_awaddr	Output	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	Write address
m_axi_awlen	Output	8	Burst length
m_axi_awsize	Output	3	Burst size
m_axi_awburst	Output	2	Burst type
m_axi_awlock	Output	1	Lock type
m_axi_awcache	Output	4	Cache type
m_axi_awprot	Output	3	Protection type
m_axi_awqos	Output	4	Quality of service
m_axi_awregion	Output	4	Region identifier
m_axi_awuser	Output	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User signal
m_axi_awvalid	Output	1	Write address valid
m_axi_awready	Input	1	Write address ready
m_axi_wdata	Output	AXI_DATA_WIDTH	Write data
m_axi_wstrb	Output	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	Write strobes
m_axi_wlast	Output	1	Write last
m_axi_wuser	Output	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User signal

Port	Direction	Width	Description
m_axi_wvalid	Output	1	Write data valid
m_axi_wready	Input	1	Write data ready
m_axi_bid	Input	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Response ID
m_axi_bresp	Input	2	Write response
m_axi_buser	Input	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User signal
m_axi_bvalid	Input	1	Write response valid
m_axi_bready	Output	1	Write response ready

10.3.3 AXI4 Read Channels

Port	Direction	Width	Description
m_axi_arid	Output	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Read address ID
m_axi_araddr	Output	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	Read address
m_axi_arlen	Output	8	Burst length
m_axi_arsize	Output	3	Burst size
m_axi_arburst	Output	2	Burst type
m_axi_arlock	Output	1	Lock type
m_axi_arcache	Output	4	Cache type
m_axi_arprot	Output	3	Protection type
m_axi_arqos	Output	4	Quality of service
m_axi_arregion	Output	4	Region identifier
m_axi_aruser	Output	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User signal
m_axi_arvalid	Output	1	Read address valid

Port	Direction	Width	Description
m_axi_arready	Input	1	Read address ready
m_axi_rid	Input	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Read data ID
m_axi_rdata	Input	AXI_DATA_WIDTH	Read data
m_axi_rresp	Input	2	Read response
m_axi_rlast	Input	1	Read last
m_axi_ruser	Input	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User signal
m_axi_rvalid	Input	1	Read data valid
m_axi_rready	Output	1	Read data ready

10.3.4 Write Packet Interfaces

Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_awvalid	Input	1	AW packet valid
fub_axi_awready	Output	1	Ready to accept AW packet
fub_axi_aw_count	Output	4	AW buffer occupancy
fub_axi_aw_pkt	Input	AWSize	Packed AW packet data
fub_axi_wvalid	Input	1	W packet valid
fub_axi_wready	Output	1	Ready to accept W packet
fub_axi_w_pkt	Input	WSize	Packed W packet data
fub_axi_bvalid	Output	1	B packet valid
fub_axi_bread	Input	1	Ready to

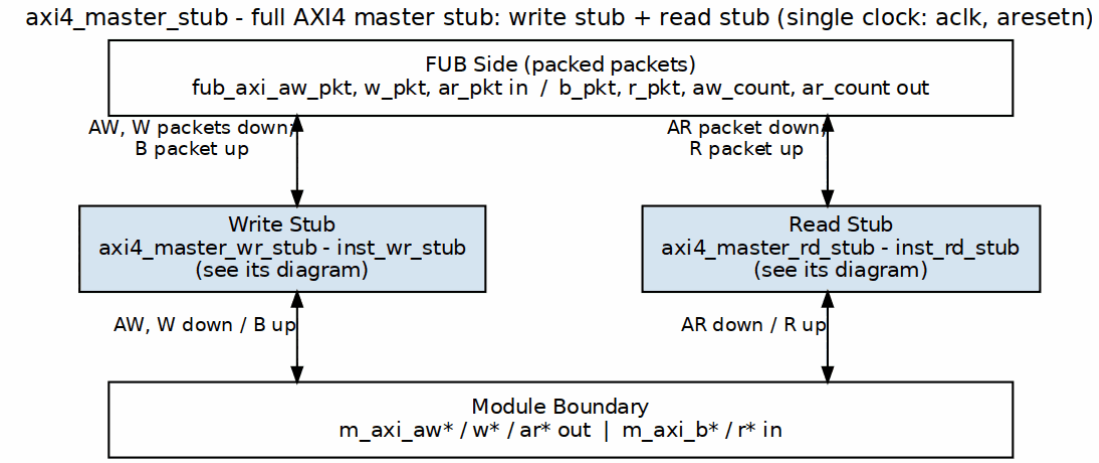
Port	Direction	Width	Description
y			accept B packet
fub_axi_b_pkt	Output	BSize	Packed B packet data

10.3.5 Read Packet Interfaces

Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_arvalid	Input	1	AR packet valid
fub_axi_arready	Output	1	Ready to accept AR packet
fub_axi_ar_count	Output	4	AR skid occupancy (driven since the round_20 fix; was an undriven 3-bit port)
fub_axi_ar_pkt	Input	ARSize	Packed AR packet data
fub_axi_rvalid	Output	1	R packet valid
fub_axi_rready	Input	1	Ready to accept R packet
fub_axi_r_pkt	Output	RSize	Packed R packet data

10.4 Functional Description

10.4.1 Block diagram



axi4_master_stub block diagram

The full master stub is two child boxes: `axi4_master_wr_stub` (AW, W, B) and `axi4_master_rd_stub` (AR, R), each with its own diagram. The packed packets and the AW/AR occupancy counts are at the FUB side on top; the AXI4 master fields are at the bar. The two halves share only the clock and reset.

10.4.2 Packet Formats

10.4.2.1 Write Channel Packets

AW Packet (Write Address):

```
fub_axi_aw_pkt = {awid, awaddr, awlen, awsize, awburst, awlock,
awcache, awprot, awqos, awregion, awuser}
Width = IW + AW + 8 + 3 + 2 + 1 + 4 + 3 + 4 + 4 + UW
```

W Packet (Write Data):

```
fub_axi_w_pkt = {wdata, wstrb, wlast, wuser}
Width = DW + SW + 1 + UW
```

B Packet (Write Response):

```
fub_axi_b_pkt = {bid, bresp, buser}
Width = IW + 2 + UW
```

10.4.2.2 Read Channel Packets

AR Packet (Read Address):

```
fub_axi_ar_pkt = {arid, araddr, arlen, arsize, arburst, arlock,
arcache, arprot, arqos, arregion, aruser}
Width = IW + AW + 8 + 3 + 2 + 1 + 4 + 3 + 4 + 4 + UW
```

R Packet (Read Data):

```
fub_axi_r_pkt = {rid, rdata, rresp, rlast, ruser}
Width = IW + DW + 2 + 1 + UW
```

Complete packet format details: See AXI4 Master Write Stub and AXI4 Master Read Stub

10.4.3 Transaction Flow

Read and write run independently and can overlap — the sequence below shows both in flight at once.

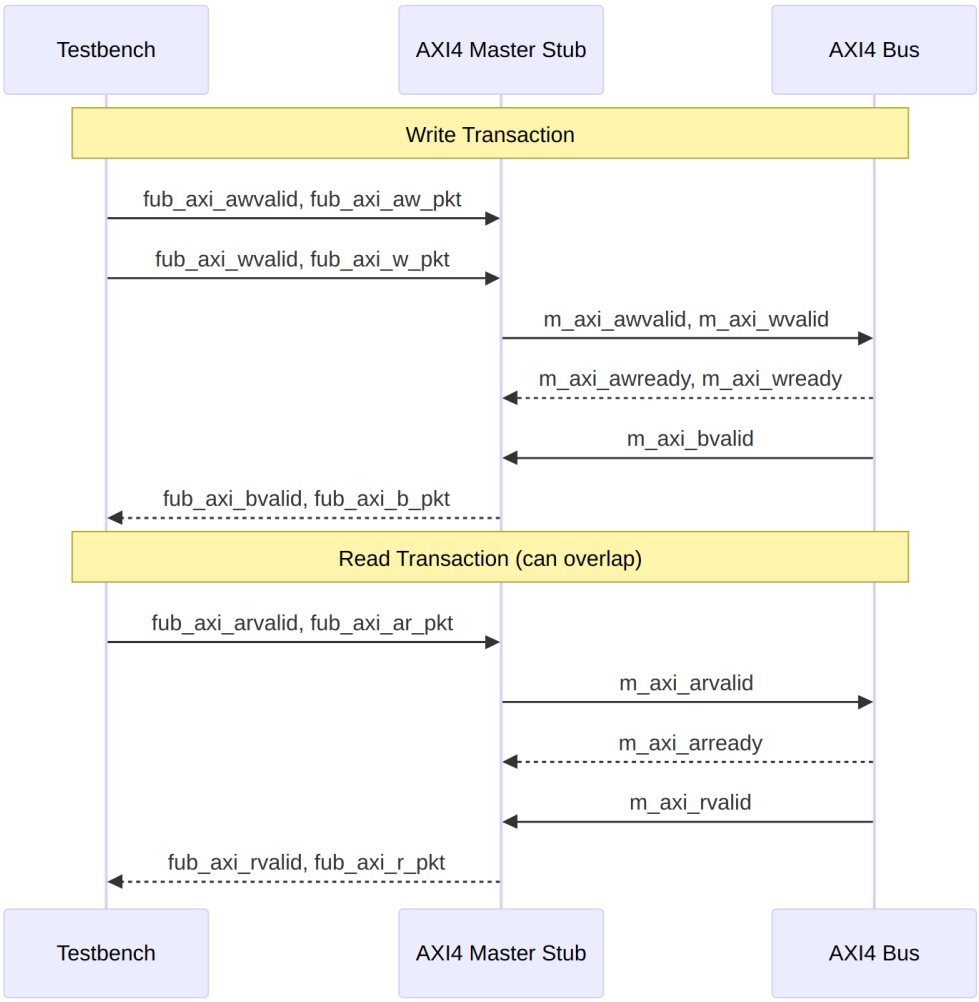


Diagram 7

10.5 Timing Characteristics

Timing diagram pending. The signals and sequence this scenario exercises:

- aclk
- Write packet interfaces (fub_axi_aw, *fub_axi_w*, fub_axi_b*)
- Read packet interfaces (fub_axi_ar, *fub_axi_r*)
- AXI write channels (m_axi_aw, *m_axi_w*, m_axi_b*)
- AXI read channels (m_axi_ar, *m_axi_r*)
- Overlapping read/write operations

10.6 Usage Examples

```
axi4_master_stub #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AW   (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_W    (4),
    .SKID_DEPTH_B    (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_AR   (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_R    (4),
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH    (8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH  (32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH  (64),
    .AXI_USER_WIDTH  (4)
) u_axi4_master_stub (
    .aclk            (axi_clk),
    .aresetn         (axi_rst_n),

    // AXI4 master interface (all channels)
    .m_axi_awid      (m_axi_awid),
    .m_axi_awaddr    (m_axi_awaddr),
    .m_axi_awlen     (m_axi_awlen),
    .m_axi_awsize    (m_axi_awsize),
    .m_axi_awburst   (m_axi_awburst),
    .m_axi_awlock    (m_axi_awlock),
    .m_axi_awcache   (m_axi_awcache),
    .m_axi_awprot    (m_axi_awprot),
    .m_axi_awqos     (m_axi_awqos),
    .m_axi_awregion  (m_axi_awregion),
    .m_axi_awuser    (m_axi_awuser),
    .m_axi_awvalid   (m_axi_awvalid),
    .m_axi_awready   (m_axi_awready),
```

```
    .m_axi_wdata     (m_axi_wdata),
    .m_axi_wstrb     (m_axi_wstrb),
    .m_axi_wlast     (m_axi_wlast),
    .m_axi_wuser     (m_axi_wuser),
    .m_axi_wvalid    (m_axi_wvalid),
    .m_axi_wready    (m_axi_wready),

    .m_axi_bid       (m_axi_bid),
    .m_axi_bresp     (m_axi_bresp),
    .m_axi_buser     (m_axi_buser),
    .m_axi_bvalid    (m_axi_bvalid),
    .m_axi_bready    (m_axi_bready),

    .m_axi_arid      (m_axi_arid),
    .m_axi_araddr    (m_axi_araddr),
    .m_axi_arlen     (m_axi_arlen),
    .m_axi_arsize    (m_axi_arsize),
    .m_axi_arburst   (m_axi_arburst),
    .m_axi_arlock    (m_axi_arlock),
    .m_axi_arcache   (m_axi_arcache),
    .m_axi_arprot    (m_axi_arprot),
    .m_axi_arqos     (m_axi_arqos),
    .m_axi_arregion  (m_axi_arregion),
    .m_axi_aruser    (m_axi_aruser),
    .m_axi_arvalid   (m_axi_arvalid),
    .m_axi_arready   (m_axi_arready),

    .m_axi_rid       (m_axi_rid),
    .m_axi_rdata     (m_axi_rdata),
    .m_axi_rresp     (m_axi_rresp),
    .m_axi_rlast     (m_axi_rlast),
    .m_axi_ruser     (m_axi_ruser),
    .m_axi_rvalid    (m_axi_rvalid),
    .m_axi_rready    (m_axi_rready),

    // Write packet interfaces
    .fub_axi_awvalid (tb_aw_valid),
    .fub_axi_awready (tb_aw_ready),
    .fub_axi_aw_count(tb_aw_count),
    .fub_axi_aw_pkt  (tb_aw_pkt),

    .fub_axi_wvalid  (tb_w_valid),
    .fub_axi_wready  (tb_w_ready),
    .fub_axi_w_pkt   (tb_w_pkt),
```

```
    .fub_axi_bvalid  (tb_b_valid),
    .fub_axi_bready  (tb_b_ready),
    .fub_axi_b_pkt   (tb_b_pkt),

    // Read packet interfaces
    .fub_axi_arvalid (tb_ar_valid),
    .fub_axi_arready (tb_ar_ready),
    .fub_axi_ar_count(tb_ar_count),
    .fub_axi_ar_pkt  (tb_ar_pkt),

    .fub_axi_rvalid  (tb_r_valid),
    .fub_axi_rready  (tb_r_ready),
    .fub_axi_r_pkt   (tb_r_pkt)
);

// Example: Build write transaction packets
assign tb_aw_pkt = {
    8'd1,           // awid
    32'h1000_0000,  // awaddr
    8'd0,           // awlen (1 beat)
    3'b011,         // awsize (8 bytes)
    2'b01,          // awburst (INCR)
    1'b0,           // awlock
    4'b0011,        // awcache
    3'b000,         // awprot
    4'b0000,        // awqos
    4'b0000,        // awregion
    4'h0            // awuser
};

assign tb_w_pkt = {
    64'hDEAD_BEEF_CAFE_BABE,  // wdata
    8'hFF,                    // wstrb
    1'b1,                     // wlast
    4'h0                      // wuser
};

// Example: Build read transaction packet
assign tb_ar_pkt = {
    8'd2,           // arid
    32'h2000_0000,  // araddr
    8'd3,           // arlen (4 beats)
    3'b011,         // arsize (8 bytes)
    2'b01,          // arburst (INCR)
    1'b0,           // arlock
    4'b0011,        // arcache
    3'b000,         // arprot
```

```
    4'b0000,        // arqos
    4'b0000,        // arregion
    4'h0            // aruser
};

// Parse responses
localparam int BSize = 8 + 2 + 4;        // IW + resp + UW -- match
your instance
localparam int RSize = 8 + 64 + 2 + 1 + 4; // IW + DW + resp + last +
UW
wire [7:0] b_id   = tb_b_pkt[BSize-1:BSize-8];
wire [1:0] b_resp = tb_b_pkt[5:4];

wire [7:0]  r_id   = tb_r_pkt[RSize-1:RSize-8];
wire [63:0] r_data = tb_r_pkt[RSize-9:RSize-72];
wire [1:0]  r_resp = tb_r_pkt[6:5];
wire        r_last = tb_r_pkt[4];
```

10.7 Design Notes

10.7.1 Internal Architecture

The stub instantiates two sub-modules:

- **axi4_master_wr_stub** - Handles AW, W, and B channels
- **axi4_master_rd_stub** - Handles AR and R channels

This hierarchical design:

- Reuses proven read/write stub modules
- Maintains clear channel separation
- Simplifies verification and testing
- Allows independent read/write operation

10.7.2 Read/Write Independence

Read and write channels are completely independent:

- Can overlap in time (simultaneous read and write)
- Each has independent skid buffers
- No ordering constraints between reads and writes
- Testbench can drive at different rates

10.7.3 Skid Buffer Depths

Recommended configurations:

Low latency (fast memory):

```
.SKID_DEPTH_AW(2), .SKID_DEPTH_W(2), .SKID_DEPTH_B(2),
.SKID_DEPTH_AR(2), .SKID_DEPTH_R(2)
```

Typical system:

```
.SKID_DEPTH_AW(2), .SKID_DEPTH_W(4), .SKID_DEPTH_B(2),
.SKID_DEPTH_AR(2), .SKID_DEPTH_R(4)
```

High throughput bursts:

```
.SKID_DEPTH_AW(4), .SKID_DEPTH_W(8), .SKID_DEPTH_B(4),
.SKID_DEPTH_AR(4), .SKID_DEPTH_R(8)
```

10.8 Related Modules

- **AXI4 Master Read Stub** - Read-only stub (instantiated internally)
- **AXI4 Master Write Stub** - Write-only stub (instantiated internally)
- **AXI4 Slave Stub** - Corresponding combined slave stub
- **AXI4 Master Read** - Full AXI4 master read module
- **AXI4 Master Write** - Full AXI4 master write module

10.9 Testing

No dedicated testbench, and none is expected. This is a stub: a tie-off shell that presents the interface and drives inert values, so there is no behaviour to verify beyond elaboration. `make verilator` lints it as its own top on every run, which is the coverage that applies.

Treat any behaviour described on this page as unverified by simulation.

10.10 References

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.2.1 “Handshake process” and §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the per-channel VALID/READY contract each skid buffer preserves); §A1.2.3 “Register slices” and §A3.1.1 “Clock” (a register

stage may sit in any channel for one cycle of latency, and an interface must have no combinational input-to-output path, which a slice breaks). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.

- Carloni, L.P., McMillan, K.L., Sangiovanni-Vincentelli, A.L. “Theory of Latency-Insensitive Design.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 20(9), Sept. 2001. DOI: 10.1109/43.945302 – relay stations: a channel can be pipelined by any number of back-pressured stages without changing its behavior, which is why a skid buffer per channel is transparent to both ends.
- Cortadella, J., Kishinevsky, M., Grundmann, B. “Synthesis of Synchronous Elastic Architectures.” *Proc. 43rd Design Automation Conference (DAC ’06)*, July 2006, pp. 657-662. DOI: 10.1145/1146909.1147077 – the elastic buffer with valid/stop back-pressure, the structure a skid buffer implements.
- Chipressian. *Crack the Hardware Interview: from RTL Designers’ Perspective*, Part 2 ch. 2 “Handshake Protocols” (forward and backward register slices) – textbook treatment of the valid/ready slice; the backward slice’s extra data register is the skid entry (secondary source).
- Maaref, M. *Architecting and Building High-Speed SoCs*, Packt, 2022, ch. 3 “Basic and Advanced On-Chip Busses and Interconnects” (“AXI bus protocol overview”) – textbook overview of the AXI channels, bursts and ID ordering (secondary source).
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF: `LatencyInsensitiveDesign__Carloni2001.pdf`, `ElasticBuffer__Cortadella2006.pdf`)

10.11 Navigation

- **← Back to AXI4 Index**
- **← Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **← Back to Main Documentation Index**

11 AXI4 Master Write

Module: `axi4_master_wr.sv` **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/` **Status:** Production Ready

11.1 Overview

Think of this module as an elastic buffer that speaks fluent AXI4. The AXI4 Master Write sits between a write initiator and an AXI4 interconnect with an independent, configurable-depth skid buffer on each of the AW, W, and B channels, so timing on one side never leaks into the other and backpressure always has somewhere to park.

11.1.1 Key Features

- **Full AXI4 Write Support:** Complete AW, W, and B channel implementation
- **Independent Channel Buffering:** Separate configurable depth buffers for each channel
- **Elastic Buffering:** Decouples upstream and downstream timing domains
- **Burst Support:** Full burst transaction handling with WLAST tracking
- **User Signal Support:** Carries AWUSER, WUSER, and BUSER signals
- **Clock Gating Support:** Busy signal for dynamic power management

11.2 Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
`SKID_DEPTH_AW`	int	2	Depth of write address (AW) channel skid buffer
`SKID_DEPTH_W`	int	4	Depth of write data (W) channel skid buffer
`SKID_DEPTH_B`	int	2	Depth of write response (B) channel skid buffer
`AXI_ID_WIDTH`	int	8	Width of transaction ID signals (AWID, BID)
`AXI_ADDR_WIDTH`	int	32	Width of address bus (AWADDR)
`AXI_DATA_WIDTH`	int	32	Width of data bus

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
			(WDATA), must be 8, 16, 32, 64, 128, 256, 512, or 1024
AXI_USER_WIDTH	int	1	Width of user-defined signals (AWUSER, WUSER, BUSER)

11.2.1 Derived Parameters (do not override)

These are declared as `parameter` so the elaborator can compute them, not so callers can set them. Each defaults to an expression over the parameters above; overriding one desynchronises it from its source and the design fails to elaborate or silently mis-sizes a bus. Set the parameters they are derived FROM and leave these alone.

Derived parameter	Default expression
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	AXI_DATA_WIDTH / 8
DW	AXI_DATA_WIDTH
IW	AXI_ID_WIDTH
SW	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH
UW	AXI_USER_WIDTH
AWSize	IW+AW+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+UW
WSize	DW+SW+1+UW
BSize	IW+2+UW

11.3 Ports

The full port list, straight from the RTL:

```
module axi4_master_wr #(
    parameter int SKID_DEPTH_AW     = 2,
    parameter int SKID_DEPTH_W      = 4,
    parameter int SKID_DEPTH_B      = 2,
    parameter int AXI_ID_WIDTH      = 8,
    parameter int AXI_ADDR_WIDTH    = 32,
    parameter int AXI_DATA_WIDTH    = 32,
    parameter int AXI_USER_WIDTH    = 1
) (
    // Clock and Reset
    input  logic                        aclk,
    input  logic                        aresetn,
```

```
// Frontend AXI Interface (fub_axi_*)
// Write address channel (AW)
input  logic [AXI_ID_WIDTH-1:0]   fub_axi_awid,
input  logic [AXI_ADDR_WIDTH-1:0] fub_axi_awaddr,
input  logic [7:0]                fub_axi_awlen,
input  logic [2:0]                fub_axi_awsize,
input  logic [1:0]                fub_axi_awburst,
input  logic                      fub_axi_awlock,
input  logic [3:0]                fub_axi_awcache,
input  logic [2:0]                fub_axi_awprot,
input  logic [3:0]                fub_axi_awqos,
input  logic [3:0]                fub_axi_awregion,
input  logic [AXI_USER_WIDTH-1:0] fub_axi_awuser,
input  logic                      fub_axi_awvalid,
output logic                      fub_axi_awready,

// Write data channel (W)
input  logic [AXI_DATA_WIDTH-1:0] fub_axi_wdata,
input  logic [AXI_DATA_WIDTH/8-1:0] fub_axi_wstrb,
input  logic                      fub_axi_wlast,
input  logic [AXI_USER_WIDTH-1:0] fub_axi_wuser,
input  logic                      fub_axi_wvalid,
output logic                      fub_axi_wready,

// Write response channel (B)
output logic [AXI_ID_WIDTH-1:0]   fub_axi_bid,
output logic [1:0]                fub_axi_bresp,
output logic [AXI_USER_WIDTH-1:0] fub_axi_buser,
output logic                      fub_axi_bvalid,
input  logic                      fub_axi_bready,

// Master AXI Interface (m_axi_*)
// Write address channel (AW)
output logic [AXI_ID_WIDTH-1:0]   m_axi_awid,
output logic [AXI_ADDR_WIDTH-1:0] m_axi_awaddr,
output logic [7:0]                m_axi_awlen,
output logic [2:0]                m_axi_awsize,
output logic [1:0]                m_axi_awburst,
output logic                      m_axi_awlock,
output logic [3:0]                m_axi_awcache,
output logic [2:0]                m_axi_awprot,
output logic [3:0]                m_axi_awqos,
output logic [3:0]                m_axi_awregion,
output logic [AXI_USER_WIDTH-1:0] m_axi_awuser,
output logic                      m_axi_awvalid,
input  logic                      m_axi_awready,
```

```
    // Write data channel (W)
    output logic [AXI_DATA_WIDTH-1:0] m_axi_wdata,
    output logic [AXI_DATA_WIDTH/8-1:0] m_axi_wstrb,
    output logic                        m_axi_wlast,
    output logic [AXI_USER_WIDTH-1:0] m_axi_wuser,
    output logic                        m_axi_wvalid,
    input  logic                        m_axi_wready,

    // Write response channel (B)
    input  logic [AXI_ID_WIDTH-1:0]   m_axi_bid,
    input  logic [1:0]                  m_axi_bresp,
    input  logic [AXI_USER_WIDTH-1:0] m_axi_buser,
    input  logic                        m_axi_bvalid,
    output logic                        m_axi_bready,

    // Status
    output logic                        busy
);
```

11.3.1 Clock and Reset

Port	Direction	Width	Description
`aclk`	Input	1	AXI clock - all signals sampled on rising edge
`aresetn`	Input	1	Active-low asynchronous reset

11.3.2 Frontend AXI Interface (fub_axi_*)

Write Address Channel (AW)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
`fub_axi_awid`	Input	`AXI_ID_WIDTH`	Write transaction ID
`fub_axi_awaddr`	Input	`AXI_ADDR_WIDTH`	Write address
`fub_axi_awlen`	Input	8	Burst length, AXI-encoded: beats - 1 (`0x00` = 1 beat, `0xFF` = 256)
`fub_axi_awsize`	Input	3	Burst size (bytes per beat)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_awburst	Input	2	Burst type (FIXED, INCR, WRAP)
fub_axi_awlock	Input	1	Lock type (atomic access support)
fub_axi_awcache	Input	4	Cache attributes
fub_axi_awprot	Input	3	Protection attributes
fub_axi_awqos	Input	4	Quality of Service identifier
fub_axi_awregion	Input	4	Region identifier
fub_axi_awuser	Input	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User-defined signal
fub_axi_awvalid	Input	1	Write address valid
fub_axi_awready	Output	1	Write address ready

Write Data Channel (W)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_wdata	Input	AXI_DATA_WIDTH	Write data
fub_axi_wstrb	Input	AXI_DATA_WIDTH/8	Write strobes (byte enables)
fub_axi_wlast	Input	1	Last beat of burst indicator
fub_axi_wuser	Input	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User-defined signal
fub_axi_wvalid	Input	1	Write data valid
fub_axi_wready	Output	1	Write data ready

Write Response Channel (B)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_bid	Output	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Response transaction ID

Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_bresp	Output	2	Write response (OKAY, EXOKAY, SLVERR, DECERR)
fub_axi_buser	Output	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User-defined signal
fub_axi_bvalid	Output	1	Write response valid
fub_axi_bready	Input	1	Write response ready

11.3.3 Master AXI Interface (m_axi_*)

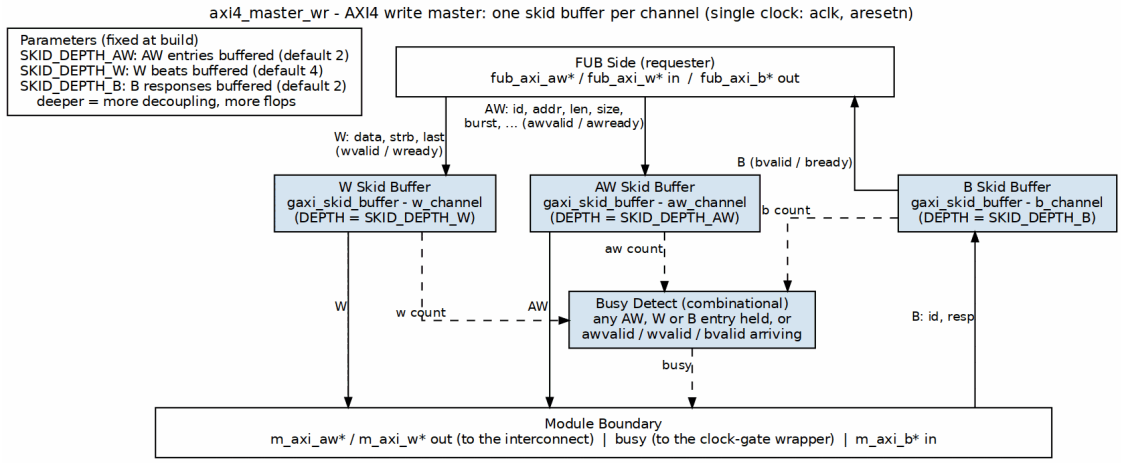
Mirrors the frontend interface but in the opposite direction (output on AW/W, input on B).

11.3.4 Status Outputs

Port	Direction	Width	Description
busy	Output	1	Indicates active transactions in buffers (for clock gating)

11.4 Functional Description

11.4.1 Block diagram



axi4_master_wr block diagram

Write data (W) takes its own lane down the left and AW goes down the center, each through its own `gaxi_skid_buffer` from the requester (FUB) side to the m_axi master port; the write response (B) comes back up the right lane through a third skid buffer. Busy Detect reads all three occupancies plus the incoming valids and drives `busy` for the `_cg` clock-gated wrapper. The `SKID_DEPTH_*` parameters size each buffer.

11.4.2 Architecture

Three independent `gaxi_skid_buffer` instances provide the elastic buffering, one per write channel (see the block diagram above).

11.4.3 Channel Operations

11.4.3.1 Write Address (AW) Channel

1. Frontend presents write address and attributes
2. AW skid buffer accepts when space available (`fub_axi_awready` high)
3. Buffered address presented to master interface when ready
4. Configurable depth (`SKID_DEPTH_AW`) smooths timing variations

11.4.3.2 Write Data (W) Channel

1. Frontend presents write data with strobes
2. W skid buffer provides deeper buffering (default depth=4)
3. WLAST signal preserved to indicate burst boundaries
4. Independent from AW channel (AXI4 allows W before AW)

11.4.3.3 Write Response (B) Channel

1. Master returns write response with transaction ID
2. B skid buffer captures response when frontend busy
3. Frontend receives response when ready to accept
4. ID matching handled by AXI interconnect (not this module)

11.4.4 Busy Signal

The `busy` output indicates active transactions:

```
assign busy = (int_aw_count > 0) || (int_w_count > 0) || (int_b_count
> 0) ||
                  fub_axi_awvalid || fub_axi_wvalid || m_axi_bvalid;
```

Use cases: - **Clock gating:** Disable clock when `busy` is low - **Power management:** Enter low-power mode when idle - **Synchronization:** Wait for idle before configuration changes

---

11.5 Timing Characteristics

Skid parameter	Default depth
SKID_DEPTH_AW	2 entries
SKID_DEPTH_W	4 entries
SKID_DEPTH_B	2 entries

Each channel traverses one gaxi_skid_buffer, which registers both rd_valid and its storage. The **1-cycle input-to-output latency therefore applies on every transfer, including the unstalled case** – there is no combinational bypass. Depth buys backpressure absorption, not throughput; full rate is sustained once the pipeline is primed. Legal range is 2..8 inclusive, odd values included.

Clocking: aclk, reset aresetn (active-low asynchronous).

No synthesis numbers are quoted here. Frequency and area depend on the target device and the parameters you elaborate with; run your own build.

11.6 Usage Examples

Every parameter and port below is read from the module declaration.

```
axi4_master_wr #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AW          (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_W           (4),
    .SKID_DEPTH_B           (2),
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH           (8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH         (32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH         (32),
    .AXI_USER_WIDTH         (1)
) u_axi4_master_wr (
    .aclk                   (aclk),
    .aresetn                (aresetn),
    .fub_axi_awid           (fub_axi_awid),
    .fub_axi_awaddr         (fub_axi_awaddr),
    .fub_axi_awlen          (fub_axi_awlen),
    .fub_axi_awsize         (fub_axi_awsize),
    .fub_axi_awburst        (fub_axi_awburst),
    .fub_axi_awlock         (fub_axi_awlock),
    .fub_axi_awcache        (fub_axi_awcache),
    .fub_axi_awprot         (fub_axi_awprot),
    .fub_axi_awqos          (fub_axi_awqos),
    .fub_axi_awregion       (fub_axi_awregion),
    .fub_axi_awuser         (fub_axi_awuser),
    .fub_axi_awvalid        (fub_axi_awvalid),
```

```
    .fub_axi_awready       (fub_axi_awready),
    .fub_axi_wdata         (fub_axi_wdata),
    .fub_axi_wstrb         (fub_axi_wstrb),
    .fub_axi_wlast         (fub_axi_wlast),
    .fub_axi_wuser         (fub_axi_wuser),
    .fub_axi_wvalid        (fub_axi_wvalid),
    .fub_axi_wready        (fub_axi_wready),
    .fub_axi_bid           (fub_axi_bid),
    .fub_axi_bresp         (fub_axi_bresp),
    .fub_axi_buser         (fub_axi_buser),
    .fub_axi_bvalid        (fub_axi_bvalid),
    .fub_axi_bready        (fub_axi_bready),
    .m_axi_awid            (m_axi_awid),
    .m_axi_awaddr          (m_axi_awaddr),
    .m_axi_awlen           (m_axi_awlen),
    .m_axi_awsize          (m_axi_awsize),
    .m_axi_awburst         (m_axi_awburst),
    .m_axi_awlock          (m_axi_awlock),
    .m_axi_awcache         (m_axi_awcache),
    .m_axi_awprot          (m_axi_awprot),
    .m_axi_awqos           (m_axi_awqos),
    .m_axi_awregion        (m_axi_awregion),
    .m_axi_awuser          (m_axi_awuser),
    .m_axi_awvalid         (m_axi_awvalid),
    .m_axi_awready         (m_axi_awready),
    .m_axi_wdata           (m_axi_wdata),
    .m_axi_wstrb           (m_axi_wstrb),
    .m_axi_wlast           (m_axi_wlast),
    .m_axi_wuser           (m_axi_wuser),
    .m_axi_wvalid          (m_axi_wvalid),
    .m_axi_wready          (m_axi_wready),
    .m_axi_bid             (m_axi_bid),
    .m_axi_bresp           (m_axi_bresp),
    .m_axi_buser           (m_axi_buser),
    .m_axi_bvalid          (m_axi_bvalid),
    .m_axi_bready          (m_axi_bready),
    .busy                  (busy)
);
```

11.7 Design Notes

11.7.1 Buffer Depth Selection

`SKID_DEPTH_*` is an entry count, not a log2 exponent. The underlying `gaxi_skid_buffer` allocates one register slot per entry and tracks occupancy with a 4-bit counter, so legal values are 2..8 inclusive (any integer). Values greater than 8 overflow the occupancy counter and are not supported.

Write Address (SKID_DEPTH_AW): - Default: 2 (sufficient for most cases) - Increase if: - High-latency address decode paths - Frequent address channel backpressure - Multiple outstanding bursts needed

Write Data (SKID_DEPTH_W): - Default: 4 (deeper than AW for burst data) - Increase if: - Large burst sizes (AWLEN > 4) - High-bandwidth streaming writes - Significant W channel backpressure

Write Response (SKID_DEPTH_B): - Default: 2 (responses are typically single-beat) - Increase if: - Frontend slow to accept responses - Many concurrent outstanding writes - Response channel backpressure observed

11.7.2 Recommended Configurations

Low-Latency System (single outstanding write):

```
axi4_master_wr #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AW(2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_W(2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_B(2)
) u_master_wr ( ... );
```

High-Throughput Streaming (burst writes):

```
axi4_master_wr #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AW(4),
    .SKID_DEPTH_W(8),    // Deep for burst data
    .SKID_DEPTH_B(4)
) u_master_wr ( ... );
```

Multiple Outstanding Writes:

```
axi4_master_wr #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AW(8),
    .SKID_DEPTH_W(8),
    .SKID_DEPTH_B(8)
) u_master_wr ( ... );
```

11.7.3 Buffer Independence

The three skid buffers operate independently: - AW and W channels can progress at different rates - AXI4 allows W data before AW address - B responses return asynchronously based on slave timing

11.7.4 Packet Preservation

All signal groups packed and unpacked atomically: - AW channel: `{awid, awaddr, awlen, awsize, awburst, awlock, awcache, awprot, awqos, awregion, awuser}` - W channel: `{wdata, wstrb, wlast, wuser}` - B channel: `{bid, bresp, buser}`

11.7.5 Backpressure Handling

Ready signals propagate backpressure: - Frontend sees `awready/wready` low when buffers full - Master backpressure captured in buffers - Prevents data loss while decoupling timing

11.7.6 Reset Behavior

On `aresetn` assertion (active-low): - All skid buffers flush - Valid signals deasserted - Busy signal goes low - No data retained across reset

---

11.8 Related Modules

11.8.1 Companion Modules

- **axi4_master_rd** - AXI4 master read with buffering
- **axi4_master_wr_cg** - Clock-gated variant with additional CG logic
- **axi4_master_wr_mon** - Write transaction monitor for verification

11.8.2 Used Components

- **gaxi_skid_buffer** - Elastic buffer with valid/ready handshake
- **clock_gate_ctrl** - Clock gating control (example)

11.8.3 Related Infrastructure

- **axi4_interconnect** - Multi-master/multi-slave crossbar
- **axi4_slave_wr** - Corresponding AXI4 write slave module

11.9 Testing

`val/amba/test_axi4_master_wr.py` exercises this module. It collects 8 parameter cases at the default `REG_LEVEL`.

```
source env_python
pytest val/amba/test_axi4_master_wr.py -v
```

11.10 References

11.10.1 Specifications

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.2.1 “Handshake process” and §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the per-channel VALID/READY contract each skid buffer preserves); §A1.2.3 “Register slices” and §A3.1.1 “Clock” (a register stage may sit in any channel for one cycle of latency, and an interface must have no combinational input-to-output path, which a slice breaks). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.

11.10.2 Papers and textbooks

- Carloni, L.P., McMillan, K.L., Sangiovanni-Vincentelli, A.L. “Theory of Latency-Insensitive Design.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 20(9), Sept. 2001. DOI: 10.1109/43.945302 – relay stations: a channel can be pipelined by any number of back-pressured stages without changing its behavior, which is why a skid buffer per channel is transparent to both ends.
- Cortadella, J., Kishinevsky, M., Grundmann, B. “Synthesis of Synchronous Elastic Architectures.” *Proc. 43rd Design Automation Conference (DAC ’06)*, July 2006, pp. 657-662. DOI: 10.1145/1146909.1147077 – the elastic buffer with valid/stop back-pressure, the structure a skid buffer implements.
- Chipressian. *Crack the Hardware Interview: from RTL Designers’ Perspective*, Part 2 ch. 2 “Handshake Protocols” (forward and backward register slices) – textbook treatment of the valid/ready slice; the backward slice’s extra data register is the skid entry (secondary source).
- Maaref, M. *Architecting and Building High-Speed SoCs*, Packt, 2022, ch. 3 “Basic and Advanced On-Chip Busses and Interconnects” (“AXI bus protocol overview”) – textbook overview of the AXI channels, bursts and ID ordering (secondary source).
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF: `LatencyInsensitiveDesign__Carloni2001.pdf`, `ElasticBuffer__Cortadella2006.pdf`)

11.10.3 Source Code

- RTL: `rtl/amba/axi4/axi4_master_wr.sv`

- Tests: `val/amba/test_axi4_master_wr.py`
- Framework: `bin/TBClasses/components/axi4/`

11.10.4 Documentation

- Architecture: rtl-amba Overview
- AXI4 Index: axi4/README.md
- GAXI Buffers: gaxi/README.md

Last Updated: 2025-10-20

11.11 Navigation

- **← Back to AXI4 Index**
- **← Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **← Back to Main Documentation Index**

12 AXI4 Master Write Interface (Clock-Gated)

Module: `axi4_master_wr_cg.sv` **Base Module:** axi4_master_wr **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/`
Status: Production Ready

12.1 Overview

Same module, smaller power bill. This is the **clock-gated variant** of axi4_master_wr: functionally identical, with activity-based clock gating wrapped around it.

For complete clock-gating documentation, usage examples, and configuration guidelines, see the **Clock-Gated Variants Guide**.

What the wrapper buys you:

- **Same Functionality:** 100% equivalent to base module
- **Power Savings:** traffic-dependent; unmeasured in this repo – treat any percentage as a placeholder until characterized
- **Configurable at runtime:** `cfg_cg_enable` / `cfg_cg_idle_count` inputs
- **Zero Overhead When Disabled:** `cfg_cg_enable=0` bypasses the gate

12.2 Parameters

In addition to all axi4_master_wr parameters:

Parameter	Default	Description
`CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH`	4	Width of the idle countdown, sizing `cfg_cg_idle_count`
`SKID_DEPTH_AW`	2	Skid-buffer depth on the AW channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are legal.
`SKID_DEPTH_B`	2	Skid-buffer depth on the B channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are legal.
`SKID_DEPTH_W`	4	Skid-buffer depth on the W

Parameter	Default	Description
		channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are legal.

The gating controls are RUNTIME INPUTS, not parameters: `cfg_cg_enable` and `cfg_cg_idle_count`; status outputs `cg_gating` / `cg_idle`. One `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` gates the whole module – no per-domain gates. The base module's `busy` output is NOT re-exported (consumed internally as a wake term). (The ENABLE_CLOCK_GATING / CG_IDLE_CYCLES / CG_GATE_* interface this page once documented never existed.)

12.2.1 Derived Parameters (do not override)

These are declared as `parameter` so the elaborator can compute them, not so callers can set them. Each defaults to an expression over the parameters above; overriding one desynchronises it from its source and the design fails to elaborate or silently mis-sizes a bus. Set the parameters they are derived FROM and leave these alone.

Derived parameter	Default expression
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	AXI_DATA_WIDTH / 8
AW	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH
DW	AXI_DATA_WIDTH
IW	AXI_ID_WIDTH
SW	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH
UW	AXI_USER_WIDTH
AWSize	IW+AW+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+UW
WSize	DW+SW+1+UW
BSize	IW+2+UW

12.3 Ports

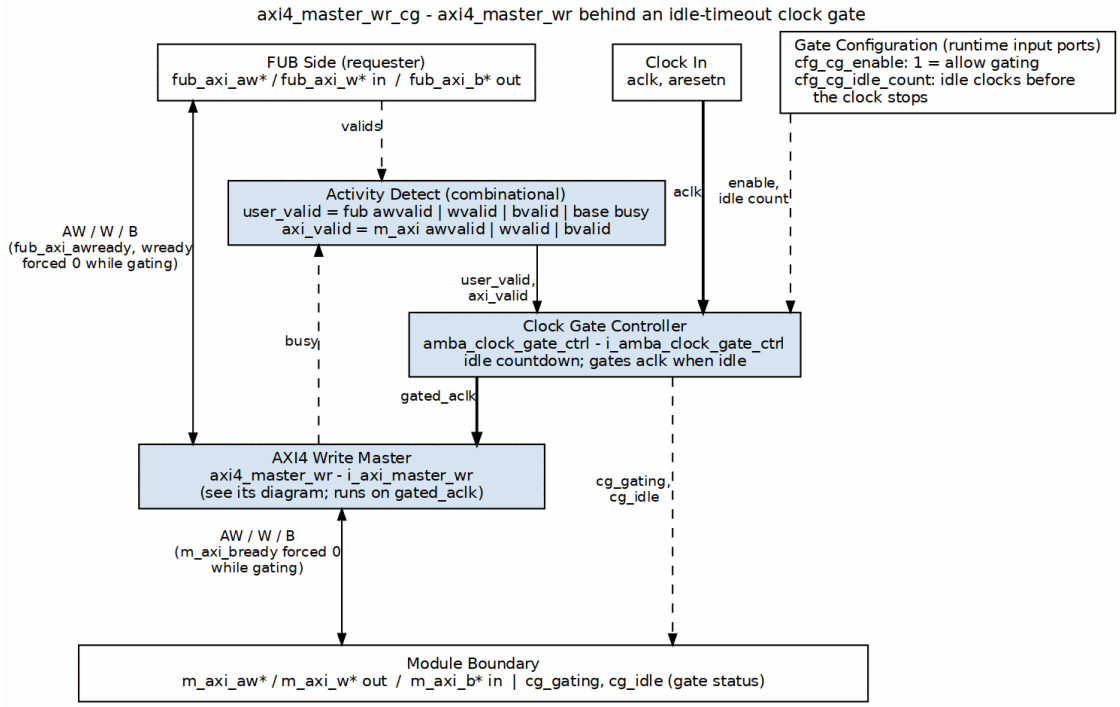
Port	Dir	Width	Description
aclk	In	1	
aresetn	In	1	
cfg_cg_enable	In	1	
cfg_cg_idle_count	In	[CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH-1:0]	
fub_axi_awid	In	[IW-1:0]	
fub_axi_awadd	In	[AW-1:0]	

Port	Dir	Width	Description
r			
fub_axi_awlen	In	[7:0]	
fub_axi_awsize	In	[2:0]	
fub_axi_awburst	In	[1:0]	
fub_axi_awlock	In	1	
fub_axi_awcache	In	[3:0]	
fub_axi_awprot	In	[2:0]	
fub_axi_awqos	In	[3:0]	
fub_axi_awregion	In	[3:0]	
fub_axi_awuser	In	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_awvalid	In	1	
fub_axi_awready	Out	1	
fub_axi_wdata	In	[DW-1:0]	
fub_axi_wstrb	In	[SW-1:0]	
fub_axi_wlast	In	1	
fub_axi_wuser	In	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_wvalid	In	1	
fub_axi_wready	Out	1	
fub_axi_bid	Out	[IW-1:0]	
fub_axi_bresp	Out	[1:0]	
fub_axi_buser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_bvalid	Out	1	
fub_axi_bready	In	1	
m_axi_awid	Out	[IW-1:0]	

Port	Dir	Width	Description
m_axi_awaddr	Out	[AW-1:0]	
m_axi_awlen	Out	[7:0]	
m_axi_awsize	Out	[2:0]	
m_axi_awburst	Out	[1:0]	
m_axi_awlock	Out	1	
m_axi_awcache	Out	[3:0]	
m_axi_awprot	Out	[2:0]	
m_axi_awqos	Out	[3:0]	
m_axi_awregion	Out	[3:0]	
m_axi_awuser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
m_axi_awvalid	Out	1	
m_axi_awready	In	1	
m_axi_wdata	Out	[DW-1:0]	
m_axi_wstrb	Out	[SW-1:0]	
m_axi_wlast	Out	1	
m_axi_wuser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
m_axi_wvalid	Out	1	
m_axi_wready	In	1	
m_axi_bid	In	[IW-1:0]	
m_axi_bresp	In	[1:0]	
m_axi_buser	In	[UW-1:0]	
m_axi_bvalid	In	1	
m_axi_bready	Out	1	
cg_gating	Out	1	
cg_idle	Out	1	

12.4 Functional Description

12.4.1 Block diagram



axi4_master_wr_cg block diagram

The base `axi4_master_wr` is one child box (see its own diagram), clocked by `gated_aclk`. The clock is the heavy center column: `aclk` enters `amba_clock_gate_ctrl`, which stops it after `cfg_cg_idle_count` idle clocks. Activity Detect ORs this side's valids with the base's `busy` (`user_valid`) and the far side's valids (`axi_valid`) to wake the clock. While gating, the outward ready signals are forced to 0, so no handshake is lost; `cg_gating` and `cg_idle` report the gate's state.

This wrapper is the base module plus one `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` instance. The datapath is untouched – every channel signal is forwarded verbatim – so functional behaviour is identical to the base module and the wrapper adds no latency of its own.

What it adds is a gated clock. `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` watches two activity terms, `user_valid` (this side's valids plus the base module's `busy`) and `axi_valid` (the far side's valids), registers their OR into `r_wakeup`, and stops the inner module's clock once both have been quiet for `cfg_cg_idle_count` cycles. The clock restarts on the next activity, one cycle later.

While the clock is stopped the wrapper masks its outward-facing READY signals with `! cg_gating`, so a peer sees no acceptance until the clock runs again and no handshake is lost across the wake boundary.

`cfg_cg_enable` arms this behaviour; with it low the clock free-runs and the module is indistinguishable from its base.

12.5 Timing Characteristics

Skid parameter	Default depth
`SKID_DEPTH_AW`	2 entries
`SKID_DEPTH_W`	4 entries
`SKID_DEPTH_B`	2 entries

Each channel traverses one `gaxi_skid_buffer`, which registers both `rd_valid` and its storage. The **1-cycle input-to-output latency therefore applies on every transfer, including the unstalled case** – there is no combinational bypass. Depth buys backpressure absorption, not throughput; full rate is sustained once the pipeline is primed. Legal range is 2..8 inclusive, odd values included.

Clocking: `aclk`, reset `aresetn` (active-low asynchronous).

No synthesis numbers are quoted here. Frequency and area depend on the target device and the parameters you elaborate with; run your own build.

12.6 Usage Examples

```
axi4_master_wr_cg #(
    // Base module parameters (see axi4_master_wr.md)
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH(8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH(64),

    .CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH(4)
) u_cg (
    .aclk(clk),
    .aresetn(rst_n),
    .cfg_cg_enable(1'b1),
    .cfg_cg_idle_count(4'd8),
    .cg_gating(), .cg_idle(),
    // ... all other ports same as axi4_master_wr (except busy)
);
```

12.7 Design Notes

A peer's READY must never enter the activity term. A consumer that parks its response-ready high while idle is behaving correctly; folding that signal into `user_valid` pins this block permanently awake and defeats gating entirely – silently, because function is unaffected. Ten wrappers in this repository shipped that way and nothing failed until someone measured. `val/amba/test_cg_peer_ready.py` parks the peer READY high, holds every VALID low, and requires `cg_gating`. Canonical rule: `vault/handbook/design/clock-gating-activity-terms.md`.

`cfg_cg_enable` is not a kill switch. It arms gating and reaches `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` only; the datapath and any monitor enables are forwarded untouched. With it low the clock free-runs and this module behaves exactly like its base.

Gating latency. The clock stops `cfg_cg_idle_count` + 2 cycles after the last bus activity – the idle counter, plus one for the `r_wakeup` flop. Size the idle count against your traffic's inter-burst gap: too small and the block wakes constantly, too large and it never gates.

Cost. Five flops: `r_wakeup` plus `r_idle_counter` at `IDLE_CNTR_WIDTH`, scaling as 1 + `CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH`. The ICG itself is a latch or BUFGCE, not fabric flops.

12.8 Related Modules

- **Base Module Functionality:** axi4_master_wr.md
- **Clock Gating Guide:** clock_gated_variants.md
- **Detailed CG Examples:**
  - axi4_master_rd_mon_cg.md (AXI4 monitor)
  - axil4_master_rd_mon_cg.md (AXIL4 monitor)
  - apb4_slave_cg.md (APB interface)

12.9 Testing

`val/amba/test_axi4_master_wr_cg.py` exercises this module. It collects 1 parameter cases at the default `REG_LEVEL`.

```
source env_python
pytest val/amba/test_axi4_master_wr_cg.py -v
```

12.10 References

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.2.1 “Handshake process” and §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the per-channel VALID/READY contract each skid buffer preserves); §A1.2.3 “Register slices” and §A3.1.1 “Clock” (a register stage may sit in any channel for one cycle of latency, and an interface must have no combinational input-to-output path, which a slice breaks). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.
- Benini, L., De Micheli, G. “Automatic Synthesis of Low-Power Gated-Clock Finite-State Machines.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 15(6), June 1996. DOI: 10.1109/43.503933 – the latch-based clock-gating cell (`icg`, via `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` and `clock_gate_ctrl`) that gates this wrapper’s clock.
- Benini, L., Bogliolo, A., De Micheli, G. “A Survey of Design Techniques for System-Level Dynamic Power Management.” *IEEE Trans. VLSI Systems*, 8(3), June 2000. DOI: 10.1109/92.845896 – fixed-timeout shutdown: gate after `cfg_cg_idle_count` idle cycles, wake on activity.
- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – AXI4 has no wake-up signal. AXI5 adds AWAKEUP (Issue H §E1.7 “Wake-up Signaling”; Issue L §A14.1.1), which lets a manager restart a gated interface before VALID. This wrapper wakes on the flopped OR of the VALIDs and holds READY low while gated.
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF, archived under `rtl/common/references/`: `LatchBasedClockGating__Benini1996.pdf`, `DynamicPowerManagementTimeout__Benini2000.pdf`)

12.11 Navigation

- **← Back to AXI4 Index**
- **← Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **← Back to Main Documentation Index**

13 AXI4 Master Write Monitor

Module: `axi4_master_wr_mon.sv` **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/` (protocol monitors live with their protocol; only the monitor CORE pieces are in `rtl/amba/ocelus/`) **Status:** Production Ready

---

13.1 Overview

Some modules move data; this one moves data and tells you how the transfer went. The AXI4 Master Write Monitor pairs a fully functional `axi4_master_wr` with an `axi_monitor_filtered`, so you get a working buffered master write interface plus real-time protocol checking, error detection, performance metrics, and configurable packet filtering on write transactions. It's built for verification environments that need eyes on the bus without getting in the way of it.

13.1.1 Key Features

- **Integrated Monitoring:** Combines `axi4_master_wr` with `axi_monitor_filtered`
- **2-Level Filtering:** packet-type drop masks + per-event masks (err_select is reserved – no routing)
- **Error Detection:** Protocol violations, SLVERR, DECERR, orphan transactions
- **Timeout Monitoring:** Configurable timeout detection for stuck transactions
- **Performance Metrics:** Latency tracking, transaction counting, throughput analysis
- **Monitor Bus Output:** 128-bit packets paired with 64-bit side-band timestamps
- **Configuration Validation:** Detects conflicting configuration settings
- **Clock Gating Support:** Busy signal for power management

13.2 Parameters

A lite-monitor version of this wrapper exists as `axi4_master_wr_monlite`: the same core and taps with `axi_monitor_lite` instead of `axi_monitor_filtered`, about a fifth of the monitor gates, error/timeout/completion/threshold packets only. Selected in generated bridges by `mon_preset = "lite"`.

13.2.1 AXI4 Master Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
SKID_DEPTH_AW	int	2	AW channel skid buffer depth
SKID_DEPTH_W	int	4	W channel skid buffer depth
SKID_DEPTH_B	int	2	B channel skid buffer depth
AXI_ID_WIDTH	int	8	Transaction ID width
AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	int	32	Address bus width
AXI_DATA_WIDTH	int	32	Data bus width
AXI_USER_WIDTH	int	1	User signal width

13.2.2 Monitor Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
UNIT_ID	logic [7:0]	8'h01	8-bit unit identifier in monitor packets
AGENT_ID	logic [15:0]	16'h000B	16-bit agent identifier in monitor packets
MAX_TRANSACTIONS	int	16	Maximum concurrent outstanding transactions
USE_WDATA_ORDER_Q	bit	0	Write-data ordering queue
NUM_BANKS	int	1	Banked transaction tables. **>1 on a WRITE monitor requires `USE_WDATA_ORDER_Q=1`** – `axi_monitor_trans_mgr` fails elaboration

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
			otherwise
ID_FILTER_ENABLE	bit	0	Synthesises the per-instance ID-slice filter
ID_MATCH_BASE	int	0	First ID this instance owns
ID_MATCH_COUNT	int	0	How many; `0` means ALL, so a zeroed register block does not silently filter everything away
`ACLK_MHZ`	int	100	Clock frequency in MHz – keeps the 1 us tick exact off-100MHz
`CFI_MIN_FREQ_MHZ` / `CFI_MAX_FREQ_MHZ`	int	= ACLK_MHZ	Freq-invariant counter LUT bounds (`cfg_freq_sel` indexes within them)
`ACTIVE_TRANS_THRESHOLD`	int	MAX_TRANSACTIONS/2	Active-transaction count that trips a threshold packet when `cfg_threshold_enable=1`. Replaces the former hardwired 8/4; threshold packets now scale with the table sizing
`ENABLE_FILTERING`	bit	1	Enable packet filtering: two active drop levels (packet type, then event code). Level 2 is reserved and routes nothing
`ADD_PIPELINE_STAGE`	bit	0	Add register stage for timing closure
`USE_MONITOR`	bit	1	Synthesis-time monitor enable. 0 = omit monitor and tie outputs to safe non-blocking defaults; 1

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
			= full monitor functionality.
N_ADDR_RANGES	int	0	Number of address-range comparators. 0 = checker omitted (zero area). >0 = N independent [low, high] ranges; feeds the shared allowlist checker: a debug-range hit -> AddrMatch, an error-allowlist miss -> Error/ADDR_RANGE (see axi_monitor_addr_check.md).
ADDR_RANGE_IS_ERROR	logic [N_ADDR_RANGES-1:0]	'0	Per-range flavor: bit i = 0 -> DEBUG range (hit -> AddrMatch), 1 -> ERROR range (allowlist miss -> Error/ADDR_RANGE). Default all-0 (feature inert).

13.2.3 Synthesis-Cone Parameters

Each detection cone can be compiled out to save area. The classic cones default on; the debug cone defaults off. Setting a bit to 0 drops the corresponding cone at synthesis via a `generate`-if inside `axi_monitor_reporter` — the area saving is real.

Parameter	Type	Default	Effect when 0
ENABLE_ERROR_LOGIC	bit	1	Drop the error-detection cone
ENABLE_TIMEOUT_LOGIC	bit	1	Drop the timeout cone **and** the `axi_monitor_timeout` instance
ENABLE_COMPL_LOGIC	bit	1	Drop the completion cone

Parameter	Type	Default	Effect when 0
ENABLE_THRESHOLD_LOGIC	bit	1	Drop the threshold cone
ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC	bit	1	Gates only the reporter's legacy perf-packet cone and the two lifetime counters – the window FSM and meters are unconditional
ENABLE_DEBUG_LOGIC	bit	0	Drop the debug (trace) cone — the 6th reporter sub-block (off by default)

Internally the wrapper hardwires two master switches on its `axi_monitor_filtered` instance: `ENABLE_PERF_PACKETS = 1` (the reporter's legacy perf cone is built; `ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC` gates THAT cone only, never the measurement window) and `ENABLE_DEBUG_MODULE = 0` (debug tracking module omitted). These are not top-level parameters of the wrapper.

The transaction CAM is always pipelined.

13.2.4 Derived Parameters (do not override)

These are declared as `parameter` so the elaborator can compute them, not so callers can set them. Each defaults to an expression over the parameters above; overriding one desynchronises it from its source and the design fails to elaborate or silently mis-sizes a bus. Set the parameters they are derived FROM and leave these alone.

Derived parameter	Default expression
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	AXI_DATA_WIDTH / 8
DW	AXI_DATA_WIDTH
IW	AXI_ID_WIDTH
SW	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH
UW	AXI_USER_WIDTH

13.3 Ports

13.3.1 AXI4 Write Channels

Frontend Interface (fub_axi_*): - AW channel: `awid, awaddr, awlen, awsize, awburst, awlock, awcache, awprot, awqos, awregion, awuser, awvalid, awready` - W channel: `wdata, wstrb, wlast, wuser, wvalid, wready` - B channel: `bid, bresp, buser, bvalid, bready`

Master Interface (m_axi_*): - Same signals as frontend, mirrored direction

13.3.2 Monitor Configuration

Configuration ports are identical to axi4_master_rd_mon: - Basic enables: `cfg_monitor_enable` (master runtime gate: 0 = monitor inert, CAM held clear, never stalls the datapath), `cfg_error_enable`, `cfg_timeout_enable`, `cfg_perf_enable`, `cfg_compl_enable` (completion packets), `cfg_threshold_enable` (threshold-crossed packets), `cfg_debug_enable` (debug/trace cone — the 6th reporter sub-block) - Clear: `cam_clear` (Input, 1) - synchronous clear of the monitor transaction CAM (driven from the harness clear control bit, e.g. CTRL[4]) - Thresholds: `cfg_timeout_cycles` (unified coarse timeout, a MICROSECOND count at full 16-bit width: 1..65535 us per phase, 0 = 16'hFFFF ~ effectively never; drives all three phase counts), `cfg_latency_threshold` - Filtering: 8 mask signals (`cfg_axi_*_mask`: pkt, error, timeout, compl, thresh, perf, addr, debug) plus `cfg_axi_err_select` - Performance window control: `cfg_start_event_sel`, `cfg_end_event_sel`, `cfg_start_trigger`, `cfg_end_trigger`, `cfg_window_force_close` (see Performance Monitoring)

> The inner monitor's `cfg_debug_level` (tied to 0), `cfg_debug_mask` (0) are fixed inside the wrapper; `cfg_active_trans_threshold` is driven by the `ACTIVE_TRANS_THRESHOLD` parameter (default MAX_TRANSACTIONS/2), not hardwired to 8, and all three are **not** top-level ports on this module.

13.3.3 Monitor Bus Output

Port	Direction	Width	Description
`monbus_valid`	Output	1	Monitor packet valid
`monbus_ready`	Input	1	Downstream ready to accept packet
`monbus_packet`	Output	128	`monitor_packet_t` (see format below)
`monbus_timestamp`	Output	64	`monbus_timestamp_t` paired atomically with `monbus_packet`
debug_block_ready	Output	1	Observability tap for the block_ready gating net (drives nothing internally; leave unconnected if unused)
`i_mon_time`	Input	64	Free-running counter from `monbus_group_core`, sampled at packet

Port	Direction	Width	Description
			emission

13.3.4 Status Outputs

Port	Direction	Width	Description
busy	Output	1	Indicates active transactions (for clock gating)
active_transactions	Output	8	Current number of outstanding transactions
error_count	Output	16	Lifetime count of error+timeout packets actually emitted (reporter perf counter; reads 0 when ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC=0 or USE_MONITOR=0)
transaction_count	Output	32	Lifetime count of completion packets actually emitted (zero-extended 16-bit reporter perf counter; reads 0 when ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC=0 or USE_MONITOR=0)
cfg_conflict_error	Output	1	Configuration conflict detected

13.3.5 Packet filters

Two independent runtime filters cut monbus traffic without touching the datapath. Both are inert until driven, which is the failure to watch for: the build-time parameter only decides whether the logic is SYNTHESISED, and a design that sets the parameter but leaves the cfg_* ports tied low filters nothing and looks like the feature is broken.

Address-range filter — ADDR_FILTER_ENABLE (bit, default 0) builds it.

Port	Width	Description
cfg_addr_filter_enable	1	High: suppress packets for transactions outside the window. Low: inert, whatever the parameter says
cfg_addr_filter_low	ADDR_WIDTH	Window base, inclusive
cfg_addr_filter_high	ADDR_WIDTH	Window limit, inclusive

The verdict is latched per table entry at ALLOCATION, from the command address, and held for that entry's life. Widening the window mid-flight does not un-filter entries already admitted — which is exactly what makes it safe to reprogram live, since an entry's fate is decided when it is admitted and the retire accounting cannot be corrupted afterwards. Contrast the address-range CHECKER (`N_ADDR_RANGES`), which re-evaluates per command.

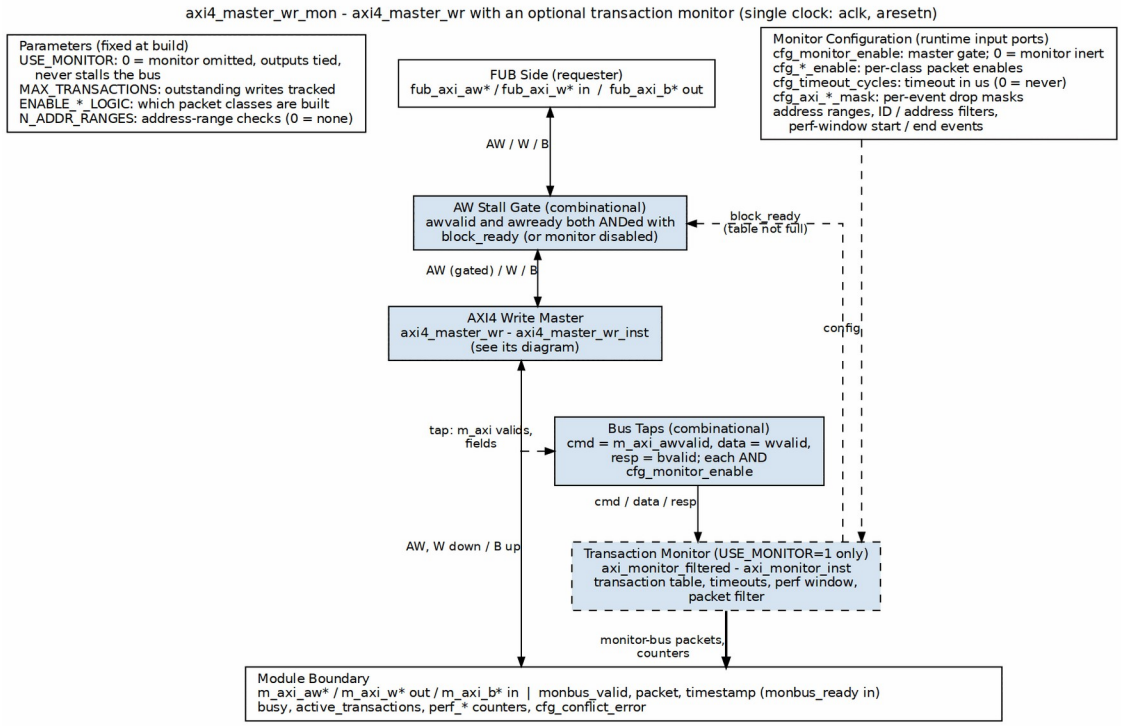
Runtime ID filter — overrides the `ID_MATCH_BASE`/`ID_MATCH_COUNT` elaboration constants so an instance can be retargeted at a different master without a rebuild.

Port	Width	Description
cfg_id_filter_enable	1	High: use the window below. Low: use the parameters, bit-identical to a build without this feature
cfg_id_match_base	ID_WIDTH	First ID owned
cfg_id_match_count	ID_WIDTH+1	How many; `0` means ALL, matching the parameter rule so a zeroed register block does not silently filter everything away

The window is half-open: `[base, base + count)`.

13.4 Functional Description

13.4.1 Block diagram



axi4_master_wr_mon block diagram

AXI traffic runs down the left column: through the AW stall gate, into the base `axi4_master_wr` (one child box, see its own diagram), and out through the bar. The monitor taps the m_axi side, below the base, gates each valid with `cfg_monitor_enable`, and `axi_monitor_filtered` turns the transactions into monitor-bus packets (the heavy edge). When its transaction table is full, `block_ready` drops and the stall gate holds both awvalid and awready low, so a full table stalls the bus instead of losing events. With `USE_MONITOR=0` the monitor is omitted, its outputs are tied off, and the gate never stalls.

The module instantiates two sub-modules: 1. **axi4_master_wr** - Core AXI4 write functionality with buffering 2. **axi_monitor_filtered** - Transaction monitoring with 2-Level Filtering: packet-type drop masks + per-event masks (err_select is reserved – no routing)

13.4.2 Monitor Backpressure (block_ready)

`block_ready` is exported as the `debug_block_ready` output port – the wrapper deliberately makes the gating contract observable (the `_mon_cg` wrapper ties it off rather than forwarding it). It goes low when the monitor's transaction-table occupancy reaches its blocking threshold (a function of `MAX_TRANSACTIONS`; the reporter FIFO depth `INTR_FIFO_DEPTH` has no path to it). The wrapper ANDs it into the upstream-facing `fub_axi_awready` so a saturated monitor throttles new transactions at the handshake instead of dropping events.

- **Where the stall lands**: the upstream `fub_axi_awready` is forced low until the monitor drains.
- **When `USE_MONITOR=0`**: `block_ready` is internally tied high, so the wrapper imposes no stall and runs at full bandwidth.
- **When `cfg_monitor_enable=0`**: the wrapper gate forces the upstream ready open, so a runtime-disabled monitor can never stall the datapath (in-RTL formal property `ap_disabled_never_stalls`).

Recovery is guaranteed by the **saturation-recovery contract**: command-originated table entries are capped at `MAX_TRANSACTIONS - cmd_entry_reserve(MAX_TRANSACTIONS)` (reserve = 4 for tables of 16 or more, 0 below; the function lives in `monitor_common_pkg`), and `block_ready` re-asserts at occupancy `< MAX_TRANSACTIONS - (reserve - 1)` – a threshold strictly ABOVE the command cap – so a saturated table always drains back below the reopen point. Blocking throttles; it never deadlocks. Tables smaller than 16 keep full legacy allocation (small tables cannot spare slots) and trade the recovery guarantee for tracking capacity. The contract is verified by in-RTL formal properties (mutation-checked) and a 100-seed deliberately-undersized-table stream sweep; see axi_monitor_base for the canonical description.

Sizing note: a monitor on a bus shared by several channels/requesters must size `MAX_TRANSACTIONS` to cover `NUM_CHANNELS x per-channel outstanding` plus margin – the per-channel limit alone makes the monitor throttle the shared master. Tables deeper than 64 also need Verilator's `--unroll-count` raised (default 64) in sim builds.

13.4.3 Address-Range Checker

With `N_ADDR_RANGES > 0` the wrapper instantiates the shared allowlist checker (`axi_monitor_addr_check`). Each range carries a DEBUG/ERROR flavor:

- **DEBUG range** — a hit emits a `PktTypeAddrMatch` (`4'h8`) packet with event code `AXI_ADDR_RANGE_MATCH` (`8'h01`), gated by `cfg_debug_enable`.
- **ERROR range** — the enabled ERROR ranges form an allowlist; an address in NONE of them emits a `PktTypeError` (`4'h0`) packet with event code `AXI_ERR_ADDR_RANGE` (`8'h0D`), gated by `cfg_error_enable`.

This wrapper exposes **`ADDR_RANGE_IS_ERROR`** (per-range) as a parameter, so ranges can be assigned to either flavor.

Config inputs (active only when `N_ADDR_RANGES > 0`): - `cfg_addr_check_enable` — master on/off for the checker. - `cfg_addr_range_enable[N-1:0]` — per-range enable bit. - `cfg_addr_range_low/high[N-1:0][AXI_ADDR_WIDTH-1:0]` — inclusive bounds.

Event encoding: `event_data[63:60]` = `range_index` (matching DEBUG range, or `4'hF` sentinel on an ERROR miss); `event_data[59:0]` = full address. **Filtering:** AddrMatch is dropped by `cfg_axi_addr_mask[1]`, the ADDR_RANGE error by `cfg_axi_error_mask[13]`. See the checker page for coalescing + formal properties.

13.4.4 Performance Monitoring

The wrapper hardwires `ENABLE_PERF_PACKETS = 1` on its inner `axi_monitor_filtered`. The **measurement-window state machine** and its counters are unconditional `always_ff` blocks in `axi_monitor_base` – outside every generate – so they are present and running in EVERY build, including `ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC = 0`. That parameter reaches one consumer: the `g_perf` generate in `axi_monitor_reporter` holding the legacy perf-packet cone and the two 16-bit lifetime counters behind `perf_completed_count` / `perf_error_count`. Setting it to 0 saves that cone and nothing else. `USE_MONITOR = 0` is what ties the perfmon outputs off. The wrapper instantiates plus a bank of W-data-channel utilization counters. All counters accumulate **only while a window is open** (`window_active = 1`) and hold their values between windows, so the host can read a completed window's totals.

13.4.4.1 The Measurement Window

A window is opened by a **start event** and closed by an **end event**. The event sources are selected by `cfg_start_event_sel` / `cfg_end_event_sel` (3-bit; e.g. `3'b010` selects the `cfg_perf_enable` edge) and can also be fired directly by the `cfg_start_trigger` / `cfg_end_trigger` pulses (from an engine or CSR). `cfg_window_force_close` is a software override that closes the window immediately. While the window is open:

- `window_active` is high.
- `window_cycles[31:0]` free-runs, counting every clock elapsed inside the window.

Sample the counters on the cycle `window_active` falls to 0 (drive `cfg_end_trigger`, or wait for the configured end event).

13.4.4.2 Utilization Counters (W Data Channel)

Every cycle inside the window is classified by the W channel's `wvalid` / `wready` into exactly one of four buckets:

Output	Width	Condition	Meaning
`perf_prod_cycles`	32	wvalid && wready	productive beat transferred
`perf_bp_cycles`	32	wvalid && !wready	back-pressure (data offered, sink not ready)
`perf_starv_cycles`	32	!wvalid && wready	starvation (sink ready, no data)
`perf_idle_cycles`	32	!wvalid && !wready	idle

The four buckets sum to `window_cycles - 1` (the start cycle seeds window_cycles to 1 while the buckets reset to 0); the one-count skew is negligible for long windows.

13.4.4.3 Throughput Counters

Output	Width	Meaning
`perf_beat_count`	32	W data beats transferred (= `perf_prod_cycles`, 1 beat/cycle)
`perf_byte_count`	64	bytes transferred = beats × (1 << AWSIZE), using the AWSIZE captured at the most recent AW address phase (upper bound: counts full-width beats and does not subtract bytes masked off by `WSTRB` on unaligned or partial beats)
`perf_burst_count`	32	AW address-phase handshakes

The integrator computes average burst length as `perf_beat_count / perf_burst_count`.

13.4.4.4 Performance Monitoring Ports

Port	Direction	Width	Description
`cfg_perf_enable`	Input	1	Enable performance-metric packet generation
`cfg_start_event_sel`	Input	3	Window **start** event source select
`cfg_end_event_sel`	Input	3	Window **end** event source select
`cfg_start_trigger`	Input	1	Pulse: open the measurement window
`cfg_end_trigger`	Input	1	Pulse: close the measurement window
`cfg_window_force_close`	Input	1	Software override: force the window closed

Port	Direction	Width	Description
window_active	Output	1	High while a measurement window is open
window_cycles	Output	32	Cycles elapsed in the current window
perf_prod_cycles	Output	32	wvalid && wready cycles
perf_bp_cycles	Output	32	wvalid && !wready cycles (back-pressure)
perf_starv_cycles	Output	32	!wvalid && wready cycles (starvation)
perf_idle_cycles	Output	32	!wvalid && !wready cycles
perf_beat_count	Output	32	W data beats transferred
perf_byte_count	Output	64	bytes transferred
perf_burst_count	Output	32	AW address-phase handshakes

When `USE_MONITOR = 0`, every perfmon output is tied to 0 and the window never opens.

13.4.5 Monitor Packet Format

The 128-bit `monbus_packet` (paired with the 64-bit `monbus_timestamp` side-band signal) follows the standardized AMBA monitor bus format. Identical format as axi4_master_rd_mon:

```
Bits [127:124] - Packet Type:
  0x0 = ERROR      Error events (SLVERR, DECERR, protocol violations)
  0x1 = COMPL      Completion events (transaction finished)
  0x2 = THRESH     Threshold events
  0x3 = TIMEOUT    Timeout events
  0x4 = PERF       Performance metrics
  0x8 = ADDR_MATCH Address match events
  0x9 = APB        APB-specific events
  0xF = DEBUG      Debug events
Bits [123:109] - Reserved (15 bits, forward-compat slack)
Bits [108:105] - Protocol (4 bits): 0x0=AXI, 0x1=AXIS, 0x2=APB,
0x3=ARB, 0x4=CORE
Bits [104:97]  - Event Code (8 bits, protocol-specific)
Bits [96:88]   - Channel ID (9 bits — AXI ID or channel index)
Bits [87:72]   - Agent ID (16 bits, from AGENT_ID parameter)
```

```
Bits [71:64]   - Unit ID (8 bits, from UNIT_ID parameter)
Bits [63:0]    - Event Data (64 bits — full address, latency, etc.)
```

13.5 Timing Characteristics

Skid parameter	Default depth
`SKID_DEPTH_AW`	2 entries
`SKID_DEPTH_W`	4 entries
`SKID_DEPTH_B`	2 entries

Each channel traverses one `gaxi_skid_buffer`, which registers both `rd_valid` and its storage. The **1-cycle input-to-output latency therefore applies on every transfer, including the unstalled case** – there is no combinational bypass. Depth buys backpressure absorption, not throughput; full rate is sustained once the pipeline is primed. Legal range is 2..8 inclusive, odd values included.

Clocking: `aclk`, reset `aresetn` (active-low asynchronous).

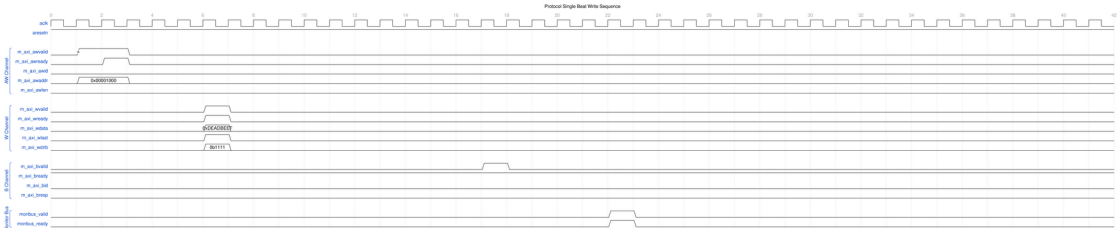
No synthesis numbers are quoted here. Frequency and area depend on the target device and the parameters you elaborate with; run your own build.

13.6 Waveforms

The following waveforms show AXI4 master write monitor behavior:

13.6.1 Scenario 1: Single-Beat Write Transaction

Complete AXI4 write transaction showing AW, W, and B channels:



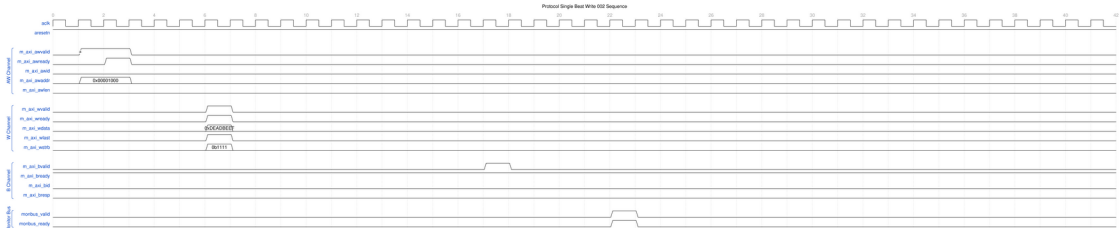
Single Beat Write

WaveJSON: single_beat_write_001.json

Key Observations: - AW channel handshake (AWVALID/AWREADY) - W channel data (WVALID/WREADY/WLAST/WSTRB) - B channel response (BVALID/BREADY/BRESP) - Monitor bus packet generation - Three-channel write protocol coordination

13.6.2 Scenario 2: Alternative Single-Beat Write

Variant single-beat write with different backpressure pattern:



Single Beat Write Alt

WaveJSON: single_beat_write_002_001.json

Key Observations: - Different ready signal timing - Channel interleaving effects - Write strobe (WSTRB) handling - Response latency variation - Monitor packet correlation with transaction ID

13.7 Usage Examples

13.7.1 Configuration Strategies

13.7.1.1 Strategy 1: Functional Verification (Recommended)

Goal: Catch write errors and track completion

```
// Enable configuration
.cfg_monitor_enable     (1'b1),
.cfg_error_enable       (1'b1),      // Catch SLVERR/DECERR
.cfg_timeout_enable     (1'b1),      // Detect stuck writes
.cfg_perf_enable        (1'b0),      // Disable (reduces traffic)

// Filtering - pass error and timeout only
.cfg_axi_pkt_mask       (16'hFFF6),  // Drop all but ERROR, TIMEOUT
.cfg_axi_error_mask     (16'h0000),  // Pass all errors
.cfg_axi_timeout_mask   (16'h0000),  // Pass all timeouts
.cfg_axi_compl_mask     (16'hFFFF),  // Drop completions
.cfg_axi_perf_mask      (16'hFFFF),  // Drop performance

// Timeouts
.cfg_timeout_cycles     (16'd10),    // 10 microseconds per phase
```

```
(full 16-bit range)
.cfg_freq_sel         (4'd0),   // counter_freq_invariant LUT index;
scales the 1 us tick
.cam_clear            (1'b0),   // hold high one cycle while idle to
clear the CAM -- do NOT leave unconnected
.cfg_latency_threshold  (32'd500)
```

13.7.1.2 Strategy 2: Performance Analysis

Goal: Collect write performance metrics

```
// Enable configuration
.cfg_monitor_enable     (1'b1),
.cfg_error_enable       (1'b1),      // Still catch errors
.cfg_timeout_enable     (1'b0),      // Disable timeouts
.cfg_perf_enable        (1'b1),      // Enable performance

// Filtering - pass error and performance only
.cfg_axi_pkt_mask       (16'hFFEE),  // Drop all but ERROR, PERF (set
bit = drop)
.cfg_axi_error_mask     (16'h0000),  // Pass all errors
.cfg_axi_perf_mask      (16'h0000),  // Pass all performance
.cfg_axi_compl_mask     (16'hFFFF),  // Drop completions
.cfg_axi_timeout_mask   (16'hFFFF)   // Drop timeouts
```

13.7.1.3 Strategy 3: Debug Mode

Goal: Maximum visibility for write transactions

```
// Enable everything
.cfg_monitor_enable     (1'b1),
.cfg_error_enable       (1'b1),
.cfg_timeout_enable     (1'b1),
.cfg_perf_enable        (1'b1),

// Filtering - pass all packets
.cfg_axi_pkt_mask       (16'h0000),  // Pass all
// All individual masks set to 16'h0000
```

WARNING: Avoid enabling all packet types in high-throughput write scenarios — the monitor bus sustains at most one packet per two cycles and will congest. (Congestion or runtime-disabled classes can drop packets but, since `95c9490a`, can no longer leak table slots or wedge the bus.)

13.7.2 Basic Integration

```
axi4_master_wr_mon #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AW      (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_W       (4),
    .SKID_DEPTH_B       (2),
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH       (4),
```

```
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH     (32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH     (64),
    .AXI_USER_WIDTH     (1),
    .UNIT_ID            (1),
    .AGENT_ID           (11),
    .MAX_TRANSACTIONS   (16),
    .ENABLE_FILTERING   (1)
) u_master_wr_mon (
    .aclk               (axi_aclk),
    .aresetn            (axi_aresetn),

    // Frontend interface (from write initiator)
    .fub_axi_awid       (write_awid),
    .fub_axi_awaddr     (write_awaddr),
    // ... rest of AW/W/B signals

    // Master interface (to interconnect)
    .m_axi_awid         (m_axi_awid),
    .m_axi_awaddr       (m_axi_awaddr),
    // ... rest of AW/W/B signals

    // Monitor configuration (Strategy 1 - Functional)
    .cfg_monitor_enable     (1'b1),
    .cfg_error_enable       (1'b1),
    .cfg_timeout_enable     (1'b1),
    .cfg_perf_enable        (1'b0),
    .cfg_timeout_cycles     (16'd10),    // 10 microseconds per phase
(full 16-bit range)
    .cfg_latency_threshold  (32'd500),

    .cfg_axi_pkt_mask       (16'hFFF6),  // Drop all but ERROR,
TIMEOUT
    .cfg_axi_error_mask     (16'h0000),
    .cfg_axi_timeout_mask   (16'h0000),
    .cfg_axi_compl_mask     (16'hFFFF),
    // ... rest of mask signals

    // Monitor bus output
    .monbus_valid           (mon_valid),
    .monbus_ready           (mon_ready),
    .monbus_packet          (mon_packet),

    // Status
    .busy                   (wr_busy),
    .active_transactions    (wr_active),
    .error_count            (wr_errors),
    .transaction_count      (wr_count),
```

```
    .cfg_conflict_error     (cfg_conflict)
);
```

13.8 Design Notes

13.8.1 Write-Specific Monitoring

Write Response Tracking: - Monitors AW channel for write address capture - Tracks W channel beats (WLAST detection) - Correlates B channel responses with AWID - Completes write data on WLAST or the expected beat count – there is NO mismatch event; a short-terminated or over-long burst is not flagged

Common Write Errors Detected: - **SLVERR:** Slave error response (decode failure, access violation) - **DECERR:** Decode error (address not mapped) - **Orphan responses:** a B response (BID) arriving with NO matching tracked command – the detection direction is response-side; an AW that never gets its B surfaces as a TIMEOUT, not an orphan - **Timeout:** Write address or response stuck beyond threshold - **Protocol violations:** response-before-data ordering only (WSTRB never reaches the monitor – no strobe check exists; WLAST is used for completion, not validated)

13.8.2 Performance Considerations

Write Transaction Bandwidth: - AW channel: 1 transaction/cycle (when buffer not full) - W channel: 1 beat/cycle sustained (burst pipelining) - B channel: 1 response/cycle (sparse compared to W beats)

Monitor Packet Budget (Write): - Typical: 2-3 packets per write transaction - Burst writes: More efficient packet/beat ratio - Single writes: Higher packet overhead

13.8.3 Buffer Depth Guidelines

Same as axi4_master_wr: - **SKID_DEPTH_AW:** 2 (default) - sufficient for most systems - **SKID_DEPTH_W:** 4 (default) - accommodates moderate bursts - **SKID_DEPTH_B:** 2 (default) - responses are single-beat

Increase depths for high-latency or high-throughput scenarios.

13.9 Related Modules

13.9.1 Companion Monitors

- **axi4_master_rd_mon** - AXI4 master read with monitoring
- **axi4_slave_rd_mon** - AXI4 slave read with monitoring
- **axi4_slave_wr_mon** - AXI4 slave write with monitoring

13.9.2 Base Modules

- **axi4_master_wr** - Functional AXI4 master write (without monitoring)
- **axi_monitor_filtered** - Monitoring engine with filtering (monitor/)

13.9.3 Used Components

- **gaxi_skid_buffer** - Elastic buffering
- **axi_monitor_base** - Core monitoring logic (monitor/)
- **axi_monitor_trans_mgr** - Transaction tracking (monitor/)

13.10 Testing

`val/amba/test_axi4_master_wr_mon.py` exercises this module. It collects 3 parameter cases at the default `REG_LEVEL`.

```
source env_python
pytest val/amba/test_axi4_master_wr_mon.py -v
```

13.11 References

13.11.1 Specifications

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.4.5 “Read and write response structure” (the SLVERR/DECERR codes the monitor reports), ch. A5 “Transaction Identifiers” (per-ID tracking of outstanding transactions), §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the orderings a monitor timeout watches). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.
- Monitor Bus Packet Format: monitor_package_spec.md

13.11.2 Papers and textbooks

- The monitor’s own techniques (transaction table, timeouts, packet filtering) are cited on the AXI Monitor Base page and in the monitor family of the archive.
- Maaref, M. *Architecting and Building High-Speed SoCs*, Packt, 2022, ch. 3 “Basic and Advanced On-Chip Busses and Interconnects” (“AXI bus protocol

overview") – textbook overview of AXI responses and ID ordering (secondary source).
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (protocol specifications are citation only)

13.11.3 Source Code

- RTL: `rtl/amba/axi4/axi4_master_wr_mon.sv`
- Tests: `val/amba/test_axi4_master_wr_mon.py`
- Framework: `bin/TBClasses/components/axi4/`

13.11.4 Documentation

- Configuration Guide: AXI Monitor Base
- Architecture: rtl-amba Overview
- AXI4 Index: README.md

Last Updated: 2026-07-18

13.12 Navigation

- **← Back to AXI4 Index**
- **← Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **← Back to Main Documentation Index**

14 AXI4 Master Write Monitor (Clock-Gated)

Module: `axi4_master_wr_mon_cg.sv` **Base Module:** axi4_master_wr_mon **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/` (protocol monitors live with their protocol; only the monitor CORE pieces are in `rtl/amba/ocelus/`) **Status:** Production Ready

---

14.1 Overview

This is the **clock-gated variant** of axi4_master_wr_mon — the same monitored master write, with activity-based clock gating wrapped around it.

For complete clock-gating documentation, usage examples, and configuration guidelines, see the **Clock-Gated Variants Guide**.

What the wrapper buys you:

- **Same Functionality:** 100% equivalent to base module
- **Power Savings:** traffic-dependent; unmeasured in this repo – treat any percentage as a placeholder until characterized
- **Configurable:** Idle threshold, gating domains, enable/disable
- **Zero Overhead When Disabled:** `cfg_cg_enable=0` bypasses the gate at runtime

---

14.2 Parameters

> A lite-monitor version of this clock-gated wrapper exists as `axi4_master_wr_monlite_cg`: the same gating logic around `axi4_master_wr_monlite` instead of `axi4_master_wr_mon`, about a fifth of the monitor gates.

MOST axi4_master_wr_mon parameters pass through. As of 2026-09-01 only `ACTIVE_TRANS_THRESHOLD` is NOT forwarded, and that one is harmless: its inner default is `MAX_TRANSACTIONS/2`, computed from the `MAX_TRANSACTIONS` this wrapper DOES forward.

An earlier version of this page listed nine more as unforwarded, which was accurate when written. `ACLK_MHZ`, `CFI_MIN_FREQ_MHZ`, `CFI_MAX_FREQ_MHZ`, `USE_WDATA_ORDER_Q`, `NUM_BANKS` and `ADDR_RANGE_IS_ERROR` were threaded through every `_cg` wrapper on 2026-09-01, and `ID_FILTER_ENABLE` / `ID_MATCH_BASE` / `ID_MATCH_COUNT` the day before. Until then a clock-gated build could not state its clock frequency, so the 1 us timer tick was pinned to the 100 MHz default and every microsecond-denominated timeout was miscalibrated on any other clock – silently.

Parameter	Default	Description
CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH	4	Width of the idle countdown, sizing cfg_cg_idle_count
USE_MONITOR	1	Synthesis-time monitor enable (forwarded to inner monitor).
N_ADDR_RANGES	0	Number of address-range comparators (forwarded to base module).
ADDR_FILTER_ENABLE	0	Synthesises the address-range report filter. **The parameter only decides whether the logic EXISTS** – a build that sets it and leaves cfg_addr_filter_enable low filters nothing and looks broken.
ID_FILTER_ENABLE	0	Synthesises the ID report filter (see cfg_id_* for the runtime override).
ID_MATCH_BASE	0	First ID this instance owns.
ID_MATCH_COUNT	0	How many IDs; 0 means ALL, so a zeroed register block does not silently filter everything away.
ADD_PIPELINE_STAGE	0	Insert a register stage for timing closure. Costs a cycle of latency. (Add register stage for timing closure)
ENABLE_COMPL_LOGIC	1'b1	Synthesise the completion-packet cone. 0 removes the logic entirely.
ENABLE_DEBUG_LOGIC	1'b0	Synthesise the debug-packet cone. 0 removes the logic entirely.

Parameter	Default	Description
ENABLE_ERROR_LOGIC	1'b1	Synthesise the error detection cone. 0 removes the logic entirely.
ENABLE_FILTERING	1	Enable packet filtering: two active drop levels (packet type, then event code). Level 2 is reserved and routes nothing.
ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC	1'b1	Synthesise the reporter's performance cone (g_perf). Does NOT gate the perfmon window state machine or its counters.
ENABLE_THRESHOLD_LOGIC	1'b1	Synthesise the threshold-packet cone. 0 removes the logic entirely.
ENABLE_TIMEOUT_LOGIC	1'b1	Synthesise the timeout detection cone. 0 removes the logic entirely.
SKID_DEPTH_AW	2	Skid-buffer depth on the AW channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are legal.
SKID_DEPTH_B	2	Skid-buffer depth on the B channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are legal.
SKID_DEPTH_W	4	Skid-buffer depth on the W channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are legal.
AGENT_ID	16'h000B	Agent identifier emitted in the agent_id field of every monitor packet. Pairs with UNIT_ID to identify the packet

Parameter	Default	Description
		source. (16-bit Agent ID for monitor packets)
UNIT_ID	8'h01	Unit identifier emitted in the unit_id field of every monitor packet. Give each monitored interface a distinct value or the packets cannot be told apart at the collector. (8-bit Unit ID for monitor packets)

Gating is controlled by RUNTIME inputs cfg_cg_enable / cfg_cg_idle_count with status outputs cg_gating / cg_idle; ONE amba_clock_gate_ctrl gates the entire inner module (no per-domain gates). (The ENABLE_CLOCK_GATING / CG_IDLE_CYCLES / CG_GATE_* interface this page once documented never existed.)

Base-module ports are forwarded EXCEPT debug_block_ready, which this wrapper ties off (use the base module for the backpressure tap). cam_clear is forwarded (Input, 1) - synchronous clear of the monitor transaction CAM (driven from the harness clear control bit, e.g. CTRL[4]) - and the full performance-monitoring interface (see Performance Monitoring below). The six ENABLE_*_LOGIC synthesis-cone parameters and the cfg_compl_enable / cfg_threshold_enable / cfg_debug_enable control enables are also passed straight through.

14.2.1 Filter configuration (forwarded)

These reach the inner monitor through this wrapper; before 2026-09-01 they did not.

Port	Direction	Width	Description
cfg_addr_filter_enable	Input	1	High: suppress packets for transactions outside the window. Low: inert, whatever ADDR_FILTER_ENABLE says
cfg_addr_filter_low	Input	ADDR_WIDTH	Window base, inclusive
cfg_addr_filter_high	Input	ADDR_WIDTH	Window limit, inclusive
cfg_id_filter_enab	Input	1	High: use the runtime window below instead of

Port	Direction	Width	Description
le			the ID_MATCH_* parameters
cfg_id_match_base	Input	ID_WIDTH	First ID to accept
cfg_id_match_count	Input	ID_WIDTH+1	How many; 0 means ALL

Neither filter un-filters entries already admitted to the transaction table, which is what makes changing them at runtime safe.

14.2.2 Derived Parameters (do not override)

These are declared as `parameter` so the elaborator can compute them, not so callers can set them. Each defaults to an expression over the parameters above; overriding one desynchronises it from its source and the design fails to elaborate or silently mis-sizes a bus. Set the parameters they are derived FROM and leave these alone.

Derived parameter	Default expression
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	AXI_DATA_WIDTH / 8
AW	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH
DW	AXI_DATA_WIDTH
IW	AXI_ID_WIDTH
SW	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH
UW	AXI_USER_WIDTH

14.3 Ports

Port	Dir	Width	Description
aclk	In	1	
aresetn	In	1	
cam_clear	In	1	sync clear of the monitor trans CAM
fub_axi_awid	In	[IW-1:0]	
fub_axi_awaddr	In	[AW-1:0]	
fub_axi_awlen	In	[7:0]	
fub_axi_awsize	In	[2:0]	

Port	Dir	Width	Description
fub_axi_awburst	In	[1:0]	
fub_axi_awlock	In	1	
fub_axi_awcache	In	[3:0]	
fub_axi_awprot	In	[2:0]	
fub_axi_awqos	In	[3:0]	
fub_axi_awregion	In	[3:0]	
fub_axi_awuser	In	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_awvalid	In	1	
fub_axi_awready	Out	1	
fub_axi_wdata	In	[DW-1:0]	
fub_axi_wstrb	In	[SW-1:0]	
fub_axi_wlast	In	1	
fub_axi_wuser	In	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_wvalid	In	1	
fub_axi_wready	Out	1	
fub_axi_bid	Out	[IW-1:0]	
fub_axi_bresp	Out	[1:0]	
fub_axi_buser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_bvalid	Out	1	
fub_axi_bready	In	1	
m_axi_awid	Out	[IW-1:0]	
m_axi_awaddr	Out	[AW-1:0]	
m_axi_awlen	Out	[7:0]	
m_axi_awsize	Out	[2:0]	
m_axi_awburst	Out	[1:0]	
m_axi_awlock	Out	1	
m_axi_awcache	Out	[3:0]	
m_axi_awprot	Out	[2:0]	
m_axi_awqos	Out	[3:0]	
m_axi_awregion	Out	[3:0]	

Port	Dir	Width	Description
m_axi_awuser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
m_axi_awvalid	Out	1	
m_axi_awready	In	1	
m_axi_wdata	Out	[DW-1:0]	
m_axi_wstrb	Out	[SW-1:0]	
m_axi_wlast	Out	1	
m_axi_wuser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
m_axi_wvalid	Out	1	
m_axi_wready	In	1	
m_axi_bid	In	[IW-1:0]	
m_axi_bresp	In	[1:0]	
m_axi_buser	In	[UW-1:0]	
m_axi_bvalid	In	1	
m_axi_bready	Out	1	
cfg_monitor_enable	In	1	Enable monitoring
cfg_error_enable	In	1	Enable error detection
cfg_timeout_enable	In	1	Enable timeout detection
cfg_perf_enable	In	1	Enable performance monitoring
cfg_compl_enable	In	1	Enable completion packets
cfg_threshold_enable	In	1	Enable threshold packets
cfg_debug_enable	In	1	Enable debug packets
cfg_timeout_cycles	In	[15:0]	Timeout threshold in

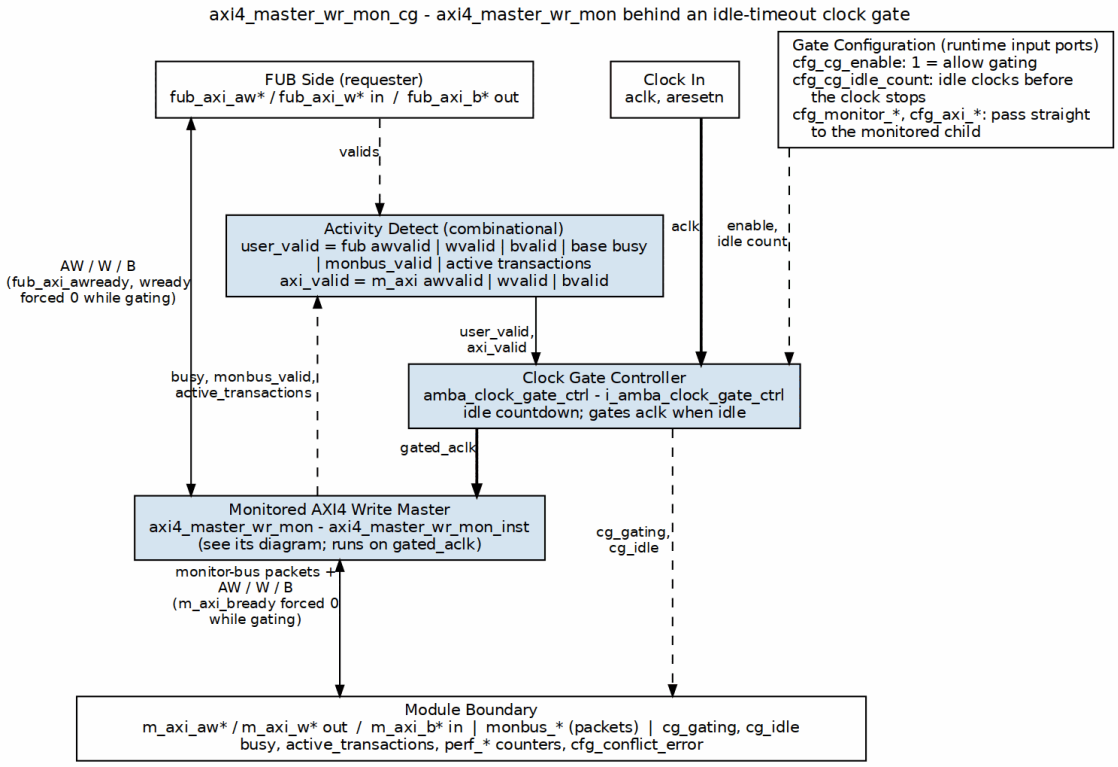
Port	Dir	Width	Description
			MICROSECONDS (1 us tick), despite the name
cfg_freq_sel	In	[3:0]	counter_freq_invariant LUT index
cfg_latency_threshold	In	[31:0]	Latency threshold for alerts
cfg_axi_pkt_mask	In	[15:0]	Drop mask for packet types
cfg_axi_err_select	In	[15:0]	Error select for packet types (for future routing)
cfg_axi_error_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual error event mask
cfg_axi_timeout_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual timeout event mask
cfg_axi_compl_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual completion event mask
cfg_axi_thresh_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual threshold event mask
cfg_axi_perf_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual performance event mask
cfg_axi_addr_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual address match event mask
cfg_axi_debug_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual debug event mask
cfg_cg_enable	In	1	Enable clock gating
cfg_cg_idle_coun	In	[CG_IDLE_COUNT_W	Idle cycles before

Port	Dir	Width	Description
t		IDTH-1:0]	gating
cfg_addr_check_enable	In	1	
cfg_addr_range_enable	In	[(N_ADDR_RANGES > 0 ? N_ADDR_RANGES : 1)-1:0]	
cfg_addr_range_low	In	[(N_ADDR_RANGES > 0 ? N_ADDR_RANGES : 1)-1:0]	
cfg_addr_range_high	In	[(N_ADDR_RANGES > 0 ? N_ADDR_RANGES : 1)-1:0]	
cfg_addr_filter_enable	In	1	
cfg_addr_filter_low	In	[AW-1:0]	
cfg_addr_filter_high	In	[AW-1:0]	
cfg_id_filter_enable	In	1	
cfg_id_match_base	In	[IW-1:0]	
cfg_id_match_count	In	[IW:0]	
i_mon_time	In	1	
monbus_valid	Out	1	Monitor bus valid
monbus_ready	In	1	Monitor bus ready
monbus_packet	Out	1	Monitor packet (128-bit)
monbus_timestamp	Out	1	Side-band sampled time
busy	Out	1	
active_transactions	Out	[7:0]	Number of active transactions
error_count	Out	[15:0]	Total error count

Port	Dir	Width	Description
transaction_count	Out	[31:0]	Total transaction count
cg_gating	Out	1	Gated clock is stopped
cg_idle	Out	1	No activity observed
cfg_conflict_error	Out	1	Configuration conflict detected
cfg_start_event_sel	In	[2:0]	
cfg_end_event_sel	In	[2:0]	
cfg_start_trigger	In	1	
cfg_end_trigger	In	1	
cfg_window_force_close	In	1	
window_active	Out	1	
window_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_prod_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_bp_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_starv_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_idle_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_beat_count	Out	[31:0]	
perf_byte_count	Out	[63:0]	
perf_burst_count	Out	[31:0]	

14.4 Functional Description

14.4.1 Block diagram



axi4_master_wr_mon_cg block diagram

This is the `_cg` pattern wrapped around `axi4_master_wr_mon` (one child box, see its own diagram): the heavy `aclk` column runs through `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` into the monitored child as `gated_aclk`. The activity term adds `monbus_valid` and any active transactions to the usual valids and `busy`, so the clock cannot stop with a monitor packet or an open transaction in flight. The `cfg_monitor_*` and `cfg_axi_*` ports pass straight through to the child; the outward readies are forced to 0 while gating.

14.4.2 Performance Monitoring

The clock-gated wrapper exposes the full perfmon interface of the base module and **forwards every port unchanged** to the inner `axi4_master_wr_mon`. The measurement-window state machine, the four W-channel utilization buckets (productive / back-pressure / starvation / idle), and the beat/byte/burst throughput counters behave exactly as documented in the base module — see Performance Monitoring in axi4_master_wr_mon for the full narrative and per-bit semantics.

Forwarded perfmon ports (identical width and direction to the base module):

- **Inputs:** `cfg_perf_enable`, `cfg_start_event_sel` (3), `cfg_end_event_sel` (3), `cfg_start_trigger`, `cfg_end_trigger`, `cfg_window_force_close`
- **Outputs:** `window_active`, `window_cycles` (32), `perf_prod_cycles` (32), `perf_bp_cycles` (32), `perf_starv_cycles` (32), `perf_idle_cycles` (32), `perf_beat_count` (32), `perf_byte_count` (64), `perf_burst_count` (32)

WARNING – gating vs window accounting: an open measurement window is NOT a wake term, and the entire inner monitor (window state machine and counters included) runs on the gated clock. If the bus idles past `cfg_cg_idle_count` with a window open, the counters FREEZE while wall-clock time passes, and trigger pulses (`cfg_start_trigger`, `cfg_end_trigger`, `cfg_window_force_close`, `cam_clear`) arriving while gated are DROPPED. For exact wall-clock windows or idle-bus triggering, hold `cfg_cg_enable` low around the measurement, or use the base module.

14.5 Timing Characteristics

Skid parameter	Default depth
`SKID_DEPTH_AW`	2 entries
`SKID_DEPTH_W`	4 entries
`SKID_DEPTH_B`	2 entries

Each channel traverses one `gaxi_skid_buffer`, which registers both `rd_valid` and its storage. The **1-cycle input-to-output latency therefore applies on every transfer, including the unstalled case** – there is no combinational bypass. Depth buys backpressure absorption, not throughput; full rate is sustained once the pipeline is primed. Legal range is 2..8 inclusive, odd values included.

Clocking: `aclk`, reset `aresetn` (active-low asynchronous).

No synthesis numbers are quoted here. Frequency and area depend on the target device and the parameters you elaborate with; run your own build.

14.6 Usage Examples

```
axi4_master_wr_mon_cg #(
    // Base module parameters (see axi4_master_wr_mon.md)
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH(8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH(64),

    .CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH(4)
```

```
) u_cg (
    .aclk(clk),
    .aresetn(rst_n),
    .cfg_cg_enable(1'b1),
    .cfg_cg_idle_count(4'd8),
    .cg_gating(), .cg_idle(),
    // ... all other ports same as axi4_master_wr_mon (except
debug_block_ready)
);
```

14.7 Design Notes

A peer's READY must never enter the activity term. A consumer that parks its response-ready high while idle is behaving correctly; folding that signal into `user_valid` pins this block permanently awake and defeats gating entirely – silently, because function is unaffected. Ten wrappers in this repository shipped that way and nothing failed until someone measured. `val/amba/test_cg_peer_ready.py` parks the peer READY high, holds every VALID low, and requires `cg_gating`. Canonical rule: `vault/handbook/design/clock-gating-activity-terms.md`.

`cfg_cg_enable` is not a kill switch. It arms gating and reaches `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` only; the datapath and any monitor enables are forwarded untouched. With it low the clock free-runs and this module behaves exactly like its base.

Gating latency. The clock stops `cfg_cg_idle_count` + 2 cycles after the last bus activity – the idle counter, plus one for the `r_wakeup` flop. Size the idle count against your traffic's inter-burst gap: too small and the block wakes constantly, too large and it never gates.

Cost. Five flops: `r_wakeup` plus `r_idle_counter` at `IDLE_CNTR_WIDTH`, scaling as 1 + `CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH`. The ICG itself is a latch or BUFGCE, not fabric flops.

14.8 Related Modules

- **Base Module Functionality:** axi4_master_wr_mon.md
- **Clock Gating Guide:** clock_gated_variants.md
- **Detailed CG Examples:**
  - axi4_master_rd_mon_cg.md (AXI4 monitor)
  - axil4_master_rd_mon_cg.md (AXIL4 monitor)
  - apb4_slave_cg.md (APB interface)

14.9 Testing

`val/amba/test_axi4_master_wr_mon_cg.py` exercises this module. It collects 3 parameter cases at the default `REG_LEVEL`.

```
source env_python
pytest val/amba/test_axi4_master_wr_mon_cg.py -v
```

14.10 References

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.4.5 “Read and write response structure” (the SLVERR/DECERR codes the monitor reports), ch. A5 “Transaction Identifiers” (per-ID tracking of outstanding transactions), §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the orderings a monitor timeout watches). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.
- Benini, L., De Micheli, G. “Automatic Synthesis of Low-Power Gated-Clock Finite-State Machines.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 15(6), June 1996. DOI: 10.1109/43.503933 – the latch-based clock-gating cell (`icg`, via `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` and `clock_gate_ctrl`) that gates this wrapper’s clock.
- Benini, L., Bogliolo, A., De Micheli, G. “A Survey of Design Techniques for System-Level Dynamic Power Management.” *IEEE Trans. VLSI Systems*, 8(3), June 2000. DOI: 10.1109/92.845896 – fixed-timeout shutdown: gate after `cfg_cg_idle_count` idle cycles, wake on activity.
- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – AXI4 has no wake-up signal. AXI5 adds AWAKEUP (Issue H §E1.7 “Wake-up Signaling”; Issue L §A14.1.1), which lets a manager restart a gated interface before VALID. This wrapper wakes on the flopped OR of the VALIDs and holds READY low while gated.
- The monitor’s own techniques are cited on the AXI Monitor Base page and in the monitor family of the archive.
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF, archived under `rtl/common/references/`: `LatchBasedClockGating__Benini1996.pdf`, `DynamicPowerManagementTimeout__Benini2000.pdf`)

14.11 Navigation

- ← Back to AXI4 Index
- ← Back to rtl-amba Index
- ← Back to Main Documentation Index

15 AXI4 Master Write Stub

Module: `axi4_master_wr_stub.sv` **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/stubs/` **Status:** Production Ready

15.1 Overview

The write-side counterpart to the read stub. The AXI4 Master Write Stub packs the AW (write address), W (write data), and B (write response) channels into simple packet interfaces through skid buffers, so your testbench drives one wide payload per channel instead of handshaking a dozen AXI signals. Ideal for testbenches and integration scenarios where a simplified interface is the whole point.

15.1.1 Key Features

- Packed packet interface for AW, W, and B channels
- Configurable skid buffer depth on each channel
- Full AXI4 write transaction support
- Burst, ID, strobe, and user signal support
- Parameterized data widths

15.2 Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
SKID_DEPTH_AW	int	2	AW channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
SKID_DEPTH_W	int	4	W channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
SKID_DEPTH_B	int	2	B channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
AXI_ID_WIDTH	int	8	AXI transaction ID width
AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	int	32	AXI address bus width
AXI_DATA_WIDTH	int	32	AXI data bus width
AXI_USER_WIDTH	int	1	AXI user signal width

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	int	AXI_DATA_WIDTH/8	Write strobe width
AW	int	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	Short alias for address width
DW	int	AXI_DATA_WIDTH	Short alias for data width
IW	int	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Short alias for ID width
SW	int	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	Short alias for strobe width
UW	int	AXI_USER_WIDTH	Short alias for user width
AWSize	int	IW+AW+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+UW	AW packet size (calculated)
WSize	int	DW+SW+1+UW	W packet size (calculated)
BSize	int	IW+2+UW	B packet size (calculated)

15.3 Ports

15.3.1 Clock and Reset

Port	Direction	Width	Description
aclk	Input	1	AXI clock
aresetn	Input	1	AXI reset (active low)

15.3.2 AXI4 Write Address Channel (AW)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
m_axi_awid	Output	IW	Write address ID
m_axi_awaddr	Output	AW	Write address
m_axi_awlen	Output	8	Burst length

Port	Direction	Width	Description
m_axi_awsize	Output	3	Burst size
m_axi_awburst	Output	2	Burst type
m_axi_awlock	Output	1	Lock type
m_axi_awcache	Output	4	Cache type
m_axi_awprot	Output	3	Protection type
m_axi_awqos	Output	4	Quality of service
m_axi_awregion	Output	4	Region identifier
m_axi_awuser	Output	UW	User signal
m_axi_awvalid	Output	1	Write address valid
m_axi_awready	Input	1	Write address ready

15.3.3 AXI4 Write Data Channel (W)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
m_axi_wdata	Output	DW	Write data
m_axi_wstrb	Output	SW	Write strobes
m_axi_wlast	Output	1	Write last
m_axi_wuser	Output	UW	User signal
m_axi_wvalid	Output	1	Write data valid
m_axi_wready	Input	1	Write data ready

15.3.4 AXI4 Write Response Channel (B)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
m_axi_bid	Input	IW	Response ID
m_axi_bresp	Input	2	Write response
m_axi_buser	Input	UW	User signal
m_axi_bvalid	Input	1	Write response

Port	Direction	Width	Description
			valid
m_axi_bready	Output	1	Write response ready

15.3.5 AW Packet Interface

Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_awvalid	Input	1	AW packet valid
fub_axi_awready	Output	1	Ready to accept AW packet
fub_axi_aw_count	Output	4	AW buffer occupancy
fub_axi_aw_pkt	Input	AWSize	Packed AW packet data

15.3.6 W Packet Interface

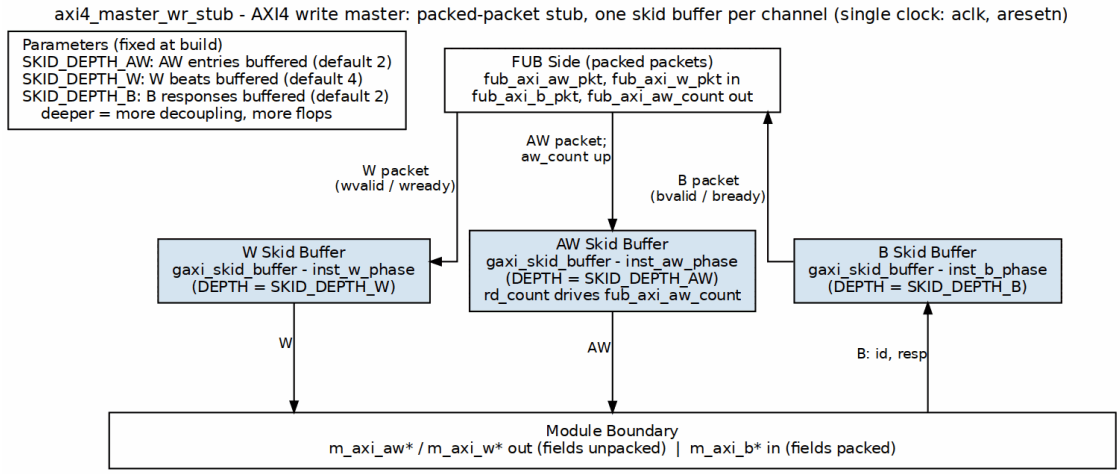
Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_wvalid	Input	1	W packet valid
fub_axi_wready	Output	1	Ready to accept W packet
fub_axi_w_pkt	Input	WSize	Packed W packet data

15.3.7 B Packet Interface

Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_bvalid	Output	1	B packet valid
fub_axi_bready	Input	1	Ready to accept B packet
fub_axi_b_pkt	Output	BSize	Packed B packet data

15.4 Functional Description

15.4.1 Block diagram

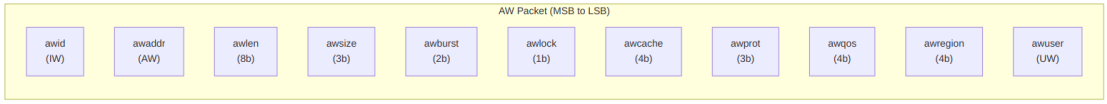


axi4_master_wr_stub block diagram

This stub is `axi4_master_wr` with a packed-packet interface at the top (FUB side): each channel's fields travel as one packet (`*_pkt`) through its own `gaxi_skid_buffer` (`inst_*_phase`), and are unpacked onto, or packed from, the AXI4 fields at the other side. The AW buffer's occupancy is exported as `fub_axi_aw_count`. There is no busy output and no clock gating.

15.4.2 Packet Formats

Packets are packed MSB-to-LSB in AXI signal order — one concatenation per channel, no bit shuffling required on the testbench side.

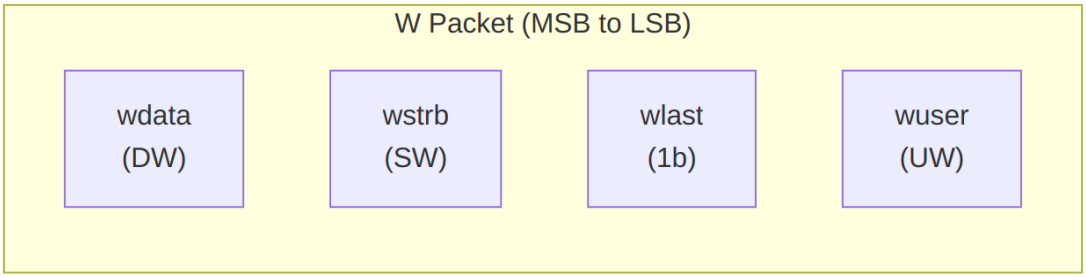


AW Packet Structure (Write Address)

Bit Positions:

```
fub_axi_aw_pkt = {awid, awaddr, awlen, awsize, awburst, awlock,
awcache, awprot, awqos, awregion, awuser}

Width = IW + AW + 8 + 3 + 2 + 1 + 4 + 3 + 4 + 4 + UW
```

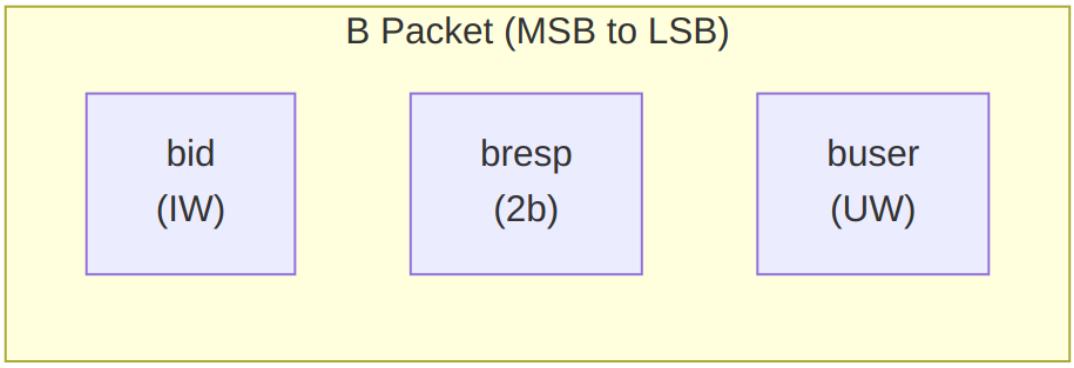


W Packet Structure (Write Data)

Bit Positions:

```
fub_axi_w_pkt = {wdata, wstrb, wlast, wuser}
```

```
Width = DW + SW + 1 + UW
```

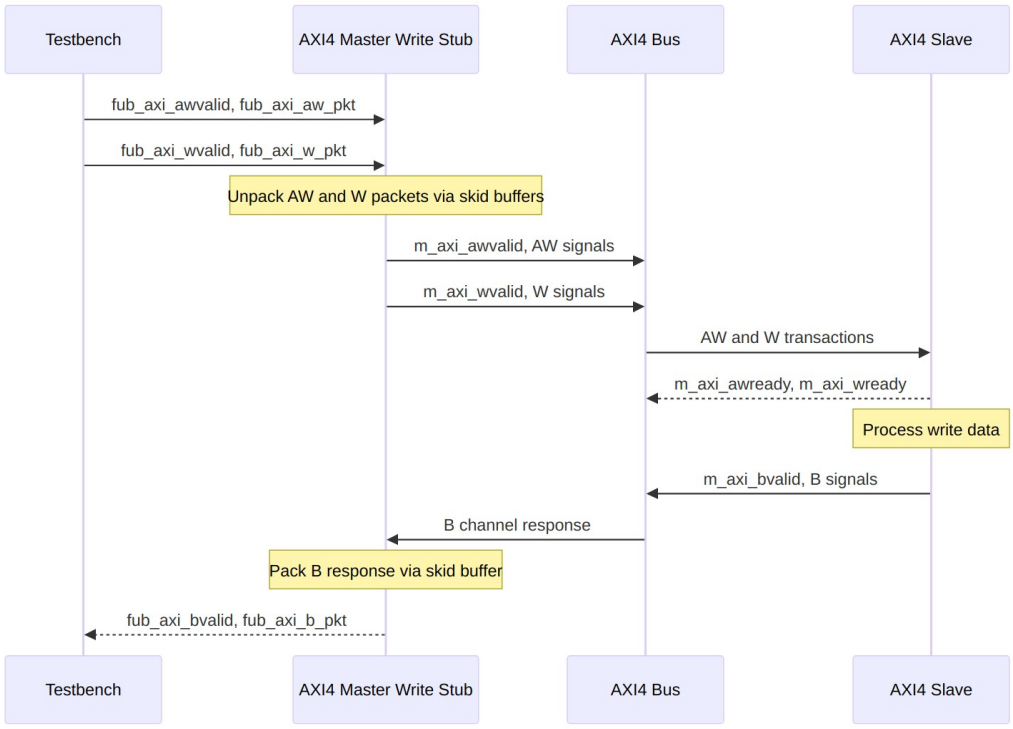


B Packet Structure (Write Response)

Bit Positions:

```
fub_axi_b_pkt = {bid, bresp, buser}
```

```
Width = IW + 2 + UW
```



Transaction Flow

15.5 Timing Characteristics

Timing diagram pending. The signals and sequence this scenario exercises:

- aclk
- fub_axi_awvalid, fub_axi_awready, fub_axi_aw_pkt
- fub_axi_wvalid, fub_axi_wready, fub_axi_w_pkt
- AXI AW signals (m_axi_awvalid, m_axi_awaddr, m_axi_awlen, etc.)
- AXI W signals (m_axi_wvalid, m_axi_wdata, m_axi_wstrb, m_axi_wlast, etc.)
- AXI B signals (m_axi_bvalid, m_axi_bid, m_axi_bresp, etc.)
- fub_axi_bvalid, fub_axi_bready, fub_axi_b_pkt
- Packet-to-AXI timing relationship with skid buffer operation

15.6 Usage Examples

```
axi4_master_wr_stub #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AW   (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_W    (4),
    .SKID_DEPTH_B    (2),
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH    (8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH  (32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH  (64),
    .AXI_USER_WIDTH  (4)
) u_axi4_master_wr_stub (
    .aclk            (axi_clk),
    .aresetn         (axi_rst_n),

    // AXI4 master write interface
    .m_axi_awid      (m_axi_awid),
    .m_axi_awaddr    (m_axi_awaddr),
    .m_axi_awlen     (m_axi_awlen),
    .m_axi_awsize    (m_axi_awsize),
    .m_axi_awburst   (m_axi_awburst),
    .m_axi_awlock    (m_axi_awlock),
    .m_axi_awcache   (m_axi_awcache),
    .m_axi_awprot    (m_axi_awprot),
    .m_axi_awqos     (m_axi_awqos),
    .m_axi_awregion  (m_axi_awregion),
    .m_axi_awuser    (m_axi_awuser),
    .m_axi_awvalid   (m_axi_awvalid),
    .m_axi_awready   (m_axi_awready),

    .m_axi_wdata     (m_axi_wdata),
    .m_axi_wstrb     (m_axi_wstrb),
    .m_axi_wlast     (m_axi_wlast),
    .m_axi_wuser     (m_axi_wuser),
    .m_axi_wvalid    (m_axi_wvalid),
    .m_axi_wready    (m_axi_wready),

    .m_axi_bid       (m_axi_bid),
    .m_axi_bresp     (m_axi_bresp),
    .m_axi_buser     (m_axi_buser),
    .m_axi_bvalid    (m_axi_bvalid),
    .m_axi_bready    (m_axi_bready),

    // Packed AW interface
    .fub_axi_awvalid (tb_aw_valid),
    .fub_axi_awready (tb_aw_ready),
    .fub_axi_aw_count(tb_aw_count),
    .fub_axi_aw_pkt  (tb_aw_pkt),
```

```
    // Packed W interface
    .fub_axi_wvalid  (tb_w_valid),
    .fub_axi_wready  (tb_w_ready),
    .fub_axi_w_pkt   (tb_w_pkt),

    // Packed B interface
    .fub_axi_bvalid  (tb_b_valid),
    .fub_axi_bready  (tb_b_ready),
    .fub_axi_b_pkt   (tb_b_pkt)
);

// Build AW packet (single beat write at address 0x1000)
localparam AWSize = 8 + 32 + 8 + 3 + 2 + 1 + 4 + 3 + 4 + 4 + 4;  //
Calculate size
assign tb_aw_pkt = {
    8'd0,           // awid
    32'h0000_1000,  // awaddr
    8'd0,           // awlen (1 beat)
    3'b011,         // awsize (8 bytes)
    2'b01,          // awburst (INCR)
    1'b0,           // awlock
    4'b0011,        // awcache
    3'b000,         // awprot
    4'b0000,        // awqos
    4'b0000,        // awregion
    4'h0            // awuser
};

// Build W packet
localparam WSize = 64 + 8 + 1 + 4;  // Calculate size
assign tb_w_pkt = {
    64'hDEAD_BEEF_CAFE_BABE,  // wdata
    8'hFF,                    // wstrb (all bytes)
    1'b1,                     // wlast
    4'h0                      // wuser
};

// Parse B packet
localparam int BSize = 8 + 2 + 4;   // IW + resp + UW
wire [7:0] b_id   = tb_b_pkt[BSize-1:BSize-8];
wire [1:0] b_resp = tb_b_pkt[5:4];
wire [3:0] b_user = tb_b_pkt[3:0];
```

15.7 Design Notes

15.7.1 Skid Buffer Operation

The stub is three `gaxi_skid_buffer` instances and nothing fancier. They:

- Decouple timing between testbench and AXI bus
- Provide configurable buffering depth per channel
- Handle backpressure gracefully
- Support burst transactions without stalling

Recommended Depths: - **AW Channel:** 2-4 (address transactions) - **W Channel:** 4-8 (data beats for bursts) - **B Channel:** 2-4 (responses)

15.7.2 Channel Independence

The AW, W, and B channels are independent: - AW and W can be driven in any order - Stub handles proper AXI timing - B responses arrive asynchronously

15.7.3 Packet Packing Order

AW, W, and B packets are packed MSB-to-LSB following AXI signal order: - Simplifies testbench packet creation - Matches common concatenation order - Efficient for burst transaction handling

15.7.4 Internal Architecture

The stub instantiates three `gaxi_skid_buffer` modules: - **AW Skid Buffer:** Unpacks AW packets to AXI AW channel - **W Skid Buffer:** Unpacks W packets to AXI W channel - **B Skid Buffer:** Packs AXI B channel to B packets

All AXI protocol handling is done by the skid buffers and downstream modules.

15.8 Related Modules

- **AXI4 Master Write** - Full AXI4 master write module (if wrapping one)
- **AXI4 Master Read Stub** - Corresponding read stub
- **AXI4 Master Stub** - Combined read/write stub
- **AXI4 Slave Write Stub** - Slave-side write stub

15.9 Testing

No dedicated testbench, and none is expected. This is a stub: a tie-off shell that presents the interface and drives inert values, so there is no behaviour to verify beyond elaboration. `make verilator` lints it as its own top on every run, which is the coverage that applies.

Treat any behaviour described on this page as unverified by simulation.

15.10 References

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h — §A3.2.1 “Handshake process” and §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the per-channel VALID/READY contract each skid buffer preserves); §A1.2.3 “Register slices” and §A3.1.1 “Clock” (a register stage may sit in any channel for one cycle of latency, and an interface must have no combinational input-to-output path, which a slice breaks). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.
- Carloni, L.P., McMillan, K.L., Sangiovanni-Vincentelli, A.L. “Theory of Latency-Insensitive Design.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 20(9), Sept. 2001. DOI: 10.1109/43.945302 — relay stations: a channel can be pipelined by any number of back-pressured stages without changing its behavior, which is why a skid buffer per channel is transparent to both ends.
- Cortadella, J., Kishinevsky, M., Grundmann, B. “Synthesis of Synchronous Elastic Architectures.” *Proc. 43rd Design Automation Conference (DAC ’06)*, July 2006, pp. 657-662. DOI: 10.1145/1146909.1147077 — the elastic buffer with valid/stop back-pressure, the structure a skid buffer implements.
- Chipressian. *Crack the Hardware Interview: from RTL Designers’ Perspective*, Part 2 ch. 2 “Handshake Protocols” (forward and backward register slices) — textbook treatment of the valid/ready slice; the backward slice’s extra data register is the skid entry (secondary source).
- Maaref, M. *Architecting and Building High-Speed SoCs*, Packt, 2022, ch. 3 “Basic and Advanced On-Chip Busses and Interconnects” (“AXI bus protocol overview”) — textbook overview of the AXI channels, bursts and ID ordering (secondary source).
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF: `LatencyInsensitiveDesign__Carloni2001.pdf`, `ElasticBuffer__Cortadella2006.pdf`)

15.11 Navigation

- ← Back to AXI4 Index
- ← Back to rtl-amba Index
- ← Back to Main Documentation Index

16 AXI4 Slave Read

Module: `axi4_slave_rd.sv` **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/` **Status:** Production Ready

16.1 Overview

The mirror image of the master-side buffers. The AXI4 Slave Read sits between an AXI4 interconnect and your memory or backend processing element, with configurable-depth skid buffers on the AR and R channels. The interconnect can present addresses whenever it likes, the backend can return data whenever it's ready, and neither one stalls the other — that's the entire job, and it's worth doing well.

16.1.1 Key Features

- **Full AXI4 Read Support:** Complete AR and R channel implementation
- **Independent Channel Buffering:** Separate configurable depth buffers for each channel
- **Elastic Buffering:** Decouples interconnect and backend timing domains
- **Burst Support:** Full burst transaction handling with RLAST tracking
- **User Signal Support:** Carries ARUSER and RUSER signals
- **Clock Gating Support:** Busy signal for dynamic power management

16.2 Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
`SKID_DEPTH_AR`	int	2	Depth of read address (AR) channel skid buffer
`SKID_DEPTH_R`	int	4	Depth of read data (R) channel skid buffer
`AXI_ID_WIDTH`	int	8	Width of transaction ID signals (ARID, RID)
`AXI_ADDR_WIDTH`	int	32	Width of address bus (ARADDR)
`AXI_DATA_WIDTH`	int	32	Width of data bus (RDATA), must be 8, 16, 32, 64, 128, 256, 512, or 1024

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
AXI_USER_WIDTH	int	1	Width of user-defined signals (ARUSER, RUSER)

16.2.1 Derived Parameters (do not override)

These are declared as `parameter` so the elaborator can compute them, not so callers can set them. Each defaults to an expression over the parameters above; overriding one desynchronises it from its source and the design fails to elaborate or silently mis-sizes a bus. Set the parameters they are derived FROM and leave these alone.

Derived parameter	Default expression
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	AXI_DATA_WIDTH / 8
AW	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH
DW	AXI_DATA_WIDTH
IW	AXI_ID_WIDTH
SW	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH
UW	AXI_USER_WIDTH
ARSize	IW+AW+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+UW
RSize	IW+DW+2+1+UW

16.3 Ports

The full port list, straight from the RTL:

```
module axi4_slave_rd #(
    parameter int SKID_DEPTH_AR     = 2,
    parameter int SKID_DEPTH_R      = 4,
    parameter int AXI_ID_WIDTH      = 8,
    parameter int AXI_ADDR_WIDTH    = 32,
    parameter int AXI_DATA_WIDTH    = 32,
    parameter int AXI_USER_WIDTH    = 1
) (
    // Clock and Reset
    input  logic                        aclk,
    input  logic                        aresetn,

    // Slave AXI Interface (s_axi_*)
    // Read address channel (AR)
    input  logic [AXI_ID_WIDTH-1:0]   s_axi_arid,
    input  logic [AXI_ADDR_WIDTH-1:0] s_axi_araddr,
    input  logic [7:0]                 s_axi_arlen,
    input  logic [2:0]                 s_axi_arsize,
```

```
    input  logic [1:0]                 s_axi_arburst,
    input  logic                       s_axi_arlock,
    input  logic [3:0]                 s_axi_arcache,
    input  logic [2:0]                 s_axi_arprot,
    input  logic [3:0]                 s_axi_arqos,
    input  logic [3:0]                 s_axi_arregion,
    input  logic [AXI_USER_WIDTH-1:0] s_axi_aruser,
    input  logic                       s_axi_arvalid,
    output logic                       s_axi_arready,

    // Read data channel (R)
    output logic [AXI_ID_WIDTH-1:0]   s_axi_rid,
    output logic [AXI_DATA_WIDTH-1:0] s_axi_rdata,
    output logic [1:0]                 s_axi_rresp,
    output logic                       s_axi_rlast,
    output logic [AXI_USER_WIDTH-1:0] s_axi_ruser,
    output logic                       s_axi_rvalid,
    input  logic                       s_axi_rready,

    // Backend Interface (fub_axi_* - to memory/backend)
    // Read address channel (AR)
    output logic [AXI_ID_WIDTH-1:0]   fub_axi_arid,
    output logic [AXI_ADDR_WIDTH-1:0] fub_axi_araddr,
    output logic [7:0]                 fub_axi_arlen,
    output logic [2:0]                 fub_axi_arsize,
    output logic [1:0]                 fub_axi_arburst,
    output logic                       fub_axi_arlock,
    output logic [3:0]                 fub_axi_arcache,
    output logic [2:0]                 fub_axi_arprot,
    output logic [3:0]                 fub_axi_arqos,
    output logic [3:0]                 fub_axi_arregion,
    output logic [AXI_USER_WIDTH-1:0] fub_axi_aruser,
    output logic                       fub_axi_arvalid,
    input  logic                       fub_axi_arready,

    // Read data channel (R)
    input  logic [AXI_ID_WIDTH-1:0]   fub_axi_rid,
    input  logic [AXI_DATA_WIDTH-1:0] fub_axi_rdata,
    input  logic [1:0]                 fub_axi_rresp,
    input  logic                       fub_axi_rlast,
    input  logic [AXI_USER_WIDTH-1:0] fub_axi_ruser,
    input  logic                       fub_axi_rvalid,
    output logic                       fub_axi_rready,

    // Status
    output logic                       busy
);
```

16.3.1 Clock and Reset

Port	Direction	Width	Description
aclk	Input	1	AXI clock - all signals sampled on rising edge
aresetn	Input	1	Active-low asynchronous reset

16.3.2 Slave AXI Interface (s_axi_*)

Read Address Channel (AR)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
s_axi_arid	Input	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Read transaction ID
s_axi_araddr	Input	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	Read address
s_axi_arlen	Input	8	Burst length, AXI-encoded: beats - 1 (0x00 = 1 beat, 0xFF = 256)
s_axi_arsize	Input	3	Burst size (bytes per beat)
s_axi_arburst	Input	2	Burst type (FIXED, INCR, WRAP)
s_axi_arlock	Input	1	Lock type (atomic access support)
s_axi_arcache	Input	4	Cache attributes
s_axi_arprot	Input	3	Protection attributes
s_axi_arqos	Input	4	Quality of Service identifier
s_axi_arregion	Input	4	Region identifier
s_axi_aruser	Input	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User-defined signal
s_axi_arv	Input	1	Read address valid

Port	Direction	Width	Description
alid			
s_axi_arready	Output	1	Read address ready

Read Data Channel (R)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
s_axi_rid	Output	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Read transaction ID
s_axi_rdata	Output	AXI_DATA_WIDTH	Read data
s_axi_rresp	Output	2	Read response (OKAY, EXOKAY, SLVERR, DECERR)
s_axi_rlast	Output	1	Last beat of burst indicator
s_axi_ruser	Output	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User-defined signal
s_axi_rvalid	Output	1	Read data valid
s_axi_rready	Input	1	Read data ready

16.3.3 Backend Interface (fub_axi_*)

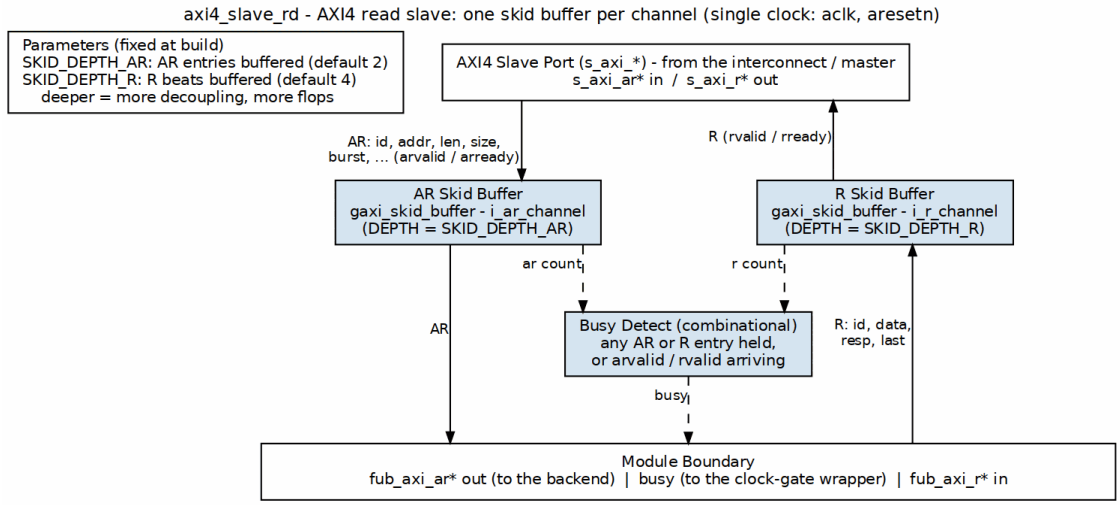
Mirrors the slave interface but in the opposite direction (output on AR, input on R).

16.3.4 Status Outputs

Port	Direction	Width	Description
busy	Output	1	Indicates active transactions in buffers (for clock gating)

16.4 Functional Description

16.4.1 Block diagram



axi4_slave_rd block diagram

AR travels down the left lane from the s_axi slave port through its own `gaxi_skid_buffer` to the backend (fub_axi); read data (R) comes back up the right lane through a second skid buffer. Busy Detect sits between the lanes: it watches both buffers' occupancy and the incoming valids, and drives `busy`, the activity input the `_cg` clock-gated wrapper uses. `SKID_DEPTH_AR` and `SKID_DEPTH_R` set how many entries each buffer holds.

16.4.2 Architecture

Two independent `gaxi_skid_buffer` instances provide the elastic buffering, one per read channel (see the block diagram above).

16.4.3 Channel Operations

16.4.3.1 Read Address (AR) Channel

1. Master presents read address and attributes via interconnect
2. AR skid buffer accepts when space available (`s_axi_arready` high)
3. Buffered address presented to backend when ready
4. Configurable depth (`SKID_DEPTH_AR`) smooths timing variations

16.4.3.2 Read Data (R) Channel

1. Backend returns read data with transaction ID
2. R skid buffer provides deeper buffering (default depth=4)
3. RLAST signal preserved to indicate burst boundaries

4. Data forwarded to master when ready to accept

16.4.4 Busy Signal

The `busy` output indicates active transactions:

```
assign busy = (int_ar_count > 0) || (int_r_count > 0) ||
                s_axi_arvalid || fub_axi_rvalid;
```

Use cases: - **Clock gating:** Disable clock when `busy` is low - **Power management:** Enter low-power mode when idle - **Synchronization:** Wait for idle before configuration changes

---

16.5 Timing Characteristics

Skid parameter	Default depth
`SKID_DEPTH_AR`	2 entries
`SKID_DEPTH_R`	4 entries

Each channel traverses one `gaxi_skid_buffer`, which registers both `rd_valid` and its storage. The **1-cycle input-to-output latency therefore applies on every transfer, including the unstalled case** – there is no combinational bypass. Depth buys backpressure absorption, not throughput; full rate is sustained once the pipeline is primed. Legal range is 2..8 inclusive, odd values included.

Clocking: `aclk`, reset `aresetn` (active-low asynchronous).

No synthesis numbers are quoted here. Frequency and area depend on the target device and the parameters you elaborate with; run your own build.

16.6 Usage Examples

Every parameter and port below is read from the module declaration.

```
axi4_slave_rd #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AR          (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_R           (4),
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH           (8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH         (32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH         (32),
    .AXI_USER_WIDTH         (1)
) u_axi4_slave_rd (
    .aclk                   (aclk),
    .aresetn                (aresetn),
```

```
    .s_axi_arid           (s_axi_arid),
    .s_axi_araddr         (s_axi_araddr),
    .s_axi_arlen          (s_axi_arlen),
    .s_axi_arsize         (s_axi_arsize),
    .s_axi_arburst        (s_axi_arburst),
    .s_axi_arlock         (s_axi_arlock),
    .s_axi_arcache        (s_axi_arcache),
    .s_axi_arprot         (s_axi_arprot),
    .s_axi_arqos          (s_axi_arqos),
    .s_axi_arregion       (s_axi_arregion),
    .s_axi_aruser         (s_axi_aruser),
    .s_axi_arvalid        (s_axi_arvalid),
    .s_axi_arready        (s_axi_arready),
    .s_axi_rid            (s_axi_rid),
    .s_axi_rdata          (s_axi_rdata),
    .s_axi_rresp          (s_axi_rresp),
    .s_axi_rlast          (s_axi_rlast),
    .s_axi_ruser          (s_axi_ruser),
    .s_axi_rvalid         (s_axi_rvalid),
    .s_axi_rready         (s_axi_rready),
    .fub_axi_arid         (fub_axi_arid),
    .fub_axi_araddr       (fub_axi_araddr),
    .fub_axi_arlen        (fub_axi_arlen),
    .fub_axi_arsize       (fub_axi_arsize),
    .fub_axi_arburst      (fub_axi_arburst),
    .fub_axi_arlock       (fub_axi_arlock),
    .fub_axi_arcache      (fub_axi_arcache),
    .fub_axi_arprot       (fub_axi_arprot),
    .fub_axi_arqos        (fub_axi_arqos),
    .fub_axi_arregion     (fub_axi_arregion),
    .fub_axi_aruser       (fub_axi_aruser),
    .fub_axi_arvalid      (fub_axi_arvalid),
    .fub_axi_arready      (fub_axi_arready),
    .fub_axi_rid          (fub_axi_rid),
    .fub_axi_rdata        (fub_axi_rdata),
    .fub_axi_rresp        (fub_axi_rresp),
    .fub_axi_rlast        (fub_axi_rlast),
    .fub_axi_ruser        (fub_axi_ruser),
    .fub_axi_rvalid       (fub_axi_rvalid),
    .fub_axi_rready       (fub_axi_rready),
    .busy                 (busy)
);
```

16.7 Design Notes

16.7.1 Buffer Depth Selection

`SKID_DEPTH_*` is an entry count, not a log2 exponent. The underlying `gaxi_skid_buffer` allocates one register slot per entry and tracks occupancy with a 4-bit counter, so legal values are 2..8 inclusive (any integer). Values greater than 8 overflow the occupancy counter and are not supported.

Read Address (SKID_DEPTH_AR): - Default: 2 (sufficient for most cases) - Increase if: - High-latency backend address processing - Frequent address channel backpressure - Multiple outstanding bursts needed

Read Data (SKID_DEPTH_R): - Default: 4 (deeper than AR for burst data) - Increase if: - Large burst sizes (ARLEN > 4) - High-bandwidth streaming reads - Variable backend read latency

16.7.2 Recommended Configurations

Low-Latency Memory (single outstanding read):

```
axi4_slave_rd #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AR(2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_R(2)
) u_slave_rd ( ... );
```

High-Throughput Streaming (burst reads):

```
axi4_slave_rd #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AR(4),
    .SKID_DEPTH_R(8)     // Deep for burst data
) u_slave_rd ( ... );
```

Variable Latency Backend:

```
axi4_slave_rd #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AR(8),
    .SKID_DEPTH_R(8)
) u_slave_rd ( ... );
```

16.7.3 Buffer Independence

The two skid buffers operate independently: - AR channel can accept new addresses while R channel returns data - Burst reads can pipeline - next burst starts before previous completes - Backend can have variable read latency without stalling interconnect

16.7.4 Packet Preservation

All signal groups packed and unpacked atomically: - AR channel: `{arid, araddr, arlen, arsize, arburst, arlock, arcache, arprot, arqos, arregion, aruser}` - R channel: `{rid, rdata, rresp, rlast, ruser}`

16.7.5 Backpressure Handling

Ready signals propagate backpressure: - Interconnect sees `arready` low when AR buffer full - Backend sees `rready` low when R buffer full - Prevents data loss while decoupling timing

16.7.6 ID and Burst Handling

This module is a pass-through buffer: - Does NOT track transaction IDs - Does NOT enforce burst ordering - Relies on backend to: - Match RID to ARID - Return correct number of beats (ARLEN+1) - Assert RLAST on final beat

16.7.7 Reset Behavior

On `aresetn` assertion (active-low): - All skid buffers flush - Valid signals deasserted - Busy signal goes low - No data retained across reset

---

16.8 Related Modules

16.8.1 Companion Modules

- **axi4_slave_wr** - AXI4 slave write with buffering
- **axi4_slave_rd_cg** - Clock-gated variant with additional CG logic
- **axi4_slave_rd_mon** - Read transaction monitor for verification

16.8.2 Used Components

- **gaxi_skid_buffer** - Elastic buffer with valid/ready handshake
- **clock_gate_ctrl** - Clock gating control (example)

16.8.3 Related Infrastructure

- **axi4_master_rd** - Corresponding AXI4 read master module
- **axi4_interconnect** - Multi-master/multi-slave crossbar

16.9 Testing

`val/amba/test_axi4_slave_rd.py` exercises this module. It collects 8 parameter cases at the default `REG_LEVEL`.

```
source env_python
pytest val/amba/test_axi4_slave_rd.py -v
```

16.10 References

16.10.1 Specifications

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.2.1 “Handshake process” and §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the per-channel VALID/READY contract each skid buffer preserves); §A1.2.3 “Register slices” and §A3.1.1 “Clock” (a register stage may sit in any channel for one cycle of latency, and an interface must have no combinational input-to-output path, which a slice breaks). §A5.2.1 “Read data ordering” (same-ID read data returns in order, so a FIFO per channel is enough). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.

16.10.2 Papers and textbooks

- Carloni, L.P., McMillan, K.L., Sangiovanni-Vincentelli, A.L. “Theory of Latency-Insensitive Design.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 20(9), Sept. 2001. DOI: 10.1109/43.945302 – relay stations: a channel can be pipelined by any number of back-pressured stages without changing its behavior, which is why a skid buffer per channel is transparent to both ends.
- Cortadella, J., Kishinevsky, M., Grundmann, B. “Synthesis of Synchronous Elastic Architectures.” *Proc. 43rd Design Automation Conference (DAC ’06)*, July 2006, pp. 657-662. DOI: 10.1145/1146909.1147077 – the elastic buffer with valid/stop back-pressure, the structure a skid buffer implements.
- Chipressian. *Crack the Hardware Interview: from RTL Designers’ Perspective*, Part 2 ch. 2 “Handshake Protocols” (forward and backward register slices) – textbook treatment of the valid/ready slice; the backward slice’s extra data register is the skid entry (secondary source).
- Maaref, M. *Architecting and Building High-Speed SoCs*, Packt, 2022, ch. 3 “Basic and Advanced On-Chip Busses and Interconnects” (“AXI bus protocol overview”) – textbook overview of the AXI channels, bursts and ID ordering (secondary source).
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF: `LatencyInsensitiveDesign__Carloni2001.pdf`, `ElasticBuffer__Cortadella2006.pdf`)

16.10.3 Source Code

- RTL: `rtl/amba/axi4/axi4_slave_rd.sv`

- Tests: `val/amba/test_axi4_slave_rd.py`
- Framework: `bin/TBClasses/components/axi4/`

16.10.4 Documentation

- Architecture: rtl-amba Overview
- AXI4 Index: axi4/README.md
- GAXI Buffers: gaxi/README.md

Last Updated: 2025-10-20

16.11 Navigation

- **← Back to AXI4 Index**
- **← Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **← Back to Main Documentation Index**

17 AXI4 Slave Read Interface (Clock-Gated)

Module: `axi4_slave_rd_cg.sv` **Base Module:** axi4_slave_rd **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/`
Status: Production Ready

17.1 Overview

This is the **clock-gated variant** of axi4_slave_rd — same elastic buffer, with activity-based clock gating wrapped around it for power.

For complete clock-gating documentation, usage examples, and configuration guidelines, see the **Clock-Gated Variants Guide**.

What the wrapper buys you:

- **Same Functionality:** 100% equivalent to base module
- **Power Savings:** traffic-dependent; unmeasured in this repo – treat any percentage as a placeholder until characterized
- **Configurable at runtime:** `cfg_cg_enable` / `cfg_cg_idle_count` inputs
- **Zero Overhead When Disabled:** `cfg_cg_enable=0` bypasses the gate

17.2 Parameters

In addition to all axi4_slave_rd parameters:

Parameter	Default	Description
`CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH`	4	Width of the idle countdown, sizing `cfg_cg_idle_count`
`SKID_DEPTH_AR`	2	Skid-buffer depth on the AR channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are legal.
`SKID_DEPTH_R`	4	Skid-buffer depth on the R channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are legal.

The gating controls are RUNTIME INPUTS, not parameters: `cfg_cg_enable` and `cfg_cg_idle_count`; status outputs `cg_gating` / `cg_idle`. One `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` gates the whole module – no per-domain gates. The base module's `busy` output is NOT re-exported (consumed internally as a wake term). (The ENABLE_CLOCK_GATING / CG_IDLE_CYCLES / CG_GATE_* interface this page once documented never existed.)

17.2.1 Derived Parameters (do not override)

These are declared as `parameter` so the elaborator can compute them, not so callers can set them. Each defaults to an expression over the parameters above; overriding one desynchronises it from its source and the design fails to elaborate or silently mis-sizes a bus. Set the parameters they are derived FROM and leave these alone.

Derived parameter	Default expression
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	AXI_DATA_WIDTH / 8
AW	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH
DW	AXI_DATA_WIDTH
IW	AXI_ID_WIDTH
SW	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH
UW	AXI_USER_WIDTH
ARSize	IW+AW+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+UW
RSize	IW+DW+2+1+UW

17.3 Ports

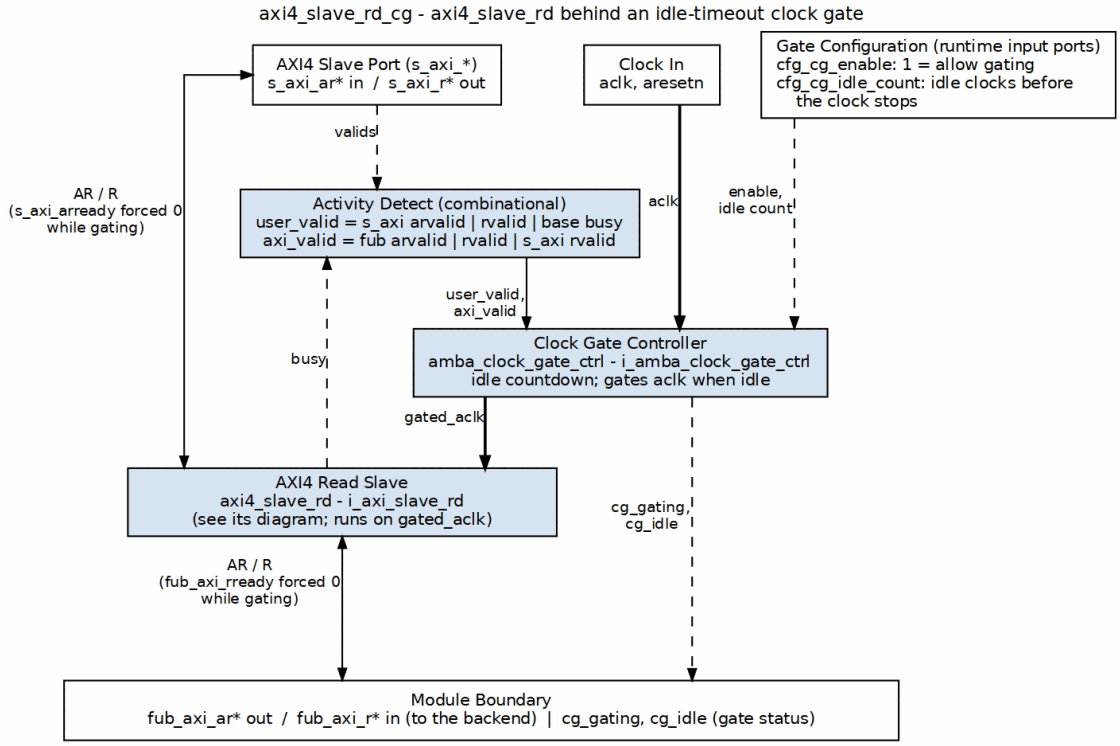
Port	Dir	Width	Description
aclk	In	1	
aresetn	In	1	
cfg_cg_enable	In	1	
cfg_cg_idle_count	In	[CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH-1:0]	
s_axi_arid	In	[IW-1:0]	
s_axi_araddr	In	[AW-1:0]	
s_axi_arlen	In	[7:0]	
s_axi_arsize	In	[2:0]	
s_axi_arburst	In	[1:0]	
s_axi_arlock	In	1	

Port	Dir	Width	Description
s_axi_arcache	In	[3:0]	
s_axi_arprot	In	[2:0]	
s_axi_arqos	In	[3:0]	
s_axi_arregion	In	[3:0]	
s_axi_aruser	In	[UW-1:0]	
s_axi_arvalid	In	1	
s_axi_arready	Out	1	
s_axi_rid	Out	[IW-1:0]	
s_axi_rdata	Out	[DW-1:0]	
s_axi_rresp	Out	[1:0]	
s_axi_rlast	Out	1	
s_axi_ruser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
s_axi_rvalid	Out	1	
s_axi_rready	In	1	
fub_axi_arid	Out	[IW-1:0]	
fub_axi_araddr	Out	[AW-1:0]	
fub_axi_arlen	Out	[7:0]	
fub_axi_arsize	Out	[2:0]	
fub_axi_arburst	Out	[1:0]	
fub_axi_arlock	Out	1	
fub_axi_arcache	Out	[3:0]	
fub_axi_arprot	Out	[2:0]	
fub_axi_arqos	Out	[3:0]	
fub_axi_arregion	Out	[3:0]	
fub_axi_aruser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_arval	Out	1	

Port	Dir	Width	Description
id			
fub_axi_arready	In	1	
fub_axi_rid	In	[IW-1:0]	
fub_axi_rdata	In	[DW-1:0]	
fub_axi_rresp	In	[1:0]	
fub_axi_rlast	In	1	
fub_axi_ruser	In	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_rvalid	In	1	
fub_axi_rready	Out	1	
cg_gating	Out	1	
cg_idle	Out	1	

17.4 Functional Description

17.4.1 Block diagram



axi4_slave_rd_cg block diagram

The base `axi4_slave_rd` is one child box (see its own diagram), clocked by `gated_aclk`. The clock is the heavy center column: `aclk` enters `amba_clock_gate_ctrl`, which stops it after `cfg_cg_idle_count` idle clocks. Activity Detect ORs this side's valids with the base's `busy` (`user_valid`) and the far side's valids (`axi_valid`) to wake the clock. While gating, the outward ready signals are forced to 0, so no handshake is lost; `cg_gating` and `cg_idle` report the gate's state.

This wrapper is the base module plus one `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` instance. The datapath is untouched – every channel signal is forwarded verbatim – so functional behaviour is identical to the base module and the wrapper adds no latency of its own.

What it adds is a gated clock. `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` watches two activity terms, `user_valid` (this side's valids plus the base module's `busy`) and `axi_valid` (the far side's valids), registers their OR into `r_wakeup`, and stops the inner module's clock once both have been quiet for `cfg_cg_idle_count` cycles. The clock restarts on the next activity, one cycle later.

While the clock is stopped the wrapper masks its outward-facing READY signals with `! cg_gating`, so a peer sees no acceptance until the clock runs again and no handshake is lost across the wake boundary.

`cfg_cg_enable` arms this behaviour; with it low the clock free-runs and the module is indistinguishable from its base.

17.5 Timing Characteristics

Skid parameter	Default depth
`SKID_DEPTH_AR`	2 entries
`SKID_DEPTH_R`	4 entries

Each channel traverses one `gaxi_skid_buffer`, which registers both `rd_valid` and its storage. The **1-cycle input-to-output latency therefore applies on every transfer, including the unstalled case** – there is no combinational bypass. Depth buys backpressure absorption, not throughput; full rate is sustained once the pipeline is primed. Legal range is 2..8 inclusive, odd values included.

Clocking: `aclk`, reset `aresetn` (active-low asynchronous).

No synthesis numbers are quoted here. Frequency and area depend on the target device and the parameters you elaborate with; run your own build.

17.6 Usage Examples

```
axi4_slave_rd_cg #(
    // Base module parameters (see axi4_slave_rd.md)
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH(8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH(64),

    .CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH(4)
) u_cg (
    .aclk(clk),
    .aresetn(rst_n),
    .cfg_cg_enable(1'b1),
    .cfg_cg_idle_count(4'd8),
    .cg_gating(), .cg_idle(),
    // ... all other ports same as axi4_slave_rd (except busy)
);
```

17.7 Design Notes

A peer's READY must never enter the activity term. A consumer that parks its response-ready high while idle is behaving correctly; folding that signal into `user_valid` pins this block permanently awake and defeats gating entirely – silently, because function is unaffected. Ten wrappers in this repository shipped that way and nothing failed until someone measured. `val/amba/test_cg_peer_ready.py` parks the peer READY high, holds every VALID low, and requires `cg_gating`. Canonical rule: `vault/handbook/design/clock-gating-activity-terms.md`.

`cfg_cg_enable` is not a kill switch. It arms gating and reaches `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` only; the datapath and any monitor enables are forwarded untouched. With it low the clock free-runs and this module behaves exactly like its base.

Gating latency. The clock stops `cfg_cg_idle_count` + 2 cycles after the last bus activity – the idle counter, plus one for the `r_wakeup` flop. Size the idle count against your traffic's inter-burst gap: too small and the block wakes constantly, too large and it never gates.

Cost. Five flops: `r_wakeup` plus `r_idle_counter` at `IDLE_CNTR_WIDTH`, scaling as 1 + `CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH`. The ICG itself is a latch or BUFGCE, not fabric flops.

17.8 Related Modules

- **Base Module Functionality:** axi4_slave_rd.md
- **Clock Gating Guide:** clock_gated_variants.md
- **Detailed CG Examples:**
  - axi4_master_rd_mon_cg.md (AXI4 monitor)
  - axil4_master_rd_mon_cg.md (AXIL4 monitor)
  - apb4_slave_cg.md (APB interface)

17.9 Testing

`val/amba/test_axi4_slave_rd_cg.py` exercises this module. It collects 1 parameter cases at the default `REG_LEVEL`.

```
source env_python
pytest val/amba/test_axi4_slave_rd_cg.py -v
```

17.10 References

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.2.1 “Handshake process” and §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the per-channel VALID/READY contract each skid buffer preserves); §A1.2.3 “Register slices” and §A3.1.1 “Clock” (a register stage may sit in any channel for one cycle of latency, and an interface must have no combinational input-to-output path, which a slice breaks). §A5.2.1 “Read data ordering” (same-ID read data returns in order, so a FIFO per channel is enough). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.
- Benini, L., De Micheli, G. “Automatic Synthesis of Low-Power Gated-Clock Finite-State Machines.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 15(6), June 1996. DOI: 10.1109/43.503933 – the latch-based clock-gating cell (`icg`, via `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` and `clock_gate_ctrl`) that gates this wrapper’s clock.
- Benini, L., Bogliolo, A., De Micheli, G. “A Survey of Design Techniques for System-Level Dynamic Power Management.” *IEEE Trans. VLSI Systems*, 8(3), June 2000. DOI: 10.1109/92.845896 – fixed-timeout shutdown: gate after `cfg_cg_idle_count` idle cycles, wake on activity.
- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – AXI4 has no wake-up signal. AXI5 adds AWAKEUP (Issue H §E1.7 “Wake-up Signaling”; Issue L §A14.1.1), which lets a manager restart a gated interface before VALID. This wrapper wakes on the flopped OR of the VALIDs and holds READY low while gated.
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF, archived under `rtl/common/references/`: `LatchBasedClockGating__Benini1996.pdf`, `DynamicPowerManagementTimeout__Benini2000.pdf`)

17.11 Navigation

- **← Back to AXI4 Index**
- **← Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **← Back to Main Documentation Index**

18 AXI4 Slave Read Monitor

Module: `axi4_slave_rd_mon.sv` **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/` (protocol monitors live with their protocol; only the monitor CORE pieces are in `rtl/amba/ocelus/`) **Status:** Production Ready

---

18.1 Overview

The slave-side counterpart to the master monitors. The AXI4 Slave Read Monitor combines a working `axi4_slave_rd` with an `axi_monitor_filtered`, watching read transactions as they pass from the interconnect through to your backend and back. You get real-time protocol checking, error detection, performance metrics, and configurable packet filtering — from the slave's point of view, which is usually the angle that catches backend problems first.

18.1.1 Key Features

- **Integrated Monitoring:** Combines `axi4_slave_rd` with `axi_monitor_filtered`
- **2-Level Filtering:** packet-type drop masks + per-event masks (err_select is reserved – no routing)
- **Error Detection:** SLVERR, DECERR, orphaned read data, timeouts (protocol-violation events are write-monitor only – see Error Detection Events)
- **Timeout Monitoring:** Configurable timeout detection for stuck transactions
- **Performance Metrics:** Latency tracking, transaction counting, throughput analysis
- **Monitor Bus Output:** 128-bit packets paired with 64-bit side-band timestamps
- **Configuration Validation:** Detects conflicting configuration settings
- **Clock Gating Support:** Busy signal for power management

18.2 Parameters

A lite-monitor version of this wrapper exists as `axi4_slave_rd_monlite`: the same core and taps with `axi_monitor_lite` instead of `axi_monitor_filtered`, about a fifth of the monitor gates, error/timeout/completion/threshold packets only. Selected in generated bridges by `mon_preset = "lite"`.

18.2.1 AXI4 Slave Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
SKID_DEPTH_AR	int	2	AR channel skid buffer depth
SKID_DEPTH_R	int	4	R channel skid buffer depth
AXI_ID_WIDTH	int	8	Transaction ID width
AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	int	32	Address bus width
AXI_DATA_WIDTH	int	32	Data bus width
AXI_USER_WIDTH	int	1	User signal width

18.2.2 Monitor Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
UNIT_ID	logic [7:0]	8'h02	8-bit unit identifier in monitor packets
AGENT_ID	logic [15:0]	16'h0014	16-bit agent identifier in monitor packets
MAX_TRANSACTIONS	int	16	Maximum concurrent outstanding transactions
USE_WDATA_ORDER_Q	bit	0	Write-data ordering queue
NUM_BANKS	int	1	Banked transaction tables. **>1 on a WRITE monitor requires `USE_WDATA_ORDER_Q=1`** – `axi_monitor_trans_mgr` fails elaboration otherwise
ID_FILTER_ENABLE	bit	0	Synthesises the per-instance ID-slice filter

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
ID_MATCH_BASE	int	0	First ID this instance owns
ID_MATCH_COUNT	int	0	How many; `0` means ALL, so a zeroed register block does not silently filter everything away
`ACLK_MHZ`	int	100	Clock frequency in MHz – keeps the 1 us tick exact off-100MHz
`CFI_MIN_FREQ_MHZ` / `CFI_MAX_FREQ_MHZ`	int	= ACLK_MHZ	Freq-invariant counter LUT bounds (`cfg_freq_sel` indexes within them)
`ACTIVE_TRANS_THRESHOLD`	int	MAX_TRANSACTIONS/2	Active-transaction count that trips a threshold packet when `cfg_threshold_enable=1`. Replaces the former hardwired 8/4; threshold packets now scale with the table sizing
`ENABLE_FILTERING`	bit	1	Enable packet filtering: two active drop levels (packet type, then event code). Level 2 is reserved and routes nothing
`ADD_PIPELINE_STAGE`	bit	0	Add register stage for timing closure
`USE_MONITOR`	bit	1	Synthesis-time monitor enable. 0 = omit monitor and tie outputs to safe non-blocking defaults; 1 = full monitor functionality.
`N_ADDR_RANGES`	int	0	Number of address-

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
			range comparators. 0 = checker omitted (zero area). >0 = N independent [low, high] ranges; feeds the shared allowlist checker: a debug-range hit -> AddrMatch, an error-allowlist miss -> Error/ADDR_RANGE (see axi_monitor_addr_check.md).
ADDR_RANGE_IS_ERROR	logic [N_ADDR_RANGES-1:0]	'0	Per-range flavor: bit i = 0 -> DEBUG range (hit -> AddrMatch), 1 -> ERROR range (allowlist miss -> Error/ADDR_RANGE). Default all-0 (feature inert).

18.2.3 Synthesis-Cone Parameters

Each detection cone can be compiled out to save area. The classic cones default on; the debug cone defaults off. Setting a bit to 0 drops the corresponding cone at synthesis via a `generate`-if inside `axi_monitor_reporter` — the area saving is real.

Parameter	Type	Default	Effect when 0
ENABLE_ERROR_LOGIC	bit	1	Drop the error-detection cone
ENABLE_TIMEOUT_LOGIC	bit	1	Drop the timeout cone **and** the `axi_monitor_timeout` instance
ENABLE_COMPL_LOGIC	bit	1	Drop the completion cone
ENABLE_THRESHOLD_LOGIC	bit	1	Drop the threshold cone
ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC	bit	1	Gates only the reporter's legacy perf-packet cone and

Parameter	Type	Default	Effect when 0
			the two lifetime counters – the window FSM and meters are unconditional
ENABLE_DEBUG_LOGIC	bit	0	Drop the debug (trace) cone — the 6th reporter sub-block (off by default)

Internally the wrapper hardwires two master switches on its `axi_monitor_filtered` instance: `ENABLE_PERF_PACKETS = 1` (the reporter's legacy perf cone is built; `ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC` gates THAT cone only, never the measurement window) and `ENABLE_DEBUG_MODULE = 0` (debug tracking module omitted). These are not top-level parameters of the wrapper.

The transaction CAM is always pipelined.

18.2.4 Derived Parameters (do not override)

These are declared as `parameter` so the elaborator can compute them, not so callers can set them. Each defaults to an expression over the parameters above; overriding one desynchronises it from its source and the design fails to elaborate or silently mis-sizes a bus. Set the parameters they are derived FROM and leave these alone.

Derived parameter	Default expression
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	AXI_DATA_WIDTH / 8
AW	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH
DW	AXI_DATA_WIDTH
IW	AXI_ID_WIDTH
SW	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH
UW	AXI_USER_WIDTH

18.3 Ports

18.3.1 AXI4 Read Channels

Slave Interface (s_axi_*): - AR channel: `arid, araddr, arlen, arsize, arburst, arlock, arcache, arprot, arqos, arregion, aruser, arvalid, arready` - R channel: `rid, rdata, rresp, rlast, ruser, rvalid, rready`

Backend Interface (fub_axi_*): - Same signals as slave, mirrored direction (to memory/backend)

18.3.2 Monitor Configuration

Configuration ports are identical to other AXI4 monitors: - Basic enables: `cfg_monitor_enable` (master runtime gate: 0 = monitor inert, CAM held clear, never stalls the datapath), `cfg_error_enable`, `cfg_timeout_enable`, `cfg_perf_enable`, `cfg_compl_enable` (completion packets), `cfg_threshold_enable` (threshold-crossed packets), `cfg_debug_enable` (debug/trace cone — the 6th reporter sub-block) - Clear: `cam_clear` (Input, 1) - synchronous clear of the monitor transaction CAM (driven from the harness clear control bit, e.g. CTRL[4]) - Thresholds: `cfg_timeout_cycles` (unified coarse timeout, a MICROSECOND count at full 16-bit width: 1..65535 us per phase, 0 = 16'hFFFF ~ effectively never; drives all three phase counts), `cfg_latency_threshold` - Filtering: 8 mask signals (`cfg_axi_*_mask`: pkt, error, timeout, compl, thresh, perf, addr, debug) plus `cfg_axi_err_select` - Performance window control: `cfg_start_event_sel`, `cfg_end_event_sel`, `cfg_start_trigger`, `cfg_end_trigger`, `cfg_window_force_close` (see Performance Monitoring)

> The inner monitor's `cfg_debug_level` (tied to 0), `cfg_debug_mask` (0) are fixed inside the wrapper; `cfg_active_trans_threshold` is driven by the `ACTIVE_TRANS_THRESHOLD` parameter (default MAX_TRANSACTIONS/2), not hardwired to 8, and all three are **not** top-level ports on this module.

18.3.3 Monitor Bus Output

Port	Direction	Width	Description
`monbus_valid`	Output	1	Monitor packet valid
`monbus_ready`	Input	1	Downstream ready to accept packet
`monbus_packet`	Output	128	`monitor_packet_t` (see format below)
`monbus_timestamp`	Output	64	`monbus_timestamp_t` paired atomically with `monbus_packet`
debug_block_ready	Output	1	Observability tap for the block_ready gating net (drives nothing internally; leave unconnected if unused)
`i_mon_time`	Input	64	Free-running counter from `monbus_group_core`, sampled at packet emission

18.3.4 Status Outputs

Port	Direction	Width	Description
busy	Output	1	Indicates active transactions (for clock gating)
active_transactions	Output	8	Current number of outstanding transactions
error_count	Output	16	Lifetime count of error+timeout packets actually emitted (reporter perf counter; reads 0 when ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC=0 or USE_MONITOR=0)
transaction_count	Output	32	Lifetime count of completion packets actually emitted (zero-extended 16-bit reporter perf counter; reads 0 when ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC=0 or USE_MONITOR=0)
cfg_conflict_error	Output	1	Configuration conflict detected

18.3.5 Packet filters

Two independent runtime filters cut monbus traffic without touching the datapath. Both are inert until driven, which is the failure to watch for: the build-time parameter only decides whether the logic is SYNTHESISED, and a design that sets the parameter but leaves the cfg_* ports tied low filters nothing and looks like the feature is broken.

Address-range filter — ADDR_FILTER_ENABLE (bit, default 0) builds it.

Port	Width	Description
cfg_addr_filter_enable	1	High: suppress packets for transactions outside

Port	Width	Description
		the window. Low: inert, whatever the parameter says
cfg_addr_filter_low	ADDR_WIDTH	Window base, inclusive
cfg_addr_filter_high	ADDR_WIDTH	Window limit, inclusive

The verdict is latched per table entry at ALLOCATION, from the command address, and held for that entry's life. Widening the window mid-flight does not un-filter entries already admitted — which is exactly what makes it safe to reprogram live, since an entry's fate is decided when it is admitted and the retire accounting cannot be corrupted afterwards. Contrast the address-range CHECKER (N_ADDR_RANGES), which re-evaluates per command.

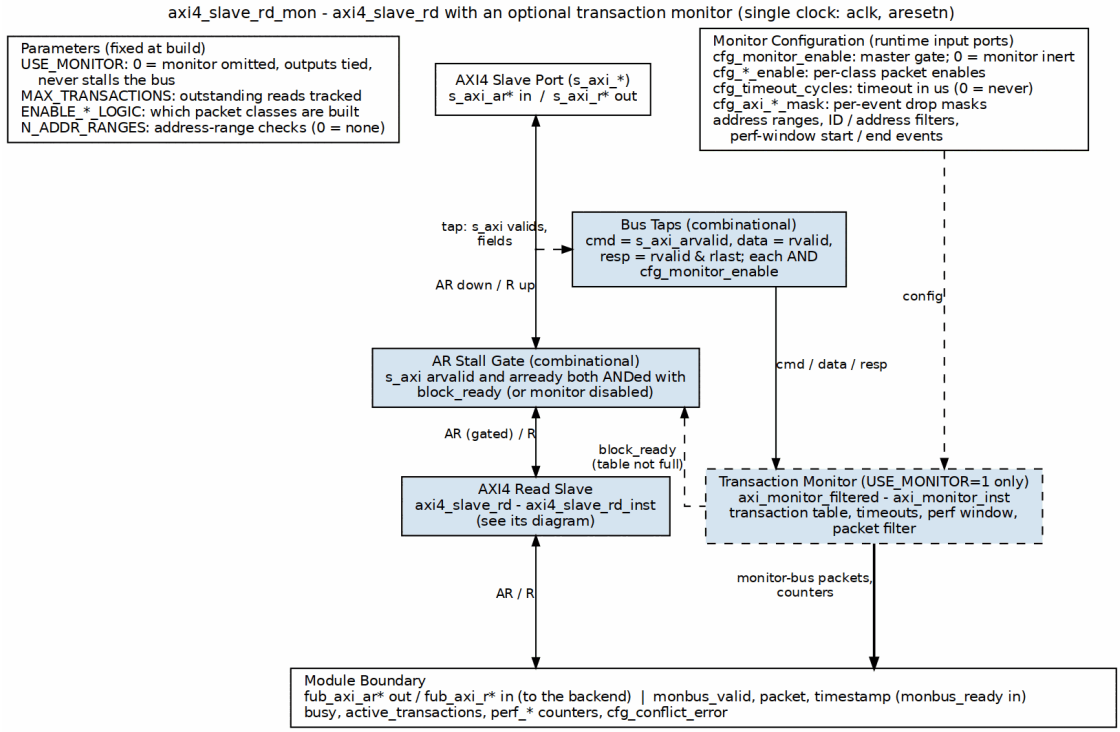
Runtime ID filter — overrides the ID_MATCH_BASE/ID_MATCH_COUNT elaboration constants so an instance can be retargeted at a different master without a rebuild.

Port	Width	Description
cfg_id_filter_enable	1	High: use the window below. Low: use the parameters, bit-identical to a build without this feature
cfg_id_match_base	ID_WIDTH	First ID owned
cfg_id_match_count	ID_WIDTH+1	How many; 0 means ALL, matching the parameter rule so a zeroed register block does not silently filter everything away

The window is half-open: [base, base + count).

18.4 Functional Description

18.4.1 Block diagram



axi4_slave_rd_mon block diagram

AXI traffic runs down the left column: through the AR stall gate, into the base `axi4_slave_rd` (one child box, see its own diagram), and out through the bar. The monitor taps the s_axi side, above the stall gate, gates each valid with `cfg_monitor_enable`, and `axi_monitor_filtered` turns the transactions into monitor-bus packets (the heavy edge). When its transaction table is full, `block_ready` drops and the stall gate holds both arvalid and arready low, so a full table stalls the bus instead of losing events. With `USE_MONITOR=0` the monitor is omitted, its outputs are tied off, and the gate never stalls.

The module instantiates two sub-modules: 1. **axi4_slave_rd** - Core AXI4 slave read functionality with buffering 2. **axi_monitor_filtered** - Transaction monitoring with 2-Level Filtering: packet-type drop masks + per-event masks (err_select is reserved – no routing)

18.4.2 Monitor Backpressure (block_ready)

`block_ready` is exported as the `debug_block_ready` output port – the wrapper deliberately makes the gating contract observable (the `_mon_cg` wrapper ties it off rather than forwarding it). It goes low when the monitor's transaction-table occupancy reaches its blocking threshold (a function of `MAX_TRANSACTIONS`; the reporter FIFO depth `INTR_FIFO_DEPTH` has no path to it). The wrapper ANDs it into the upstream-facing `s_axi_arready` so a saturated monitor throttles new transactions at the handshake instead of dropping events.

- **Where the stall lands**: the upstream `s_axi_aready` is forced low until the monitor drains.
- **When `USE_MONITOR=0`**: `block_ready` is internally tied high, so the wrapper imposes no stall and runs at full bandwidth.
- **When `cfg_monitor_enable=0`**: the wrapper gate forces the upstream ready open, so a runtime-disabled monitor can never stall the datapath (in-RTL formal property `ap_disabled_never_stalls`).

Recovery is guaranteed by the **saturation-recovery contract**: command-originated table entries are capped at `MAX_TRANSACTIONS - cmd_entry_reserve(MAX_TRANSACTIONS)` (reserve = 4 for tables of 16 or more, 0 below; the function lives in `monitor_common_pkg`), and `block_ready` re-asserts at occupancy `< MAX_TRANSACTIONS - (reserve - 1)` – a threshold strictly ABOVE the command cap – so a saturated table always drains back below the reopen point. Blocking throttles; it never deadlocks. Tables smaller than 16 keep full legacy allocation (small tables cannot spare slots) and trade the recovery guarantee for tracking capacity. The contract is verified by in-RTL formal properties (mutation-checked) and a 100-seed deliberately-undersized-table stream sweep; see axi_monitor_base for the canonical description.

Sizing note: a monitor on a bus shared by several channels/requesters must size `MAX_TRANSACTIONS` to cover `NUM_CHANNELS x per-channel outstanding` plus margin – the per-channel limit alone makes the monitor throttle the shared master. Tables deeper than 64 also need Verilator's `--unroll-count` raised (default 64) in sim builds.

18.4.3 Address-Range Checker

With `N_ADDR_RANGES > 0` the wrapper instantiates the shared allowlist checker (`axi_monitor_addr_check`). Each range carries a DEBUG/ERROR flavor:

- **DEBUG range** — a hit emits a `PktTypeAddrMatch` (`4'h8`) packet with event code `AXI_ADDR_RANGE_MATCH` (`8'h01`), gated by `cfg_debug_enable`.
- **ERROR range** — the enabled ERROR ranges form an allowlist; an address in NONE of them emits a `PktTypeError` (`4'h0`) packet with event code `AXI_ERR_ADDR_RANGE` (`8'h0D`), gated by `cfg_error_enable`.

This wrapper exposes **`ADDR_RANGE_IS_ERROR`** (per-range) as a parameter, so ranges can be assigned to either flavor.

Config inputs (active only when `N_ADDR_RANGES > 0`): - `cfg_addr_check_enable` — master on/off for the checker. - `cfg_addr_range_enable[N-1:0]` — per-range enable bit. - `cfg_addr_range_low/high[N-1:0][AXI_ADDR_WIDTH-1:0]` — inclusive bounds.

Event encoding: `event_data[63:60]` = `range_index` (matching DEBUG range, or `4'hF` sentinel on an ERROR miss); `event_data[59:0]` = full address. **Filtering:** AddrMatch is dropped by `cfg_axi_addr_mask[1]`, the ADDR_RANGE error by `cfg_axi_error_mask[13]`. See the checker page for coalescing + formal properties.

18.4.4 Performance Monitoring

The wrapper hardwires `ENABLE_PERF_PACKETS = 1` on its inner `axi_monitor_filtered`. The **measurement-window state machine** and its counters are unconditional `always_ff` blocks in `axi_monitor_base` – outside every generate – so they are present and running in EVERY build, including `ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC = 0`. That parameter reaches one consumer: the `g_perf` generate in `axi_monitor_reporter` holding the legacy perf-packet cone and the two 16-bit lifetime counters behind `perf_completed_count` / `perf_error_count`. Setting it to 0 saves that cone and nothing else. `USE_MONITOR = 0` is what ties the perfmon outputs off. The wrapper instantiates plus a bank of R-data-channel utilization counters. All counters accumulate **only while a window is open** (`window_active = 1`) and hold their values between windows, so the host can read a completed window's totals.

18.4.4.1 The Measurement Window

A window is opened by a **start event** and closed by an **end event**. The event sources are selected by `cfg_start_event_sel` / `cfg_end_event_sel` (3-bit; e.g. `3'b010` selects the `cfg_perf_enable` edge) and can also be fired directly by the `cfg_start_trigger` / `cfg_end_trigger` pulses (from an engine or CSR). `cfg_window_force_close` is a software override that closes the window immediately. While the window is open:

- `window_active` is high.
- `window_cycles[31:0]` free-runs, counting every clock elapsed inside the window.

Sample the counters on the cycle `window_active` falls to 0 (drive `cfg_end_trigger`, or wait for the configured end event).

18.4.4.2 Utilization Counters (R Data Channel)

Every cycle inside the window is classified by the R channel's `rvalid` / `rready` into exactly one of four buckets:

Output	Width	Condition	Meaning
`perf_prod_cycles`	32	rvalid && rready	productive beat transferred
`perf_bp_cycles`	32	rvalid && !rready	back-pressure (data offered, sink not ready)
`perf_starv_cycles`	32	!rvalid && rready	starvation (sink ready, no data)
`perf_idle_cycles`	32	!rvalid && !rready	idle

The four buckets sum to `window_cycles - 1` (the start cycle seeds window_cycles to 1 while the buckets reset to 0); the one-count skew is negligible for long windows.

18.4.4.3 Throughput Counters

Output	Width	Meaning
`perf_beat_count`	32	R data beats transferred (= `perf_prod_cycles`, 1 beat/cycle)
`perf_byte_count`	64	bytes transferred = beats × (1 << ARSIZE), using the ARSIZE captured at the most recent AR address phase (upper bound: counts full-width beats; an unaligned start address means the first beat carries fewer useful bytes)
`perf_burst_count`	32	AR address-phase handshakes

The integrator computes average burst length as `perf_beat_count / perf_burst_count`.

18.4.4.4 Performance Monitoring Ports

Port	Direction	Width	Description
`cfg_perf_enable`	Input	1	Enable performance-metric packet generation
`cfg_start_event_sel`	Input	3	Window **start** event source select
`cfg_end_event_sel`	Input	3	Window **end** event source select
`cfg_start_trigger`	Input	1	Pulse: open the measurement window
`cfg_end_trigger`	Input	1	Pulse: close the measurement window
`cfg_window_force_close`	Input	1	Software override: force the window closed

Port	Direction	Width	Description
window_active	Output	1	High while a measurement window is open
window_cycles	Output	32	Cycles elapsed in the current window
perf_prod_cycles	Output	32	rvalid && rready cycles
perf_bp_cycles	Output	32	rvalid && !rready cycles (back-pressure)
perf_starv_cycles	Output	32	!rvalid && rready cycles (starvation)
perf_idle_cycles	Output	32	!rvalid && !rready cycles
perf_beat_count	Output	32	R data beats transferred
perf_byte_count	Output	64	bytes transferred
perf_burst_count	Output	32	AR address-phase handshakes

When `USE_MONITOR = 0`, every perfmon output is tied to 0 and the window never opens.

18.4.5 Monitor Packet Format

Identical 128-bit format (with 64-bit side-band timestamp) as other AXI4 monitors. See axi4_master_rd_mon for complete specification.

18.5 Timing Characteristics

Skid parameter	Default depth
SKID_DEPTH_AR	2 entries
SKID_DEPTH_R	4 entries

Each channel traverses one `gaxi_skid_buffer`, which registers both `rd_valid` and its storage. The **1-cycle input-to-output latency therefore applies on every transfer, including the unstalled case** – there is no combinational bypass. Depth buys backpressure absorption, not throughput; full rate is sustained once the pipeline is primed. Legal range is 2..8 inclusive, odd values included.

Clocking: `aclk`, reset `aresetn` (active-low asynchronous).

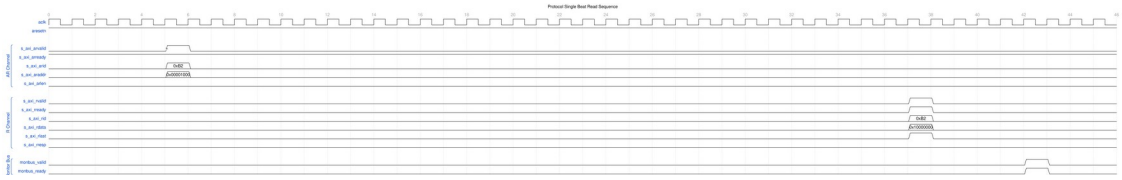
No synthesis numbers are quoted here. Frequency and area depend on the target device and the parameters you elaborate with; run your own build.

18.6 Waveforms

The following waveforms show AXI4 slave read monitor behavior from the slave perspective:

18.6.1 Scenario 1: Single-Beat Read (Slave View)

AXI4 read transaction from slave interface perspective:



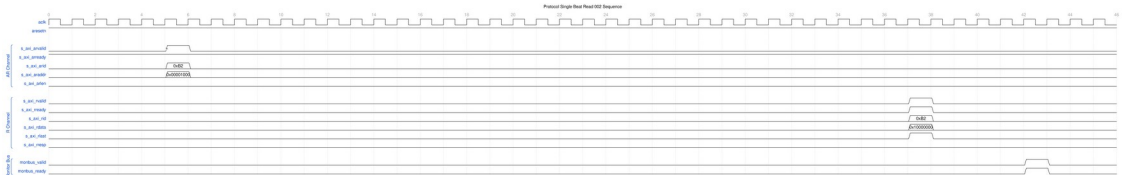
Single Beat Read Slave

WaveJSON: single_beat_read_001.json

Key Observations: - Slave-side AR channel (s_axi_ar*) - Slave-side R channel response (s_axi_r*) - Monitor packet generation from slave perspective - Slave RRESP status monitoring - Transaction tracking in slave context

18.6.2 Scenario 2: Alternative Single-Beat Read (Slave View)

Variant read transaction with different timing from slave:



Single Beat Read Slave Alt

WaveJSON: single_beat_read_002_001.json

Key Observations: - Slave ready signal behavior - ARREADY backpressure effects - RVALID generation timing - Slave latency monitoring - Error detection from slave side

---

18.7 Usage Examples

Every parameter and port below is read from the module declaration.

```
axi4_slave_rd_mon #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AR         (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_R          (4),
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH          (8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH        (32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH        (32),
    .AXI_USER_WIDTH        (1),
    .ACLK_MHZ              (100),
    .USE_MONITOR           (1'b1),
    .N_ADDR_RANGES         (0),
    .ADDR_RANGE_IS_ERROR   ('0)
) u_axi4_slave_rd_mon (
    .aclk                  (aclk),
    .aresetn               (aresetn),
    .cam_clear             (cam_clear),
    .s_axi_arid            (s_axi_arid),
    .s_axi_araddr          (s_axi_araddr),
    .s_axi_arlen           (s_axi_arlen),
    .s_axi_arsize          (s_axi_arsize),
    .s_axi_arburst         (s_axi_arburst),
    .s_axi_arlock          (s_axi_arlock),
    .s_axi_arcache         (s_axi_arcache),
    .s_axi_arprot          (s_axi_arprot),
    .s_axi_arqos           (s_axi_arqos),
    .s_axi_arregion        (s_axi_arregion),
    .s_axi_aruser          (s_axi_aruser),
    .s_axi_arvalid         (s_axi_arvalid),
    .s_axi_arready         (s_axi_arready),
    .s_axi_rid             (s_axi_rid),
    .s_axi_rdata           (s_axi_rdata),
    .s_axi_rresp           (s_axi_rresp),
    .s_axi_rlast           (s_axi_rlast),
    .s_axi_ruser           (s_axi_ruser),
    .s_axi_rvalid          (s_axi_rvalid),
    .s_axi_rready          (s_axi_rready),
    .fub_axi_arid          (fub_axi_arid),
    .fub_axi_araddr        (fub_axi_araddr),
    .fub_axi_arlen         (fub_axi_arlen),
    .fub_axi_arsize        (fub_axi_arsize),
    .fub_axi_arburst       (fub_axi_arburst),
    .fub_axi_arlock        (fub_axi_arlock),
    .fub_axi_arcache       (fub_axi_arcache),
    .fub_axi_arprot        (fub_axi_arprot),
    .fub_axi_arqos         (fub_axi_arqos),
```

```
    .fub_axi_arregion      (fub_axi_arregion),
    .fub_axi_aruser        (fub_axi_aruser),
    .fub_axi_arvalid       (fub_axi_arvalid),
    .fub_axi_arready       (fub_axi_arready),
    .fub_axi_rid           (fub_axi_rid),
    .fub_axi_rdata         (fub_axi_rdata),
    .fub_axi_rresp         (fub_axi_rresp),
    .fub_axi_rlast         (fub_axi_rlast),
    .fub_axi_ruser         (fub_axi_ruser),
    .fub_axi_rvalid        (fub_axi_rvalid),
    .fub_axi_rready        (fub_axi_rready),
    .cfg_monitor_enable    (cfg_monitor_enable),
    .cfg_error_enable      (cfg_error_enable),
    .cfg_timeout_enable    (cfg_timeout_enable),
    .cfg_perf_enable       (cfg_perf_enable),
    .cfg_compl_enable      (cfg_compl_enable),
    .cfg_threshold_enable  (cfg_threshold_enable),
    .cfg_debug_enable      (cfg_debug_enable),
    .cfg_timeout_cycles    (cfg_timeout_cycles),
    .cfg_freq_sel          (cfg_freq_sel),
    .cfg_latency_threshold (cfg_latency_threshold),
    .cfg_axi_pkt_mask      (cfg_axi_pkt_mask),
    .cfg_axi_err_select    (cfg_axi_err_select),
    .cfg_axi_error_mask    (cfg_axi_error_mask),
    .cfg_axi_timeout_mask  (cfg_axi_timeout_mask),
    .cfg_axi_compl_mask    (cfg_axi_compl_mask),
    .cfg_axi_thresh_mask   (cfg_axi_thresh_mask),
    .cfg_axi_perf_mask     (cfg_axi_perf_mask),
    .cfg_axi_addr_mask     (cfg_axi_addr_mask),
    .cfg_axi_debug_mask    (cfg_axi_debug_mask),
    .cfg_addr_check_enable (cfg_addr_check_enable),
    .cfg_addr_range_enable (cfg_addr_range_enable),
    .cfg_addr_range_low    (cfg_addr_range_low),
    .cfg_addr_range_high   (cfg_addr_range_high),
    .cfg_id_filter_enable  (cfg_id_filter_enable),
    .cfg_id_match_base     (cfg_id_match_base),
    .cfg_id_match_count    (cfg_id_match_count),
    .cfg_addr_filter_enable(cfg_addr_filter_enable),
    .cfg_addr_filter_low   (cfg_addr_filter_low),
    .cfg_addr_filter_high  (cfg_addr_filter_high),
    .cfg_start_event_sel   (cfg_start_event_sel),
    .cfg_end_event_sel     (cfg_end_event_sel),
    .cfg_start_trigger     (cfg_start_trigger),
    .cfg_end_trigger       (cfg_end_trigger),
    .cfg_window_force_close(cfg_window_force_close),
    .i_mon_time            (i_mon_time),
    .monbus_valid          (monbus_valid),
    .monbus_ready          (monbus_ready),
```

```
    .monbus_packet          (monbus_packet),
    .monbus_timestamp       (monbus_timestamp),
    .busy                   (busy),
    .active_transactions    (active_transactions),
    .error_count            (error_count),
    .transaction_count      (transaction_count),
    .debug_block_ready      (debug_block_ready),
    .window_active          (window_active),
    .window_cycles          (window_cycles),
    .perf_prod_cycles       (perf_prod_cycles),
    .perf_bp_cycles         (perf_bp_cycles),
    .perf_starv_cycles      (perf_starv_cycles),
    .perf_idle_cycles       (perf_idle_cycles),
    .perf_beat_count        (perf_beat_count),
    .perf_byte_count        (perf_byte_count),
    .perf_burst_count       (perf_burst_count),
    .cfg_conflict_error     (cfg_conflict_error)
);
```

18.8 Design Notes

18.8.1 Slave-Side Monitoring

Key Differences from Master Monitors: - Monitors from slave perspective (interconnect → backend) - Tracks backend response latency - Detects backend timeout scenarios - Default UNIT_ID=2, AGENT_ID=20 (distinguishes from master)

Slave Read Sequence: 1. AR channel: Master request arrives at slave 2. Monitor captures: Address, ID, burst parameters 3. AR forwarded to backend (memory/logic) 4. R channel: Backend returns data 5. Monitor tracks: Response latency, RLAST, RRESP 6. R forwarded back to master via interconnect

Common Slave Errors Detected: - **Backend timeout:** AR accepted but R never returned - **SLVERR:** Slave error (access violation, parity error) - **DECERR:** Decode error (shouldn't occur at slave, but detected) - (Read burst-length mismatch is NOT checked: reads complete on RLAST or error RRESP; expected_beats is stored but never compared) - **ID corruption:** RID doesn't match tracked ARID

18.8.2 Performance Considerations

Backend Latency Monitoring: - Tracks AR -> R LAST-beat latency (data_timestamp is written on the final beat; there is no first-beat timestamp) - Configurable timeout threshold - Separate from master-side latency

Typical Timeout Values: - SRAM backend: 1-5 us - DDR controller: 10-50 us - PCIe/external: 100+ us (the knob is a MICROSECOND count, not clock cycles)

18.8.3 Buffer Depth Guidelines

Same as axi4_slave_rd: - **SKID_DEPTH_AR:** 2 (default) - handles interconnect backpressure - **SKID_DEPTH_R:** 4 (default) - buffers backend burst data - Increase for high-latency backends or large bursts

---

18.9 Related Modules

18.9.1 Companion Monitors

- **axi4_master_rd_mon** - AXI4 master read with monitoring
- **axi4_master_wr_mon** - AXI4 master write with monitoring
- **axi4_slave_wr_mon** - AXI4 slave write with monitoring

18.9.2 Base Modules

- **axi4_slave_rd** - Functional AXI4 slave read (without monitoring)
- **axi_monitor_filtered** - Monitoring engine with filtering (monitor/)

18.9.3 Used Components

- **gaxi_skid_buffer** - Elastic buffering
- **axi_monitor_base** - Core monitoring logic (monitor/)
- **axi_monitor_trans_mgr** - Transaction tracking (monitor/)

18.10 Testing

`val/amba/test_axi4_slave_rd_mon.py` exercises this module. It collects 3 parameter cases at the default `REG_LEVEL`.

```
source env_python
pytest val/amba/test_axi4_slave_rd_mon.py -v
```

18.11 References

18.11.1 Specifications

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.4.5 “Read and write response structure” (the SLVERR/DECERR codes the monitor

reports), ch. A5 “Transaction Identifiers” (per-ID tracking of outstanding transactions), §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the orderings a monitor timeout watches). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.

- Monitor Bus Packet Format: monitor_package_spec.md

18.11.2 Papers and textbooks

- The monitor’s own techniques (transaction table, timeouts, packet filtering) are cited on the AXI Monitor Base page and in the monitor family of the archive.
- Maaref, M. *Architecting and Building High-Speed SoCs*, Packt, 2022, ch. 3 “Basic and Advanced On-Chip Busses and Interconnects” (“AXI bus protocol overview”) – textbook overview of AXI responses and ID ordering (secondary source).
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (protocol specifications are citation only)

18.11.3 Source Code

- RTL: `rtl/amba/axi4/axi4_slave_rd_mon.sv`
- Tests: `val/amba/test_axi4_slave_rd_mon.py`
- Framework: `bin/TBClasses/components/axi4/`

18.11.4 Documentation

- Configuration Guide: AXI Monitor Base
- Architecture: rtl-amba Overview
- AXI4 Index: README.md

Last Updated: 2026-07-18

18.12 Navigation

- **← Back to AXI4 Index**
- **← Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **← Back to Main Documentation Index**

19 AXI4 Slave Read Monitor (Clock-Gated)

Module: `axi4_slave_rd_mon_cg.sv` **Base Module:** axi4_slave_rd_mon **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/` (protocol monitors live with their protocol; only the monitor CORE pieces are in `rtl/amba/ocelus/`) **Status:** Production Ready

---

19.1 Overview

This is the **clock-gated variant** of axi4_slave_rd_mon — the same monitored slave read, with activity-based clock gating wrapped around it.

For complete clock-gating documentation, usage examples, and configuration guidelines, see the **Clock-Gated Variants Guide**.

What the wrapper buys you:

- **Same Functionality:** 100% equivalent to base module
- **Power Savings:** traffic-dependent; unmeasured in this repo – treat any percentage as a placeholder until characterized
- **Configurable:** Idle threshold, gating domains, enable/disable
- **Zero Overhead When Disabled:** `cfg_cg_enable=0` bypasses the gate at runtime

---

19.2 Parameters

> A lite-monitor version of this clock-gated wrapper exists as `axi4_slave_rd_monlite_cg`: the same gating logic around `axi4_slave_rd_monlite` instead of `axi4_slave_rd_mon`, about a fifth of the monitor gates.

MOST axi4_slave_rd_mon parameters pass through. As of 2026-09-01 only `ACTIVE_TRANS_THRESHOLD` is NOT forwarded, and that one is harmless: its inner default is `MAX_TRANSACTIONS/2`, computed from the `MAX_TRANSACTIONS` this wrapper DOES forward.

An earlier version of this page listed nine more as unforwarded, which was accurate when written. `ACLK_MHZ`, `CFI_MIN_FREQ_MHZ`, `CFI_MAX_FREQ_MHZ`, `USE_WDATA_ORDER_Q`, `NUM_BANKS` and `ADDR_RANGE_IS_ERROR` were threaded through every `_cg` wrapper on 2026-09-01, and `ID_FILTER_ENABLE` / `ID_MATCH_BASE` / `ID_MATCH_COUNT` the day before. Until then a clock-gated build could not state its clock frequency, so the 1 us timer tick was pinned to the 100 MHz default and every microsecond-denominated timeout was miscalibrated on any other clock – silently.

Parameter	Default	Description
CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH	4	Width of the idle countdown, sizing cfg_cg_idle_count
USE_MONITOR	1	Synthesis-time monitor enable (forwarded to inner monitor).
N_ADDR_RANGES	0	Number of address-range comparators (forwarded to base module).
ADDR_FILTER_ENABLE	0	Synthesises the address-range report filter. **The parameter only decides whether the logic EXISTS** – a build that sets it and leaves cfg_addr_filter_enable low filters nothing and looks broken.
ID_FILTER_ENABLE	0	Synthesises the ID report filter (see cfg_id_* for the runtime override).
ID_MATCH_BASE	0	First ID this instance owns.
ID_MATCH_COUNT	0	How many IDs; 0 means ALL, so a zeroed register block does not silently filter everything away.
ADD_PIPELINE_STAGE	0	Insert a register stage for timing closure. Costs a cycle of latency. (Add register stage for timing closure)
ENABLE_FILTERING	1	Enable packet filtering: two active drop levels (packet type, then event code). Level 2 is reserved and routes nothing.
SKID_DEPTH_AR	2	Skid-buffer depth on the AR channel. Legal range 2..8

Parameter	Default	Description
		inclusive; odd depths are legal.
SKID_DEPTH_R	4	Skid-buffer depth on the R channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are legal.
AGENT_ID	16'h0014	Agent identifier emitted in the agent_id field of every monitor packet. Pairs with UNIT_ID to identify the packet source. (16-bit Agent ID for monitor packets)
UNIT_ID	8'h02	Unit identifier emitted in the unit_id field of every monitor packet. Give each monitored interface a distinct value or the packets cannot be told apart at the collector. (8-bit Unit ID for monitor packets)

Gating is controlled by RUNTIME inputs cfg_cg_enable / cfg_cg_idle_count with status outputs cg_gating / cg_idle; ONE amba_clock_gate_ctrl gates the entire inner module. (The ENABLE_CLOCK_GATING / CG_IDLE_CYCLES / CG_GATE_* interface this page once documented never existed.)

Base-module ports are forwarded EXCEPT debug_block_ready, which this wrapper ties off (use the base module for the backpressure tap) – including the full performance-monitoring interface (see Performance Monitoring below). The six ENABLE_*_LOGIC synthesis-cone parameters (ENABLE_ERROR_LOGIC, ENABLE_TIMEOUT_LOGIC, ENABLE_COMPL_LOGIC, ENABLE_THRESHOLD_LOGIC, ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC, ENABLE_DEBUG_LOGIC) and the cfg_compl_enable / cfg_threshold_enable / cfg_debug_enable control enables are also passed straight through.

19.2.1 Filter configuration (forwarded)

These reach the inner monitor through this wrapper; before 2026-09-01 they did not.

Port	Direction	Width	Description
cfg_addr_	Input	1	High: suppress packets for

Port	Direction	Width	Description
filter_enable			transactions outside the window. Low: inert, whatever ADDR_FILTER_ENABLE says
cfg_addr_filter_low	Input	ADDR_WIDTH	Window base, inclusive
cfg_addr_filter_high	Input	ADDR_WIDTH	Window limit, inclusive
cfg_id_filter_enable	Input	1	High: use the runtime window below instead of the ID_MATCH_* parameters
cfg_id_match_base	Input	ID_WIDTH	First ID to accept
cfg_id_match_count	Input	ID_WIDTH+1	How many; 0 means ALL

Neither filter un-filters entries already admitted to the transaction table, which is what makes changing them at runtime safe.

19.2.2 Derived Parameters (do not override)

These are declared as `parameter` so the elaborator can compute them, not so callers can set them. Each defaults to an expression over the parameters above; overriding one desynchronises it from its source and the design fails to elaborate or silently mis-sizes a bus. Set the parameters they are derived FROM and leave these alone.

Derived parameter	Default expression
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	AXI_DATA_WIDTH / 8
AW	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH
DW	AXI_DATA_WIDTH
IW	AXI_ID_WIDTH
SW	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH
UW	AXI_USER_WIDTH

19.3 Ports

Port	Dir	Width	Description
aclk	In	1	
aresetn	In	1	
cam_clear	In	1	sync clear of the monitor trans CAM
s_axi_arid	In	[IW-1:0]	
s_axi_araddr	In	[AW-1:0]	
s_axi_arlen	In	[7:0]	
s_axi_arsize	In	[2:0]	
s_axi_arburst	In	[1:0]	
s_axi_arlock	In	1	
s_axi_arcache	In	[3:0]	
s_axi_arprot	In	[2:0]	
s_axi_arqos	In	[3:0]	
s_axi_arregion	In	[3:0]	
s_axi_aruser	In	[UW-1:0]	
s_axi_arvalid	In	1	
s_axi_arready	Out	1	
s_axi_rid	Out	[IW-1:0]	
s_axi_rdata	Out	[DW-1:0]	
s_axi_rresp	Out	[1:0]	
s_axi_rlast	Out	1	
s_axi_ruser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
s_axi_rvalid	Out	1	
s_axi_rready	In	1	
fub_axi_arid	Out	[IW-1:0]	
fub_axi_araddr	Out	[AW-1:0]	
fub_axi_arlen	Out	[7:0]	
fub_axi_arsize	Out	[2:0]	

Port	Dir	Width	Description
fub_axi_arburst	Out	[1:0]	
fub_axi_arlock	Out	1	
fub_axi_arcache	Out	[3:0]	
fub_axi_arprot	Out	[2:0]	
fub_axi_arqos	Out	[3:0]	
fub_axi_arregion	Out	[3:0]	
fub_axi_aruser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_arvalid	Out	1	
fub_axi_arready	In	1	
fub_axi_rid	In	[IW-1:0]	
fub_axi_rdata	In	[DW-1:0]	
fub_axi_rresp	In	[1:0]	
fub_axi_rlast	In	1	
fub_axi_ruser	In	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_rvalid	In	1	
fub_axi_rready	Out	1	
cfg_monitor_enable	In	1	Enable monitoring
cfg_error_enable	In	1	Enable error detection
cfg_timeout_enable	In	1	Enable timeout detection
cfg_perf_enable	In	1	Enable performance monitoring
cfg_compl_enable	In	1	Enable completion packets
cfg_threshold_enable	In	1	Enable threshold packets
cfg_debug_enable	In	1	Enable debug packets

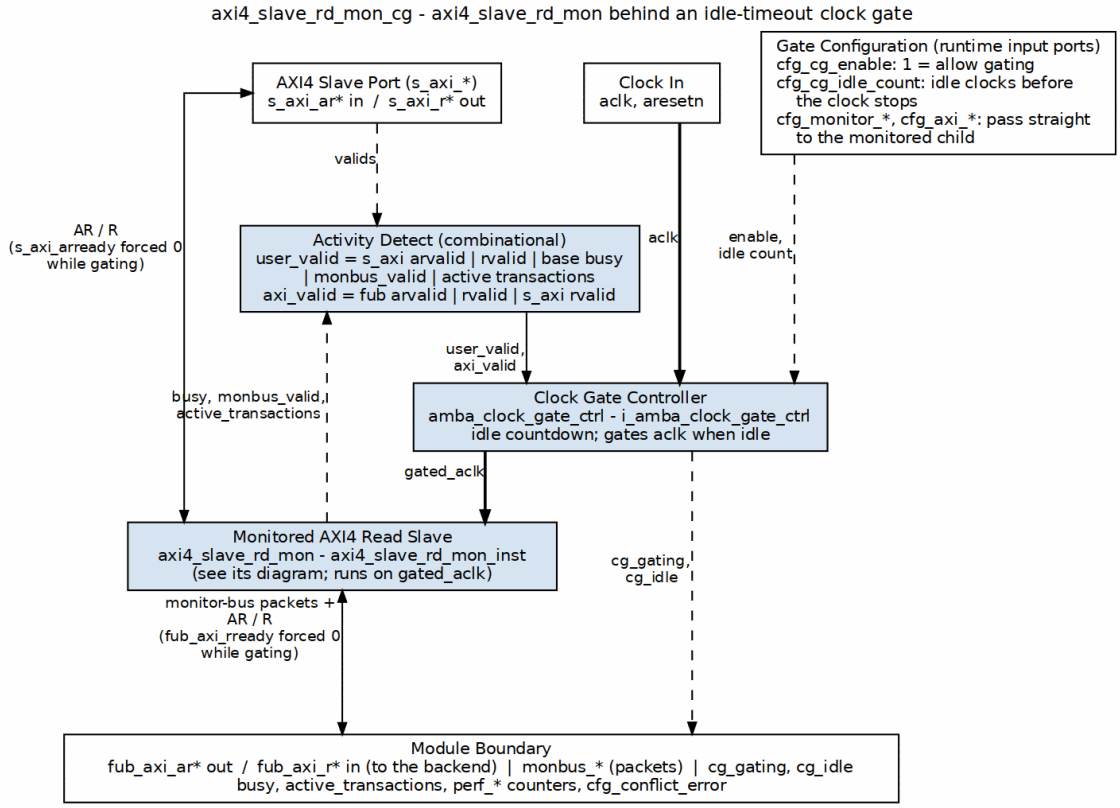
Port	Dir	Width	Description
cfg_timeout_cycles	In	[15:0]	Timeout threshold in MICROSECONDS (1 us tick), despite the name
cfg_freq_sel	In	[3:0]	counter_freq_invariant LUT index
cfg_latency_threshold	In	[31:0]	Latency threshold for alerts
cfg_axi_pkt_mask	In	[15:0]	Drop mask for packet types
cfg_axi_err_select	In	[15:0]	Error select for packet types (for future routing)
cfg_axi_error_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual error event mask
cfg_axi_timeout_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual timeout event mask
cfg_axi_compl_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual completion event mask
cfg_axi_thresh_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual threshold event mask
cfg_axi_perf_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual performance event mask
cfg_axi_addr_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual address match event mask
cfg_axi_debug_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual debug event mask
cfg_cg_enable	In	1	Enable clock

Port	Dir	Width	Description
			gating
cfg_cg_idle_count	In	[CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH-1:0]	Idle cycles before gating
cfg_addr_check_enable	In	1	
cfg_addr_range_enable	In	[(N_ADDR_RANGES > 0 ? N_ADDR_RANGES : 1)-1:0]	
cfg_addr_range_low	In	[(N_ADDR_RANGES > 0 ? N_ADDR_RANGES : 1)-1:0]	
cfg_addr_range_high	In	[(N_ADDR_RANGES > 0 ? N_ADDR_RANGES : 1)-1:0]	
cfg_addr_filter_enable	In	1	
cfg_addr_filter_low	In	[AW-1:0]	
cfg_addr_filter_high	In	[AW-1:0]	
cfg_id_filter_enable	In	1	
cfg_id_match_base	In	[IW-1:0]	
cfg_id_match_count	In	[IW:0]	
i_mon_time	In	1	
monbus_valid	Out	1	Monitor bus valid
monbus_ready	In	1	Monitor bus ready
monbus_packet	Out	1	Monitor packet (128-bit)
monbus_timestamp	Out	1	Side-band sampled time
busy	Out	1	
active_transactions	Out	[7:0]	Number of active

Port	Dir	Width	Description
			transactions
error_count	Out	[15:0]	Total error count
transaction_count	Out	[31:0]	Total transaction count
cg_gating	Out	1	Gated clock is stopped
cg_idle	Out	1	No activity observed
cfg_conflict_error	Out	1	Configuration conflict detected
cfg_start_event_sel	In	[2:0]	
cfg_end_event_sel	In	[2:0]	
cfg_start_trigger	In	1	
cfg_end_trigger	In	1	
cfg_window_force_close	In	1	
window_active	Out	1	
window_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_prod_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_bp_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_starv_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_idle_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_beat_count	Out	[31:0]	
perf_byte_count	Out	[63:0]	
perf_burst_count	Out	[31:0]	

19.4 Functional Description

19.4.1 Block diagram



axi4_slave_rd_mon_cg block diagram

This is the `_cg` pattern wrapped around `axi4_slave_rd_mon` (one child box, see its own diagram): the heavy `aclk` column runs through `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` into the monitored child as `gated_aclk`. The activity term adds `monbus_valid` and any active transactions to the usual valids and `busy`, so the clock cannot stop with a monitor packet or an open transaction in flight. The `cfg_monitor_*` and `cfg_axi_*` ports pass straight through to the child; the outward readies are forced to 0 while gating.

19.4.2 Performance Monitoring

The clock-gated wrapper exposes the full perfmon interface of the base module and **forwards every port unchanged** to the inner `axi4_slave_rd_mon`. The measurement-window state machine, the four R-channel utilization buckets (productive / back-pressure / starvation / idle), and the beat/byte/burst throughput counters behave exactly as documented in the base module — see Performance Monitoring in axi4_slave_rd_mon for the full narrative and per-bit semantics.

Forwarded perfmon ports (identical width and direction to the base module):

- **Inputs:** `cfg_perf_enable`, `cfg_start_event_sel` (3), `cfg_end_event_sel` (3), `cfg_start_trigger`, `cfg_end_trigger`, `cfg_window_force_close`
- **Outputs:** `window_active`, `window_cycles` (32), `perf_prod_cycles` (32), `perf_bp_cycles` (32), `perf_starv_cycles` (32), `perf_idle_cycles` (32), `perf_beat_count` (32), `perf_byte_count` (64), `perf_burst_count` (32)

The `perf_burst_count` output tracks AR (read address) handshakes. **WARNING – gating vs window accounting:** an open measurement window is NOT a wake term, and the entire inner monitor (window state machine and counters included) runs on the gated clock. If the bus idles past `cfg_cg_idle_count` with a window open, the counters FREEZE while wall-clock time passes, and trigger pulses arriving while gated are DROPPED. For exact wall-clock windows or idle-bus triggering, hold `cfg_cg_enable` low around the measurement, or use the base module.

19.5 Timing Characteristics

Skid parameter	Default depth
`SKID_DEPTH_AR`	2 entries
`SKID_DEPTH_R`	4 entries

Each channel traverses one `gaxi_skid_buffer`, which registers both `rd_valid` and its storage. The **1-cycle input-to-output latency therefore applies on every transfer, including the unstalled case** – there is no combinational bypass. Depth buys backpressure absorption, not throughput; full rate is sustained once the pipeline is primed. Legal range is 2..8 inclusive, odd values included.

Clocking: `aclk`, reset `aresetn` (active-low asynchronous).

No synthesis numbers are quoted here. Frequency and area depend on the target device and the parameters you elaborate with; run your own build.

19.6 Usage Examples

```
axi4_slave_rd_mon_cg #(
    // Base module parameters (see axi4_slave_rd_mon.md)
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH(8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH(64),

    .CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH(4)
) u_cg (
    .aclk(clk),
```

```
    .aresetn(rst_n),
    .cfg_cg_enable(1'b1),
    .cfg_cg_idle_count(4'd8),
    .cg_gating(), .cg_idle(),
    // ... all other ports same as axi4_slave_rd_mon (except
debug_block_ready)
);
```

19.7 Design Notes

A peer's READY must never enter the activity term. A consumer that parks its response-ready high while idle is behaving correctly; folding that signal into `user_valid` pins this block permanently awake and defeats gating entirely – silently, because function is unaffected. Ten wrappers in this repository shipped that way and nothing failed until someone measured. `val/amba/test_cg_peer_ready.py` parks the peer READY high, holds every VALID low, and requires `cg_gating`. Canonical rule: `vault/handbook/design/clock-gating-activity-terms.md`.

`cfg_cg_enable` is not a kill switch. It arms gating and reaches `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` only; the datapath and any monitor enables are forwarded untouched. With it low the clock free-runs and this module behaves exactly like its base.

Gating latency. The clock stops `cfg_cg_idle_count` + 2 cycles after the last bus activity – the idle counter, plus one for the `r_wakeup` flop. Size the idle count against your traffic's inter-burst gap: too small and the block wakes constantly, too large and it never gates.

Cost. Five flops: `r_wakeup` plus `r_idle_counter` at `IDLE_CNTR_WIDTH`, scaling as 1 + `CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH`. The ICG itself is a latch or BUFGCE, not fabric flops.

19.8 Related Modules

- **Base Module Functionality:** axi4_slave_rd_mon.md
- **Clock Gating Guide:** clock_gated_variants.md
- **Detailed CG Examples:**
  - axi4_master_rd_mon_cg.md (AXI4 monitor)
  - axil4_master_rd_mon_cg.md (AXIL4 monitor)
  - apb4_slave_cg.md (APB interface)

19.9 Testing

`val/amba/test_axi4_slave_rd_mon_cg.py` exercises this module. It collects 3 parameter cases at the default `REG_LEVEL`.

```
source env_python
pytest val/amba/test_axi4_slave_rd_mon_cg.py -v
```

19.10 References

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.4.5 “Read and write response structure” (the SLVERR/DECERR codes the monitor reports), ch. A5 “Transaction Identifiers” (per-ID tracking of outstanding transactions), §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the orderings a monitor timeout watches). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.
- Benini, L., De Micheli, G. “Automatic Synthesis of Low-Power Gated-Clock Finite-State Machines.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 15(6), June 1996. DOI: 10.1109/43.503933 – the latch-based clock-gating cell (`icg`, via `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` and `clock_gate_ctrl`) that gates this wrapper’s clock.
- Benini, L., Bogliolo, A., De Micheli, G. “A Survey of Design Techniques for System-Level Dynamic Power Management.” *IEEE Trans. VLSI Systems*, 8(3), June 2000. DOI: 10.1109/92.845896 – fixed-timeout shutdown: gate after `cfg_cg_idle_count` idle cycles, wake on activity.
- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – AXI4 has no wake-up signal. AXI5 adds AWAKEUP (Issue H §E1.7 “Wake-up Signaling”; Issue L §A14.1.1), which lets a manager restart a gated interface before VALID. This wrapper wakes on the flopped OR of the VALIDs and holds READY low while gated.
- The monitor’s own techniques are cited on the AXI Monitor Base page and in the monitor family of the archive.
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF, archived under `rtl/common/references/`: `LatchBasedClockGating__Benini1996.pdf`, `DynamicPowerManagementTimeout__Benini2000.pdf`)

19.11 Navigation

- ← Back to AXI4 Index
- ← Back to rtl-amba Index
- ← Back to Main Documentation Index

20 AXI4 Slave Read Stub

Module: `axi4_slave_rd_stub.sv` **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/stubs/` **Status:** Production Ready

20.1 Overview

The other end of the read transaction. The AXI4 Slave Read Stub receives AXI4 read transactions from a master and exposes them as simple packet interfaces — the AR channel arrives as one packed payload for your testbench to chew on, and you hand read data back the same way. Skid buffers do the pack/unpack work, which makes the stub ideal for testbenches and integration scenarios where a simplified slave interface is what you actually need.

20.1.1 Key Features

- Packed packet interface for AR and R channels
- Configurable skid buffer depth on each channel
- Full AXI4 read transaction support
- Burst, ID, and user signal support
- Parameterized data widths

20.2 Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
SKID_DEPTH_AR	int	2	AR channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
SKID_DEPTH_R	int	4	R channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
AXI_ID_WIDTH	int	8	AXI transaction ID width
AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	int	32	AXI address bus width
AXI_DATA_WIDTH	int	32	AXI data bus width
AXI_USER_WIDTH	int	1	AXI user signal width
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	int	AXI_DATA_WIDTH/8	Write strobe width (unused)
AW	int	AXI_ADDR_WID	Short alias for address

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
		TH	width
DW	int	AXI_DATA_WIDTH	Short alias for data width
IW	int	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Short alias for ID width
SW	int	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	Short alias for strobe width
UW	int	AXI_USER_WIDTH	Short alias for user width
ARSize	int	IW+AW+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+UW	AR packet size (calculated)
RSize	int	IW+DW+2+1+UW	R packet size (calculated)

20.3 Ports

20.3.1 Clock and Reset

Port	Direction	Width	Description
aclk	Input	1	AXI clock
aresetn	Input	1	AXI reset (active low)

20.3.2 AXI4 Read Address Channel (AR)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
s_axi_arid	Input	IW	Read address ID
s_axi_araddr	Input	AW	Read address
s_axi_arlen	Input	8	Burst length
s_axi_arsize	Input	3	Burst size
s_axi_arburst	Input	2	Burst type
s_axi_arlock	Input	1	Lock type
s_axi_arcache	Input	4	Cache type
s_axi_arprot	Input	3	Protection type

Port	Direction	Width	Description
s_axi_arqos	Input	4	Quality of service
s_axi_arregion	Input	4	Region identifier
s_axi_aruser	Input	UW	User signal
s_axi_arvalid	Input	1	Read address valid
s_axi_arready	Output	1	Read address ready

20.3.3 AXI4 Read Data Channel (R)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
s_axi_rid	Output	IW	Read data ID
s_axi_rdata	Output	DW	Read data
s_axi_rresp	Output	2	Read response
s_axi_rlast	Output	1	Read last
s_axi_ruser	Output	UW	User signal
s_axi_rvalid	Output	1	Read data valid
s_axi_rready	Input	1	Read data ready

20.3.4 AR Packet Interface

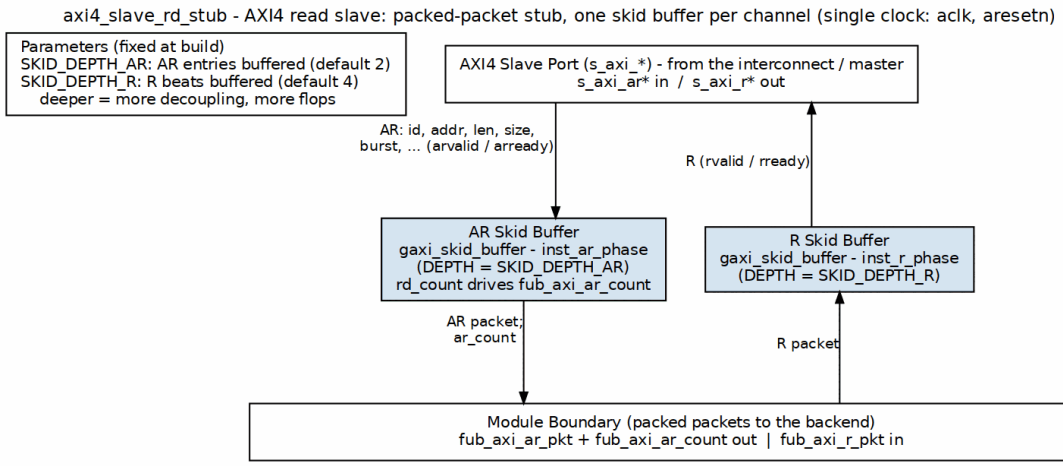
Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_arvalid	Output	1	AR packet valid
fub_axi_arready	Input	1	Ready to accept AR packet
fub_axi_ar_count	Output	4	AR buffer occupancy
fub_axi_ar_pkt	Output	ARSize	Packed AR packet data

20.3.5 R Packet Interface

Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_rvalid	Input	1	R packet valid
fub_axi_rready	Output	1	Ready to accept R packet
fub_axi_r_pkt	Input	RSize	Packed R packet data

20.4 Functional Description

20.4.1 Block diagram

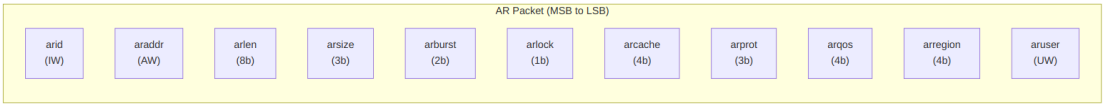


axi4_slave_rd_stub block diagram

This stub is `axi4_slave_rd` with a packed-packet interface at the bottom, toward the backend: each channel's fields travel as one packet (`*_pkt`) through its own `gaxi_skid_buffer` (`inst_*_phase`), and are unpacked onto, or packed from, the AXI4 fields at the other side. The AR buffer's occupancy is exported as `fub_axi_ar_count`. There is no busy output and no clock gating.

20.4.2 Packet Formats

Packets are packed MSB-to-LSB in AXI signal order, so parsing one in the testbench is plain slicing.

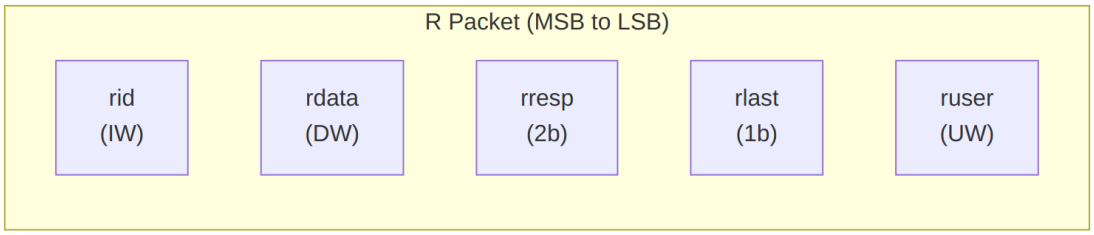


AR Packet Structure (Read Address)

Bit Positions:

```
fub_axi_ar_pkt = {arid, araddr, arlen, arsize, arburst, arlock,
arcache, arprot, arqos, arregion, aruser}

Width = IW + AW + 8 + 3 + 2 + 1 + 4 + 3 + 4 + 4 + UW
```

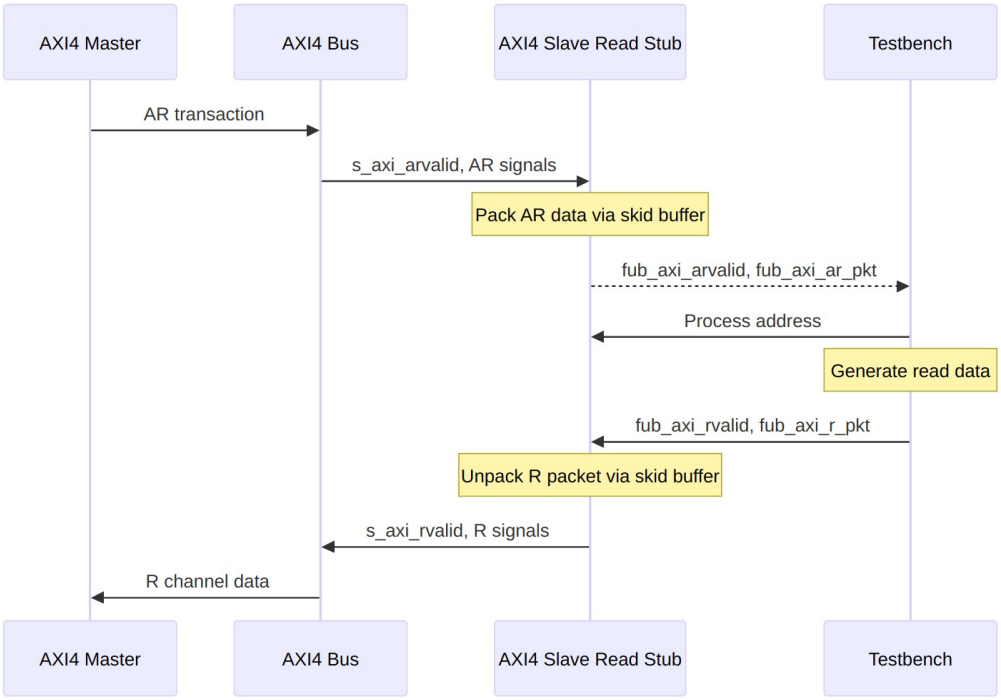


R Packet Structure (Read Data)

Bit Positions:

```
fub_axi_r_pkt = {rid, rdata, rresp, rlast, ruser}

Width = IW + DW + 2 + 1 + UW
```



Transaction Flow

20.5 Timing Characteristics

Timing diagram pending. The signals and sequence this scenario exercises:

- aclk
- AXI AR signals (s_axi_arvalid, s_axi_araddr, s_axi_arlen, etc.)
- fub_axi_arvalid, fub_axi_arready, fub_axi_ar_pkt
- fub_axi_rvalid, fub_axi_rready, fub_axi_r_pkt
- AXI R signals (s_axi_rvalid, s_axi_rdata, s_axi_rlast, etc.)
- Packet-to-AXI timing relationship with skid buffer operation

20.6 Usage Examples

```
axi4_slave_rd_stub #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AR   (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_R    (4),
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH    (8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH  (32),
```

```
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH  (64),
    .AXI_USER_WIDTH  (4)
) u_axi4_slave_rd_stub (
    .aclk            (axi_clk),
    .aresetn         (axi_rst_n),

    // AXI4 slave read interface
    .s_axi_arid      (s_axi_arid),
    .s_axi_araddr    (s_axi_araddr),
    .s_axi_arlen     (s_axi_arlen),
    .s_axi_arsize    (s_axi_arsize),
    .s_axi_arburst   (s_axi_arburst),
    .s_axi_arlock    (s_axi_arlock),
    .s_axi_arcache   (s_axi_arcache),
    .s_axi_arprot    (s_axi_arprot),
    .s_axi_arqos     (s_axi_arqos),
    .s_axi_arregion  (s_axi_arregion),
    .s_axi_aruser    (s_axi_aruser),
    .s_axi_arvalid   (s_axi_arvalid),
    .s_axi_arready   (s_axi_arready),

    .s_axi_rid       (s_axi_rid),
    .s_axi_rdata     (s_axi_rdata),
    .s_axi_rresp     (s_axi_rresp),
    .s_axi_rlast     (s_axi_rlast),
    .s_axi_ruser     (s_axi_ruser),
    .s_axi_rvalid    (s_axi_rvalid),
    .s_axi_rready    (s_axi_rready),

    // Packed AR interface
    .fub_axi_arvalid (tb_ar_valid),
    .fub_axi_arready (tb_ar_ready),
    .fub_axi_ar_count(tb_ar_count),
    .fub_axi_ar_pkt  (tb_ar_pkt),

    // Packed R interface
    .fub_axi_rvalid  (tb_r_valid),
    .fub_axi_rready  (tb_r_ready),
    .fub_axi_r_pkt   (tb_r_pkt)
);

// Parse AR packet
localparam int ARSize = 8+32+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+4;  // match your
instance widths
wire [7:0]  ar_id     = tb_ar_pkt[ARSize-1:ARSize-8];
wire [31:0] ar_addr   = tb_ar_pkt[ARSize-9:ARSize-40];
wire [7:0]  ar_len    = tb_ar_pkt[ARSize-41:ARSize-48];
```

```
wire [2:0]  ar_size   = tb_ar_pkt[ARSize-49:ARSize-51];
wire [1:0]  ar_burst  = tb_ar_pkt[ARSize-52:ARSize-53];
// ... additional fields as needed

// Build R packet (single beat response with data 0xDEADBEEFCAFEBABE)
localparam RSize = 8 + 64 + 2 + 1 + 4;  // Calculate size
assign tb_r_pkt = {
    ar_id,                      // rid (match request ID)
    64'hDEAD_BEEF_CAFE_BABE,   // rdata
    2'b00,                      // rresp (OKAY)
    1'b1,                       // rlast
    4'h0                        // ruser
};
```

20.7 Design Notes

20.7.1 Skid Buffer Operation

The stub is two `gaxi_skid_buffer` instances, and they earn their keep. They:

- Decouple timing between AXI bus and testbench
- Provide configurable buffering depth per channel
- Handle backpressure gracefully
- Support burst transactions without stalling

Recommended Depths: - **AR Channel:** 2-4 (address transactions) - **R Channel:** 4-8 (data beats for bursts)

20.7.2 Packet Packing Order

AR and R packets are packed MSB-to-LSB following AXI signal order: - Simplifies testbench packet parsing - Matches common concatenation order - Efficient for burst transaction handling

20.7.3 Internal Architecture

The stub instantiates two `gaxi_skid_buffer` modules: - **AR Skid Buffer:** Packs AXI AR channel to AR packets - **R Skid Buffer:** Unpacks R packets to AXI R channel

All AXI protocol handling is done by the skid buffers and upstream modules.

20.8 Related Modules

- **AXI4 Slave Read** - Full AXI4 slave read module (if wrapping one)

- **AXI4 Slave Write Stub** - Corresponding write stub
- **AXI4 Slave Stub** - Combined read/write stub
- **AXI4 Master Read Stub** - Master-side read stub

20.9 Testing

No dedicated testbench, and none is expected. This is a stub: a tie-off shell that presents the interface and drives inert values, so there is no behaviour to verify beyond elaboration. `make verilator` lints it as its own top on every run, which is the coverage that applies.

Treat any behaviour described on this page as unverified by simulation.

20.10 References

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h — §A3.2.1 “Handshake process” and §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the per-channel VALID/READY contract each skid buffer preserves); §A1.2.3 “Register slices” and §A3.1.1 “Clock” (a register stage may sit in any channel for one cycle of latency, and an interface must have no combinational input-to-output path, which a slice breaks). §A5.2.1 “Read data ordering” (same-ID read data returns in order, so a FIFO per channel is enough). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.
- Carloni, L.P., McMillan, K.L., Sangiovanni-Vincentelli, A.L. “Theory of Latency-Insensitive Design.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 20(9), Sept. 2001. DOI: 10.1109/43.945302 — relay stations: a channel can be pipelined by any number of back-pressured stages without changing its behavior, which is why a skid buffer per channel is transparent to both ends.
- Cortadella, J., Kishinevsky, M., Grundmann, B. “Synthesis of Synchronous Elastic Architectures.” *Proc. 43rd Design Automation Conference (DAC ’06)*, July 2006, pp. 657-662. DOI: 10.1145/1146909.1147077 — the elastic buffer with valid/stop back-pressure, the structure a skid buffer implements.
- Chipressian. *Crack the Hardware Interview: from RTL Designers’ Perspective*, Part 2 ch. 2 “Handshake Protocols” (forward and backward register slices) — textbook treatment of the valid/ready slice; the backward slice’s extra data register is the skid entry (secondary source).

- Maaref, M. *Architecting and Building High-Speed SoCs*, Packt, 2022, ch. 3 “Basic and Advanced On-Chip Busses and Interconnects” (“AXI bus protocol overview”) — textbook overview of the AXI channels, bursts and ID ordering (secondary source).
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF: `LatencyInsensitiveDesign__Carloni2001.pdf`, `ElasticBuffer__Cortadella2006.pdf`)

20.11 Navigation

- **← Back to AXI4 Index**
- **← Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **← Back to Main Documentation Index**

21 AXI4 Slave Stub

Module: `axi4_slave_stub.sv` **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/stubs/` **Status:** Production Ready

21.1 Overview

The AXI4 Slave Stub gives you a simplified packed-data interface for receiving both AXI4 read and write transactions from a master. It rolls the read and write slave stubs into one module – internally it just instantiates `axi4_slave_rd_stub` and `axi4_slave_wr_stub` – so you get a complete AXI4 slave interface with packet-based control and none of the protocol boilerplate. For testbenches and integration scenarios, this is the one I'd reach for first.

21.1.1 Key Features

- Combined read and write channel support
- Packed packet interfaces for all channels (AW, W, B, AR, R)
- Configurable skid buffer depths per channel
- Full AXI4 protocol support (bursts, IDs, user signals)
- Simplified testbench integration
- Parameterized data widths

21.2 Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
`SKID_DEPTH_AW`	int	2	AW channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
`SKID_DEPTH_W`	int	4	W channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
`SKID_DEPTH_B`	int	2	B channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
`SKID_DEPTH_AR`	int	2	AR channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
`SKID_DEPTH_R`	int	4	R channel skid buffer

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
			depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
AXI_ID_WIDTH	int	8	AXI transaction ID width
AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	int	32	AXI address bus width
AXI_DATA_WIDTH	int	32	AXI data bus width
AXI_USER_WIDTH	int	1	AXI user signal width
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	int	AXI_DATA_WIDTH/8	Write strobe width
AW	int	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	Short alias for address width
DW	int	AXI_DATA_WIDTH	Short alias for data width
IW	int	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Short alias for ID width
SW	int	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	Short alias for strobe width
UW	int	AXI_USER_WIDTH	Short alias for user width
AWSize	int	IW+AW+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+UW	AW packet size (calculated)
WSize	int	DW+SW+1+UW	W packet size (calculated)
BSize	int	IW+2+UW	B packet size (calculated)
ARSize	int	IW+AW+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+UW	AR packet size (calculated)
RSize	int	IW+DW+2+1+UW	R packet size (calculated)

21.3 Ports

21.3.1 Clock and Reset

Port	Direction	Width	Description
aclk	Input	1	AXI clock

Port	Direction	Width	Description
aresetn	Input	1	AXI reset (active low)

21.3.2 AXI4 Write Channels

Port	Direction	Width	Description
s_axi_awid	Input	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Write address ID
s_axi_awaddr	Input	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	Write address
s_axi_awlen	Input	8	Burst length
s_axi_awsize	Input	3	Burst size
s_axi_awburst	Input	2	Burst type
s_axi_awlock	Input	1	Lock type
s_axi_awcache	Input	4	Cache type
s_axi_awprot	Input	3	Protection type
s_axi_awqos	Input	4	Quality of service
s_axi_awregion	Input	4	Region identifier
s_axi_awuser	Input	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User signal
s_axi_awvalid	Input	1	Write address valid
s_axi_awready	Output	1	Write address ready
s_axi_wdata	Input	AXI_DATA_WIDTH	Write data
s_axi_wstrb	Input	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	Write strobes
s_axi_wlast	Input	1	Write last
s_axi_wuser	Input	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User signal
s_axi_wvalid	Input	1	Write data

Port	Direction	Width	Description
			valid
s_axi_wready	Output	1	Write data ready
s_axi_bid	Output	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Response ID
s_axi_bresp	Output	2	Write response
s_axi_buser	Output	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User signal
s_axi_bvalid	Output	1	Write response valid
s_axi_bready	Input	1	Write response ready

21.3.3 AXI4 Read Channels

Port	Direction	Width	Description
s_axi_arid	Input	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Read address ID
s_axi_araddr	Input	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	Read address
s_axi_arlen	Input	8	Burst length
s_axi_arsize	Input	3	Burst size
s_axi_arburst	Input	2	Burst type
s_axi_arlock	Input	1	Lock type
s_axi_arcache	Input	4	Cache type
s_axi_arprot	Input	3	Protection type
s_axi_arqos	Input	4	Quality of service
s_axi_arregion	Input	4	Region identifier
s_axi_aruser	Input	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User signal
s_axi_arvalid	Input	1	Read address valid

Port	Direction	Width	Description
s_axi_arready	Output	1	Read address ready
s_axi_rid	Output	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Read data ID
s_axi_rdata	Output	AXI_DATA_WIDTH	Read data
s_axi_rresp	Output	2	Read response
s_axi_rlast	Output	1	Read last
s_axi_ruser	Output	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User signal
s_axi_rvalid	Output	1	Read data valid
s_axi_rready	Input	1	Read data ready

21.3.4 Write Packet Interfaces

Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_awvalid	Output	1	AW packet valid
fub_axi_awready	Input	1	Ready to accept AW packet
fub_axi_aw_count	Output	4	AW buffer occupancy
fub_axi_aw_pkt	Output	AWSize	Packed AW packet data
fub_axi_wvalid	Output	1	W packet valid
fub_axi_wready	Input	1	Ready to accept W packet
fub_axi_w_pkt	Output	WSize	Packed W packet data
fub_axi_bvalid	Input	1	B packet valid

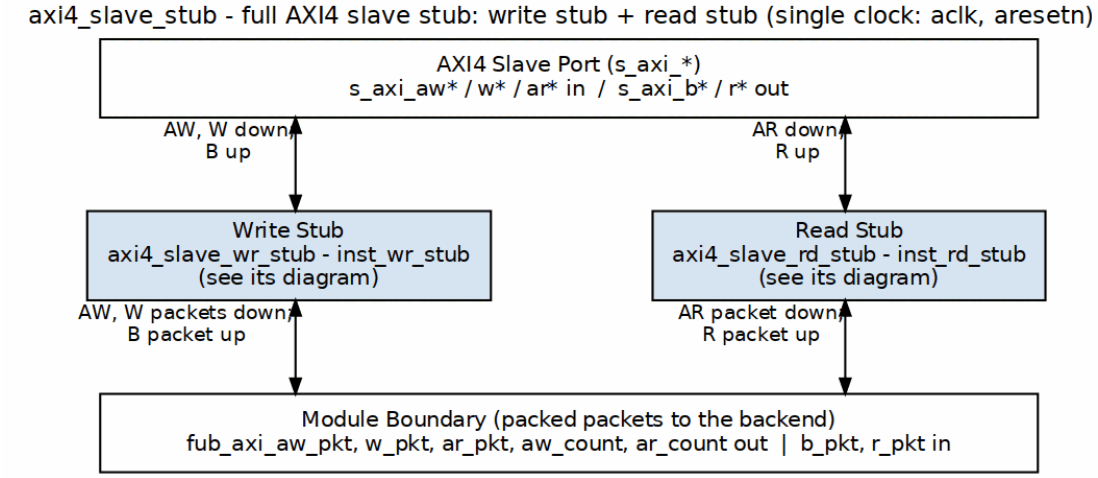
Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_bready	Output	1	Ready to accept B packet
fub_axi_b_pkt	Input	BSize	Packed B packet data

21.3.5 Read Packet Interfaces

Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_arvalid	Output	1	AR packet valid
fub_axi_arready	Input	1	Ready to accept AR packet
fub_axi_ar_count	Output	4	AR buffer occupancy
fub_axi_ar_pkt	Output	ARSize	Packed AR packet data
fub_axi_rvalid	Input	1	R packet valid
fub_axi_rready	Output	1	Ready to accept R packet
fub_axi_r_pkt	Input	RSize	Packed R packet data

21.4 Functional Description

21.4.1 Block diagram



axi4_slave_stub block diagram

The full slave stub is two child boxes: `axi4_slave_wr_stub` (AW, W, B) and `axi4_slave_rd_stub` (AR, R), each with its own diagram. The AXI4 slave fields are on top; the packed packets and the AW/AR occupancy counts leave through the bar toward the backend. The two halves share only the clock and reset.

21.4.2 Architecture

The combined stub is a thin wrapper – the channel-specific stubs do the real work, and the packed packet interfaces are what your testbench talks to (see the block diagram above).

21.4.3 Packet Formats

AW Packet (Write Address):

```
fub_axi_aw_pkt = {awid, awaddr, awlen, awsize, awburst, awlock,
awcache, awprot, awqos, awregion, awuser}
Width = IW + AW + 8 + 3 + 2 + 1 + 4 + 3 + 4 + 4 + UW
```

W Packet (Write Data):

```
fub_axi_w_pkt = {wdata, wstrb, wlast, wuser}
Width = DW + SW + 1 + UW
```

B Packet (Write Response):

```
fub_axi_b_pkt = {bid, bresp, buser}
Width = IW + 2 + UW
```

AR Packet (Read Address):

```
fub_axi_ar_pkt = {arid, araddr, arlen, arsize, arburst, arlock,
arcache, arprot, arqos, arregion, aruser}
Width = IW + AW + 8 + 3 + 2 + 1 + 4 + 3 + 4 + 4 + UW
```

R Packet (Read Data):

```
fub_axi_r_pkt = {rid, rdata, rresp, rlast, ruser}
Width = IW + DW + 2 + 1 + UW
```

Complete packet format details: See AXI4 Slave Write Stub and AXI4 Slave Read Stub

21.4.4 Transaction Flow

Reads and writes move through the stub at the same time without getting in each other's way – here's what that looks like:

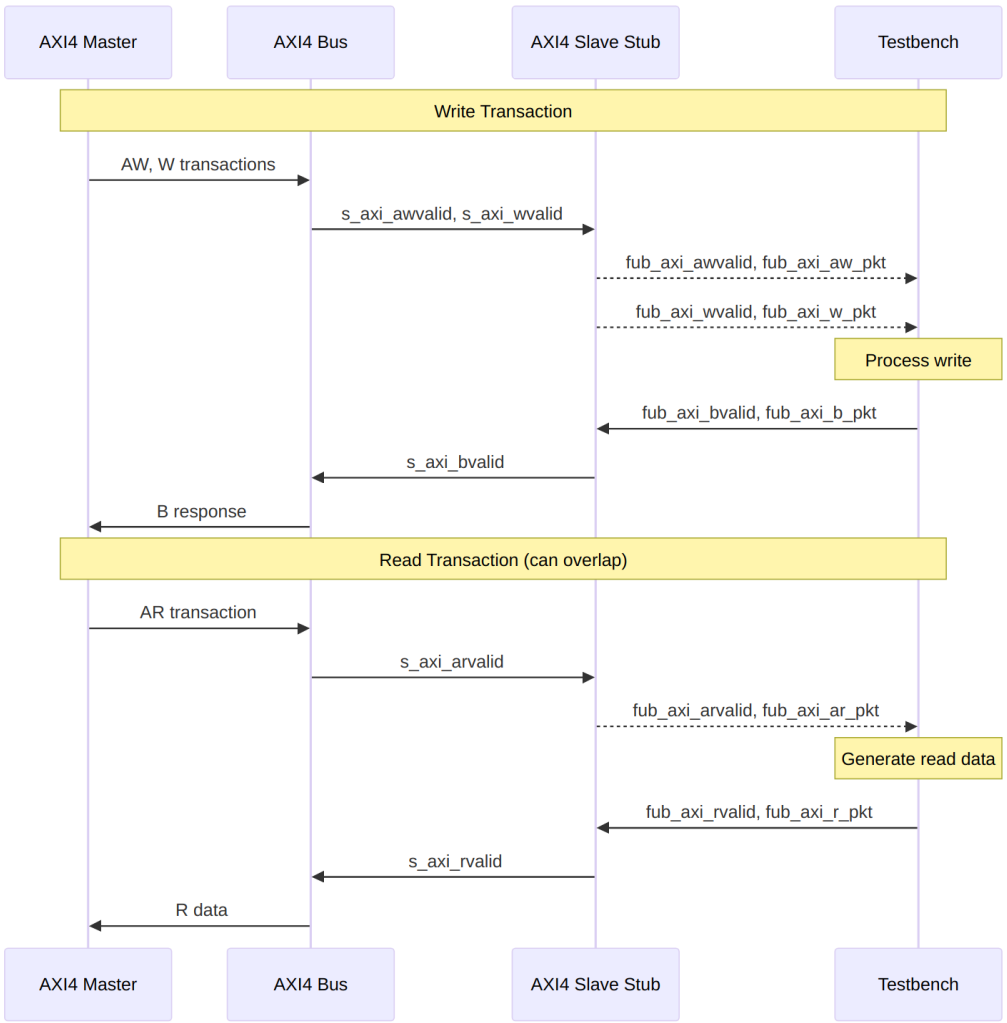


Diagram 15

21.5 Timing Characteristics

Timing diagram pending. The signals and sequence this scenario exercises:

- aclk
- AXI write channels (s_axi_aw, *s_axi_w*, s_axi_b*)
- Write packet interfaces (fub_axi_aw, *fub_axi_w*, fub_axi_b*)
- AXI read channels (s_axi_ar, *s_axi_r*)
- Read packet interfaces (fub_axi_ar, *fub_axi_r*)
- Overlapping read/write operations

21.6 Usage Examples

Wire it up, then parse and build packets in the testbench. The bit-slice localparams have to match your instance widths – get those wrong and you'll spend an afternoon chasing misaligned IDs. Don't ask how I know.

```
axi4_slave_stub #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AW   (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_W    (4),
    .SKID_DEPTH_B    (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_AR   (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_R    (4),
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH    (8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH  (32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH  (64),
    .AXI_USER_WIDTH  (4)
) u_axi4_slave_stub (
    .aclk            (axi_clk),
    .aresetn         (axi_rst_n),

    // AXI4 slave interface (all channels)
    .s_axi_awid      (s_axi_awid),
    .s_axi_awaddr    (s_axi_awaddr),
    .s_axi_awlen     (s_axi_awlen),
    .s_axi_awsize    (s_axi_awsize),
    .s_axi_awburst   (s_axi_awburst),
    .s_axi_awlock    (s_axi_awlock),
    .s_axi_awcache   (s_axi_awcache),
    .s_axi_awprot    (s_axi_awprot),
    .s_axi_awqos     (s_axi_awqos),
```

```
    .s_axi_awregion  (s_axi_awregion),
    .s_axi_awuser    (s_axi_awuser),
    .s_axi_awvalid   (s_axi_awvalid),
    .s_axi_awready   (s_axi_awready),

    .s_axi_wdata     (s_axi_wdata),
    .s_axi_wstrb     (s_axi_wstrb),
    .s_axi_wlast     (s_axi_wlast),
    .s_axi_wuser     (s_axi_wuser),
    .s_axi_wvalid    (s_axi_wvalid),
    .s_axi_wready    (s_axi_wready),

    .s_axi_bid       (s_axi_bid),
    .s_axi_bresp     (s_axi_bresp),
    .s_axi_buser     (s_axi_buser),
    .s_axi_bvalid    (s_axi_bvalid),
    .s_axi_bready    (s_axi_bready),

    .s_axi_arid      (s_axi_arid),
    .s_axi_araddr    (s_axi_araddr),
    .s_axi_arlen     (s_axi_arlen),
    .s_axi_arsize    (s_axi_arsize),
    .s_axi_arburst   (s_axi_arburst),
    .s_axi_arlock    (s_axi_arlock),
    .s_axi_arcache   (s_axi_arcache),
    .s_axi_arprot    (s_axi_arprot),
    .s_axi_arqos     (s_axi_arqos),
    .s_axi_arregion  (s_axi_arregion),
    .s_axi_aruser    (s_axi_aruser),
    .s_axi_arvalid   (s_axi_arvalid),
    .s_axi_arready   (s_axi_arready),

    .s_axi_rid       (s_axi_rid),
    .s_axi_rdata     (s_axi_rdata),
    .s_axi_rresp     (s_axi_rresp),
    .s_axi_rlast     (s_axi_rlast),
    .s_axi_ruser     (s_axi_ruser),
    .s_axi_rvalid    (s_axi_rvalid),
    .s_axi_rready    (s_axi_rready),

   // Write packet interfaces
    .fub_axi_awvalid (tb_aw_valid),
    .fub_axi_awready (tb_aw_ready),
    .fub_axi_aw_count(tb_aw_count),
    .fub_axi_aw_pkt  (tb_aw_pkt),

    .fub_axi_wvalid  (tb_w_valid),
```

```
    .fub_axi_wready  (tb_w_ready),
    .fub_axi_w_pkt   (tb_w_pkt),

    .fub_axi_bvalid  (tb_b_valid),
    .fub_axi_bready  (tb_b_ready),
    .fub_axi_b_pkt   (tb_b_pkt),

    // Read packet interfaces
    .fub_axi_arvalid (tb_ar_valid),
    .fub_axi_arready (tb_ar_ready),
    .fub_axi_ar_count(tb_ar_count),
    .fub_axi_ar_pkt  (tb_ar_pkt),

    .fub_axi_rvalid  (tb_r_valid),
    .fub_axi_rready  (tb_r_ready),
    .fub_axi_r_pkt   (tb_r_pkt)
);

// Parse incoming write address
localparam int AWSize = 8+32+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+4;  // match your
instance widths
wire [7:0]  aw_id     = tb_aw_pkt[AWSize-1:AWSize-8];
wire [31:0] aw_addr   = tb_aw_pkt[AWSize-9:AWSize-40];
wire [7:0]  aw_len    = tb_aw_pkt[AWSize-41:AWSize-48];
// ... additional fields

// Parse incoming write data
localparam int WSize = 64+8+1+4;  // match your instance widths
wire [63:0] w_data = tb_w_pkt[WSize-1:WSize-64];
wire [7:0]  w_strb = tb_w_pkt[WSize-65:WSize-72];
wire        w_last = tb_w_pkt[WSize-73];

// Generate write response (OKAY)
assign tb_b_pkt = {
    aw_id,    // bid (match request ID)
    2'b00,    // bresp (OKAY)
    4'h0      // buser
};

// Parse incoming read address
localparam int ARSize = 8+32+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+4;  // match your
instance widths
wire [7:0]  ar_id   = tb_ar_pkt[ARSize-1:ARSize-8];
wire [31:0] ar_addr = tb_ar_pkt[ARSize-9:ARSize-40];
wire [7:0]  ar_len  = tb_ar_pkt[ARSize-41:ARSize-48];
// ... additional fields
```

```
// Generate read data response
reg [63:0] read_data;  // From memory model
assign tb_r_pkt = {
    ar_id,      // rid (match request ID)
    read_data,  // rdata
    2'b00,      // rresp (OKAY)
    1'b1,       // rlast (single beat example)
    4'h0        // ruser
};
```

21.7 Design Notes

21.7.1 Internal Architecture

The stub instantiates two sub-modules: - **axi4_slave_wr_stub** - Handles AW, W, and B channels - **axi4_slave_rd_stub** - Handles AR and R channels

That hierarchy buys you a few things: it reuses the proven read/write stub modules, keeps the channel separation clean, simplifies verification and testing, and lets reads and writes operate independently.

21.7.2 Read/Write Independence

Read and write channels are completely independent: - Can overlap in time (simultaneous read and write) - Each has independent skid buffers - No ordering constraints between reads and writes - Testbench can respond at different rates

21.7.3 Skid Buffer Depths

Recommended configurations:

Low latency (fast response):

```
.SKID_DEPTH_AW(2), .SKID_DEPTH_W(2), .SKID_DEPTH_B(2),
.SKID_DEPTH_AR(2), .SKID_DEPTH_R(2)
```

Typical system:

```
.SKID_DEPTH_AW(2), .SKID_DEPTH_W(4), .SKID_DEPTH_B(2),
.SKID_DEPTH_AR(2), .SKID_DEPTH_R(4)
```

High throughput bursts:

```
.SKID_DEPTH_AW(4), .SKID_DEPTH_W(8), .SKID_DEPTH_B(4),
.SKID_DEPTH_AR(4), .SKID_DEPTH_R(8)
```

21.7.4 Memory Model Integration

The slave stub pairs naturally with a memory model – capture addresses and data on the write side, serve reads out of the array on the other:

```
// Simple memory model
reg [63:0] memory [0:1023];

// Handle write requests
always @(posedge aclk) begin
    if (tb_aw_valid && tb_aw_ready) begin
        // Capture write address
    end
    if (tb_w_valid && tb_w_ready) begin
        // Write data to memory
        memory[write_addr] <= w_data;
    end
end

// Handle read requests
always @(posedge aclk) begin
    if (tb_ar_valid && tb_ar_ready) begin
        // Generate read data from memory
        read_data <= memory[ar_addr];
    end
end
```

21.8 Related Modules

- **AXI4 Slave Read Stub** - Read-only stub (instantiated internally)
- **AXI4 Slave Write Stub** - Write-only stub (instantiated internally)
- **AXI4 Master Stub** - Corresponding combined master stub
- **AXI4 Slave Read** - Full AXI4 slave read module
- **AXI4 Slave Write** - Full AXI4 slave write module

21.9 Testing

No dedicated testbench, and none is expected. This is a stub: a tie-off shell that presents the interface and drives inert values, so there is no behaviour to verify beyond elaboration. `make verilator` lints it as its own top on every run, which is the coverage that applies.

Treat any behaviour described on this page as unverified by simulation.

21.10 References

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.2.1 “Handshake process” and §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the per-channel VALID/READY contract each skid buffer preserves); §A1.2.3 “Register slices” and §A3.1.1 “Clock” (a register stage may sit in any channel for one cycle of latency, and an interface must have no combinational input-to-output path, which a slice breaks). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.
- Carloni, L.P., McMillan, K.L., Sangiovanni-Vincentelli, A.L. “Theory of Latency-Insensitive Design.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 20(9), Sept. 2001. DOI: 10.1109/43.945302 – relay stations: a channel can be pipelined by any number of back-pressured stages without changing its behavior, which is why a skid buffer per channel is transparent to both ends.
- Cortadella, J., Kishinevsky, M., Grundmann, B. “Synthesis of Synchronous Elastic Architectures.” *Proc. 43rd Design Automation Conference (DAC ’06)*, July 2006, pp. 657-662. DOI: 10.1145/1146909.1147077 – the elastic buffer with valid/stop back-pressure, the structure a skid buffer implements.
- Chipressian. *Crack the Hardware Interview: from RTL Designers’ Perspective*, Part 2 ch. 2 “Handshake Protocols” (forward and backward register slices) – textbook treatment of the valid/ready slice; the backward slice’s extra data register is the skid entry (secondary source).
- Maaref, M. *Architecting and Building High-Speed SoCs*, Packt, 2022, ch. 3 “Basic and Advanced On-Chip Busses and Interconnects” (“AXI bus protocol overview”) – textbook overview of the AXI channels, bursts and ID ordering (secondary source).
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF: `LatencyInsensitiveDesign__Carloni2001.pdf`, `ElasticBuffer__Cortadella2006.pdf`)

21.11 Navigation

- **<- Back to AXI4 Index**
- **<- Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **<- Back to Main Documentation Index**

22 AXI4 Slave Write

Module: `axi4_slave_wr.sv` **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/` **Status:** Production Ready

22.1 Overview

The AXI4 Slave Write module is a buffered AXI4 slave write interface with configurable-depth skid buffers on all three write channels (AW, W, B). Think of it as an elastic buffer sitting between the AXI4 interconnect and your memory or backend processing element: it decouples the timing on the two sides and absorbs backpressure, so a sluggish backend doesn't stall the interconnect and an eager master doesn't overrun the backend.

22.1.1 Key Features

- **Full AXI4 Write Support:** Complete AW, W, and B channel implementation
- **Independent Channel Buffering:** Separate configurable depth buffers for each channel
- **Elastic Buffering:** Decouples interconnect and backend timing domains
- **Burst Support:** Full burst transaction handling with WLAST tracking
- **User Signal Support:** Carries AWUSER, WUSER, and BUSER signals
- **Clock Gating Support:** Busy signal for dynamic power management

22.2 Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
`SKID_DEPTH_AW`	int	2	Depth of write address (AW) channel skid buffer
`SKID_DEPTH_W`	int	4	Depth of write data (W) channel skid buffer
`SKID_DEPTH_B`	int	2	Depth of write response (B) channel skid buffer
`AXI_ID_WIDTH`	int	8	Width of transaction ID signals (AWID, BID)
`AXI_ADDR_WIDTH`	int	32	Width of address bus (AWADDR)

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
AXI_DATA_WIDTH	int	32	Width of data bus (WDATA), must be 8, 16, 32, 64, 128, 256, 512, or 1024
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	int	AXI_DATA_WIDTH/8	Write strobe width
AXI_USER_WIDTH	int	1	Width of user-defined signals (AWUSER, WUSER, BUSER)

22.3 Ports

Here's the full module declaration – the tables below it break the ports down by group.

```
module axi4_slave_wr #(
    parameter int SKID_DEPTH_AW     = 2,
    parameter int SKID_DEPTH_W      = 4,
    parameter int SKID_DEPTH_B      = 2,
    parameter int AXI_ID_WIDTH      = 8,
    parameter int AXI_ADDR_WIDTH    = 32,
    parameter int AXI_DATA_WIDTH    = 32,
    parameter int AXI_USER_WIDTH    = 1,
    parameter int AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH   = AXI_DATA_WIDTH / 8,
    // Derived shorthands -- override the eight above, not these
    parameter int AW       = AXI_ADDR_WIDTH,
    parameter int DW       = AXI_DATA_WIDTH,
    parameter int IW       = AXI_ID_WIDTH,
    parameter int SW       = AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH,
    parameter int UW       = AXI_USER_WIDTH,
    parameter int AWSize   = IW+AW+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+UW,
    parameter int WSize    = DW+SW+1+UW,
    parameter int BSize    = IW+2+UW
) (
    // Clock and Reset
    input  logic                        aclk,
    input  logic                        aresetn,

    // Slave AXI Interface (s_axi_*)
    // Write address channel (AW)
    input  logic [AXI_ID_WIDTH-1:0]   s_axi_awid,
    input  logic [AXI_ADDR_WIDTH-1:0] s_axi_awaddr,
    input  logic [7:0]                 s_axi_awlen,
```

```
input  logic [2:0]                 s_axi_awsize,
input  logic [1:0]                 s_axi_awburst,
input  logic                       s_axi_awlock,
input  logic [3:0]                 s_axi_awcache,
input  logic [2:0]                 s_axi_awprot,
input  logic [3:0]                 s_axi_awqos,
input  logic [3:0]                 s_axi_awregion,
input  logic [AXI_USER_WIDTH-1:0] s_axi_awuser,
input  logic                       s_axi_awvalid,
output logic                       s_axi_awready,

// Write data channel (W)
input  logic [AXI_DATA_WIDTH-1:0] s_axi_wdata,
input  logic [SW-1:0]              s_axi_wstrb,
input  logic                       s_axi_wlast,
input  logic [AXI_USER_WIDTH-1:0] s_axi_wuser,
input  logic                       s_axi_wvalid,
output logic                       s_axi_wready,

// Write response channel (B)
output logic [AXI_ID_WIDTH-1:0]   s_axi_bid,
output logic [1:0]                 s_axi_bresp,
output logic [AXI_USER_WIDTH-1:0] s_axi_buser,
output logic                       s_axi_bvalid,
input  logic                       s_axi_bready,

// Backend Interface (fub_axi_* - to memory/backend)
// Write address channel (AW)
output logic [AXI_ID_WIDTH-1:0]   fub_axi_awid,
output logic [AXI_ADDR_WIDTH-1:0] fub_axi_awaddr,
output logic [7:0]                 fub_axi_awlen,
output logic [2:0]                 fub_axi_awsize,
output logic [1:0]                 fub_axi_awburst,
output logic                       fub_axi_awlock,
output logic [3:0]                 fub_axi_awcache,
output logic [2:0]                 fub_axi_awprot,
output logic [3:0]                 fub_axi_awqos,
output logic [3:0]                 fub_axi_awregion,
output logic [AXI_USER_WIDTH-1:0] fub_axi_awuser,
output logic                       fub_axi_awvalid,
input  logic                       fub_axi_awready,

// Write data channel (W)
output logic [AXI_DATA_WIDTH-1:0] fub_axi_wdata,
output logic [SW-1:0]              fub_axi_wstrb,
output logic                       fub_axi_wlast,
output logic [AXI_USER_WIDTH-1:0] fub_axi_wuser,
```

```
    output logic                          fub_axi_wvalid,
    input  logic                          fub_axi_wready,

    // Write response channel (B)
    input  logic [AXI_ID_WIDTH-1:0]   fub_axi_bid,
    input  logic [1:0]                    fub_axi_bresp,
    input  logic [AXI_USER_WIDTH-1:0] fub_axi_buser,
    input  logic                          fub_axi_bvalid,
    output logic                          fub_axi_bready,

    // Status
    output logic                          busy
);
```

22.3.1 Clock and Reset

Port	Direction	Width	Description
aclk	Input	1	AXI clock - all signals sampled on rising edge
aresetn	Input	1	Active-low asynchronous reset

22.3.2 Slave AXI Interface (s_axi_*)

22.3.2.1 Write Address Channel (AW)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
s_axi_awid	Input	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Write transaction ID
s_axi_awaddr	Input	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	Write address
s_axi_awlen	Input	8	Burst length, AXI-encoded: beats - 1 (0x00 = 1 beat, 0xFF = 256)
s_axi_awsize	Input	3	Burst size (bytes per beat)
s_axi_awburst	Input	2	Burst type (FIXED, INCR, WRAP)
s_axi_awlock	Input	1	Lock type (atomic access

Port	Direction	Width	Description
			support)
s_axi_awcache	Input	4	Cache attributes
s_axi_awprot	Input	3	Protection attributes
s_axi_awqos	Input	4	Quality of Service identifier
s_axi_awregion	Input	4	Region identifier
s_axi_awuser	Input	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User-defined signal
s_axi_awvalid	Input	1	Write address valid
s_axi_awready	Output	1	Write address ready

22.3.2.2 Write Data Channel (W)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
s_axi_wdata	Input	AXI_DATA_WIDTH	Write data
s_axi_wstrb	Input	AXI_DATA_WIDTH/8	Write strobes (byte enables)
s_axi_wlast	Input	1	Last beat of burst indicator
s_axi_wuser	Input	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User-defined signal
s_axi_wvalid	Input	1	Write data valid
s_axi_wready	Output	1	Write data ready

22.3.2.3 Write Response Channel (B)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
s_axi_bid	Output	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Response transaction ID
s_axi_bresp	Output	2	Write response (OKAY, EXOKAY, SLVERR, DECERR)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
s_axi_buser	Output	AXI_USER_WIDTH	User-defined signal
s_axi_bvalid	Output	1	Write response valid
s_axi_bready	Input	1	Write response ready

22.3.3 Backend Interface (fub_axi_*)

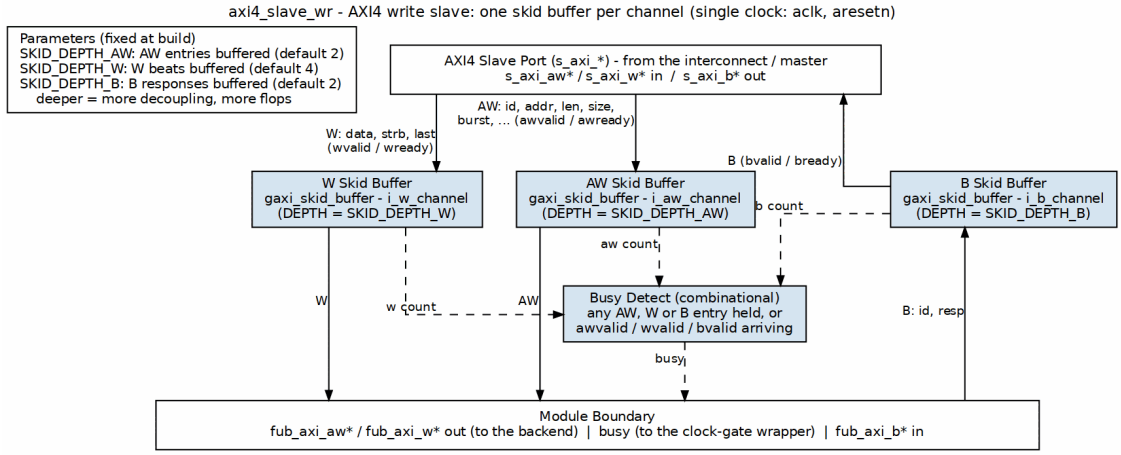
Mirrors the slave interface but in the opposite direction (output on AW/W, input on B).

22.3.4 Status Outputs

Port	Direction	Width	Description
busy	Output	1	Indicates active transactions in buffers (for clock gating)

22.4 Functional Description

22.4.1 Block diagram



axi4_slave_wr block diagram

Write data (W) takes its own lane down the left and AW goes down the center, each through its own `gaxi_skid_buffer` from the s_axi slave port to the backend (fub_axi); the write response (B) comes back up the right lane through a third skid buffer. Busy Detect reads all three occupancies plus the incoming valids and drives `busy` for the `_cg` clock-gated wrapper. The `SKID_DEPTH_*` parameters size each buffer.

22.4.2 Architecture

Three independent `gaxi_skid_buffer` instances do the heavy lifting, one per write channel (see the block diagram above).

22.4.3 Channel Operations

22.4.3.1 Write Address (AW) Channel

1. Master presents write address and attributes via interconnect
2. AW skid buffer accepts when space available (`s_axi_awready` high)
3. Buffered address presented to backend when ready
4. Configurable depth (`SKID_DEPTH_AW`) smooths timing variations

22.4.3.2 Write Data (W) Channel

1. Master presents write data with strobes via interconnect
2. W skid buffer provides deeper buffering (default depth=4)
3. WLAST signal preserved to indicate burst boundaries
4. Independent from AW channel (AXI4 allows W before AW)

22.4.3.3 Write Response (B) Channel

1. Backend returns write response with transaction ID
2. B skid buffer captures response when master busy
3. Master receives response via interconnect when ready to accept
4. ID matching handled by AXI interconnect (not this module)

22.4.4 Busy Signal

The `busy` output indicates active transactions:

```
assign busy = (int_aw_count > 0) || (int_w_count > 0) || (int_b_count
> 0) ||
                  s_axi_awvalid || s_axi_wvalid || fub_axi_bvalid;
```

Use cases: - **Clock gating:** Disable clock when `busy` is low - **Power management:** Enter low-power mode when idle - **Synchronization:** Wait for idle before configuration changes

---

22.5 Timing Characteristics

Skid parameter	Default depth
`SKID_DEPTH_AW`	2 entries

Skid parameter	Default depth
SKID_DEPTH_W	4 entries
SKID_DEPTH_B	2 entries

Each channel traverses one gaxi_skid_buffer, which registers both rd_valid and its storage. The **1-cycle input-to-output latency therefore applies on every transfer, including the unstalled case** – there is no combinational bypass. Depth buys backpressure absorption, not throughput; full rate is sustained once the pipeline is primed. Legal range is 2..8 inclusive, odd values included.

Clocking: aclk, reset aresetn (active-low asynchronous).

No synthesis numbers are quoted here. Frequency and area depend on the target device and the parameters you elaborate with; run your own build.

22.6 Usage Examples

Every parameter and port below is read from the module declaration.

```
axi4_slave_wr #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AW          (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_W           (4),
    .SKID_DEPTH_B           (2),
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH           (8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH         (32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH         (32),
    .AXI_USER_WIDTH         (1)
) u_axi4_slave_wr (
    .aclk                   (aclk),
    .aresetn                (aresetn),
    .s_axi_awid             (s_axi_awid),
    .s_axi_awaddr           (s_axi_awaddr),
    .s_axi_awlen            (s_axi_awlen),
    .s_axi_awsize           (s_axi_awsize),
    .s_axi_awburst          (s_axi_awburst),
    .s_axi_awlock           (s_axi_awlock),
    .s_axi_awcache          (s_axi_awcache),
    .s_axi_awprot           (s_axi_awprot),
    .s_axi_awqos            (s_axi_awqos),
    .s_axi_awregion         (s_axi_awregion),
    .s_axi_awuser           (s_axi_awuser),
    .s_axi_awvalid          (s_axi_awvalid),
    .s_axi_awready          (s_axi_awready),
    .s_axi_wdata            (s_axi_wdata),
    .s_axi_wstrb            (s_axi_wstrb),
```

```
    .s_axi_wlast           (s_axi_wlast),
    .s_axi_wuser           (s_axi_wuser),
    .s_axi_wvalid          (s_axi_wvalid),
    .s_axi_wready          (s_axi_wready),
    .s_axi_bid             (s_axi_bid),
    .s_axi_bresp           (s_axi_bresp),
    .s_axi_buser           (s_axi_buser),
    .s_axi_bvalid          (s_axi_bvalid),
    .s_axi_bready          (s_axi_bready),
    .fub_axi_awid          (fub_axi_awid),
    .fub_axi_awaddr        (fub_axi_awaddr),
    .fub_axi_awlen         (fub_axi_awlen),
    .fub_axi_awsize        (fub_axi_awsize),
    .fub_axi_awburst       (fub_axi_awburst),
    .fub_axi_awlock        (fub_axi_awlock),
    .fub_axi_awcache       (fub_axi_awcache),
    .fub_axi_awprot        (fub_axi_awprot),
    .fub_axi_awqos         (fub_axi_awqos),
    .fub_axi_awregion      (fub_axi_awregion),
    .fub_axi_awuser        (fub_axi_awuser),
    .fub_axi_awvalid       (fub_axi_awvalid),
    .fub_axi_awready       (fub_axi_awready),
    .fub_axi_wdata         (fub_axi_wdata),
    .fub_axi_wstrb         (fub_axi_wstrb),
    .fub_axi_wlast         (fub_axi_wlast),
    .fub_axi_wuser         (fub_axi_wuser),
    .fub_axi_wvalid        (fub_axi_wvalid),
    .fub_axi_wready        (fub_axi_wready),
    .fub_axi_bid           (fub_axi_bid),
    .fub_axi_bresp         (fub_axi_bresp),
    .fub_axi_buser         (fub_axi_buser),
    .fub_axi_bvalid        (fub_axi_bvalid),
    .fub_axi_bready        (fub_axi_bready),
    .busy                  (busy)
);
```

22.7 Design Notes

22.7.1 Buffer Depth Selection

`SKID_DEPTH_*` is an entry count, not a log2 exponent. The underlying `gaxi_skid_buffer` allocates one register slot per entry and tracks occupancy with a 4-bit counter, so legal values are 2..8 inclusive (any integer). Values greater than 8 overflow the occupancy counter and are not supported.

Write Address (SKID_DEPTH_AW): - Default: 2 (sufficient for most cases) - Increase if: - High-latency backend address decode - Frequent address channel backpressure - Multiple outstanding bursts needed

Write Data (SKID_DEPTH_W): - Default: 4 (deeper than AW for burst data) - Increase if: - Large burst sizes (AWLEN > 4) - High-bandwidth streaming writes - Variable backend write latency

Write Response (SKID_DEPTH_B): - Default: 2 (responses are typically single-beat) - Increase if: - Master slow to accept responses - Many concurrent outstanding writes - Response channel backpressure observed

22.7.2 Recommended Configurations

Low-Latency Memory (single outstanding write):

```
axi4_slave_wr #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AW(2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_W(2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_B(2)
) u_slave_wr ( ... );
```

High-Throughput Streaming (burst writes):

```
axi4_slave_wr #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AW(4),
    .SKID_DEPTH_W(8),    // Deep for burst data
    .SKID_DEPTH_B(4)
) u_slave_wr ( ... );
```

Multiple Outstanding Writes:

```
axi4_slave_wr #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AW(8),
    .SKID_DEPTH_W(8),
    .SKID_DEPTH_B(8)
) u_slave_wr ( ... );
```

22.7.3 Buffer Independence

The three skid buffers operate independently: - AW and W channels can progress at different rates - AXI4 allows W data before AW address - B responses return asynchronously based on backend timing

22.7.4 Packet Preservation

All signal groups packed and unpacked atomically: - AW channel: `{awid, awaddr, awlen, awsize, awburst, awlock, awcache, awprot, awqos, awregion, awuser}` - W channel: `{wdata, wstrb, wlast, wuser}` - B channel: `{bid, bresp, buser}`

22.7.5 Backpressure Handling

Ready signals propagate backpressure: - Interconnect sees `awready/wready` low when buffers full - Backend backpressure captured in buffers - Prevents data loss while decoupling timing

22.7.6 ID and Burst Handling

This module is a pass-through buffer, and it's honest about it: - Does NOT track transaction IDs - Does NOT enforce burst ordering - Relies on backend to: - Match BID to AWID - Generate appropriate BRESP

22.7.7 Reset Behavior

On `aresetn` assertion (active-low): - All skid buffers flush - Valid signals deasserted - Busy signal goes low - No data retained across reset

---

22.8 Related Modules

22.8.1 Companion Modules

- **axi4_slave_rd** - AXI4 slave read with buffering
- **axi4_slave_wr_cg** - Clock-gated variant with additional CG logic
- **axi4_slave_wr_mon** - Write transaction monitor for verification

22.8.2 Used Components

- **gaxi_skid_buffer** - Elastic buffer with valid/ready handshake
- **clock_gate_ctrl** - Clock gating control (example)

22.8.3 Related Infrastructure

- **axi4_master_wr** - Corresponding AXI4 write master module
- **axi4_interconnect** - Multi-master/multi-slave crossbar

22.9 Testing

The unit testbench lives at `val/amba/test_axi4_slave_wr.py`, built on the shared AXI4 test framework in `bin/TBClasses/components/axi4/`.

22.10 References

22.10.1 Specifications

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.2.1

"Handshake process" and §A3.3.1 "Dependencies between channel handshake signals" (the per-channel VALID/READY contract each skid buffer preserves); §A1.2.3 "Register slices" and §A3.1.1 "Clock" (a register stage may sit in any channel for one cycle of latency, and an interface must have no combinational input-to-output path, which a slice breaks). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.

22.10.2 Papers and textbooks

- Carloni, L.P., McMillan, K.L., Sangiovanni-Vincentelli, A.L. "Theory of Latency-Insensitive Design." *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 20(9), Sept. 2001. DOI: 10.1109/43.945302 – relay stations: a channel can be pipelined by any number of back-pressured stages without changing its behavior, which is why a skid buffer per channel is transparent to both ends.
- Cortadella, J., Kishinevsky, M., Grundmann, B. "Synthesis of Synchronous Elastic Architectures." *Proc. 43rd Design Automation Conference (DAC '06)*, July 2006, pp. 657-662. DOI: 10.1145/1146909.1147077 – the elastic buffer with valid/stop back-pressure, the structure a skid buffer implements.
- Chipressian. *Crack the Hardware Interview: from RTL Designers' Perspective*, Part 2 ch. 2 "Handshake Protocols" (forward and backward register slices) – textbook treatment of the valid/ready slice; the backward slice's extra data register is the skid entry (secondary source).
- Maaref, M. *Architecting and Building High-Speed SoCs*, Packt, 2022, ch. 3 "Basic and Advanced On-Chip Busses and Interconnects" ("AXI bus protocol overview") – textbook overview of the AXI channels, bursts and ID ordering (secondary source).
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF: `LatencyInsensitiveDesign__Carloni2001.pdf`, `ElasticBuffer__Cortadella2006.pdf`)

22.10.3 Source Code

- RTL: `rtl/amba/axi4/axi4_slave_wr.sv`

22.10.4 Documentation

- Architecture: rtl-amba Overview
- AXI4 Index: axi4/README.md
- GAXI Buffers: gaxi/README.md

Last Updated: 2025-10-20

22.11 Navigation

- <- Back to AXI4 Index
- <- Back to rtl-amba Index
- <- Back to Main Documentation Index

23 AXI4 Slave Write Interface (Clock-Gated)

Module: `axi4_slave_wr_cg.sv` **Base Module:** axi4_slave_wr **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/`
Status: Production Ready

23.1 Overview

This is the **clock-gated variant** of axi4_slave_wr. The base page owns the functional story; this page only covers what changes when you put the module behind a clock gate.

For complete clock-gating documentation, usage examples, and configuration guidelines, see the Clock-Gated Variants Guide.

The `axi4_slave_wr_cg` module adds power optimization to `axi4_slave_wr` through activity-based clock gating:

- **Same Functionality:** 100% equivalent to base module
- **Power Savings:** traffic-dependent; unmeasured in this repo – treat any percentage as a placeholder until characterized
- **Configurable at runtime:** `cfg_cg_enable` / `cfg_cg_idle_count` inputs
- **Zero Overhead When Disabled:** `cfg_cg_enable=0` bypasses the gate

23.2 Parameters

In addition to all axi4_slave_wr parameters:

Parameter	Default	Description
`CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH`	4	Width of the idle countdown, sizing `cfg_cg_idle_count`
`SKID_DEPTH_AW`	2	Skid-buffer depth on the AW channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are legal.
`SKID_DEPTH_B`	2	Skid-buffer depth on the B channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are legal.

Parameter	Default	Description
SKID_DEPTH_W	4	Skid-buffer depth on the W channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are legal.

The gating controls are RUNTIME INPUTS, not parameters: `cfg_cg_enable` and `cfg_cg_idle_count`; status outputs `cg_gating` / `cg_idle`. One `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` gates the whole module – no per-domain gates. The base module's `busy` output is NOT re-exported (consumed internally as a wake term). (The ENABLE_CLOCK_GATING / CG_IDLE_CYCLES / CG_GATE_* interface this page once documented never existed.)

23.2.1 Derived Parameters (do not override)

These are declared as `parameter` so the elaborator can compute them, not so callers can set them. Each defaults to an expression over the parameters above; overriding one desynchronises it from its source and the design fails to elaborate or silently mis-sizes a bus. Set the parameters they are derived FROM and leave these alone.

Derived parameter	Default expression
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	AXI_DATA_WIDTH / 8
AW	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH
DW	AXI_DATA_WIDTH
IW	AXI_ID_WIDTH
SW	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH
UW	AXI_USER_WIDTH
AWSize	IW+AW+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+UW
WSize	DW+SW+1+UW
BSize	IW+2+UW

23.3 Ports

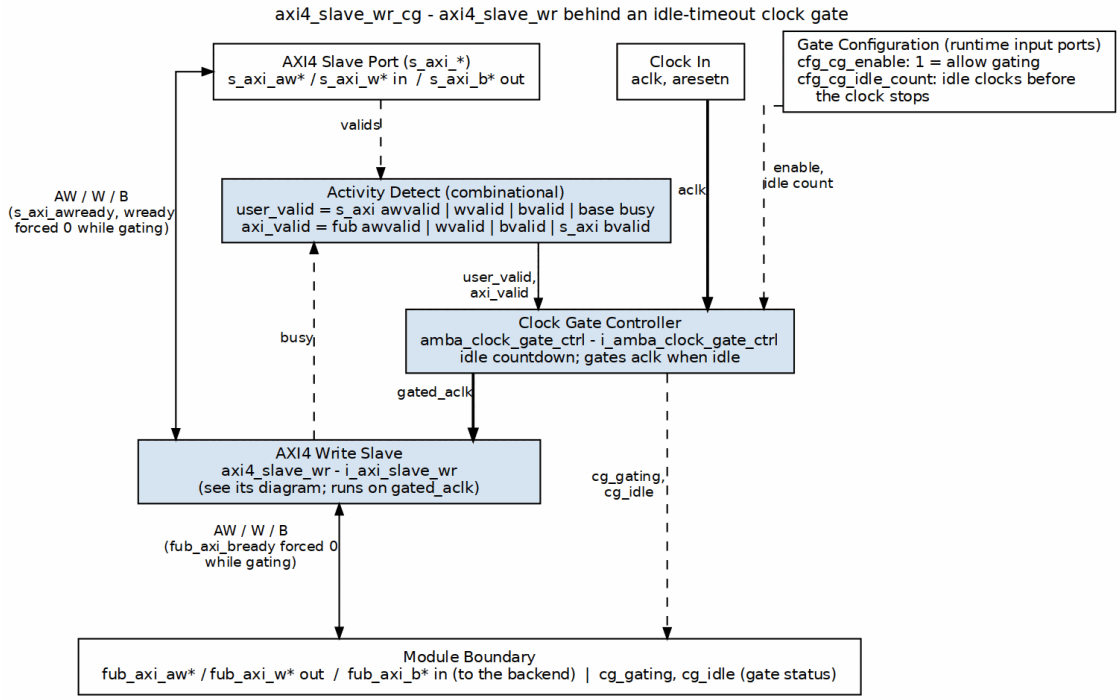
Port	Dir	Width	Description
aclk	In	1	
aresetn	In	1	
cfg_cg_enable	In	1	
cfg_cg_idle_count	In	[CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH-1:0]	
s_axi_awid	In	[IW-1:0]	

Port	Dir	Width	Description
s_axi_awaddr	In	[AW-1:0]	
s_axi_awlen	In	[7:0]	
s_axi_awsize	In	[2:0]	
s_axi_awburst	In	[1:0]	
s_axi_awlock	In	1	
s_axi_awcache	In	[3:0]	
s_axi_awprot	In	[2:0]	
s_axi_awqos	In	[3:0]	
s_axi_awregion	In	[3:0]	
s_axi_awuser	In	[UW-1:0]	
s_axi_awvalid	In	1	
s_axi_awready	Out	1	
s_axi_wdata	In	[DW-1:0]	
s_axi_wstrb	In	[SW-1:0]	
s_axi_wlast	In	1	
s_axi_wuser	In	[UW-1:0]	
s_axi_wvalid	In	1	
s_axi_wready	Out	1	
s_axi_bid	Out	[IW-1:0]	
s_axi_bresp	Out	[1:0]	
s_axi_buser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
s_axi_bvalid	Out	1	
s_axi_bready	In	1	
fub_axi_awid	Out	[IW-1:0]	
fub_axi_awaddr	Out	[AW-1:0]	
fub_axi_awlen	Out	[7:0]	
fub_axi_awsize	Out	[2:0]	
fub_axi_awburst	Out	[1:0]	

Port	Dir	Width	Description
fub_axi_awlock	Out	1	
fub_axi_awcache	Out	[3:0]	
fub_axi_awprot	Out	[2:0]	
fub_axi_awqos	Out	[3:0]	
fub_axi_awregion	Out	[3:0]	
fub_axi_awuser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_awvalid	Out	1	
fub_axi_awready	In	1	
fub_axi_wdata	Out	[DW-1:0]	
fub_axi_wstrb	Out	[SW-1:0]	
fub_axi_wlast	Out	1	
fub_axi_wuser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_wvalid	Out	1	
fub_axi_wready	In	1	
fub_axi_bid	In	[IW-1:0]	
fub_axi_bresp	In	[1:0]	
fub_axi_buser	In	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_bvalid	In	1	
fub_axi_bready	Out	1	
cg_gating	Out	1	
cg_idle	Out	1	

23.4 Functional Description

23.4.1 Block diagram



axi4_slave_wr_cg block diagram

The base `axi4_slave_wr` is one child box (see its own diagram), clocked by `gated_aclk`. The clock is the heavy center column: `aclk` enters `amba_clock_gate_ctrl`, which stops it after `cfg_cg_idle_count` idle clocks. Activity Detect ORs this side's valids with the base's `busy` (`user_valid`) and the far side's valids (`axi_valid`) to wake the clock. While gating, the outward ready signals are forced to 0, so no handshake is lost; `cg_gating` and `cg_idle` report the gate's state.

This wrapper is the base module plus one `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` instance. The datapath is untouched – every channel signal is forwarded verbatim – so functional behaviour is identical to the base module and the wrapper adds no latency of its own.

What it adds is a gated clock. `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` watches two activity terms, `user_valid` (this side's valids plus the base module's `busy`) and `axi_valid` (the far side's valids), registers their OR into `r_wakeup`, and stops the inner module's clock once both have been quiet for `cfg_cg_idle_count` cycles. The clock restarts on the next activity, one cycle later.

While the clock is stopped the wrapper masks its outward-facing READY signals with `! cg_gating`, so a peer sees no acceptance until the clock runs again and no handshake is lost across the wake boundary.

`cfg_cg_enable` arms this behaviour; with it low the clock free-runs and the module is indistinguishable from its base.

23.5 Timing Characteristics

Skid parameter	Default depth
`SKID_DEPTH_AW`	2 entries
`SKID_DEPTH_W`	4 entries
`SKID_DEPTH_B`	2 entries

Each channel traverses one `gaxi_skid_buffer`, which registers both `rd_valid` and its storage. The **1-cycle input-to-output latency therefore applies on every transfer, including the unstalled case** – there is no combinational bypass. Depth buys backpressure absorption, not throughput; full rate is sustained once the pipeline is primed. Legal range is 2..8 inclusive, odd values included.

Clocking: `aclk`, reset `aresetn` (active-low asynchronous).

No synthesis numbers are quoted here. Frequency and area depend on the target device and the parameters you elaborate with; run your own build.

23.6 Usage Examples

```
axi4_slave_wr_cg #(
    // Base module parameters (see axi4_slave_wr.md)
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH(8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH(64),

    .CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH(4)
) u_cg (
    .aclk(clk),
    .aresetn(rst_n),
    .cfg_cg_enable(1'b1),
    .cfg_cg_idle_count(4'd8),
    .cg_gating(), .cg_idle(),
    // ... all other ports same as axi4_slave_wr (except busy)
);
```

23.7 Design Notes

A peer's READY must never enter the activity term. A consumer that parks its response-ready high while idle is behaving correctly; folding that signal into `user_valid` pins this block permanently awake and defeats gating entirely – silently, because function is unaffected. Ten wrappers in this repository shipped that way and nothing failed until someone measured. `val/amba/test_cg_peer_ready.py` parks the peer READY high, holds every VALID low, and requires `cg_gating`. Canonical rule: `vault/handbook/design/clock-gating-activity-terms.md`.

`cfg_cg_enable` is not a kill switch. It arms gating and reaches `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` only; the datapath and any monitor enables are forwarded untouched. With it low the clock free-runs and this module behaves exactly like its base.

Gating latency. The clock stops `cfg_cg_idle_count` + 2 cycles after the last bus activity – the idle counter, plus one for the `r_wakeup` flop. Size the idle count against your traffic's inter-burst gap: too small and the block wakes constantly, too large and it never gates.

Cost. Five flops: `r_wakeup` plus `r_idle_counter` at `IDLE_CNTR_WIDTH`, scaling as 1 + `CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH`. The ICG itself is a latch or BUFGCE, not fabric flops.

23.8 Related Modules

- **Base Module Functionality:** axi4_slave_wr.md
- **Clock Gating Guide:** clock_gated_variants.md
- **Detailed CG Examples:**
  - axi4_master_rd_mon_cg.md (AXI4 monitor)
  - axil4_master_rd_mon_cg.md (AXIL4 monitor)
  - apb4_slave_cg.md (APB interface)

23.9 Testing

`val/amba/test_axi4_slave_wr_cg.py` exercises this module. It collects 1 parameter cases at the default `REG_LEVEL`.

```
source env_python
pytest val/amba/test_axi4_slave_wr_cg.py -v
```

23.10 References

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.2.1 “Handshake process” and §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the per-channel VALID/READY contract each skid buffer preserves); §A1.2.3 “Register slices” and §A3.1.1 “Clock” (a register stage may sit in any channel for one cycle of latency, and an interface must have no combinational input-to-output path, which a slice breaks). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.
- Benini, L., De Micheli, G. “Automatic Synthesis of Low-Power Gated-Clock Finite-State Machines.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 15(6), June 1996. DOI: 10.1109/43.503933 – the latch-based clock-gating cell (`icg`, via `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` and `clock_gate_ctrl`) that gates this wrapper’s clock.
- Benini, L., Bogliolo, A., De Micheli, G. “A Survey of Design Techniques for System-Level Dynamic Power Management.” *IEEE Trans. VLSI Systems*, 8(3), June 2000. DOI: 10.1109/92.845896 – fixed-timeout shutdown: gate after `cfg_cg_idle_count` idle cycles, wake on activity.
- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – AXI4 has no wake-up signal. AXI5 adds AWAKEUP (Issue H §E1.7 “Wake-up Signaling”; Issue L §A14.1.1), which lets a manager restart a gated interface before VALID. This wrapper wakes on the flopped OR of the VALIDs and holds READY low while gated.
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF, archived under `rtl/common/references/`: `LatchBasedClockGating__Benini1996.pdf`, `DynamicPowerManagementTimeout__Benini2000.pdf`)

23.11 Navigation

- **<- Back to AXI4 Index**
- **<- Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **<- Back to Main Documentation Index**

24 AXI4 Slave Write Monitor

Module: `axi4_slave_wr_mon.sv` **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/` (protocol monitors live with their protocol; only the monitor CORE pieces are in `rtl/amba/ocelus/`) **Status:** Production Ready

---

24.1 Overview

The AXI4 Slave Write Monitor bolts a full transaction monitor onto a working AXI4 slave write interface. You get the buffered slave from `axi4_slave_wr` plus real-time protocol checking, error detection, performance metrics, and configurable packet filtering on slave-side write transactions – everything a verification environment needs to know what the bus actually did, not just what it was supposed to do.

24.1.1 Key Features

- **Integrated Monitoring:** Combines `axi4_slave_wr` with `axi_monitor_filtered`
- **2-Level Filtering:** Packet-type drop masks, individual event masking
- **Error Detection:** Protocol violations, SLVERR, DECERR, orphan transactions
- **Timeout Monitoring:** Configurable timeout detection for stuck transactions
- **Performance Metrics:** Latency tracking, transaction counting, throughput analysis
- **Monitor Bus Output:** 128-bit packets paired with 64-bit side-band timestamps
- **Configuration Validation:** Detects conflicting configuration settings
- **Clock Gating Support:** Busy signal for power management

24.2 Parameters

A lite-monitor version of this wrapper exists as `axi4_slave_wr_monlite`: the same core and taps with `axi_monitor_lite` instead of `axi_monitor_filtered`, about a fifth of the monitor gates, error/timeout/completion/threshold packets only. Selected in generated bridges by `mon_preset = "lite"`.

24.2.1 AXI4 Slave Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
SKID_DEPTH_AW	int	2	AW channel skid buffer depth
SKID_DEPTH_W	int	4	W channel skid buffer depth
SKID_DEPTH_B	int	2	B channel skid buffer depth
AXI_ID_WIDTH	int	8	Transaction ID width
AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	int	32	Address bus width
AXI_DATA_WIDTH	int	32	Data bus width
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	int	AXI_DATA_WIDTH/8	Write strobe width (transport only – the monitor does not inspect strobes)
AXI_USER_WIDTH	int	1	User signal width

24.2.2 Monitor Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
UNIT_ID	logic [7:0]	8'h02	8-bit unit identifier in monitor packets
AGENT_ID	logic [15:0]	16'h0015	16-bit agent identifier in monitor packets
MAX_TRANSACTIONS	int	16	Maximum concurrent outstanding transactions
ACLK_MHZ	int	100	Clock frequency in MHz – keeps the 1 us tick exact off-100MHz
USE_WDATA_ORDER_Q	bit	0	Write-data ordering queue
NUM_BANKS	int	1	Banked transaction tables. **>1 on a WRITE monitor requires `USE_WDATA_ORDER_Q=1`** – `axi_monitor_trans_mgr`

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
			fails elaboration otherwise
ID_FILTER_ENABLE	bit	0	Synthesises the per-instance ID-slice filter
ID_MATCH_BASE	int	0	First ID this instance owns
ID_MATCH_COUNT	int	0	How many; `0` means ALL, so a zeroed register block does not silently filter everything away
`CFI_MIN_FREQ_MHZ` / `CFI_MAX_FREQ_MHZ`	int	= ACLK_MHZ	Freq-invariant counter LUT bounds (`cfg_freq_sel` indexes within them)
`ACTIVE_TRANS_THRESHOLD`	int	MAX_TRANSACTIONS/2	Active-transaction count that trips a threshold packet when `cfg_threshold_enable=1`. Replaces the former hardwired 8/4; threshold packets now scale with the table sizing
`ENABLE_FILTERING`	bit	1	Enable packet filtering: two active drop levels (packet type, then event code). Level 2 is reserved and routes nothing
`ADD_PIPELINE_STAGE`	bit	0	Add register stage for timing closure
`USE_MONITOR`	bit	1	Synthesis-time monitor enable. 0 = omit monitor and tie outputs to safe non-blocking defaults; 1 = full monitor functionality.

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
N_ADDR_RANGES	int	0	Number of address-range comparators. 0 = checker omitted (zero area). >0 = N independent [low, high] ranges; feeds the shared allowlist checker: a debug-range hit -> AddrMatch, an error-allowlist miss -> Error/ADDR_RANGE (see axi_monitor_addr_check.md).
ADDR_RANGE_IS_ERROR	logic [N_ADDR_RANGES-1:0]	'0	Per-range flavor: bit i = 0 -> DEBUG range (hit -> AddrMatch), 1 -> ERROR range (allowlist miss -> Error/ADDR_RANGE). Default all-0 (feature inert).

24.2.3 Synthesis-Cone Parameters

Each detection cone can be compiled out to save area. The classic cones default on; the debug cone defaults off. Setting a bit to 0 drops the corresponding cone at synthesis via a `generate`-if inside `axi_monitor_reporter` – the area saving is real.

Parameter	Type	Default	Effect when 0
ENABLE_ERROR_LOGIC	bit	1	Drop the error-detection cone
ENABLE_TIMEOUT_LOGIC	bit	1	Drop the timeout cone **and** the `axi_monitor_timeout` instance
ENABLE_COMPL_LOGIC	bit	1	Drop the completion cone
ENABLE_THRESHOLD_LOGIC	bit	1	Drop the threshold cone
ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC	bit	1	Gates only the reporter's

Parameter	Type	Default	Effect when 0
			legacy perf-packet cone and the two lifetime counters – the window FSM and meters are unconditional
ENABLE_DEBUG_LOGIC	bit	0	Drop the debug (trace) cone – the 6th reporter sub-block (off by default)

Internally the wrapper hardwires two master switches on its axi_monitor_filtered instance: ENABLE_PERF_PACKETS = 1 (the reporter's legacy perf cone is built; ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC gates THAT cone only, never the measurement window) and ENABLE_DEBUG_MODULE = 0 (debug tracking module omitted). These are not top-level parameters of the wrapper.

The transaction CAM is always pipelined.

24.2.4 Derived Parameters (do not override)

These are declared as parameter so the elaborator can compute them, not so callers can set them. Each defaults to an expression over the parameters above; overriding one desynchronises it from its source and the design fails to elaborate or silently mis-sizes a bus. Set the parameters they are derived FROM and leave these alone.

Derived parameter	Default expression
DW	AXI_DATA_WIDTH
IW	AXI_ID_WIDTH
SW	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH
UW	AXI_USER_WIDTH

24.3 Ports

24.3.1 AXI4 Write Channels

Slave Interface (s_axi_*): - AW channel: awid, awaddr, awlen, awsize, awburst, awlock, awcache, awprot, awqos, awregion, awuser, awvalid, awready - W channel: wdata, wstrb, wlast, wuser, wvalid, wready - B channel: bid, bresp, buser, bvalid, bready

Backend Interface (fub_axi_*): - Same signals as slave, mirrored direction (to memory/backend)

24.3.2 Monitor Configuration

Configuration ports are identical to other AXI4 monitors: - Basic enables: `cfg_monitor_enable` (master runtime gate: 0 = monitor inert, CAM held clear, never stalls the datapath), `cfg_error_enable`, `cfg_timeout_enable`, `cfg_perf_enable`, `cfg_compl_enable` (completion packets), `cfg_threshold_enable` (threshold-crossed packets), `cfg_debug_enable` (debug/trace cone – the 6th reporter sub-block) - Clear: `cam_clear` (Input, 1) - synchronous clear of the monitor transaction CAM (driven from the harness clear control bit, e.g. CTRL[4]) - Thresholds: `cfg_timeout_cycles` (unified coarse timeout, a MICROSECOND count at full 16-bit width: 1..65535 us per phase, 0 = 16'hFFFF ~ effectively never; drives all three phase counts), `cfg_latency_threshold` - Filtering: 8 mask signals (`cfg_axi_*_mask`: pkt, error, timeout, compl, thresh, perf, addr, debug) plus `cfg_axi_err_select` - Performance window control: `cfg_start_event_sel`, `cfg_end_event_sel`, `cfg_start_trigger`, `cfg_end_trigger`, `cfg_window_force_close` (see Performance Monitoring)

> The inner monitor's `cfg_debug_level` (tied to 0), `cfg_debug_mask` (0) are fixed inside the wrapper; `cfg_active_trans_threshold` is driven by the `ACTIVE_TRANS_THRESHOLD` parameter (default MAX_TRANSACTIONS/2), not hardwired to 8, and all three are **not** top-level ports on this module.

24.3.3 Monitor Bus Output

Port	Direction	Width	Description
`monbus_valid`	Output	1	Monitor packet valid
`monbus_ready`	Input	1	Downstream ready to accept packet
`monbus_packet`	Output	128	`monitor_packet_t` (see format below)
`monbus_timestamp`	Output	64	`monbus_timestamp_t` paired atomically with `monbus_packet`
`debug_block_ready`	Output	1	Observability tap for the block_ready gating net (drives nothing internally; leave unconnected if unused)
`i_mon_time`	Input	64	Free-running counter from `monbus_group_core`, sampled at packet emission

24.3.4 Status Outputs

Port	Direction	Width	Description
busy	Output	1	Indicates active transactions (for clock gating)
active_transactions	Output	8	Current number of outstanding transactions
error_count	Output	16	Lifetime count of error+timeout packets actually emitted (reporter perf counter; reads 0 when ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC=0 or USE_MONITOR=0)
transaction_count	Output	32	Lifetime count of completion packets actually emitted (zero-extended 16-bit reporter perf counter; reads 0 when ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC=0 or USE_MONITOR=0)
cfg_conflict_error	Output	1	Configuration conflict detected

24.3.5 Packet filters

Two independent runtime filters cut monbus traffic without touching the datapath. Both are inert until driven, which is the failure to watch for: the build-time parameter only decides whether the logic is SYNTHESISED, and a design that sets the parameter but leaves the cfg_* ports tied low filters nothing and looks like the feature is broken.

Address-range filter — ADDR_FILTER_ENABLE (bit, default 0) builds it.

Port	Width	Description
cfg_addr_filter_enable	1	High: suppress packets for transactions outside

Port	Width	Description
		the window. Low: inert, whatever the parameter says
cfg_addr_filter_low	ADDR_WIDTH	Window base, inclusive
cfg_addr_filter_high	ADDR_WIDTH	Window limit, inclusive

The verdict is latched per table entry at ALLOCATION, from the command address, and held for that entry's life. Widening the window mid-flight does not un-filter entries already admitted — which is exactly what makes it safe to reprogram live, since an entry's fate is decided when it is admitted and the retire accounting cannot be corrupted afterwards. Contrast the address-range CHECKER (N_ADDR_RANGES), which re-evaluates per command.

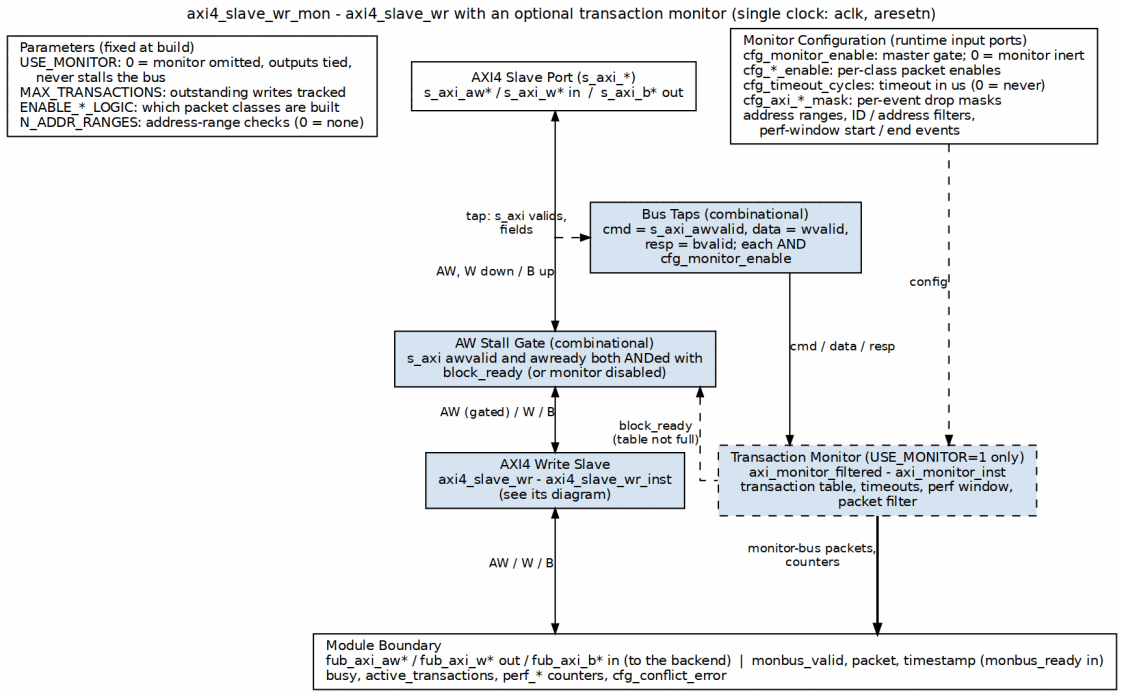
Runtime ID filter — overrides the ID_MATCH_BASE/ID_MATCH_COUNT elaboration constants so an instance can be retargeted at a different master without a rebuild.

Port	Width	Description
cfg_id_filter_enable	1	High: use the window below. Low: use the parameters, bit-identical to a build without this feature
cfg_id_match_base	ID_WIDTH	First ID owned
cfg_id_match_count	ID_WIDTH+1	How many; 0 means ALL, matching the parameter rule so a zeroed register block does not silently filter everything away

The window is half-open: [base, base + count).

24.4 Functional Description

24.4.1 Block diagram



axi4_slave_wr_mon block diagram

AXI traffic runs down the left column: through the AW stall gate, into the base `axi4_slave_wr` (one child box, see its own diagram), and out through the bar. The monitor taps the s_axi side, above the stall gate, gates each valid with `cfg_monitor_enable`, and `axi_monitor_filtered` turns the transactions into monitor-bus packets (the heavy edge). When its transaction table is full, `block_ready` drops and the stall gate holds both awvalid and awready low, so a full table stalls the bus instead of losing events. With `USE_MONITOR=0` the monitor is omitted, its outputs are tied off, and the gate never stalls.

The module instantiates two sub-modules: 1. **axi4_slave_wr** - Core AXI4 slave write functionality with buffering 2. **axi_monitor_filtered** - Transaction monitoring with 2-Level Filtering: packet-type drop masks + per-event masks (err_select is reserved – no routing)

24.4.2 Monitor Backpressure (block_ready)

`block_ready` is exported as the `debug_block_ready` output port – the wrapper deliberately makes the gating contract observable (the `_mon_cg` wrapper ties it off rather than forwarding it). It goes low when the monitor's transaction-table occupancy reaches its blocking threshold (a function of `MAX_TRANSACTIONS`; the reporter FIFO depth `INTR_FIFO_DEPTH` has no path to it). The wrapper ANDs it into the upstream-facing `s_axi_awready` so a saturated monitor throttles new transactions at the handshake instead of dropping events.

- **Where the stall lands**: the upstream `s_axi_awready` is forced low until the monitor drains.
- **When `USE_MONITOR=0`**: `block_ready` is internally tied high, so the wrapper imposes no stall and runs at full bandwidth.
- **When `cfg_monitor_enable=0`**: the wrapper gate forces the upstream ready open, so a runtime-disabled monitor can never stall the datapath (in-RTL formal property `ap_disabled_never_stalls`).

Recovery is guaranteed by the **saturation-recovery contract**: command-originated table entries are capped at `MAX_TRANSACTIONS - cmd_entry_reserve(MAX_TRANSACTIONS)` (reserve = 4 for tables of 16 or more, 0 below; the function lives in `monitor_common_pkg`), and `block_ready` re-asserts at occupancy `< MAX_TRANSACTIONS - (reserve - 1)` – a threshold strictly ABOVE the command cap – so a saturated table always drains back below the reopen point. Blocking throttles; it never deadlocks. Tables smaller than 16 keep full legacy allocation (small tables cannot spare slots) and trade the recovery guarantee for tracking capacity. The contract is verified by in-RTL formal properties (mutation-checked) and a 100-seed deliberately-undersized-table stream sweep; see axi_monitor_base for the canonical description.

Sizing note: a monitor on a bus shared by several channels/requesters must size `MAX_TRANSACTIONS` to cover `NUM_CHANNELS x per-channel outstanding` plus margin – the per-channel limit alone makes the monitor throttle the shared master. Tables deeper than 64 also need Verilator's `--unroll-count` raised (default 64) in sim builds.

24.4.3 Address-Range Checker

With `N_ADDR_RANGES > 0` the wrapper instantiates the shared allowlist checker (`axi_monitor_addr_check`). Each range carries a DEBUG/ERROR flavor:

- **DEBUG range** – a hit emits a `PktTypeAddrMatch` (`4'h8`) packet with event code `AXI_ADDR_RANGE_MATCH` (`8'h01`), gated by `cfg_debug_enable`.
- **ERROR range** – the enabled ERROR ranges form an allowlist; an address in NONE of them emits a `PktTypeError` (`4'h0`) packet with event code `AXI_ERR_ADDR_RANGE` (`8'h0D`), gated by `cfg_error_enable`.

This wrapper exposes **`ADDR_RANGE_IS_ERROR`** (per-range) as a parameter, so ranges can be assigned to either flavor.

Config inputs (active only when `N_ADDR_RANGES > 0`): - `cfg_addr_check_enable` – master on/off for the checker. - `cfg_addr_range_enable[N-1:0]` – per-range enable bit. - `cfg_addr_range_low/high[N-1:0][AXI_ADDR_WIDTH-1:0]` – inclusive bounds.

Event encoding: `event_data[63:60]` = `range_index` (matching DEBUG range, or `4'hF` sentinel on an ERROR miss); `event_data[59:0]` = full address. **Filtering:** AddrMatch is dropped by `cfg_axi_addr_mask[1]`, the ADDR_RANGE error by `cfg_axi_error_mask[13]`. See the checker page for coalescing + formal properties.

24.4.4 Performance Monitoring

The wrapper hardwires `ENABLE_PERF_PACKETS = 1` on its inner `axi_monitor_filtered`. The **measurement-window state machine** and its counters are unconditional `always_ff` blocks in `axi_monitor_base` – outside every generate – so they are present and running in EVERY build, including `ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC = 0`. That parameter reaches one consumer: the `g_perf` generate in `axi_monitor_reporter` holding the legacy perf-packet cone and the two 16-bit lifetime counters behind `perf_completed_count` / `perf_error_count`. Setting it to 0 saves that cone and nothing else. `USE_MONITOR = 0` is what ties the perfmon outputs off. The wrapper instantiates plus a bank of W-data-channel utilization counters. All counters accumulate **only while a window is open** (`window_active = 1`) and hold their values between windows, so the host can read a completed window's totals.

24.4.4.1 The Measurement Window

A window is opened by a **start event** and closed by an **end event**. The event sources are selected by `cfg_start_event_sel` / `cfg_end_event_sel` (3-bit; e.g. `3'b010` selects the `cfg_perf_enable` edge) and can also be fired directly by the `cfg_start_trigger` / `cfg_end_trigger` pulses (from an engine or CSR). `cfg_window_force_close` is a software override that closes the window immediately. While the window is open:

- `window_active` is high.
- `window_cycles[31:0]` free-runs, counting every clock elapsed inside the window.

Sample the counters on the cycle `window_active` falls to 0 (drive `cfg_end_trigger`, or wait for the configured end event).

24.4.4.2 Utilization Counters (W Data Channel)

Every cycle inside the window is classified by the W channel's `wvalid` / `wready` into exactly one of four buckets:

Output	Width	Condition	Meaning
`perf_prod_cycles`	32	wvalid && wready	productive beat transferred
`perf_bp_cycles`	32	wvalid && !wready	back-pressure (data offered, sink not ready)
`perf_starv_cycles`	32	!wvalid && wready	starvation (sink ready, no data)
`perf_idle_cycles`	32	!wvalid && !wready	idle

The four buckets sum to `window_cycles - 1` (the start cycle seeds window_cycles to 1 while the buckets reset to 0); the one-count skew is negligible for long windows.

24.4.4.3 Throughput Counters

Output	Width	Meaning
`perf_beat_count`	32	W data beats transferred (= `perf_prod_cycles`, 1 beat/cycle)
`perf_byte_count`	64	bytes transferred = beats x (1 << AWSIZE), using the AWSIZE captured at the most recent AW address phase (upper bound: counts full-width beats and does not subtract bytes masked off by `WSTRB` on unaligned or partial beats)
`perf_burst_count`	32	AW address-phase handshakes

The integrator computes average burst length as `perf_beat_count / perf_burst_count`.

24.4.4.4 Performance Monitoring Ports

Port	Direction	Width	Description
`cfg_perf_enable`	Input	1	Enable performance-metric packet generation
`cfg_start_event_sel`	Input	3	Window **start** event source select
`cfg_end_event_sel`	Input	3	Window **end** event source select
`cfg_start_trigger`	Input	1	Pulse: open the measurement window
`cfg_end_trigger`	Input	1	Pulse: close the measurement window
`cfg_window_force_close`	Input	1	Software override: force the window closed

Port	Direction	Width	Description
window_active	Output	1	High while a measurement window is open
window_cycles	Output	32	Cycles elapsed in the current window
perf_prod_cycles	Output	32	wvalid && wready cycles
perf_bp_cycles	Output	32	wvalid && !wready cycles (back-pressure)
perf_starv_cycles	Output	32	!wvalid && wready cycles (starvation)
perf_idle_cycles	Output	32	!wvalid && !wready cycles
perf_beat_count	Output	32	W data beats transferred
perf_byte_count	Output	64	bytes transferred
perf_burst_count	Output	32	AW address-phase handshakes

When `USE_MONITOR = 0`, every perfmon output is tied to 0 and the window never opens.

24.4.5 Monitor Packet Format

Identical 128-bit format (with 64-bit side-band timestamp) as other AXI4 monitors. See axi4_master_rd_mon for complete specification.

24.5 Timing Characteristics

Skid parameter	Default depth
SKID_DEPTH_AW	2 entries
SKID_DEPTH_W	4 entries
SKID_DEPTH_B	2 entries

Each channel traverses one `gaxi_skid_buffer`, which registers both `rd_valid` and its storage. The **1-cycle input-to-output latency therefore applies on every transfer, including the unstalled case** – there is no combinational bypass. Depth buys backpressure absorption, not

throughput; full rate is sustained once the pipeline is primed. Legal range is 2..8 inclusive, odd values included.

Clocking: `aclk`, reset `aresetn` (active-low asynchronous).

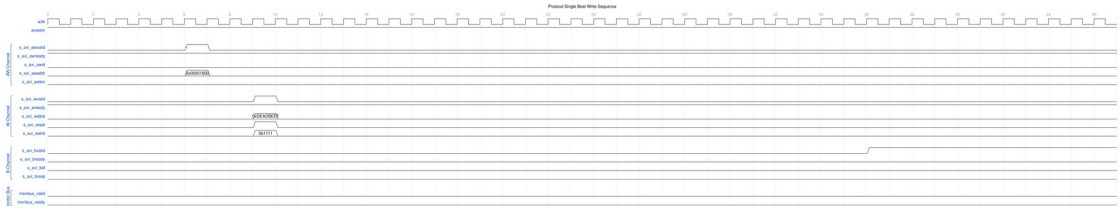
No synthesis numbers are quoted here. Frequency and area depend on the target device and the parameters you elaborate with; run your own build.

24.6 Waveforms

The following waveforms show AXI4 slave write monitor behavior from the slave perspective:

24.6.1 Scenario 1: Single-Beat Write (Slave View)

AXI4 write transaction from slave interface perspective:



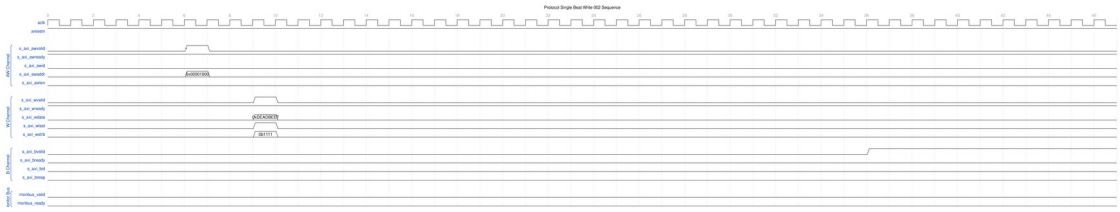
Single Beat Write Slave

WaveJSON: single_beat_write_001.json

Key Observations: - Slave-side AW channel (s_axi_aw*) - Slave-side W channel data (s_axi_w*) - Slave-side B channel response (s_axi_b*) - Monitor packet generation from slave perspective - Slave BRESP status monitoring - Transaction tracking in slave context

24.6.2 Scenario 2: Alternative Single-Beat Write (Slave View)

Variant write transaction with different timing from slave:



Single Beat Write Slave Alt

WaveJSON: single_beat_write_002_001.json

Key Observations: - Slave ready signal behavior - AWREADY backpressure effects - WREADY flow control - BVALID generation timing - Slave latency monitoring - Error detection from slave side

---

24.7 Usage Examples

Every parameter and port below is read from the module declaration.

```
axi4_slave_wr_mon #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AW          (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_W           (4),
    .SKID_DEPTH_B           (2),
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH           (8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH         (32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH         (32),
    .AXI_USER_WIDTH         (1),
    .ACLK_MHZ               (100),
    .USE_MONITOR            (1'b1),
    .N_ADDR_RANGES          (0)
) u_axi4_slave_wr_mon (
    .aclk                   (aclk),
    .aresetn                (aresetn),
    .cam_clear              (cam_clear),
    .s_axi_awid             (s_axi_awid),
    .s_axi_awaddr           (s_axi_awaddr),
    .s_axi_awlen            (s_axi_awlen),
    .s_axi_awsize           (s_axi_awsize),
    .s_axi_awburst          (s_axi_awburst),
    .s_axi_awlock           (s_axi_awlock),
    .s_axi_awcache          (s_axi_awcache),
    .s_axi_awprot           (s_axi_awprot),
    .s_axi_awqos            (s_axi_awqos),
    .s_axi_awregion         (s_axi_awregion),
    .s_axi_awuser           (s_axi_awuser),
    .s_axi_awvalid          (s_axi_awvalid),
    .s_axi_awready          (s_axi_awready),
    .s_axi_wdata            (s_axi_wdata),
    .s_axi_wstrb            (s_axi_wstrb),
    .s_axi_wlast            (s_axi_wlast),
    .s_axi_wuser            (s_axi_wuser),
    .s_axi_wvalid           (s_axi_wvalid),
    .s_axi_wready           (s_axi_wready),
    .s_axi_bid              (s_axi_bid),
    .s_axi_bresp            (s_axi_bresp),
    .s_axi_buser            (s_axi_buser),
    .s_axi_bvalid           (s_axi_bvalid),
    .s_axi_bready           (s_axi_bready),
```

```
    .fub_axi_awid          (fub_axi_awid),
    .fub_axi_awaddr        (fub_axi_awaddr),
    .fub_axi_awlen         (fub_axi_awlen),
    .fub_axi_awsize        (fub_axi_awsize),
    .fub_axi_awburst       (fub_axi_awburst),
    .fub_axi_awlock        (fub_axi_awlock),
    .fub_axi_awcache       (fub_axi_awcache),
    .fub_axi_awprot        (fub_axi_awprot),
    .fub_axi_awqos         (fub_axi_awqos),
    .fub_axi_awregion      (fub_axi_awregion),
    .fub_axi_awuser        (fub_axi_awuser),
    .fub_axi_awvalid       (fub_axi_awvalid),
    .fub_axi_awready       (fub_axi_awready),
    .fub_axi_wdata         (fub_axi_wdata),
    .fub_axi_wstrb         (fub_axi_wstrb),
    .fub_axi_wlast         (fub_axi_wlast),
    .fub_axi_wuser         (fub_axi_wuser),
    .fub_axi_wvalid        (fub_axi_wvalid),
    .fub_axi_wready        (fub_axi_wready),
    .fub_axi_bid           (fub_axi_bid),
    .fub_axi_bresp         (fub_axi_bresp),
    .fub_axi_buser         (fub_axi_buser),
    .fub_axi_bvalid        (fub_axi_bvalid),
    .fub_axi_bready        (fub_axi_bready),
    .cfg_monitor_enable    (cfg_monitor_enable),
    .cfg_error_enable      (cfg_error_enable),
    .cfg_timeout_enable    (cfg_timeout_enable),
    .cfg_perf_enable       (cfg_perf_enable),
    .cfg_compl_enable      (cfg_compl_enable),
    .cfg_threshold_enable  (cfg_threshold_enable),
    .cfg_debug_enable      (cfg_debug_enable),
    .cfg_timeout_cycles    (cfg_timeout_cycles),
    .cfg_freq_sel          (cfg_freq_sel),
    .cfg_latency_threshold (cfg_latency_threshold),
    .cfg_axi_pkt_mask      (cfg_axi_pkt_mask),
    .cfg_axi_err_select    (cfg_axi_err_select),
    .cfg_axi_error_mask    (cfg_axi_error_mask),
    .cfg_axi_timeout_mask  (cfg_axi_timeout_mask),
    .cfg_axi_compl_mask    (cfg_axi_compl_mask),
    .cfg_axi_thresh_mask   (cfg_axi_thresh_mask),
    .cfg_axi_perf_mask     (cfg_axi_perf_mask),
    .cfg_axi_addr_mask     (cfg_axi_addr_mask),
    .cfg_axi_debug_mask    (cfg_axi_debug_mask),
    .cfg_addr_check_enable (cfg_addr_check_enable),
    .cfg_addr_range_enable (cfg_addr_range_enable),
    .cfg_addr_range_low    (cfg_addr_range_low),
    .cfg_addr_range_high   (cfg_addr_range_high),
    .cfg_id_filter_enable  (cfg_id_filter_enable),
```

```
    .cfg_id_match_base     (cfg_id_match_base),
    .cfg_id_match_count    (cfg_id_match_count),
    .cfg_addr_filter_enable(cfg_addr_filter_enable),
    .cfg_addr_filter_low   (cfg_addr_filter_low),
    .cfg_addr_filter_high  (cfg_addr_filter_high),
    .cfg_start_event_sel   (cfg_start_event_sel),
    .cfg_end_event_sel     (cfg_end_event_sel),
    .cfg_start_trigger     (cfg_start_trigger),
    .cfg_end_trigger       (cfg_end_trigger),
    .cfg_window_force_close(cfg_window_force_close),
    .i_mon_time            (i_mon_time),
    .monbus_valid          (monbus_valid),
    .monbus_ready          (monbus_ready),
    .monbus_packet         (monbus_packet),
    .monbus_timestamp      (monbus_timestamp),
    .busy                  (busy),
    .active_transactions   (active_transactions),
    .error_count           (error_count),
    .transaction_count     (transaction_count),
    .debug_block_ready     (debug_block_ready),
    .window_active         (window_active),
    .window_cycles         (window_cycles),
    .perf_prod_cycles      (perf_prod_cycles),
    .perf_bp_cycles        (perf_bp_cycles),
    .perf_starv_cycles     (perf_starv_cycles),
    .perf_idle_cycles      (perf_idle_cycles),
    .perf_beat_count       (perf_beat_count),
    .perf_byte_count       (perf_byte_count),
    .perf_burst_count      (perf_burst_count),
    .cfg_conflict_error    (cfg_conflict_error)
);
```

24.8 Design Notes

24.8.1 Configuration Strategies

24.8.1.1 Strategy 1: Functional Verification (Recommended)

Goal: Catch slave-side write errors

```
// Enable configuration
.cfg_monitor_enable     (1'b1),
.cfg_error_enable       (1'b1),      // Detect SLVERR/DECERR from
backend
.cfg_timeout_enable     (1'b1),      // Detect backend timeouts
.cfg_perf_enable        (1'b0),      // Disable (reduces traffic)

// Filtering - pass error and timeout only
```

```
.cfg_axi_pkt_mask       (16'hFFF6),  // Drop all but ERROR, TIMEOUT
.cfg_axi_error_mask     (16'h0000),  // Pass all errors
.cfg_axi_timeout_mask   (16'h0000),  // Pass all timeouts
.cfg_axi_compl_mask     (16'hFFFF),  // Drop completions
.cfg_axi_perf_mask      (16'hFFFF),  // Drop performance

// Timeouts
.cfg_timeout_cycles     (16'd15),    // 15 microseconds per phase:
allow backend write latency
.cfg_latency_threshold  (32'd1000)
```

24.8.1.2 Strategy 2: Performance Analysis

Goal: Analyze slave write performance

```
// Enable configuration
.cfg_monitor_enable     (1'b1),
.cfg_error_enable       (1'b1),
.cfg_timeout_enable     (1'b0),
.cfg_perf_enable        (1'b1),      // Enable performance metrics

// Filtering - pass error and performance only
.cfg_axi_pkt_mask       (16'hFFEE),  // Drop all but ERROR, PERF (set
bit = drop)
.cfg_axi_error_mask     (16'h0000),  // Pass all errors
.cfg_axi_perf_mask      (16'h0000),  // Pass all performance
.cfg_axi_compl_mask     (16'hFFFF),  // Drop completions
```

24.8.2 Slave-Side Monitoring

Key Differences from Master Monitors: - Monitors from slave perspective (interconnect to backend) - Tracks backend write response latency - Detects backend timeout scenarios - Default UNIT_ID=2, AGENT_ID=21 (distinguishes from master)

Slave Write Sequence: 1. AW channel: Master write address arrives at slave 2. Monitor captures: Address, ID, burst parameters 3. AW forwarded to backend (memory/logic) 4. W channel: Master sends data beats 5. Monitor tracks: Write beat count, WLAST 6. B channel: Backend returns write response 7. Monitor tracks: Response latency, BRESP 8. B forwarded back to master via interconnect

Common Slave Errors Detected: - **Backend timeout:** AW accepted but B never returned - **Write data timeout:** AW accepted but W never completed - **SLVERR:** Slave error (access violation, parity error, write protection) - **DECERR:** Decode error (shouldn't occur at slave, but detected) - (Burst-length mismatch is NOT detected – completion logic only) - **ID corruption:** BID doesn't match tracked AWID - (WSTRB violations are NOT detected – no strobe reaches the monitor)

24.8.3 Performance Considerations

Backend Latency Monitoring: - Tracks AW-to-B response latency - Includes W channel completion time - Configurable timeout threshold - Separate from master-side latency

Typical Timeout Values: - SRAM backend: 100-500 cycles - DDR controller: 1000-5000 cycles - Flash/EEPROM: 10000+ cycles (write operations) - PCIe/external: 10000+ cycles

Write-Specific Timing: - AW-W ordering flexible in AXI4 - Backend may wait for WLAST before responding - B response latency includes W channel completion

24.8.4 Buffer Depth Guidelines

Same as axi4_slave_wr: - **SKID_DEPTH_AW:** 2 (default) - handles interconnect backpressure - **SKID_DEPTH_W:** 4 (default) - buffers burst write data - **SKID_DEPTH_B:** 2 (default) - write responses are single-beat - Increase for high-latency backends or large bursts

24.8.5 Write Transaction Characteristics

Burst Write Monitoring: - Monitors AW channel for address capture - Tracks W channel beats until WLAST - Correlates B channel response with AWID - Completes write data on WLAST or the expected count – no burst-length mismatch event exists - (WSTRB is NOT checked – no strobe signal reaches the monitor)

Performance Impact: - Write bursts more efficient than single writes - Backend may buffer/pipeline write data - A B response before W completion is flagged as a protocol error (EVT_PROTOCOL) – the monitor does not model response reordering - Monitor packets generated per transaction, not per beat

---

24.9 Related Modules

24.9.1 Companion Monitors

- **axi4_master_rd_mon** - AXI4 master read with monitoring
- **axi4_master_wr_mon** - AXI4 master write with monitoring
- **axi4_slave_rd_mon** - AXI4 slave read with monitoring

24.9.2 Base Modules

- **axi4_slave_wr** - Functional AXI4 slave write (without monitoring)
- **axi_monitor_filtered** - Monitoring engine with filtering (monitor/)

24.9.3 Used Components

- **gaxi_skid_buffer** - Elastic buffering

- **axi_monitor_base** - Core monitoring logic (monitor/)
- **axi_monitor_trans_mgr** - Transaction tracking (monitor/)

24.10 Testing

The unit testbench lives at `val/amba/test_axi4_slave_wr_mon.py`, built on the shared AXI4 test framework in `bin/TBClasses/components/axi4/`.

24.11 References

24.11.1 Specifications

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.4.5 “Read and write response structure” (the SLVERR/DECERR codes the monitor reports), ch. A5 “Transaction Identifiers” (per-ID tracking of outstanding transactions), §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the orderings a monitor timeout watches). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.
- Monitor Bus Packet Format: monitor_package_spec.md

24.11.2 Papers and textbooks

- The monitor’s own techniques (transaction table, timeouts, packet filtering) are cited on the AXI Monitor Base page and in the monitor family of the archive.
- Maaref, M. *Architecting and Building High-Speed SoCs*, Packt, 2022, ch. 3 “Basic and Advanced On-Chip Busses and Interconnects” (“AXI bus protocol overview”) – textbook overview of AXI responses and ID ordering (secondary source).
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (protocol specifications are citation only)

24.11.3 Source Code

- RTL: `rtl/amba/axi4/axi4_slave_wr_mon.sv`

24.11.4 Documentation

- Configuration Guide: AXI Monitor Base

- Architecture: rtl-amba Overview
- AXI4 Index: README.md

Last Updated: 2026-07-18

24.12 Navigation

- **<- Back to AXI4 Index**
- **<- Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **<- Back to Main Documentation Index**

25 AXI4 Slave Write Monitor (Clock-Gated)

Module: `axi4_slave_wr_mon_cg.sv` **Base Module:** axi4_slave_wr_mon **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/` (protocol monitors live with their protocol; only the monitor CORE pieces are in `rtl/amba/ocelus/`) **Status:** Production Ready

---

25.1 Overview

This is the **clock-gated variant** of axi4_slave_wr_mon. The base page owns the functional story; this page only covers what changes when the whole monitor sits behind a clock gate.

For complete clock-gating documentation, usage examples, and configuration guidelines, see the Clock-Gated Variants Guide.

The `axi4_slave_wr_mon_cg` module adds power optimization to `axi4_slave_wr_mon` through activity-based clock gating:

- **Same Functionality:** 100% equivalent to base module
- **Power Savings:** traffic-dependent; unmeasured in this repo – treat any percentage as a placeholder until characterized
- **Configurable at runtime:** `cfg_cg_enable` / `cfg_cg_idle_count` (one gate, no domains)
- **Zero Overhead When Disabled:** `cfg_cg_enable=0` bypasses the gate at runtime

---

25.2 Parameters

> A lite-monitor version of this clock-gated wrapper exists as `axi4_slave_wr_monlite_cg`: the same gating logic around `axi4_slave_wr_monlite` instead of `axi4_slave_wr_mon`, about a fifth of the monitor gates.

MOST axi4_slave_wr_mon parameters pass through. As of 2026-09-01 only `ACTIVE_TRANS_THRESHOLD` is NOT forwarded, and that one is harmless: its inner default is `MAX_TRANSACTIONS/2`, computed from the `MAX_TRANSACTIONS` this wrapper DOES forward.

An earlier version of this page listed nine more as unforwarded, which was accurate when written. `ACLK_MHZ`, `CFI_MIN_FREQ_MHZ`, `CFI_MAX_FREQ_MHZ`, `USE_WDATA_ORDER_Q`, `NUM_BANKS` and `ADDR_RANGE_IS_ERROR` were threaded through every `_cg` wrapper on 2026-09-01, and `ID_FILTER_ENABLE` / `ID_MATCH_BASE` / `ID_MATCH_COUNT` the day before. Until then a clock-gated

build could not state its clock frequency, so the 1 us timer tick was pinned to the 100 MHz default and every microsecond-denominated timeout was miscalibrated on any other clock – silently.

Parameter	Default	Description
CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH	4	Width of the idle countdown, sizing cfg_cg_idle_count
USE_MONITOR	1	Synthesis-time monitor enable (forwarded to inner monitor).
N_ADDR_RANGES	0	Number of address-range comparators (forwarded to base module).
ADDR_FILTER_ENABLE	0	Synthesises the address-range report filter. **The parameter only decides whether the logic EXISTS** – a build that sets it and leaves cfg_addr_filter_enable low filters nothing and looks broken.
ID_FILTER_ENABLE	0	Synthesises the ID report filter (see cfg_id_* for the runtime override).
ID_MATCH_BASE	0	First ID this instance owns.
ID_MATCH_COUNT	0	How many IDs; 0 means ALL, so a zeroed register block does not silently filter everything away.
ADD_PIPELINE_STAGE	0	Insert a register stage for timing closure. Costs a cycle of latency. (Add register stage for timing closure)
ENABLE_FILTERING	1	Enable packet filtering: two active drop levels (packet type, then event code). Level 2 is reserved and routes

Parameter	Default	Description
		nothing.
SKID_DEPTH_AW	2	Skid-buffer depth on the AW channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are legal.
SKID_DEPTH_B	2	Skid-buffer depth on the B channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are legal.
SKID_DEPTH_W	4	Skid-buffer depth on the W channel. Legal range 2..8 inclusive; odd depths are legal.
AGENT_ID	16'h0015	Agent identifier emitted in the agent_id field of every monitor packet. Pairs with UNIT_ID to identify the packet source. (16-bit Agent ID for monitor packets)
UNIT_ID	8'h02	Unit identifier emitted in the unit_id field of every monitor packet. Give each monitored interface a distinct value or the packets cannot be told apart at the collector. (8-bit Unit ID for monitor packets)

Gating is controlled by RUNTIME inputs cfg_cg_enable / cfg_cg_idle_count with status outputs cg_gating / cg_idle; ONE amba_clock_gate_ctrl gates the entire inner module. (The ENABLE_CLOCK_GATING / CG_IDLE_CYCLES / CG_GATE_* interface this page once documented never existed.)

Base-module ports are forwarded EXCEPT debug_block_ready, which this wrapper ties off (use the base module for the backpressure tap) – including the full performance-monitoring interface (see Performance Monitoring below). The six ENABLE_*_LOGIC synthesis-cone parameters (ENABLE_ERROR_LOGIC, ENABLE_TIMEOUT_LOGIC, ENABLE_COMPL_LOGIC, ENABLE_THRESHOLD_LOGIC, ENABLE_PERF_LOGIC, ENABLE_DEBUG_LOGIC) and the

cfg_compl_enable / cfg_threshold_enable / cfg_debug_enable control enables are also passed straight through.

25.2.1 Filter configuration (forwarded)

These reach the inner monitor through this wrapper; before 2026-09-01 they did not.

Port	Direction	Width	Description
cfg_addr_filter_enable	Input	1	High: suppress packets for transactions outside the window. Low: inert, whatever ADDR_FILTER_ENABLE says
cfg_addr_filter_low	Input	ADDR_WIDTH	Window base, inclusive
cfg_addr_filter_high	Input	ADDR_WIDTH	Window limit, inclusive
cfg_id_filter_enable	Input	1	High: use the runtime window below instead of the ID_MATCH_* parameters
cfg_id_match_base	Input	ID_WIDTH	First ID to accept
cfg_id_match_count	Input	ID_WIDTH+1	How many; 0 means ALL

Neither filter un-filters entries already admitted to the transaction table, which is what makes changing them at runtime safe.

25.2.2 Derived Parameters (do not override)

These are declared as parameter so the elaborator can compute them, not so callers can set them. Each defaults to an expression over the parameters above; overriding one desynchronises it from its source and the design fails to elaborate or silently mis-sizes a bus. Set the parameters they are derived FROM and leave these alone.

Derived parameter	Default expression
AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	AXI_DATA_WIDTH / 8
DW	AXI_DATA_WIDTH

Derived parameter	Default expression
IW	AXI_ID_WIDTH
SW	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH
UW	AXI_USER_WIDTH

25.3 Ports

Port	Dir	Width	Description
aclk	In	1	
aresetn	In	1	
cam_clear	In	1	sync clear of the monitor trans CAM
s_axi_awid	In	[IW-1:0]	
s_axi_awaddr	In	[AW-1:0]	
s_axi_awlen	In	[7:0]	
s_axi_awsize	In	[2:0]	
s_axi_awburst	In	[1:0]	
s_axi_awlock	In	1	
s_axi_awcache	In	[3:0]	
s_axi_awprot	In	[2:0]	
s_axi_awqos	In	[3:0]	
s_axi_awregion	In	[3:0]	
s_axi_awuser	In	[UW-1:0]	
s_axi_awvalid	In	1	
s_axi_awready	Out	1	
s_axi_wdata	In	[DW-1:0]	
s_axi_wstrb	In	[SW-1:0]	
s_axi_wlast	In	1	
s_axi_wuser	In	[UW-1:0]	
s_axi_wvalid	In	1	
s_axi_wready	Out	1	
s_axi_bid	Out	[IW-1:0]	

Port	Dir	Width	Description
s_axi_bresp	Out	[1:0]	
s_axi_buser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
s_axi_bvalid	Out	1	
s_axi_bready	In	1	
fub_axi_awid	Out	[IW-1:0]	
fub_axi_awaddr	Out	[AW-1:0]	
fub_axi_awlen	Out	[7:0]	
fub_axi_awsize	Out	[2:0]	
fub_axi_awburst	Out	[1:0]	
fub_axi_awlock	Out	1	
fub_axi_awcache	Out	[3:0]	
fub_axi_awprot	Out	[2:0]	
fub_axi_awqos	Out	[3:0]	
fub_axi_awregion	Out	[3:0]	
fub_axi_awuser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_awvalid	Out	1	
fub_axi_awready	In	1	
fub_axi_wdata	Out	[DW-1:0]	
fub_axi_wstrb	Out	[SW-1:0]	
fub_axi_wlast	Out	1	
fub_axi_wuser	Out	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_wvalid	Out	1	
fub_axi_wready	In	1	
fub_axi_bid	In	[IW-1:0]	
fub_axi_bresp	In	[1:0]	
fub_axi_buser	In	[UW-1:0]	
fub_axi_bvalid	In	1	
fub_axi_bready	Out	1	
cfg_monitor_enable	In	1	Enable monitoring

Port	Dir	Width	Description
cfg_error_enable	In	1	Enable error detection
cfg_timeout_enable	In	1	Enable timeout detection
cfg_perf_enable	In	1	Enable performance monitoring
cfg_compl_enable	In	1	Enable completion packets
cfg_threshold_enable	In	1	Enable threshold packets
cfg_debug_enable	In	1	Enable debug packets
cfg_timeout_cycles	In	[15:0]	Timeout threshold in MICROSECONDS (1 us tick), despite the name
cfg_freq_sel	In	[3:0]	counter_freq_invariant LUT index
cfg_latency_threshold	In	[31:0]	Latency threshold for alerts
cfg_axi_pkt_mask	In	[15:0]	Drop mask for packet types
cfg_axi_err_select	In	[15:0]	Error select for packet types (for future routing)
cfg_axi_error_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual error event mask
cfg_axi_timeout_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual timeout event mask
cfg_axi_compl_ma	In	[15:0]	Individual

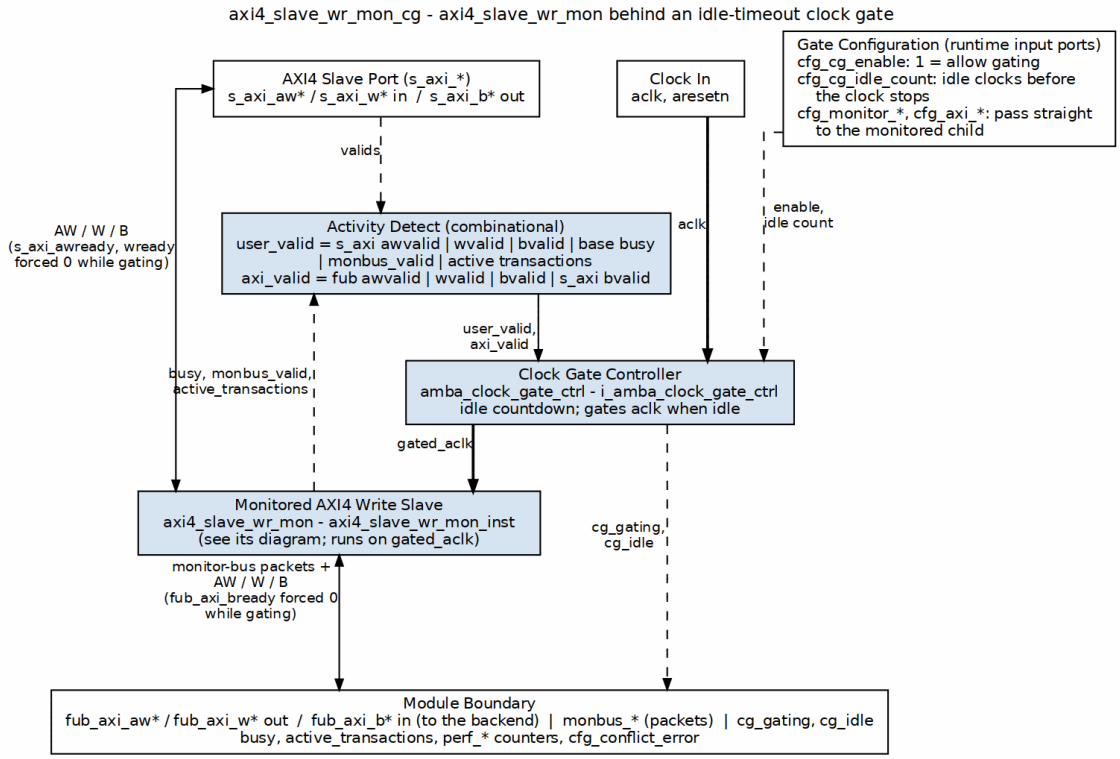
Port	Dir	Width	Description
sk			completion event mask
cfg_axi_thresh_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual threshold event mask
cfg_axi_perf_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual performance event mask
cfg_axi_addr_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual address match event mask
cfg_axi_debug_mask	In	[15:0]	Individual debug event mask
cfg_cg_enable	In	1	Enable clock gating
cfg_cg_idle_count	In	[CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH-1:0]	Idle cycles before gating
cfg_addr_check_enable	In	1	
cfg_addr_range_enable	In	[(N_ADDR_RANGES > 0 ? N_ADDR_RANGES : 1)-1:0]	
cfg_addr_range_low	In	[(N_ADDR_RANGES > 0 ? N_ADDR_RANGES : 1)-1:0]	
cfg_addr_range_high	In	[(N_ADDR_RANGES > 0 ? N_ADDR_RANGES : 1)-1:0]	
cfg_addr_filter_enable	In	1	
cfg_addr_filter_low	In	[AW-1:0]	
cfg_addr_filter_high	In	[AW-1:0]	
cfg_id_filter_en	In	1	

Port	Dir	Width	Description
able			
cfg_id_match_base	In	[IW-1:0]	
cfg_id_match_count	In	[IW:0]	
i_mon_time	In	1	
monbus_valid	Out	1	Monitor bus valid
monbus_ready	In	1	Monitor bus ready
monbus_packet	Out	1	Monitor packet (128-bit)
monbus_timestamp	Out	1	Side-band sampled time
busy	Out	1	
active_transactions	Out	[7:0]	Number of active transactions
error_count	Out	[15:0]	Total error count
transaction_count	Out	[31:0]	Total transaction count
cg_gating	Out	1	Gated clock is stopped
cg_idle	Out	1	No activity observed
cfg_conflict_error	Out	1	Configuration conflict detected
cfg_start_event_sel	In	[2:0]	
cfg_end_event_sel	In	[2:0]	
cfg_start_trigger	In	1	
cfg_end_trigger	In	1	
cfg_window_force_close	In	1	
window_active	Out	1	
window_cycles	Out	[31:0]	

Port	Dir	Width	Description
perf_prod_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_bp_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_starv_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_idle_cycles	Out	[31:0]	
perf_beat_count	Out	[31:0]	
perf_byte_count	Out	[63:0]	
perf_burst_count	Out	[31:0]	

25.4 Functional Description

25.4.1 Block diagram



axi4_slave_wr_mon_cg block diagram

This is the `_cg` pattern wrapped around `axi4_slave_wr_mon` (one child box, see its own diagram): the heavy `aclk` column runs through `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` into the monitored child as `gated_aclk`. The activity term adds `monbus_valid` and any active transactions to the usual valids and `busy`, so the clock cannot stop with a monitor packet or an open transaction in

flight. The `cfg_monitor_*` and `cfg_axi_*` ports pass straight through to the child; the outward readies are forced to 0 while gating.

25.4.2 Performance Monitoring

The clock-gated wrapper exposes the full perfmon interface of the base module and **forwards every port unchanged** to the inner `axi4_slave_wr_mon`. The measurement-window state machine, the four W-channel utilization buckets (productive / back-pressure / starvation / idle), and the beat/byte/burst throughput counters behave exactly as documented in the base module – see Performance Monitoring in axi4_slave_wr_mon for the full narrative and per-bit semantics.

Forwarded perfmon ports (identical width and direction to the base module):

- **Inputs:** `cfg_perf_enable`, `cfg_start_event_sel` (3), `cfg_end_event_sel` (3), `cfg_start_trigger`, `cfg_end_trigger`, `cfg_window_force_close`
- **Outputs:** `window_active`, `window_cycles` (32), `perf_prod_cycles` (32), `perf_bp_cycles` (32), `perf_starv_cycles` (32), `perf_idle_cycles` (32), `perf_beat_count` (32), `perf_byte_count` (64), `perf_burst_count` (32)

The `perf_burst_count` output tracks AW (write address) handshakes. **WARNING – gating vs window accounting:** an open measurement window is NOT a wake term, and the entire inner monitor (window state machine and counters included) runs on the gated clock. If the bus idles past `cfg_cg_idle_count` with a window open, the counters FREEZE while wall-clock time passes, and trigger pulses arriving while gated are DROPPED. For exact wall-clock windows or idle-bus triggering, hold `cfg_cg_enable` low around the measurement, or use the base module.

25.5 Timing Characteristics

Skid parameter	Default depth
`SKID_DEPTH_AW`	2 entries
`SKID_DEPTH_W`	4 entries
`SKID_DEPTH_B`	2 entries

Each channel traverses one `gaxi_skid_buffer`, which registers both `rd_valid` and its storage. The **1-cycle input-to-output latency therefore applies on every transfer, including the unstalled case** – there is no combinational bypass. Depth buys backpressure absorption, not throughput; full rate is sustained once the pipeline is primed. Legal range is 2..8 inclusive, odd values included.

Clocking: `aclk`, reset `aresetn` (active-low asynchronous).

No synthesis numbers are quoted here. Frequency and area depend on the target device and the parameters you elaborate with; run your own build.

25.6 Usage Examples

```
axi4_slave_wr_mon_cg #(
    // Base module parameters (see axi4_slave_wr_mon.md)
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH(8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH(32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH(64),

    .CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH(4)
) u_cg (
    .aclk(clk),
    .aresetn(rst_n),
    .cfg_cg_enable(1'b1),
    .cfg_cg_idle_count(4'd8),
    .cg_gating(), .cg_idle(),
    // ... all other ports same as axi4_slave_wr_mon (except
debug_block_ready)
);
```

25.7 Design Notes

A peer's READY must never enter the activity term. A consumer that parks its response-ready high while idle is behaving correctly; folding that signal into `user_valid` pins this block permanently awake and defeats gating entirely – silently, because function is unaffected. Ten wrappers in this repository shipped that way and nothing failed until someone measured. `val/amba/test_cg_peer_ready.py` parks the peer READY high, holds every VALID low, and requires `cg_gating`. Canonical rule: `vault/handbook/design/clock-gating-activity-terms.md`.

`cfg_cg_enable` is not a kill switch. It arms gating and reaches `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` only; the datapath and any monitor enables are forwarded untouched. With it low the clock free-runs and this module behaves exactly like its base.

Gating latency. The clock stops `cfg_cg_idle_count` + 2 cycles after the last bus activity – the idle counter, plus one for the `r_wakeup` flop. Size the idle count against your traffic's inter-burst gap: too small and the block wakes constantly, too large and it never gates.

Cost. Five flops: `r_wakeup` plus `r_idle_counter` at `IDLE_CNTR_WIDTH`, scaling as 1 + `CG_IDLE_COUNT_WIDTH`. The ICG itself is a latch or BUFGCE, not fabric flops.

25.8 Related Modules

- **Base Module Functionality:** axi4_slave_wr_mon.md
- **Clock Gating Guide:** clock_gated_variants.md
- **Detailed CG Examples:**
  - axi4_master_rd_mon_cg.md (AXI4 monitor)
  - axil4_master_rd_mon_cg.md (AXIL4 monitor)
  - apb4_slave_cg.md (APB interface)

25.9 Testing

`val/amba/test_axi4_slave_wr_mon_cg.py` exercises this module. It collects 3 parameter cases at the default `REG_LEVEL`.

```
source env_python
pytest val/amba/test_axi4_slave_wr_mon_cg.py -v
```

25.10 References

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.4.5 “Read and write response structure” (the SLVERR/DECERR codes the monitor reports), ch. A5 “Transaction Identifiers” (per-ID tracking of outstanding transactions), §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the orderings a monitor timeout watches). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.
- Benini, L., De Micheli, G. “Automatic Synthesis of Low-Power Gated-Clock Finite-State Machines.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 15(6), June 1996. DOI: 10.1109/43.503933 – the latch-based clock-gating cell (`icg`, via `amba_clock_gate_ctrl` and `clock_gate_ctrl`) that gates this wrapper’s clock.
- Benini, L., Bogliolo, A., De Micheli, G. “A Survey of Design Techniques for System-Level Dynamic Power Management.” *IEEE Trans. VLSI Systems*, 8(3), June 2000. DOI: 10.1109/92.845896 – fixed-timeout shutdown: gate after `cfg_cg_idle_count` idle cycles, wake on activity.
- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – AXI4 has no

wake-up signal. AXI5 adds AWAKEUP (Issue H §E1.7 “Wake-up Signaling”; Issue L §A14.1.1), which lets a manager restart a gated interface before VALID. This wrapper wakes on the flopped OR of the VALIDs and holds READY low while gated.

- The monitor’s own techniques are cited on the AXI Monitor Base page and in the monitor family of the archive.
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF, archived under `rtl/common/references/`: `LatchBasedClockGating__Benini1996.pdf`, `DynamicPowerManagementTimeout__Benini2000.pdf`)

25.11 Navigation

- **<- Back to AXI4 Index**
- **<- Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **<- Back to Main Documentation Index**

26 AXI4 Slave Write Stub

Module: `axi4_slave_wr_stub.sv` **Location:** `rtl/amba/axi4/stubs/` **Status:** Production Ready

26.1 Overview

The AXI4 Slave Write Stub gives you a simplified packed-data interface on the receiving end of AXI4 write transactions. Skid buffers pack and unpack the AW (write address), W (write data), and B (write response) channels into simple packet interfaces, which makes it a natural fit for testbenches and integration scenarios where you want a slave without the protocol ceremony.

26.1.1 Key Features

- Packed packet interface for AW, W, and B channels
- Configurable skid buffer depths for each channel
- Full AXI4 write transaction support
- Burst, ID, strobe, user signal support
- Parameterized data widths

26.2 Parameters

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
`SKID_DEPTH_AW`	int	2	AW channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
`SKID_DEPTH_W`	int	4	W channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
`SKID_DEPTH_B`	int	2	B channel skid buffer depth in entries (2..8 inclusive, any integer)
`AXI_ID_WIDTH`	int	8	AXI transaction ID width
`AXI_ADDR_WIDTH`	int	32	AXI address bus width
`AXI_DATA_WIDTH`	int	32	AXI data bus width
`AXI_USER_WIDTH`	int	1	AXI user signal width
`AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH`	int	AXI_DATA_WID	Write strobe width

Parameter	Type	Default	Description
		TH/8	
AW	int	AXI_ADDR_WIDTH	Short alias for address width
DW	int	AXI_DATA_WIDTH	Short alias for data width
IW	int	AXI_ID_WIDTH	Short alias for ID width
SW	int	AXI_WSTRB_WIDTH	Short alias for strobe width
UW	int	AXI_USER_WIDTH	Short alias for user width
AWSize	int	IW+AW+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+UW	AW packet size (calculated)
WSize	int	DW+SW+1+UW	W packet size (calculated)
BSize	int	IW+2+UW	B packet size (calculated)

26.3 Ports

26.3.1 Clock and Reset

Port	Direction	Width	Description
aclk	Input	1	AXI clock
aresetn	Input	1	AXI reset (active low)

26.3.2 AXI4 Write Address Channel (AW)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
s_axi_awid	Input	IW	Write address ID
s_axi_awaddr	Input	AW	Write address
s_axi_awlen	Input	8	Burst length
s_axi_awsize	Input	3	Burst size
s_axi_awburst	Input	2	Burst type

Port	Direction	Width	Description
s_axi_awlock	Input	1	Lock type
s_axi_awcache	Input	4	Cache type
s_axi_awprot	Input	3	Protection type
s_axi_awqos	Input	4	Quality of service
s_axi_awregion	Input	4	Region identifier
s_axi_awuser	Input	UW	User signal
s_axi_awvalid	Input	1	Write address valid
s_axi_awready	Output	1	Write address ready

26.3.3 AXI4 Write Data Channel (W)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
s_axi_wdata	Input	DW	Write data
s_axi_wstrb	Input	SW	Write strobes
s_axi_wlast	Input	1	Write last
s_axi_wuser	Input	UW	User signal
s_axi_wvalid	Input	1	Write data valid
s_axi_wready	Output	1	Write data ready

26.3.4 AXI4 Write Response Channel (B)

Port	Direction	Width	Description
s_axi_bid	Output	IW	Response ID
s_axi_bresp	Output	2	Write response
s_axi_buser	Output	UW	User signal
s_axi_bvalid	Output	1	Write response valid
s_axi_bready	Input	1	Write response ready

26.3.5 AW Packet Interface

Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_awvalid	Output	1	AW packet valid
fub_axi_awready	Input	1	Ready to accept AW packet
fub_axi_aw_count	Output	4	AW buffer occupancy
fub_axi_aw_pkt	Output	AWSize	Packed AW packet data

26.3.6 W Packet Interface

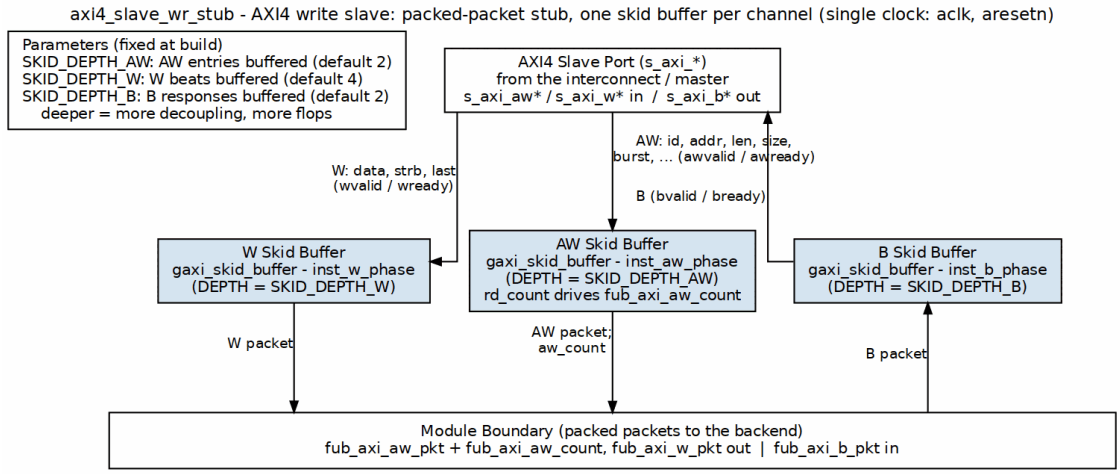
Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_wvalid	Output	1	W packet valid
fub_axi_wready	Input	1	Ready to accept W packet
fub_axi_w_pkt	Output	WSize	Packed W packet data

26.3.7 B Packet Interface

Port	Direction	Width	Description
fub_axi_bvalid	Input	1	B packet valid
fub_axi_bready	Output	1	Ready to accept B packet
fub_axi_b_pkt	Input	BSize	Packed B packet data

26.4 Functional Description

26.4.1 Block diagram



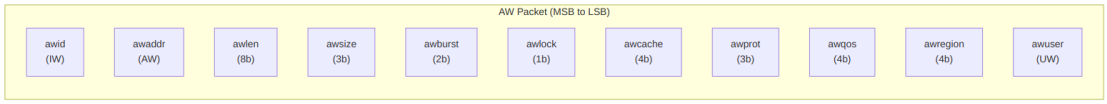
axi4_slave_wr_stub block diagram

This stub is `axi4_slave_wr` with a packed-packet interface at the bottom, toward the backend: each channel's fields travel as one packet (`*_pkt`) through its own `gaxi_skid_buffer` (`inst_*_phase`), and are unpacked onto, or packed from, the AXI4 fields at the other side. The AW buffer's occupancy is exported as `fub_axi_aw_count`. There is no busy output and no clock gating.

26.4.2 Architecture

One skid buffer per channel, packets in and out the other side – that's the whole trick (see the block diagram above).

26.4.3 Packet Formats

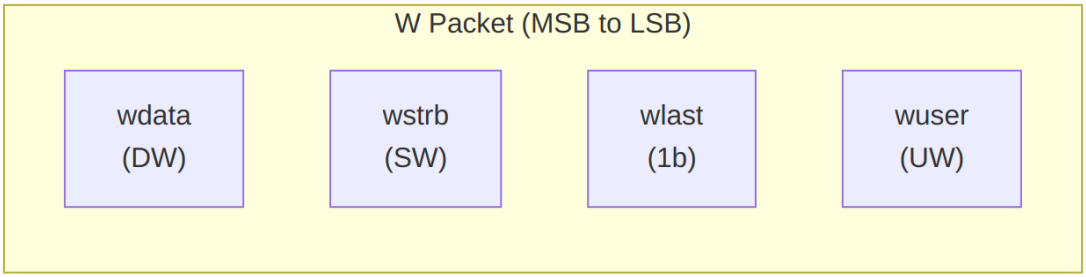


AW Packet Structure (Write Address)

Bit Positions:

```
fub_axi_aw_pkt = {awid, awaddr, awlen, awsize, awburst, awlock,
awcache, awprot, awqos, awregion, awuser}

Width = IW + AW + 8 + 3 + 2 + 1 + 4 + 3 + 4 + 4 + UW
```

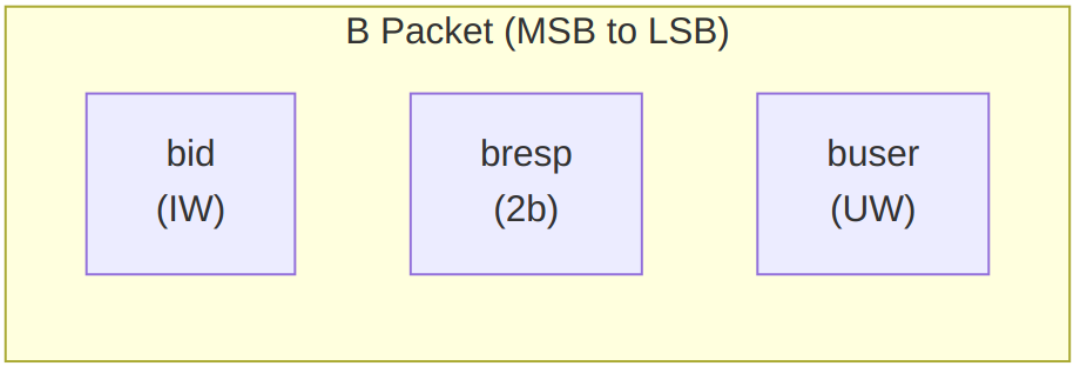


W Packet Structure (Write Data)

Bit Positions:

```
fub_axi_w_pkt = {wdata, wstrb, wlast, wuser}
```

```
Width = DW + SW + 1 + UW
```

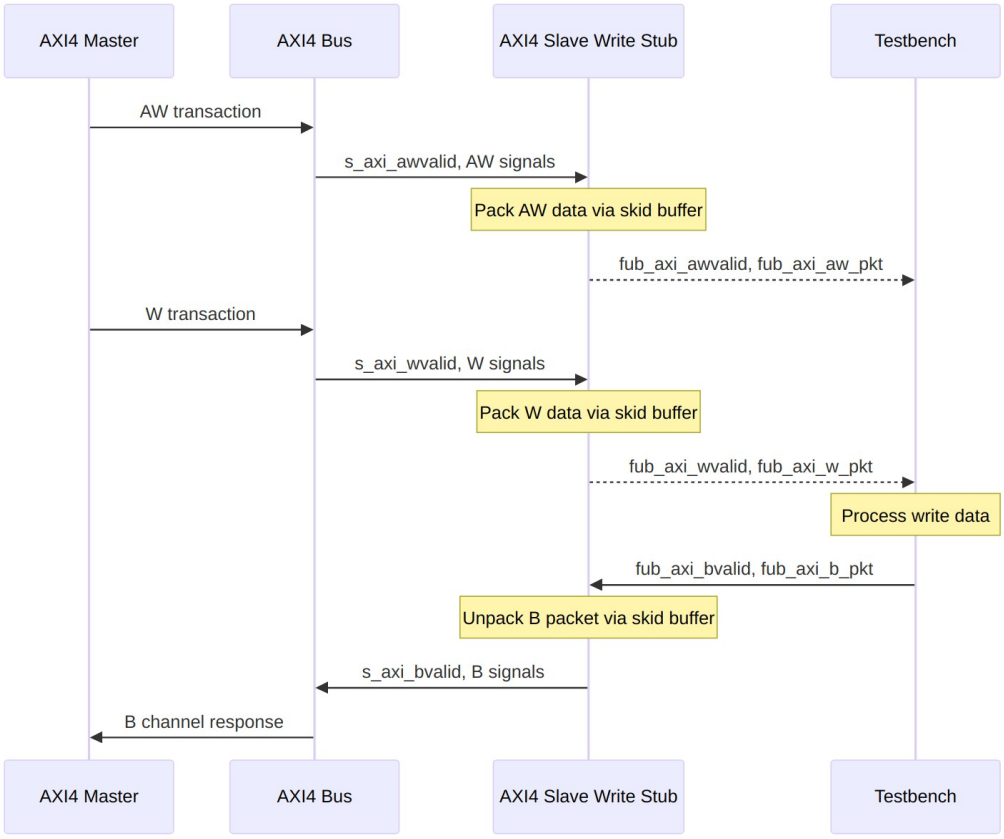


B Packet Structure (Write Response)

Bit Positions:

```
fub_axi_b_pkt = {bid, bresp, buser}
```

```
Width = IW + 2 + UW
```



Transaction Flow

26.5 Timing Characteristics

Timing diagram pending. The signals and sequence this scenario exercises:

- aclk
- AXI AW signals (s_axi_awvalid, s_axi_awaddr, s_axi_awlen, etc.)
- fub_axi_awvalid, fub_axi_awready, fub_axi_aw_pkt
- AXI W signals (s_axi_wvalid, s_axi_wdata, s_axi_wstrb, s_axi_wlast, etc.)
- fub_axi_wvalid, fub_axi_wready, fub_axi_w_pkt
- fub_axi_bvalid, fub_axi_bready, fub_axi_b_pkt
- AXI B signals (s_axi_bvalid, s_axi_bid, s_axi_bresp, etc.)
- Packet-to-AXI timing relationship with skid buffer operation

26.6 Usage Examples

Same pattern as the combined stub: instantiate, parse packets MSB-first, and drive responses back as packed words. The localparams have to match your instance widths.

```
axi4_slave_wr_stub #(
    .SKID_DEPTH_AW   (2),
    .SKID_DEPTH_W    (4),
    .SKID_DEPTH_B    (2),
    .AXI_ID_WIDTH    (8),
    .AXI_ADDR_WIDTH  (32),
    .AXI_DATA_WIDTH  (64),
    .AXI_USER_WIDTH  (4)
) u_axi4_slave_wr_stub (
    .aclk            (axi_clk),
    .aresetn         (axi_rst_n),

    // AXI4 slave write interface
    .s_axi_awid      (s_axi_awid),
    .s_axi_awaddr    (s_axi_awaddr),
    .s_axi_awlen     (s_axi_awlen),
    .s_axi_awsize    (s_axi_awsize),
    .s_axi_awburst   (s_axi_awburst),
    .s_axi_awlock    (s_axi_awlock),
    .s_axi_awcache   (s_axi_awcache),
    .s_axi_awprot    (s_axi_awprot),
    .s_axi_awqos     (s_axi_awqos),
    .s_axi_awregion  (s_axi_awregion),
    .s_axi_awuser    (s_axi_awuser),
    .s_axi_awvalid   (s_axi_awvalid),
    .s_axi_awready   (s_axi_awready),

    .s_axi_wdata     (s_axi_wdata),
    .s_axi_wstrb     (s_axi_wstrb),
    .s_axi_wlast     (s_axi_wlast),
    .s_axi_wuser     (s_axi_wuser),
    .s_axi_wvalid    (s_axi_wvalid),
    .s_axi_wready    (s_axi_wready),

    .s_axi_bid       (s_axi_bid),
    .s_axi_bresp     (s_axi_bresp),
    .s_axi_buser     (s_axi_buser),
    .s_axi_bvalid    (s_axi_bvalid),
    .s_axi_bready    (s_axi_bready),

    // Packed AW interface
    .fub_axi_awvalid (tb_aw_valid),
```

```
    .fub_axi_awready (tb_aw_ready),
    .fub_axi_aw_count(tb_aw_count),
    .fub_axi_aw_pkt  (tb_aw_pkt),

    // Packed W interface
    .fub_axi_wvalid  (tb_w_valid),
    .fub_axi_wready  (tb_w_ready),
    .fub_axi_w_pkt   (tb_w_pkt),

    // Packed B interface
    .fub_axi_bvalid  (tb_b_valid),
    .fub_axi_bready  (tb_b_ready),
    .fub_axi_b_pkt   (tb_b_pkt)
);

// Parse AW packet
localparam int AWSize = 8+32+8+3+2+1+4+3+4+4+4;  // match your
instance widths
wire [7:0]  aw_id     = tb_aw_pkt[AWSize-1:AWSize-8];
wire [31:0] aw_addr   = tb_aw_pkt[AWSize-9:AWSize-40];
wire [7:0]  aw_len    = tb_aw_pkt[AWSize-41:AWSize-48];
wire [2:0]  aw_size   = tb_aw_pkt[AWSize-49:AWSize-51];
wire [1:0]  aw_burst  = tb_aw_pkt[AWSize-52:AWSize-53];
// ... additional fields as needed

// Parse W packet
localparam int WSize = 64+8+1+4;  // match your instance widths
wire [63:0] w_data = tb_w_pkt[WSize-1:WSize-64];
wire [7:0]  w_strb = tb_w_pkt[WSize-65:WSize-72];
wire        w_last = tb_w_pkt[WSize-73];
wire [3:0]  w_user = tb_w_pkt[3:0];

// Build B packet (OKAY response)
localparam BSize = 8 + 2 + 4;  // Calculate size
assign tb_b_pkt = {
    aw_id,    // bid (match request ID)
    2'b00,    // bresp (OKAY)
    4'h0      // buser
};
```

26.7 Design Notes

26.7.1 Skid Buffer Operation

The stub uses `gaxi_skid_buffer` modules to: - Decouple timing between AXI bus and testbench - Provide configurable buffering depth per channel - Handle backpressure gracefully - Support burst transactions without stalling

Recommended Depths: - **AW Channel:** 2-4 (address transactions) - **W Channel:** 4-8 (data beats for bursts) - **B Channel:** 2-4 (responses)

26.7.2 Channel Independence

The AW, W, and B channels are independent: - AW and W arrive in any order from master - Stub handles proper AXI timing - B responses generated asynchronously by testbench

26.7.3 Packet Packing Order

AW, W, and B packets are packed MSB-to-LSB following AXI signal order: - Simplifies testbench packet parsing - Matches common concatenation order - Efficient for burst transaction handling

26.7.4 Internal Architecture

The stub instantiates three `gaxi_skid_buffer` modules: - **AW Skid Buffer:** Packs AXI AW channel to AW packets - **W Skid Buffer:** Packs AXI W channel to W packets - **B Skid Buffer:** Unpacks B packets to AXI B channel

All AXI protocol handling is done by the skid buffers and upstream modules.

26.8 Related Modules

- **AXI4 Slave Write** - Full AXI4 slave write module (if wrapping one)
- **AXI4 Slave Read Stub** - Corresponding read stub
- **AXI4 Slave Stub** - Combined read/write stub
- **AXI4 Master Write Stub** - Master-side write stub

26.9 Testing

No dedicated testbench, and none is expected. This is a stub: a tie-off shell that presents the interface and drives inert values, so there is no behaviour to verify beyond elaboration. `make verilator` lints it as its own top on every run, which is the coverage that applies.

Treat any behaviour described on this page as unverified by simulation.

26.10 References

- Arm. *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022, Issue H, Mar. 2020. developer.arm.com/documentation/ihi0022/h – §A3.2.1 “Handshake process” and §A3.3.1 “Dependencies between channel handshake signals” (the per-channel VALID/READY contract each skid buffer preserves); §A1.2.3 “Register slices” and §A3.1.1 “Clock” (a register stage may sit in any channel for one cycle of latency, and an interface must have no combinational input-to-output path, which a slice breaks). Issue H is the last issue that defines the AXI4 interface.
- Carloni, L.P., McMillan, K.L., Sangiovanni-Vincentelli, A.L. “Theory of Latency-Insensitive Design.” *IEEE Trans. Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems*, 20(9), Sept. 2001. DOI: 10.1109/43.945302 – relay stations: a channel can be pipelined by any number of back-pressured stages without changing its behavior, which is why a skid buffer per channel is transparent to both ends.
- Cortadella, J., Kishinevsky, M., Grundmann, B. “Synthesis of Synchronous Elastic Architectures.” *Proc. 43rd Design Automation Conference (DAC ’06)*, July 2006, pp. 657-662. DOI: 10.1145/1146909.1147077 – the elastic buffer with valid/stop back-pressure, the structure a skid buffer implements.
- Chipressian. *Crack the Hardware Interview: from RTL Designers’ Perspective*, Part 2 ch. 2 “Handshake Protocols” (forward and backward register slices) – textbook treatment of the valid/ready slice; the backward slice’s extra data register is the skid entry (secondary source).
- Maaref, M. *Architecting and Building High-Speed SoCs*, Packt, 2022, ch. 3 “Basic and Advanced On-Chip Busses and Interconnects” (“AXI bus protocol overview”) – textbook overview of the AXI channels, bursts and ID ordering (secondary source).
- Indexed in `rtl/amba/references/README.md` (local PDF: `LatencyInsensitiveDesign__Carloni2001.pdf`, `ElasticBuffer__Cortadella2006.pdf`)

26.11 Navigation

- **<- Back to AXI4 Index**
- **<- Back to rtl-amba Index**
- **<- Back to Main Documentation Index**